

The Gospel according to Matthew

Matthew 1

THE GENEALOGY OF JESUS THE MESSIAH

1 An account^a of the genealogy^b of Jesus the Messiah,^c the son of David, the son of Abraham.*

2 Abraham was the father of Isaac, and Isaac the father of Jacob, and Jacob the father of Judah and his brothers,*³ and Judah the father of Perez and Zerah by Tamar, and Perez the father of Hezron, and Hezron the father of Aram,*⁴ and Aram the father of Aminadab, and Aminadab the father of Nahshon, and Nahshon the father of Salmon,⁵ and Salmon the father of Boaz by Rahab, and Boaz the father of Obed by Ruth, and Obed the father of Jesse,⁶ and Jesse the father of King David.

And David was the father of Solomon by the wife of Uriah,*⁷ and Solomon the father of Rehoboam, and Rehoboam the father of Abijah, and Abijah the father of Asaph,^{d,*}⁸ and Asaph^e the father of Jehoshaphat, and Jehoshaphat the father of Joram, and Joram the father of Uzziah,⁹ and Uzziah the father of Jotham, and Jotham the father of Ahaz, and Ahaz the father of Hezekiah,¹⁰ and Hezekiah the father of Manasseh, and Manasseh the father of Amos,^f and Amos^g the father of Josiah,*¹¹ and Josiah the father of Jechoniah and his brothers, at the time of the deportation to Babylon.*

12 And after the deportation to Babylon: Jechoniah was the father of Salathiel, and Salathiel the father of Zerubbabel,*¹³ and Zerubbabel the father of Abiud, and Abiud the father of Eliakim, and Eliakim the father of Azor,¹⁴ and Azor the father of Zadok, and Zadok the father of Achim, and Achim the father of Eliud,¹⁵ and Eliud the father of Eleazar, and Eleazar the father of Matthan, and Matthan the father of Jacob,¹⁶ and Jacob the father of Joseph the husband of Mary, who bore Jesus, who is called the Messiah.^{h,*}

17 So all the generations from Abraham to David are fourteen generations; and from David to the deportation to Babylon, fourteen generations; and from the deportation to Babylon to the Messiah,ⁱ fourteen generations.

THE BIRTH OF JESUS THE MESSIAH

18 Now the birth of Jesus the Messiah^j took place in this way. When his mother Mary had been engaged to Joseph, but before they lived together, she was found to be pregnant from the Holy Spirit.* ¹⁹Her husband Joseph, being a righteous man and unwilling to expose her to public disgrace, planned to divorce her quietly.* ²⁰But just when he had resolved to do this, an angel of the Lord appeared to him in a dream and said, “Joseph, son of David, do not be afraid to take Mary as your wife, for the child conceived in her is from the Holy Spirit. ²¹She will bear a son, and you are to name him Jesus, for he will save his people from their sins.”* ²²All this took place to fulfill what had been spoken by the Lord through the prophet:

²³“Look, the virgin shall become pregnant and give birth to a son,
and they shall name him Emmanuel,”

which means, “God is with us.”* ²⁴When Joseph awoke from sleep, he did as the angel of the Lord commanded him; he took her as his wife ²⁵but had no marital relations with her until she had given birth to a son,^k and he named him Jesus.*

Matthew 2

THE VISIT OF THE MAGI

1 In the time of King Herod, after Jesus was born in Bethlehem of Judea, magi¹ from the east came to Jerusalem,* ²asking, “Where is the child who has been born king of the Jews? For we observed his star in the east^m and have come to pay him homage.”* ³When King Herod heard this, he was frightened, and all Jerusalem with him, ⁴and calling together all the chief priests and scribes of the people, he inquired of them where the Messiahⁿ was to be born. ⁵They told him, “In Bethlehem of Judea, for so it has been written by the prophet:*

⁶‘And you, Bethlehem, in the land of Judah,
are by no means least among the rulers of Judah,
for from you shall come a ruler
who is to shepherd^o my people Israel.’ ”*

7 Then Herod secretly called for the magi^p and learned from them the exact time when the star had appeared. ⁸Then he sent them to Bethlehem, saying, “Go and search diligently for the child, and when you have found him, bring me word so that I may also go and pay him homage.” ⁹When they had heard the king, they set out, and there, ahead of them, went the star that they had seen in the east,^q until it stopped over the place where the child was. ¹⁰When they saw that the star had stopped,^r they were overwhelmed with joy. ¹¹On entering the house, they saw the child with Mary his mother, and they knelt down and paid him homage. Then, opening their treasure chests, they offered him gifts of gold, frankincense, and myrrh.* ¹²And having been warned in a dream not to return to Herod, they left for their own country by another road.*

THE ESCAPE TO EGYPT

13 Now after they had left, an angel of the Lord appeared to Joseph in a dream and said, “Get up, take the child and his mother, and flee to Egypt,

and remain there until I tell you, for Herod is about to search for the child, to destroy him.”* ¹⁴Then Joseph^s got up, took the child and his mother by night, and went to Egypt* ¹⁵and remained there until the death of Herod. This was to fulfill what had been spoken by the Lord through the prophet, “Out of Egypt I have called my son.”

THE MASSACRE OF THE INFANTS

16 When Herod saw that he had been tricked by the magi,^t he was infuriated, and he sent and killed all the children in and around Bethlehem who were two years old or under, according to the time that he had learned from the magi.^u ¹⁷Then what had been spoken through the prophet Jeremiah was fulfilled:

¹⁸“A voice was heard in Ramah,
wailing and loud lamentation,
Rachel weeping for her children;
she refused to be consoled, because they are no more.”*

THE RETURN FROM EGYPT

19 When Herod died, an angel of the Lord suddenly appeared in a dream to Joseph in Egypt and said, ²⁰“Get up, take the child and his mother, and go to the land of Israel, for those who were seeking the child’s life are dead.” ²¹Then Joseph^v got up, took the child and his mother, and went to the land of Israel. ²²But when he heard that Archelaus was ruling Judea in place of his father Herod, he was afraid to go there. And after being warned in a dream, he went away to the district of Galilee.* ²³There he made his home in a town called Nazareth, so that what had been spoken through the prophets might be fulfilled, “He will be called a Nazarene.”^{w,*}

Matthew 3

THE PROCLAMATION OF JOHN THE BAPTIST

1 In those days John the Baptist appeared in the wilderness of Judea, proclaiming, ²“Repent, for the kingdom of heaven has come near.”^{x,*} ³This is the one of whom the prophet Isaiah spoke when he said,

“The voice of one crying out in the wilderness:

‘Prepare the way of the Lord;

make his paths straight.’”^{*}

⁴Now John wore clothing of camel’s hair with a leather belt around his waist, and his food was locusts and wild honey.^{*} ⁵Then Jerusalem and all Judea and all the region around the Jordan were going out to him, ⁶and they were baptized by him in the River Jordan, confessing their sins.^{*}

7 But when he saw many of the Pharisees and Sadducees coming for his^y baptism, he said to them, “You brood of vipers! Who warned you to flee from the coming wrath?”^{*} ⁸Therefore, bear fruit worthy of repentance,^{*} ⁹and do not presume to say to yourselves, ‘We have Abraham as our ancestor,’ for I tell you, God is able from these stones to raise up children to Abraham.^{*} ¹⁰Even now the ax is lying at the root of the trees; therefore every tree that does not bear good fruit will be cut down and thrown into the fire.^{*}

11 “I baptize you with^z water for repentance, but the one who is coming after me is more powerful than I, and I am not worthy to carry his sandals. He will baptize you with^a the Holy Spirit and fire.^{*} ¹²His winnowing fork is in his hand, and he will clear his threshing floor and will gather his wheat into the granary, but the chaff he will burn with unquenchable fire.”^{*}

THE BAPTISM OF JESUS

13 Then Jesus came from Galilee to John at the Jordan, to be baptized by him.^{*} ¹⁴John would have prevented him, saying, “I need to be baptized by you, and do you come to me?” ¹⁵But Jesus answered him, “Let it be so now,

for it is proper for us in this way to fulfill all righteousness.” Then he consented. ¹⁶And when Jesus had been baptized, just as he came up from the water, suddenly the heavens were opened to him and he saw God’s Spirit descending like a dove and alighting on him.* ¹⁷And a voice from the heavens said, “This is my Son, the Beloved,^b with whom I am well pleased.”*

Matthew 4

THE TESTING OF JESUS

1 Then Jesus was led up by the Spirit into the wilderness to be tested by the devil. **2**He fasted forty days and forty nights, and afterward he was famished. ^{*}**3**The tempter came and said to him, “If you are the Son of God, command these stones to become loaves of bread.” ^{*}**4**But he answered, “It is written,

‘One does not live by bread alone,

but by every word that comes from the mouth of God.’ ”^{*}

5 Then the devil took him to the holy city and placed him on the pinnacle of the temple, ^{*}**6**saying to him, “If you are the Son of God, throw yourself down, for it is written,

‘He will command his angels concerning you,’

and ‘On their hands they will bear you up,

so that you will not dash your foot against a stone.’ ”^{*}

7Jesus said to him, “Again it is written, ‘Do not put the Lord your God to the test.’ ”^{*}

8 Again, the devil took him to a very high mountain and showed him all the kingdoms of the world and their glory, ⁹and he said to him, “All these I will give you, if you will fall down and worship me.” **10**Then Jesus said to him, “Away with you, Satan! for it is written,

‘Worship the Lord your God,

and serve only him.’ ”^{*}

11Then the devil left him, and suddenly angels came and waited on him. ^{*}

JESUS BEGINS HIS MINISTRY IN GALILEE

12 Now when Jesus^c heard that John had been arrested, he withdrew to Galilee. **13**He left Nazareth and made his home in Capernaum by the sea, in

the territory of Zebulun and Naphtali, ¹⁴so that what had been spoken through the prophet Isaiah might be fulfilled:

¹⁵“Land of Zebulun, land of Naphtali,
on the road by the sea, across the Jordan, Galilee of the gentiles

—^{*}

¹⁶the people who sat in darkness
have seen a great light,
and for those who sat in the region and shadow of death
light has dawned.”^{*}

¹⁷From that time Jesus began to proclaim, “Repent, for the kingdom of heaven has come near.”^{d,*}

JESUS CALLS THE FIRST DISCIPLES

18 As he walked by the Sea of Galilee, he saw two brothers, Simon, who is called Peter, and Andrew his brother, casting a net into the sea—for they were fishers.^{*} ¹⁹And he said to them, “Follow me, and I will make you fishers of people.” ²⁰Immediately they left their nets and followed him.^{*} ²¹As he went from there, he saw two other brothers, James son of Zebedee and his brother John, in the boat with their father Zebedee, mending their nets, and he called them. ²²Immediately they left the boat and their father and followed him.

JESUS MINISTERS TO CROWDS OF PEOPLE

23 Jesus^e went throughout all Galilee, teaching in their synagogues and proclaiming the good news^f of the kingdom and curing every disease and every sickness among the people.^{*} ²⁴So his fame spread throughout all Syria, and they brought to him all the sick, those who were afflicted with various diseases and pains, people possessed by demons or having epilepsy or afflicted with paralysis, and he cured them.^{*} ²⁵And great crowds followed him from Galilee, the Decapolis, Jerusalem, Judea, and from beyond the Jordan.^{*}

Matthew 5

THE BEATITUDES

1 When Jesus^g saw the crowds, he went up the mountain, and after he sat down, his disciples came to him.* **2** And he began to speak and taught them, saying:

3 “Blessed are the poor in spirit, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.*

4 “Blessed are those who mourn, for they will be comforted.*

5 “Blessed are the meek, for they will inherit the earth.

6 “Blessed are those who hunger and thirst for righteousness, for they will be filled.*

7 “Blessed are the merciful, for they will receive mercy.

8 “Blessed are the pure in heart, for they will see God.*

9 “Blessed are the peacemakers, for they will be called children of God.*

10 “Blessed are those who are persecuted for the sake of righteousness, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.*

11 “Blessed are you when people revile you and persecute you and utter all kinds of evil against you falsely^h on my account.* **12** Rejoice and be glad, for your reward is great in heaven, for in the same way they persecuted the prophets who were before you.*

SALT AND LIGHT

13 “You are the salt of the earth, but if salt has lost its taste, how can its saltiness be restored? It is no longer good for anything but is thrown out and trampled under foot.*

14 “You are the light of the world. A city built on a hill cannot be hid.* **15** People do not light a lamp and put it under the bushel basket; rather, they put it on the lampstand, and it gives light to all in the house.* **16** In the same way, let your light shine before others, so that they may see your good works and give glory to your Father in heaven.*

THE LAW AND THE PROPHETS

17 “Do not think that I have come to abolish the Law or the Prophets; I have come not to abolish but to fulfill.* ¹⁸For truly I tell you, until heaven and earth pass away, not one letter,ⁱ not one stroke of a letter, will pass from the law until all is accomplished.* ¹⁹Therefore, whoever breaks^j one of the least of these commandments and teaches others to do the same will be called least in the kingdom of heaven, but whoever does them and teaches them will be called great in the kingdom of heaven.* ²⁰For I tell you, unless your righteousness exceeds that of the scribes and Pharisees, you will never enter the kingdom of heaven.

CONCERNING ANGER

21 “You have heard that it was said to those of ancient times, ‘You shall not murder,’ and ‘whoever murders shall be liable to judgment.’* ²²But I say to you that if you are angry with a brother or sister,^k you will be liable to judgment, and if you insult^l a brother or sister, you will be liable to the council, and if you say, ‘You fool,’ you will be liable to the hell^m of fire.* ²³So when you are offering your gift at the altar, if you remember that your brother or sister has something against you,* ²⁴leave your gift there before the altar and go; first be reconciled to your brother or sister, and then come and offer your gift. ²⁵Come to terms quickly with your accuser while you are on the way to courtⁿ with him, or your accuser may hand you over to the judge and the judge to the guard, and you will be thrown into prison.* ²⁶Truly I tell you, you will never get out until you have paid the last penny.

CONCERNING ADULTERY

27 “You have heard that it was said, ‘You shall not commit adultery.’* ²⁸But I say to you that everyone who looks at a woman with lust has already committed adultery with her in his heart.* ²⁹If your right eye causes you to sin,^o tear it out and throw it away; it is better for you to lose one of your members than for your whole body to be thrown into hell.^{p,*} ³⁰And if your right hand causes you to sin,^q cut it off and throw it away; it is better

for you to lose one of your members than for your whole body to go into hell.^r

CONCERNING DIVORCE

31 “It was also said, ‘Whoever divorces his wife, let him give her a certificate of divorce.’^{*} ³²But I say to you that anyone who divorces his wife, except on the ground of sexual immorality, causes her to commit adultery, and whoever marries a divorced woman commits adultery.

CONCERNING OATHS

33 “Again, you have heard that it was said to those of ancient times, ‘You shall not swear falsely, but carry out the vows you have made to the Lord.’^{*} ³⁴But I say to you: Do not swear at all, either by heaven, for it is the throne of God,^{*} ³⁵or by the earth, for it is his footstool, or by Jerusalem, for it is the city of the great King. ³⁶And do not swear by your head, for you cannot make one hair white or black. ³⁷Let your word be ‘Yes, Yes’ or ‘No, No’; anything more than this comes from the evil one.^s

CONCERNING RETALIATION

38 “You have heard that it was said, ‘An eye for an eye and a tooth for a tooth.’^{*} ³⁹But I say to you: Do not resist an evildoer. But if anyone strikes you on the right cheek, turn the other also,^{*} ⁴⁰and if anyone wants to sue you and take your shirt, give your coat as well, ⁴¹and if anyone forces you to go one mile, go also the second mile. ⁴²Give to the one who asks of you, and do not refuse anyone who wants to borrow from you.^{*}

LOVE FOR ENEMIES

43 “You have heard that it was said, ‘You shall love your neighbor and hate your enemy.’^{*} ⁴⁴But I say to you: Love your enemies and pray for those who persecute you,^{*} ⁴⁵so that you may be children of your Father in heaven, for he makes his sun rise on the evil and on the good and sends rain on the righteous and on the unrighteous.^{*} ⁴⁶For if you love those who love you, what reward do you have? Do not even the tax collectors do the same?

⁴⁷And if you greet only your brothers and sisters, what more are you doing than others? Do not even the gentiles do the same? ⁴⁸Be perfect, therefore, as your heavenly Father is perfect.*

Matthew 6

CONCERNING ALMSGIVING

1 “Beware of practicing your righteousness before others in order to be seen by them, for then you have no reward from your Father in heaven.*

2 “So whenever you give alms, do not sound a trumpet before you, as the hypocrites do in the synagogues and in the streets, so that they may be praised by others. Truly I tell you, they have received their reward.* ³But when you give alms, do not let your left hand know what your right hand is doing, ⁴so that your alms may be done in secret, and your Father who sees in secret will reward you.^{t,*}

CONCERNING PRAYER

5 “And whenever you pray, do not be like the hypocrites, for they love to stand and pray in the synagogues and at the street corners, so that they may be seen by others. Truly I tell you, they have received their reward.* ⁶But whenever you pray, go into your room and shut the door and pray to your Father who is in secret, and your Father who sees in secret will reward you.^{u,*}

7 “When you are praying, do not heap up empty phrases as the gentiles do, for they think that they will be heard because of their many words.* ⁸Do not be like them, for your Father knows what you need before you ask him.

9 “Pray, then, in this way:

Our Father in heaven,

may your name be revered as holy.

¹⁰May your kingdom come.

May your will be done

on earth as it is in heaven.*

¹¹Give us today our daily bread.^{v,*}

¹²And forgive us our debts,

as we also have forgiven our debtors.*

¹³And do not bring us to the time of trial,^w

but rescue us from the evil one.^{x,*}

¹⁴“For if you forgive others their trespasses, your heavenly Father will also forgive you,^{*} ¹⁵but if you do not forgive others,^y neither will your Father forgive your trespasses.^{*}

CONCERNING FASTING

16 “And whenever you fast, do not look somber, like the hypocrites, for they mark their faces to show others that they are fasting. Truly I tell you, they have received their reward. ¹⁷But when you fast, put oil on your head and wash your face, ¹⁸so that your fasting may be seen not by others but by your Father who is in secret, and your Father who sees in secret will reward you.^z

CONCERNING TREASURES

19 “Do not store up for yourselves treasures on earth, where moth and rust^a consume and where thieves break in and steal,^{*} ²⁰but store up for yourselves treasures in heaven, where neither moth nor rust^b consumes and where thieves do not break in and steal.^{*} ²¹For where your treasure is, there your heart will be also.

THE EYE

22 “The eye is the lamp of the body. So if your eye is healthy, your whole body will be full of light,^{*} ²³but if your eye is unhealthy, your whole body will be full of darkness. If, then, the light in you is darkness, how great is the darkness!

SERVING TWO MASTERS

24 “No one can serve two masters, for a slave will either hate the one and love the other or be devoted to the one and despise the other. You cannot serve God and wealth.^{c,*}

DO NOT WORRY

25 “Therefore I tell you, do not worry about your life, what you will eat or what you will drink,^d or about your body, what you will wear. Is not life more than food and the body more than clothing?^{*} **26** Look at the birds of the air: they neither sow nor reap nor gather into barns, and yet your heavenly Father feeds them. Are you not of more value than they?^{*} **27** And which of you by worrying can add a single hour to your span of life?^e **28** And why do you worry about clothing? Consider the lilies of the field, how they grow; they neither toil nor spin,²⁹ yet I tell you, even Solomon in all his glory was not clothed like one of these. **30** But if God so clothes the grass of the field, which is alive today and tomorrow is thrown into the oven, will he not much more clothe you—you of little faith? **31** Therefore do not worry, saying, ‘What will we eat?’ or ‘What will we drink?’ or ‘What will we wear?’ **32** For it is the gentiles who seek all these things, and indeed your heavenly Father knows that you need all these things. **33** But seek first the kingdom of God^f and his^g righteousness, and all these things will be given to you as well.^{*}

34 “So do not worry about tomorrow, for tomorrow will bring worries of its own. Today’s trouble is enough for today.

Matthew 7

JUDGING OTHERS

1 “Do not judge, so that you may not be judged.* **2**For the judgment you give will be the judgment you get, and the measure you give will be the measure you get. **3**Why do you see the speck in your neighbor’s eye but do not notice the log in your own eye? **4**Or how can you say to your neighbor, ‘Let me take the speck out of your eye,’ while the log is in your own eye? **5**You hypocrite, first take the log out of your own eye, and then you will see clearly to take the speck out of your neighbor’s eye.

PROFANING THE HOLY

6 “Do not give what is holy to dogs, and do not throw your pearls before swine, or they will trample them under foot and turn and maul you.*

ASK, SEARCH, KNOCK

7 “Ask, and it will be given to you; search, and you will find; knock, and the door will be opened for you.* **8**For everyone who asks receives, and everyone who searches finds, and for everyone who knocks, the door will be opened.* **9**Is there anyone among you who, if your child asked for bread, would give a stone? **10**Or if the child asked for a fish, would give a snake? **11**If you, then, who are evil, know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will your Father in heaven give good things to those who ask him!

THE GOLDEN RULE

12 “In everything do to others as you would have them do to you, for this is the Law and the Prophets.*

THE NARROW GATE

13 “Enter through the narrow gate, for the gate is wide and the road is easy^h that leads to destruction, and there are many who take it.* ¹⁴For the gate is narrow and the road is hard that leads to life, and there are few who find it.

A TREE AND ITS FRUIT

15 “Beware of false prophets, who come to you in sheep’s clothing but inwardly are ravenous wolves.* ¹⁶You will know them by their fruits. Are grapes gathered from thorns or figs from thistles? * ¹⁷In the same way, every good tree bears good fruit, but the bad tree bears bad fruit. ¹⁸A good tree cannot bear bad fruit, nor can a bad tree bear good fruit. ¹⁹Every tree that does not bear good fruit will be cut down and thrown into the fire.* ²⁰Thus you will know them by their fruits.

CONCERNING SELF-DECEPTION

21 “Not everyone who says to me, ‘Lord, Lord,’ will enter the kingdom of heaven, but only the one who does the will of my Father in heaven.* ²²On that day many will say to me, ‘Lord, Lord, did we not prophesy in your name, and cast out demons in your name, and do many mighty works in your name?’ * ²³Then I will declare to them, ‘I never knew you; go away from me, you who behave lawlessly.’ *

HEARERS AND DOERS

24 “Everyone, then, who hears these words of mine and acts on them will be like a wise man who built his house on rock.* ²⁵The rain fell, the floods came, and the winds blew and beat on that house, but it did not fall because it had been founded on rock. ²⁶And everyone who hears these words of mine and does not act on them will be like a foolish man who built his house on sand. ²⁷The rain fell, and the floods came, and the winds blew and beat against that house, and it fell—and great was its fall!”

28 Now when Jesus had finished saying these words, the crowds were astounded at his teaching,* ²⁹for he taught them as one having authority and not as their scribes.

Matthew 8

JESUS CLEANSSES A MAN

1 When Jesusⁱ had come down from the mountain, great crowds followed him,² and there was a man with a skin disease who came to him and knelt before him, saying, “Lord, if you are willing, you can make me clean.”^{*} **3** He stretched out his hand and touched him, saying, “I am willing. Be made clean!” Immediately his skin disease was cleansed. **4** Then Jesus said to him, “See that you say nothing to anyone, but go, show yourself to the priest, and offer the gift that Moses commanded, as a testimony to them.”^{*}

JESUS HEALS A CENTURION’S SERVANT

5 When he entered Capernaum, a centurion came to him, appealing to him⁶ and saying, “Lord, my servant^j is lying at home paralyzed, in terrible distress.” **7** And he said to him, “I will come and cure him.” **8** The centurion answered, “Lord, I am not worthy to have you come under my roof, but only speak the word, and my servant^k will be healed.”^{*} **9** For I also am a man under authority, with soldiers under me, and I say to one, ‘Go,’ and he goes, and to another, ‘Come,’ and he comes, and to my slave, ‘Do this,’ and the slave does it.” **10** When Jesus heard him, he was amazed and said to those who followed him, “Truly I tell you, in no one^l in Israel have I found such faith. **11** I tell you, many will come from east and west and will take their places at the banquet with Abraham and Isaac and Jacob in the kingdom of heaven,”^{*} **12** while the heirs of the kingdom will be thrown into the outer darkness, where there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth.”^{*} **13** And Jesus said to the centurion, “Go; let it be done for you according to your faith.” And the servant^m was healed in that hour.

JESUS HEALS MANY AT PETER’S HOUSE

14 When Jesus entered Peter’s house, he saw his mother-in-law lying in bed with a fever;^{*} **15** he touched her hand, and the fever left her, and she got up and began to serve him. **16** That evening they brought to him many who

were possessed by demons, and he cast out the spirits with a word and cured all who were sick. ¹⁷This was to fulfill what had been spoken through the prophet Isaiah, “He took our infirmities and bore our diseases.”*

WOULD-BE FOLLOWERS OF JESUS

18 Now when Jesus saw great crowdsⁿ around him, he gave orders to go over to the other side. * ¹⁹A scribe then approached and said, “Teacher, I will follow you wherever you go.” ²⁰And Jesus said to him, “Foxes have holes, and birds of the air have nests, but the Son of Man has nowhere to lay his head.” ²¹Another of his disciples said to him, “Lord, first let me go and bury my father.” ²²But Jesus said to him, “Follow me, and let the dead bury their own dead.”*

JESUS STILL THE STORM

23 And when he got into the boat, his disciples followed him. ²⁴A windstorm suddenly arose on the sea, so great that the boat was being swamped by the waves, but he was asleep. ²⁵And they went and woke him up, saying, “Lord, save us! We are perishing!” ²⁶And he said to them, “Why are you afraid, you of little faith?” Then he got up and rebuked the winds and the sea, and there was a dead calm.* ²⁷They were amazed, saying, “What sort of man is this, that even the winds and the sea obey him?”

JESUS HEALS TWO MEN

28 When he came to the other side, to the region of the Gadarenes,^o two men possessed by demons came out of the tombs and met him. They were so fierce that no one could pass that way. ²⁹Suddenly they shouted, “What have you to do with us, Son of God? Have you come here to torment us before the time?”* ³⁰Now a large herd of swine was feeding at some distance from them. ³¹The demons begged him, “If you cast us out, send us into the herd of swine.” ³²And he said to them, “Go!” So they came out and entered the swine, and suddenly, the whole herd stampeded down the steep bank into the sea and drowned in the water. ³³The swineherds ran off, and, going into the town, they told the whole story about what had happened to

the men possessed by demons. ³⁴Then the whole town came out to meet Jesus, and when they saw him they begged him to leave their region.

Matthew 9

1 And after getting into a boat he crossed the sea and came to his own town.*

JESUS HEALS A PARALYTIC

2 And some people were carrying to him a paralyzed man lying on a stretcher. When Jesus saw their faith, he said to the paralytic, “Take heart, child; your sins are forgiven.”* **3** Then some of the scribes said to themselves, “This man is blaspheming.” **4** But Jesus, perceiving their thoughts, said, “Why do you think evil in your hearts?”* **5** For which is easier: to say, ‘Your sins are forgiven,’ or to say, ‘Stand up and walk’? **6** But so that you may know that the Son of Man has authority on earth to forgive sins”—he then said to the paralytic—“Stand up, take your bed, and go to your home.” **7** And he stood up and went to his home. **8** When the crowds saw it, they were filled with awe, and they glorified God, who had given such authority to human beings.*

THE CALL OF MATTHEW

9 As Jesus was walking along, he saw a man called Matthew sitting at the tax-collection station, and he said to him, “Follow me.” And he got up and followed him.

10 And as he sat at dinner^p in the house, many tax collectors and sinners came and were sitting^q with Jesus and his disciples. **11** When the Pharisees saw this, they said to his disciples, “Why does your teacher eat with tax collectors and sinners?”* **12** But when he heard this, he said, “Those who are well have no need of a physician, but those who are sick. **13** Go and learn what this means, ‘I desire mercy, not sacrifice.’ For I have not come to call the righteous but sinners.”*

THE QUESTION ABOUT FASTING

14 Then the disciples of John came to him, saying, “Why do we and the Pharisees fast often,^r but your disciples do not fast?”^{*} **15** And Jesus said to them, “The wedding attendants cannot mourn as long as the bridegroom is with them, can they? The days will come when the bridegroom is taken away from them, and then they will fast.”^{*} **16** No one sews a piece of unshrunk cloth on an old cloak, for the patch pulls away from the cloak, and a worse tear is made. **17** Neither is new wine put into old wineskins; otherwise, the skins burst, and the wine is spilled, and the skins are ruined, but new wine is put into fresh wineskins, and so both are preserved.”

A GIRL RESTORED TO LIFE AND A WOMAN HEALED

18 While he was saying these things to them, suddenly a leader came in and knelt before him, saying, “My daughter has just died, but come and lay your hand on her, and she will live.”^{*} **19** And Jesus got up and followed him, with his disciples. **20** Then suddenly a woman who had been suffering from a flow of blood for twelve years came up behind him and touched the fringe of his cloak,^{*} **21** for she was saying to herself, “If I only touch his cloak, I will be made well.”^{*} **22** Jesus turned, and seeing her he said, “Take heart, daughter; your faith has made you well.” And the woman was made well from that moment.^{*} **23** When Jesus came to the leader’s house and saw the flute players and the crowd making a commotion,^{*} **24** he said, “Go away, for the girl is not dead but sleeping.” And they laughed at him.^{*} **25** But when the crowd had been put outside, he went in and took her by the hand, and the girl got up. **26** And the report of this spread through all of that district.

JESUS HEALS TWO BLIND MEN

27 As Jesus went on from there, two blind men followed him, crying loudly, “Have mercy on us, Son of David!”^{*} **28** When he entered the house, the blind men came to him, and Jesus said to them, “Do you have faith that I can do this?” They said to him, “Yes, Lord.” **29** Then he touched their eyes and said, “According to your faith, let it be done to you.” **30** And their eyes were opened. Then Jesus sternly ordered them, “See that no one knows of this.”^{*} **31** But they went away and spread the news about him through all of that district.^{*}

JESUS HEALS ONE WHO WAS MUTE

32 After they had gone away, a demon-possessed man who was mute was brought to him.* ³³And when the demon had been cast out, the one who had been mute spoke, and the crowds were amazed and said, “Never has anything like this been seen in Israel.” ³⁴But the Pharisees were saying, “By the ruler of the demons he casts out the demons.”*

THE HARVEST IS GREAT, THE LABORERS FEW

35 Then Jesus went about all the cities and villages, teaching in their synagogues and proclaiming the good news of the kingdom and curing every disease and every sickness.* ³⁶When he saw the crowds, he had compassion for them because they were harassed and helpless, like sheep without a shepherd.* ³⁷Then he said to his disciples, “The harvest is plentiful, but the laborers are few;” ³⁸therefore ask the Lord of the harvest to send out laborers into his harvest.”

Matthew 10

THE TWELVE APOSTLES

1 Then Jesus^s summoned his twelve disciples and gave them authority over unclean spirits, to cast them out, and to cure every disease and every sickness.* ²These are the names of the twelve apostles: first, Simon, also known as Peter, and his brother Andrew; James son of Zebedee and his brother John; ³Philip and Bartholomew; Thomas and Matthew the tax collector; James son of Alphaeus and Thaddaeus;^t ⁴Simon the Cananaean and Judas Iscariot, the one who betrayed him.*

THE MISSION OF THE TWELVE

5 These twelve Jesus sent out with the following instructions: “Do not take a road leading to gentiles, and do not enter a Samaritan town,* ⁶but go rather to the lost sheep of the house of Israel.* ⁷As you go, proclaim the good news, ‘The kingdom of heaven has come near.’^{u,*} ⁸Cure the sick; raise the dead; cleanse those with a skin disease; cast out demons. You received without payment; give without payment. ⁹Take no gold, or silver, or copper in your belts, ¹⁰no bag for your journey, or two tunics, or sandals, or a staff, for laborers deserve their food.* ¹¹Whatever town or village you enter, find out who in it is worthy, and stay there until you leave. ¹²As you enter the house, greet it. ¹³If the house is worthy, let your peace come upon it, but if it is not worthy, let your peace return to you. ¹⁴If anyone will not welcome you or listen to your words, shake off the dust from your feet as you leave that house or town.* ¹⁵Truly I tell you, it will be more tolerable for the land of Sodom and Gomorrah on the day of judgment than for that town.*

COMING PERSECUTIONS

16 “I am sending you out like sheep into the midst of wolves, so be wise as serpents and innocent as doves.* ¹⁷Beware of them, for they will hand you over to councils and flog you in their synagogues, ¹⁸and you will be dragged before governors and kings because of me, as a testimony to them

and the gentiles.* ¹⁹When they hand you over, do not worry about how you are to speak or what you are to say, for what you are to say will be given to you at that time, ²⁰for it is not you who speak, but the Spirit of your Father speaking through you.* ²¹Sibling will betray sibling to death and a father his child, and children will rise against parents and have them put to death, ²²and you will be hated by all because of my name. But the one who endures to the end will be saved.* ²³When they persecute you in this town, flee to the next, for truly I tell you, you will not have finished going through all the towns of Israel before the Son of Man comes.

24 “A disciple is not above the teacher nor a slave above the master; * ²⁵it is enough for the disciple to be like the teacher and the slave like the master. If they have called the master of the house Beelzebul, how much more will they malign those of his household!*

WHOM TO FEAR

26 “So have no fear of them, for nothing is covered up that will not be uncovered and nothing secret that will not become known.* ²⁷What I say to you in the dark, tell in the light, and what you hear whispered, proclaim from the housetops. ²⁸Do not fear those who kill the body but cannot kill the soul; rather, fear the one who can destroy both soul and body in hell.^v ²⁹Are not two sparrows sold for a penny? Yet not one of them will fall to the ground apart from your Father. ³⁰And even the hairs of your head are all counted.* ³¹So do not be afraid; you are of more value than many sparrows.

32 “Everyone, therefore, who acknowledges me before others, I also will acknowledge before my Father in heaven,* ³³but whoever denies me before others, I also will deny before my Father in heaven.

NOT PEACE, BUT A SWORD

34 “Do not think that I have come to bring peace to the earth; I have not come to bring peace but a sword.*

³⁵For I have come to set a man against his father,
and a daughter against her mother,
and a daughter-in-law against her mother-in-law,*

³⁶and one's foes will be members of one's own household.*

³⁷“Whoever loves father or mother more than me is not worthy of me, and whoever loves son or daughter more than me is not worthy of me,* ³⁸and whoever does not take up the cross and follow me is not worthy of me.*

³⁹Those who find their life will lose it, and those who lose their life for my sake will find it.*

REWARDS

40 “Whoever welcomes you welcomes me, and whoever welcomes me welcomes the one who sent me.* ⁴¹Whoever welcomes a prophet in the name of a prophet will receive a prophet's reward, and whoever welcomes a righteous person in the name of a righteous person will receive the reward of the righteous, ⁴²and whoever gives even a cup of cold water to one of these little ones in the name of a disciple—truly I tell you, none of these will lose their reward.”*

Matthew 11

1 Now when Jesus had finished instructing his twelve disciples, he went on from there to teach and proclaim his message in their cities.

MESSENGERS FROM JOHN THE BAPTIST

2 When John heard in prison what the Messiah^w was doing, he sent word by his^x disciples^{*} ³and said to him, “Are you the one who is to come, or are we to wait for another?”^{*} ⁴Jesus answered them, “Go and tell John what you hear and see: ⁵the blind receive their sight, the lame walk, those with a skin disease are cleansed, the deaf hear, the dead are raised, and the poor have good news brought to them.^{*} ⁶And blessed is anyone who takes no offense at me.”^{*}

JESUS PRAISES JOHN THE BAPTIST

7 As they went away, Jesus began to speak to the crowds about John: “What did you go out into the wilderness to look at? A reed shaken by the wind?”^{*} ⁸What, then, did you go out to see? Someone^y dressed in soft robes? Look, those who wear soft robes are in royal palaces. ⁹What, then, did you go out to see? A prophet?^z Yes, I tell you, and more than a prophet.^{*} ¹⁰This is the one about whom it is written,

‘See, I am sending my messenger ahead of you,
who will prepare your way before you.’^{*}

¹¹“Truly I tell you, among those born of women no one has arisen greater than John the Baptist, yet the least in the kingdom of heaven is greater than he. ¹²From the days of John the Baptist until now, the kingdom of heaven has suffered violence,^a and violent people take it by force.^{*} ¹³For all the Prophets and the Law prophesied until John came, ¹⁴and if you are willing to accept it, he is Elijah who is to come.^{*} ¹⁵Let anyone with ears^b listen!”^{*}

16 “But to what will I compare this generation? It is like children sitting in the marketplaces and calling to one another,

¹⁷‘We played the flute for you, and you did not dance;
we wailed, and you did not mourn.’

¹⁸“For John came neither eating nor drinking, and they say, ‘He has a demon’; ¹⁹the Son of Man came eating and drinking, and they say, ‘Look, a glutton and a drunkard, a friend of tax collectors and sinners!’ Yet wisdom is vindicated by her deeds.”^{c,*}

WOES TO UNREPENTANT CITIES

20 Then he began to reproach the cities in which most of his deeds of power had been done because they did not repent. ²¹“Woe to you, Chorazin! Woe to you, Bethsaida! For if the deeds of power done in you had been done in Tyre and Sidon, they would have repented long ago in sackcloth and ashes.” ²²But I tell you, on the day of judgment it will be more tolerable for Tyre and Sidon than for you. ²³And you, Capernaum,

will you be exalted to heaven?

No, you will be brought down to Hades.

“For if the deeds of power done in you had been done in Sodom, it would have remained until this day.” ²⁴But I tell you that on the day of judgment it will be more tolerable for the land of Sodom than for you.”^{*}

JESUS THANKS HIS FATHER

25 At that time Jesus said, “I thank^d you, Father, Lord of heaven and earth, because you have hidden these things from the wise and the intelligent and have revealed them to infants;” ²⁶yes, Father, for such was your gracious will.^e ²⁷All things have been handed over to me by my Father, and no one knows the Son except the Father, and no one knows the Father except the Son and anyone to whom the Son chooses to reveal him.^{*}

28 “Come to me, all you who are weary and are carrying heavy burdens, and I will give you rest.” ²⁹Take my yoke upon you, and learn from me, for I am gentle and humble in heart, and you will find rest for your souls.^{*}
³⁰For my yoke is easy, and my burden is light.”

Matthew 12

PLUCKING GRAIN ON THE SABBATH

1 At that time Jesus went through the grain fields on the Sabbath; his disciples were hungry, and they began to pluck heads of grain and to eat.*
2 When the Pharisees saw it, they said to him, “Look, your disciples are doing what is not lawful to do on the Sabbath.”* **3** He said to them, “Have you not read what David did when he and his companions were hungry?”*
4 How he entered the house of God, and they^f ate the bread of the Presence, which it was not lawful for him or his companions to eat, but only for the priests?* **5** Or have you not read in the law that on the Sabbath the priests in the temple break the Sabbath and yet are guiltless?* **6** I tell you, something greater than the temple is here.* **7** But if you had known what this means, ‘I desire mercy and not sacrifice,’ you would not have condemned the guiltless.* **8** For the Son of Man is lord of the Sabbath.”

THE MAN WITH A WITHERED HAND

9 He left that place and entered their synagogue; ¹⁰a man was there with a withered hand, and they asked him, “Is it lawful to cure on the Sabbath?” so that they might accuse him.* **11** He said to them, “Suppose one of you has only one sheep and it falls into a pit on the Sabbath; will you not lay hold of it and lift it out?”* **12** How much more valuable is a human being than a sheep! So it is lawful to do good on the Sabbath.”* **13** Then he said to the man, “Stretch out your hand.” He stretched it out, and it was restored, as sound as the other. ¹⁴But the Pharisees went out and conspired against him, how to destroy him.*

GOD’S CHOSEN SERVANT

15 When Jesus became aware of this, he departed. Many^g followed him, and he cured all of them,* ¹⁶and he ordered them not to make him known.*
¹⁷This was to fulfill what had been spoken through the prophet Isaiah:

¹⁸“Here is my servant, whom I have chosen,
my beloved, with whom my soul is well pleased.
I will put my Spirit upon him,
and he will proclaim justice to the gentiles.”^{*}
¹⁹He will not wrangle or cry aloud,
nor will anyone hear his voice in the streets.
²⁰He will not break a bruised reed
or quench a smoldering wick
until he brings justice to victory.
²¹And in his name the gentiles will hope.”

JESUS AND BEELZEBUL

22 Then they brought to him a demon-possessed man who was blind and mute, and he cured him, so that the one who had been mute could speak and see.^{*} ²³All the crowds were amazed and were saying, “Can this be the Son of David?”^{*} ²⁴But when the Pharisees heard it, they said, “It is only by Beelzebul, the ruler of the demons, that this man casts out the demons.”^{*} ²⁵He knew what they were thinking and said to them, “Every kingdom divided against itself is laid waste, and no city or house divided against itself will stand.”^{*} ²⁶If Satan casts out Satan, he is divided against himself; how, then, will his kingdom stand? ²⁷If I cast out demons by Beelzebul, by whom do your own exorcists^h cast them out? Therefore they will be your judges.^{*} ²⁸But if it is by the Spirit of God that I cast out demons, then the kingdom of God has come upon you.^{*} ²⁹Or how can one enter a strong man’s house and plunder his property without first tying up the strong man? Then indeed the house can be plundered. ³⁰Whoever is not with me is against me, and whoever does not gather with me scatters.^{*} ³¹Therefore I tell you, people will be forgiven for every sin and blasphemy, but blasphemy against the Spirit will not be forgiven.^{*} ³²Whoever speaks a word against the Son of Man will be forgiven, but whoever speaks against the Holy Spirit will not be forgiven, either in this age or in the age to come.^{*}

A TREE AND ITS FRUIT

33 “Either make the tree good and its fruit good, or make the tree bad and its fruit bad, for the tree is known by its fruit.* ³⁴You brood of vipers! How can you speak good things when you are evil? For out of the abundance of the heart the mouth speaks.* ³⁵The good person brings good things out of a good treasure, and the evil person brings evil things out of an evil treasure. ³⁶I tell you, on the day of judgment you will have to give an account for every careless word you utter, ³⁷for by your words you will be justified, and by your words you will be condemned.”

THE SIGN OF JONAH

38 Then some of the scribes and Pharisees said to him, “Teacher, we wish to see a sign from you.”* ³⁹But he answered them, “An evil and adulterous generation asks for a sign, but no sign will be given to it except the sign of the prophet Jonah.* ⁴⁰For just as Jonah was three days and three nights in the belly of the sea monster, so for three days and three nights the Son of Man will be in the heart of the earth.* ⁴¹The people of Nineveh will rise up at the judgment with this generation and condemn it, because they repented at the proclamation of Jonah, and indeed something greater than Jonah is here!* ⁴²The queen of the South will rise up at the judgment with this generation and condemn it, because she came from the ends of the earth to listen to the wisdom of Solomon, and indeed something greater than Solomon is here!*

THE RETURN OF THE UNCLEAN SPIRIT

43 “When the unclean spirit has gone out of a person, it wanders through waterless regions looking for a resting place, but it finds none. ⁴⁴Then it says, ‘I will return to my house from which I came.’ When it returns, it finds it empty, swept, and put in order. ⁴⁵Then it goes and brings along seven other spirits more evil than itself, and they enter and live there, and the last state of that person is worse than the first. So will it be also with this evil generation.”*

THE TRUE KINDRED OF JESUS

46 While he was still speaking to the crowds, his mother and his brothers were standing outside, wanting to speak to him.* ⁴⁷Someone told him, “Look, your mother and your brothers are standing outside, wanting to speak to you.”ⁱ ⁴⁸But to the one who had told him this, Jesus^j replied, “Who is my mother, and who are my brothers?” ⁴⁹And pointing to his disciples, he said, “Here are my mother and my brothers! ⁵⁰For whoever does the will of my Father in heaven is my brother and sister and mother.”*

Matthew 13

THE PARABLE OF THE SOWER

1 That same day Jesus went out of the house and sat beside the sea. **2** Such great crowds gathered around him that he got into a boat and sat there, while the whole crowd stood on the beach.* **3** And he told them many things in parables, saying: “Listen! A sower went out to sow. **4** And as he sowed, some seeds fell on a path, and the birds came and ate them up. **5** Other seeds fell on rocky ground, where they did not have much soil, and they sprang up quickly, since they had no depth of soil. **6** But when the sun rose, they were scorched, and since they had no root, they withered away. **7** Other seeds fell among thorns, and the thorns grew up and choked them. **8** Other seeds fell on good soil and brought forth grain, some a hundredfold, some sixty, some thirty.* **9** If you have ears,^k hear!”*

THE PURPOSE OF THE PARABLES

10 Then the disciples came and asked him, “Why do you speak to them in parables?” **11** He answered, “To you it has been given to know the secrets¹ of the kingdom of heaven, but to them it has not been given.* **12** For to those who have, more will be given, and they will have an abundance, but from those who have nothing, even what they have will be taken away.* **13** The reason I speak to them in parables is that ‘seeing they do not perceive, and hearing they do not listen, nor do they understand.’* **14** With them indeed is fulfilled the prophecy of Isaiah that says:

‘You will indeed listen but never understand,
and you will indeed look but never perceive.*

15 For this people’s heart has grown dull,
and their ears are hard of hearing,
and they have shut their eyes,
so that they might not look with their eyes,
and hear with their ears

and understand with their heart and turn —

and I would heal them.’^{*}

¹⁶“But blessed are your eyes, for they see, and your ears, for they hear.”^{*}

¹⁷Truly I tell you, many prophets and righteous people longed to see what you see but did not see it and to hear what you hear but did not hear it.”^{*}

THE PARABLE OF THE SOWER EXPLAINED

18 “Hear, then, the parable of the sower. ¹⁹When anyone hears the word of the kingdom and does not understand it, the evil one comes and snatches away what is sown in the heart; this is what was sown on the path.”^{*} ²⁰As for what was sown on rocky ground, this is the one who hears the word and immediately receives it with joy, ²¹yet such a person has no root but endures only for a while, and when trouble or persecution arises on account of the word, that person immediately falls away.”^{m,*} ²²As for what was sown among thorns, this is the one who hears the word, but the cares of thisⁿ age and the lure of wealth choke the word, and it yields nothing.”^{*} ²³But as for what was sown on good soil, this is the one who hears the word and understands it, who indeed bears fruit and yields in one case a hundredfold, in another sixty, and in another thirty.”^{*}

THE PARABLE OF WEEDS AMONG THE WHEAT

24 He put before them another parable: “The kingdom of heaven may be compared to someone who sowed good seed in his field,”^{*} ²⁵but while everybody was asleep an enemy came and sowed weeds among the wheat and then went away. ²⁶So when the plants came up and bore grain, then the weeds appeared as well. ²⁷And the slaves of the householder came and said to him, ‘Master, did you not sow good seed in your field? Where, then, did these weeds come from?’ ²⁸He answered, ‘An enemy has done this.’ The slaves said to him, ‘Then do you want us to go and gather them?’ ²⁹But he replied, ‘No, for in gathering the weeds you would uproot the wheat along with them. ³⁰Let both of them grow together until the harvest, and at harvest time I will tell the reapers, Collect the weeds first and bind them in bundles to be burned, but gather the wheat into my barn.’ ”^{*}

THE PARABLE OF THE MUSTARD SEED

31 He put before them another parable: “The kingdom of heaven is like a mustard seed that someone took and sowed in his field; ^{*} ³²it is the smallest of all the seeds, but when it has grown it is the greatest of shrubs and becomes a tree, so that the birds of the air come and make nests in its branches.”^{*}

THE PARABLE OF THE YEAST

33 He told them another parable: “The kingdom of heaven is like yeast that a woman took and mixed in with ^o three measures of flour until all of it was leavened.”^{*}

THE USE OF PARABLES

34 Jesus told the crowds all these things in parables; without a parable he told them nothing. ^{*} ³⁵This was to fulfill what had been spoken through the prophet:^p

“I will open my mouth to speak in parables;

I will proclaim what has been hidden since the foundation.”^{q,*}

JESUS EXPLAINS THE PARABLE OF THE WEEDS

36 Then he left the crowds and went into the house. And his disciples approached him, saying, “Explain to us the parable of the weeds of the field.” ³⁷He answered, “The one who sows the good seed is the Son of Man; ³⁸the field is the world, and the good seed are the children of the kingdom; the weeds are the children of the evil one, ^{*} ³⁹and the enemy who sowed them is the devil; the harvest is the end of the age, and the reapers are angels. ^{*} ⁴⁰Just as the weeds are collected and burned up with fire, so will it be at the end of the age. ^{*} ⁴¹The Son of Man will send his angels, and they will collect out of his kingdom all causes of sin^r and all evildoers, ^{*} ⁴²and they will throw them into the furnace of fire, where there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth. ^{*} ⁴³Then the righteous will shine like the sun in the kingdom of their Father. Let anyone with ears^s listen!”^{*}

THREE PARABLES

44 “The kingdom of heaven is like treasure hidden in a field, which a man found and reburied; then in his joy he goes and sells all that he has and buys that field.*

45 “Again, the kingdom of heaven is like a merchant in search of fine pearls; ⁴⁶on finding one pearl of great value, he went and sold all that he had and bought it.

47 “Again, the kingdom of heaven is like a net that was thrown into the sea and caught fish of every kind; ⁴⁸when it was full, they drew it ashore, sat down, and put the good into baskets but threw out the bad. ⁴⁹So it will be at the end of the age. The angels will come out and separate the evil from the righteous ⁵⁰and throw them into the furnace of fire, where there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth.*

TREASURES NEW AND OLD

51 “Have you understood all this?” They answered, “Yes.” ⁵²And he said to them, “Therefore every scribe who has become a disciple in the kingdom of heaven is like the master of a household who brings out of his treasure what is new and what is old.” ⁵³When Jesus had finished these parables, he left that place.*

THE REJECTION OF JESUS AT NAZARETH

54 He came to his hometown and began to teach the people^t in their synagogue, so that they were astounded and said, “Where did this man get this wisdom and these deeds of power? ⁵⁵Is not this the carpenter’s son? Is not his mother called Mary? And are not his brothers James and Joseph and Simon and Judas? ⁵⁶And are not all his sisters with us? Where then did this man get all this?” ⁵⁷And they took offense at him. But Jesus said to them, “Prophets are not without honor except in their own hometown and in their own house.” ⁵⁸And he did not do many deeds of power there, because of their unbelief.

Matthew 14

THE DEATH OF JOHN THE BAPTIST

1 At that time Herod the ruler heard reports about Jesus,* **2**and he said to his servants, “This is John the Baptist; he has been raised from the dead, and for this reason these powers are at work in him.” **3**For Herod had arrested John, bound him, and put him in prison on account of Herodias, his brother Philip’s wife,* **4**because John had been telling him, “It is not lawful for you to have her.”* **5**Though Herod^u wanted to put him to death, he feared the crowd, because they regarded him as a prophet.* **6**But when Herod’s birthday came, the daughter of Herodias danced before the company, and she pleased Herod **7**so much that he promised on oath to grant her whatever she might ask. **8**Prompted by her mother, she said, “Give me the head of John the Baptist here on a platter.” **9**The king was grieved, yet out of regard for his oaths and for the guests, he commanded it to be given; **10**he sent and had John beheaded in the prison. **11**His head was brought on a platter and given to the girl, who brought it to her mother. **12**His disciples came and took the body and buried him; then they went and told Jesus.

FEEDING THE FIVE THOUSAND

13 Now when Jesus heard this, he withdrew from there in a boat to a deserted place by himself. But when the crowds heard it, they followed him on foot from the towns. **14**When he went ashore, he saw a great crowd, and he had compassion for them and cured their sick.* **15**When it was evening, the disciples came to him and said, “This is a deserted place, and the hour is now late; send the crowds away so that they may go into the villages and buy food for themselves.” **16**Jesus said to them, “They need not go away; you give them something to eat.” **17**They replied, “We have nothing here but five loaves and two fish.”* **18**And he said, “Bring them here to me.” **19**Then he ordered the crowds to sit down on the grass. Taking the five loaves and the two fish, he looked up to heaven and blessed and broke the loaves and gave them to the disciples, and the disciples gave them to the

crowds.* ²⁰And all ate and were filled, and they took up what was left over of the broken pieces, twelve baskets full. ²¹And those who ate were about five thousand men, besides women and children.

JESUS WALKS ON THE WATER

22 Immediately he made the disciples get into a boat and go on ahead to the other side, while he dismissed the crowds. ²³And after he had dismissed the crowds, he went up the mountain by himself to pray. When evening came, he was there alone,* ²⁴but by this time the boat, battered by the waves, was far from the land,^v for the wind was against them. ²⁵And early in the morning he came walking toward them on the sea. ²⁶But when the disciples saw him walking on the sea, they were terrified, saying, “It is a ghost!” And they cried out in fear.* ²⁷But immediately Jesus spoke to them and said, “Take heart, it is I; do not be afraid.”*

28 Peter answered him, “Lord, if it is you, command me to come to you on the water.” ²⁹He said, “Come.” So Peter got out of the boat, started walking on the water, and came toward Jesus. ³⁰But when he noticed the strong wind,^w he became frightened, and, beginning to sink, he cried out, “Lord, save me!” ³¹Jesus immediately reached out his hand and caught him, saying to him, “You of little faith, why did you doubt?”* ³²When they got into the boat, the wind ceased. ³³And those in the boat worshiped him, saying, “Truly you are the Son of God.”*

JESUS HEALS THE SICK IN GENNESARET

34 When they had crossed over, they came to land at Gennesaret. ³⁵After the people of that place recognized him, they sent word to that whole surrounding region, and people brought all who were sick to him ³⁶and begged him that they might touch even the fringe of his cloak, and all who touched it were healed.*

Matthew 15

THE TRADITION OF THE ELDERS

1 Then Pharisees and scribes came to Jesus from Jerusalem and said,
²“Why do your disciples break the tradition of the elders? For they do not wash their hands before they eat.”^{*} ³He answered them, “And why do you break the commandment of God for the sake of your tradition? ⁴For God said,^x ‘Honor your father and your mother,’ and, ‘Whoever speaks evil of father or mother must surely die.’^{*} ⁵But you say that whoever tells father or mother, ‘Whatever support you might have had from me is given to God,’^y then that person need not honor the father.^{z,*} ⁶So, for the sake of your tradition, you nullify the word^a of God. ⁷You hypocrites! Isaiah prophesied rightly about you when he said:

⁸‘This people honors me with their lips,
but their hearts are far from me;^{*}
⁹in vain do they worship me,
teaching human precepts as doctrines.’ ”^{*}

THINGS THAT DEFILE

10 Then he called the crowd to him and said to them, “Listen and understand: ¹¹it is not what goes into the mouth that defiles a person, but it is what comes out of the mouth that defiles.”^{*} ¹²Then the disciples approached and said to him, “Do you know that the Pharisees took offense when they heard what you said?” ¹³He answered, “Every plant that my heavenly Father has not planted will be uprooted.”^{*} ¹⁴Let them alone; they are blind guides of the blind.^b And if one blind person guides another, both will fall into a pit.”^{*} ¹⁵But Peter said to him, “Explain this parable to us.”^{*} ¹⁶Then he said, “Are you also still without understanding?”^{*} ¹⁷Do you not see that whatever goes into the mouth enters the stomach and goes out into the sewer? ¹⁸But what comes out of the mouth proceeds from the heart, and this is what defiles.”^{*} ¹⁹For out of the heart come evil intentions, murder,

adultery, sexual immorality, theft, false witness, slander.* ²⁰These are what defile a person, but to eat with unwashed hands does not defile.”

THE CANAANITE WOMAN’S FAITH

21 Jesus left that place and went away to the district of Tyre and Sidon. ²²Just then a Canaanite woman from that region came out and started shouting, “Have mercy on me, Lord, Son of David; my daughter is tormented by a demon.”* ²³But he did not answer her at all. And his disciples came and urged him, saying, “Send her away, for she keeps shouting after us.” ²⁴He answered, “I was sent only to the lost sheep of the house of Israel.”* ²⁵But she came and knelt before him, saying, “Lord, help me.”* ²⁶He answered, “It is not fair to take the children’s food and throw it to the dogs.” ²⁷She said, “Yes, Lord, yet even the dogs eat the crumbs that fall from their masters’^c table.” ²⁸Then Jesus answered her, “Woman, great is your faith! Let it be done for you as you wish.” And her daughter was healed from that moment.*

JESUS CURES MANY PEOPLE

29 After Jesus had left that place, he passed along the Sea of Galilee, and he went up the mountain, where he sat down. ³⁰Great crowds came to him, bringing with them the lame, the blind, the maimed, the mute, and many others. They put them at his feet, and he cured them,* ³¹so that the crowd was amazed when they saw the mute speaking, the maimed whole, the lame walking, and the blind seeing. And they praised the God of Israel.*

FEEDING THE FOUR THOUSAND

32 Then Jesus called his disciples to him and said, “I have compassion for the crowd because they have been with me now for three days and have nothing to eat, and I do not want to send them away hungry, for they might faint on the way.”* ³³The disciples said to him, “Where are we to get enough bread in the desert to feed so great a crowd?” ³⁴Jesus asked them, “How many loaves have you?” They said, “Seven, and a few small fish.” ³⁵Then ordering the crowd to sit down on the ground, ³⁶he took the seven loaves and the fish, and after giving thanks he broke them and gave them to

the disciples, and the disciples gave them to the crowds.*³⁷ And all of them ate and were filled, and they took up the broken pieces left over, seven baskets full.³⁸ Those who had eaten were four thousand men, besides women and children.³⁹ After sending away the crowds, he got into the boat and went to the region of Magadan.^d

Matthew 16

THE DEMAND FOR A SIGN

1 The Pharisees and Sadducees came, and to test Jesus^e they asked him to show them a sign from heaven.* **2**He answered them, “When it is evening, you say, ‘It will be fair weather, for the sky is red.’ **3**And in the morning, ‘It will be stormy today, for the sky is red and threatening.’ You know how to interpret the appearance of the sky, but you cannot interpret the signs of the times.^f **4**An evil and adulterous generation asks for a sign, but no sign will be given to it except the sign of Jonah.” Then he left them and went away.*

THE YEAST OF THE PHARISEES AND SADDUCEES

5 When the disciples reached the other side, they had forgotten to bring any bread. **6**Jesus said to them, “Watch out, and beware of the yeast of the Pharisees and Sadducees.”* **7**They said to one another, “It is because we have brought no bread.” **8**And becoming aware of it, Jesus said, “You of little faith, why are you talking about having no bread?” **9**Do you still not perceive? Do you not remember the five loaves for the five thousand and how many baskets you gathered?* **10**Or the seven loaves for the four thousand and how many baskets you gathered?* **11**How could you fail to perceive that I was not speaking about bread? Beware of the yeast of the Pharisees and Sadducees!” **12**Then they understood that he had not told them to beware of the yeast of bread but of the teaching of the Pharisees and Sadducees.

PETER’S DECLARATION ABOUT JESUS

13 Now when Jesus came into the district of Caesarea Philippi, he asked his disciples, “Who do people say that the Son of Man is?” **14**And they said, “Some say John the Baptist but others Elijah and still others Jeremiah or one of the prophets.”* **15**He said to them, “But who do you say that I am?” **16**Simon Peter answered, “You are the Messiah,^g the Son of the living God.”* **17**And Jesus answered him, “Blessed are you, Simon son of Jonah!

For flesh and blood has not revealed this to you but my Father in heaven.*
¹⁸And I tell you, you are Peter,^h and on this rockⁱ I will build my church,
and the gates of Hades will not prevail against it.* ¹⁹I will give you the keys
of the kingdom of heaven, and whatever you bind on earth will be bound in
heaven, and whatever you loose on earth will be loosed in heaven.”* ²⁰Then
he sternly ordered the disciples not to tell anyone that he was^j the
Messiah.^{k,*}

JESUS FORETELLS HIS DEATH AND RESURRECTION

21 From that time on, Jesus began to show his disciples that he must go
to Jerusalem and undergo great suffering at the hands of the elders and chief
priests and scribes and be killed and on the third day be raised.* ²²And Peter
took him aside and began to rebuke him, saying, “God forbid it, Lord! This
must never happen to you.” ²³But he turned and said to Peter, “Get behind
me, Satan! You are a hindrance^l to me, for you are setting your mind not on
divine things but on human things.”

THE CROSS AND SELF-DENIAL

24 Then Jesus told his disciples, “If any wish to come after me, let them
deny themselves and take up their cross and follow me.* ²⁵For those who
want to save their life will lose it, and those who lose their life for my sake
will find it. ²⁶For what will it profit them if they gain the whole world but
forfeit their life? Or what will they give in return for their life?

27 “For the Son of Man is to come with his angels in the glory of his
Father, and then he will repay everyone for what has been done.* ²⁸Truly I
tell you, there are some standing here who will not taste death before they
see the Son of Man coming in his kingdom.”*

Matthew 17

THE TRANSFIGURATION

1 Six days later, Jesus took with him Peter and James and his brother John and led them up a high mountain, by themselves.* **2** And he was transfigured before them, and his face shone like the sun, and his clothes became bright as light. **3** Suddenly there appeared to them Moses and Elijah, talking with him. **4** Then Peter said to Jesus, “Lord, it is good for us to be here; if you wish, I^m will set up three tents here, one for you, one for Moses, and one for Elijah.” **5** While he was still speaking, suddenly a bright cloud overshadowed them, and a voice from the cloud said, “This is my Son, the Beloved;ⁿ with him I am well pleased; listen to him!”* **6** When the disciples heard this, they fell to the ground and were overcome by fear. **7** But Jesus came and touched them, saying, “Get up and do not be afraid.”* **8** And when they raised their eyes, they saw no one except Jesus himself alone.

9 As they were coming down the mountain, Jesus ordered them, “Tell no one about the vision until after the Son of Man has been raised from the dead.”* **10** And the disciples asked him, “Why, then, do the scribes say that Elijah must come first?”* **11** He replied, “Elijah is indeed coming and will restore all things,* **12** but I tell you that Elijah has already come, and they did not recognize him, but they did to him whatever they pleased. So also the Son of Man is about to suffer at their hands.”* **13** Then the disciples understood that he was speaking to them about John the Baptist.

JESUS CURES A BOY WITH A DEMON

14 When they came to the crowd, a man came to him, knelt before him,¹⁵ and said, “Lord, have mercy on my son, for he has epilepsy and suffers terribly; he often falls into the fire and often into the water. **16** And I brought him to your disciples, but they could not cure him.” **17** Jesus answered, “You faithless and perverse generation, how much longer must I be with you? How much longer must I put up with you? Bring him here to me.” **18** And Jesus rebuked the demon,^o and it^p came out of him, and the boy was cured

from that moment. ¹⁹Then the disciples came to Jesus privately and said, “Why could we not cast it out?” ²⁰He said to them, “Because of your little faith. For truly I tell you, if you have faith the size of a ^q mustard seed, you will say to this mountain, ‘Move from here to there,’ and it will move, and nothing will be impossible for you.”^{r,*}

JESUS AGAIN FORETELLS HIS DEATH AND RESURRECTION

22 As they were gathering^s in Galilee, Jesus said to them, “The Son of Man is going to be betrayed into human hands,^{*} ²³and they will kill him, and on the third day he will be raised.” And they were greatly distressed.

JESUS AND THE TEMPLE TAX

24 When they reached Capernaum, the collectors of the temple tax came to Peter and said, “Does your teacher not pay the temple tax?”^{*} ²⁵He said, “Yes, he does.” And when he came home, Jesus spoke of it first, asking, “What do you think, Simon? From whom do kings of the earth take toll or tribute? From their children or from others?”^{*} ²⁶When Peter^t said, “From others,” Jesus said to him, “Then the children are free. ²⁷However, so that we do not give offense to them, go to the sea and cast a hook; take the first fish that comes up, and when you open its mouth you will find a coin; take that and give it to them for you and me.”^{*}

Matthew 18

TRUE GREATNESS

1 At that time the disciples came to Jesus and asked, “Who is the greatest in the kingdom of heaven?” **2**He called a child, whom he put among them, **3**and said, “Truly I tell you, unless you change and become like children, you will never enter the kingdom of heaven.* **4**Whoever becomes humble like this child is the greatest in the kingdom of heaven. **5**Whoever welcomes one such child in my name welcomes me.*

TEMPTATIONS TO SIN

6 “If any of you cause one of these little ones who believe in me to sin,^u it would be better for you if a great millstone were fastened around your neck and you were drowned in the depth of the sea.* **7**Woe to the world because of things that cause sin!^v Such things are bound to come, but woe to the one through whom they come!*

8 “If your hand or your foot causes you to sin,^w cut it off and throw it away; it is better for you to enter life maimed or lame than to have two hands or two feet and to be thrown into the eternal fire.* **9**And if your eye causes you to sin,^x tear it out and throw it away; it is better for you to enter life with one eye than to have two eyes and to be thrown into the hell^y of fire.*

THE PARABLE OF THE LOST SHEEP

10 “Take care that you do not despise one of these little ones, for I tell you, in heaven their angels continually see the face of my Father in heaven.^{z,*} **12**What do you think? If a shepherd has a hundred sheep and one of them has gone astray, does he not leave the ninety-nine on the mountains and go in search of the one that went astray? **13**And if he finds it, truly I tell you, he rejoices over it more than over the ninety-nine that never went astray. **14**So it is not the will of your^a Father in heaven that one of these little ones should be lost.

REPROVING ANOTHER WHO SINS

15 “If your brother or sister sins against you,^b go and point out the fault when the two of you are alone. If you are listened to, you have regained that one.* **16**But if you are not listened to, take one or two others along with you, so that every word may be confirmed by the evidence of two or three witnesses.* **17**If that person refuses to listen to them, tell it to the church, and if the offender refuses to listen even to the church, let such a one be to you as a gentile and a tax collector.* **18**Truly I tell you, whatever you bind on earth will be bound in heaven, and whatever you loose on earth will be loosed in heaven.* **19**Again, truly I tell you, if two of you agree on earth about anything you ask, it will be done for you by my Father in heaven.* **20**For where two or three are gathered in my name, I am there among them.”

FORGIVENESS

21 Then Peter came and said to him, “Lord, if my brother or sister sins against me, how often should I forgive? As many as seven times?” **22**Jesus said to him, “Not seven times, but, I tell you, seventy-seven^c times.”

THE PARABLE OF THE UNFORGIVING SERVANT

23 “For this reason the kingdom of heaven may be compared to a king who wished to settle accounts with his slaves. **24**When he began the reckoning, one who owed him ten thousand talents was brought to him, **25**and, as he could not pay, the lord ordered him to be sold, together with his wife and children and all his possessions and payment to be made. **26**So the slave fell on his knees before him, saying, ‘Have patience with me, and I will pay you everything.’ **27**And out of pity for him, the lord of that slave released him and forgave him the debt. **28**But that same slave, as he went out, came upon one of his fellow slaves who owed him a hundred denarii, and seizing him by the throat he said, ‘Pay what you owe.’ **29**Then his fellow slave fell down and pleaded with him, ‘Have patience with me, and I will pay you.’ **30**But he refused; then he went and threw him into prison until he would pay the debt. **31**When his fellow slaves saw what had happened, they were greatly distressed, and they went and reported to their lord all that had taken place. **32**Then his lord summoned him and said to

him, ‘You wicked slave! I forgave you all that debt because you pleaded with me. ³³Should you not have had mercy on your fellow slave, as I had mercy on you?’ ³⁴And in anger his lord handed him over to be tortured until he would pay his entire debt. ³⁵So my heavenly Father will also do to every one of you, if you do not forgive your brother or sister from your heart.”

Matthew 19

TEACHING ABOUT DIVORCE

1 When Jesus had finished saying these things, he left Galilee and went to the region of Judea beyond the Jordan.* **2** Large crowds followed him, and he cured them there.*

3 Some Pharisees came to him, and to test him they asked, “Is it lawful for a man to divorce his wife for any cause?”* **4** He answered, “Have you not read that the one who made them at the beginning ‘made them male and female,’* **5** and said, ‘For this reason a man shall leave his father and mother and be joined to his wife, and the two shall become one flesh’?”* **6** So they are no longer two but one flesh. Therefore what God has joined together, let no one separate.” **7** They said to him, “Why then did Moses command us to give a certificate of dismissal and to divorce her?”* **8** He said to them, “It was because you were so hard-hearted that Moses allowed you to divorce your wives, but from the beginning it was not so. **9** And I say to you, whoever divorces his wife, except for sexual immorality, and marries another commits adultery, and he who marries a divorced woman commits adultery.”^{d,*}

10 The^e disciples said to him, “If such is the case of a man with his wife, it is better not to marry.” **11** But he said to them, “Not everyone can accept this teaching, but only those to whom it is given.* **12** For there are eunuchs who have been so from birth, and there are eunuchs who have been made eunuchs by others, and there are eunuchs who have made themselves eunuchs for the sake of the kingdom of heaven. Let anyone accept this who can.”

JESUS BLESSES LITTLE CHILDREN

13 Then children were being brought to him in order that he might lay his hands on them and pray. The disciples spoke sternly to those who brought them, ¹⁴but Jesus said, “Let the children come to me, and do not stop them,

for it is to such as these that the kingdom of heaven belongs.”* ¹⁵And he laid his hands on them and went on his way.

THE RICH YOUNG MAN

16 Then someone came to him and said, “Teacher, what good deed must I do to have eternal life?”* ¹⁷And he said to him, “Why do you ask me about what is good? There is one who is good. If you wish to enter into life, keep the commandments.” ¹⁸He said to him, “Which ones?” And Jesus said, “You shall not murder. You shall not commit adultery. You shall not steal. You shall not bear false witness.* ¹⁹Honor your father and mother. Also, you shall love your neighbor as yourself.”* ²⁰The young man said to him, “I have kept all these;^f what do I still lack?” ²¹Jesus said to him, “If you wish to be perfect, go, sell your possessions, and give the money^g to the poor, and you will have treasure in heaven; then come, follow me.”* ²²When the young man heard this word, he went away grieving, for he had many possessions.

23 Then Jesus said to his disciples, “Truly I tell you, it will be hard for a rich person to enter the kingdom of heaven.* ²⁴Again I tell you, it is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle than for someone who is rich to enter the kingdom of God.” ²⁵When the disciples heard this, they were greatly astounded and said, “Then who can be saved?” ²⁶But Jesus looked at them and said, “For mortals it is impossible, but for God all things are possible.”*

27 Then Peter said in reply, “Look, we have left everything and followed you. What then will we have?”* ²⁸Jesus said to them, “Truly I tell you, at the renewal of all things, when the Son of Man is seated on the throne of his glory, you who have followed me will also sit on twelve thrones, judging the twelve tribes of Israel.* ²⁹And everyone who has left houses or brothers or sisters or father or mother or wife or^h children or fields for my name’s sake will receive a hundredfoldⁱ and will inherit eternal life. ³⁰But many who are first will be last, and the last will be first.*

Matthew 20

THE LABORERS IN THE VINEYARD

1 “For the kingdom of heaven is like a landowner who went out early in the morning to hire laborers for his vineyard. ^{*} **2** After agreeing with the laborers for a denarius for the day, he sent them into his vineyard. **3** When he went out about nine o’clock, he saw others standing idle in the marketplace, ⁴ and he said to them, ‘You also go into the vineyard, and I will pay you whatever is right.’ So they went. **5** When he went out again about noon and about three o’clock, he did the same. **6** And about five o’clock he went out and found others standing around, and he said to them, ‘Why are you standing here idle all day?’ **7** They said to him, ‘Because no one has hired us.’ He said to them, ‘You also go into the vineyard.’ **8** When evening came, the owner of the vineyard said to his manager, ‘Call the laborers and give them their pay, beginning with the last and then going to the first.’ ^{*} **9** When those hired about five o’clock came, each of them received a denarius. **10** Now when the first came, they thought they would receive more; but each of them also received a denarius. **11** And when they received it, they grumbled against the landowner, ¹² saying, ‘These last worked only one hour, and you have made them equal to us who have borne the burden of the day and the scorching heat.’ ^{*} **13** But he replied to one of them, ‘Friend, I am doing you no wrong; did you not agree with me for a denarius?’ ^{*} **14** Take what belongs to you and go; I choose to give to this last the same as I give to you. **15** Am I not allowed to do what I choose with what belongs to me? Or are you envious because I am generous?’ ^{j,*} **16** So the last will be first, and the first will be last.’ ^{k,*}

A THIRD TIME JESUS FORETELLS HIS DEATH AND RESURRECTION

17 While Jesus was going up to Jerusalem, he took the twelve disciples aside by themselves and said to them on the way, ¹⁸ “Look, we are going up to Jerusalem, and the Son of Man will be handed over to the chief priests

and scribes, and they will condemn him to death;* ¹⁹then they will hand him over to the gentiles to be mocked and flogged and crucified, and on the third day he will be raised.”*

THE REQUEST OF THE MOTHER OF JAMES AND JOHN

20 Then the mother of the sons of Zebedee came to him with her sons, and kneeling before him, she asked a favor of him.* ²¹And he said to her, “What do you want?” She said to him, “Declare that these two sons of mine will sit, one at your right hand and one at your left, in your kingdom.”* ²²But Jesus answered, “You do not know what you are asking. Are you able to drink the cup that I am about to drink?”¹ They said to him, “We are able.”* ²³He said to them, “You will indeed drink my cup, but to sit at my right hand and at my left, this is not mine to grant, but it is for those for whom it has been prepared by my Father.”*

24 When the ten heard it, they were angry with the two brothers.* ²⁵But Jesus called them to him and said, “You know that the rulers of the gentiles lord it over them, and their great ones are tyrants over them.* ²⁶It will not be so among you, but whoever wishes to be great among you must be your servant,* ²⁷and whoever wishes to be first among you must be your slave, ²⁸just as the Son of Man came not to be served but to serve and to give his life a ransom for many.”*

JESUS HEALS TWO BLIND MEN

29 As they were leaving Jericho, a large crowd followed him. ³⁰There were two blind men sitting by the roadside. When they heard that Jesus was passing by, they shouted, “Lord,^m have mercy on us, Son of David!”* ³¹The crowd sternly ordered them to be quiet, but they shouted even more loudly, “Have mercy on us, Lord, Son of David!” ³²Jesus stood still and called them, saying, “What do you want me to do for you?” ³³They said to him, “Lord, let our eyes be opened.” ³⁴Moved with compassion, Jesus touched their eyes. Immediately they regained their sight and followed him.

Matthew 21

JESUS'S TRIUMPHAL ENTRY INTO JERUSALEM

1 When they had come near Jerusalem and had reached Bethphage, at the Mount of Olives, Jesus sent two disciples, ²saying to them, “Go into the village ahead of you, and immediately you will find a donkey tied and a colt with her; untie them and bring them to me. ³If anyone says anything to you, just say this, ‘The Lord needs them.’ And he will send them immediately.”ⁿ

⁴This took place to fulfill what had been spoken through the prophet:

⁵“Tell the daughter of Zion,
Look, your king is coming to you,
humble and mounted on a donkey,
and on a colt, the foal of a donkey.”*

⁶The disciples went and did as Jesus had directed them; ⁷they brought the donkey and the colt and put their cloaks on them, and he sat on them. ⁸A very large crowd^o spread their cloaks on the road, and others cut branches from the trees and spread them on the road.* ⁹The crowds that went ahead of him and that followed were shouting,

“Hosanna to the Son of David!

Blessed is the one who comes in the name of the Lord!

Hosanna in the highest heaven!”*

¹⁰When he entered Jerusalem, the whole city was in turmoil, asking, “Who is this?” ¹¹The crowds were saying, “This is the prophet Jesus from Nazareth in Galilee.”*

JESUS CLEANSSES THE TEMPLE

12 Then Jesus entered the temple^p and drove out all who were selling and buying in the temple, and he overturned the tables of the money changers and the seats of those who sold doves.* ¹³He said to them, “It is written,

‘My house shall be called a house of prayer,’

but you are making it a den of robbers.”*

14 The blind and the lame came to him in the temple, and he cured them.
¹⁵But when the chief priests and the scribes saw the amazing things that he did and heard⁹ the children crying out in the temple and saying, “Hosanna to the Son of David,” they became angry* ¹⁶and said to him, “Do you hear what these are saying?” Jesus said to them, “Yes; have you never read,

‘Out of the mouths of infants and nursing babies
you have prepared praise for yourself’?”*

¹⁷He left them, went out of the city to Bethany, and spent the night there.

JESUS CURSES THE FIG TREE

18 In the morning, when he returned to the city, he was hungry. ¹⁹And seeing a fig tree by the side of the road, he went to it and found nothing at all on it but leaves. Then he said to it, “May no fruit ever come from you again!” And the fig tree withered at once. ²⁰When the disciples saw it, they were amazed, saying, “How did the fig tree wither at once?” ²¹Jesus answered them, “Truly I tell you, if you have faith and do not doubt, not only will you do what has been done to the fig tree, but even if you say to this mountain, ‘Be lifted up and thrown into the sea,’ it will be done.*
²²Whatever you ask for in prayer with faith, you will receive.”*

THE AUTHORITY OF JESUS QUESTIONED

23 When he entered the temple, the chief priests and the elders of the people came to him as he was teaching and said, “By what authority are you doing these things, and who gave you this authority?”* ²⁴Jesus said to them, “I will also ask you one question; if you tell me the answer, then I will also tell you by what authority I do these things. ²⁵Did the baptism of John come from heaven, or was it of human origin?” And they argued with one another, “If we say, ‘From heaven,’ he will say to us, ‘Why, then, did you not believe him?’ ²⁶But if we say, ‘Of human origin,’ we are afraid of the crowd, for all regard John as a prophet.”* ²⁷So they answered Jesus, “We do not know.” And he said to them, “Neither will I tell you by what authority I am doing these things.

THE PARABLE OF THE TWO SONS

28 “What do you think? A man had two sons; he went to the first and said, ‘Son, go and work in the vineyard today.’^{*} **29** He answered, ‘I will not,’ but later he changed his mind and went. **30** The father^r went to the second and said the same, and he answered, ‘I go, sir,’ but he did not go. **31** Which of the two did the will of his father?” They said, “The first.” Jesus said to them, “Truly I tell you, the tax collectors and the prostitutes are going into the kingdom of God ahead of you.”^{*} **32** For John came to you in the way of righteousness, and you did not believe him, but the tax collectors and the prostitutes believed him, and even after you saw it you did not change your minds and believe him.”^{*}

THE PARABLE OF THE WICKED TENANTS

33 “Listen to another parable. There was a landowner who planted a vineyard, put a fence around it, dug a winepress in it, and built a watchtower. Then he leased it to tenants and went away.”^{*} **34** When the harvest time had come, he sent his slaves to the tenants to collect his produce.”^{*} **35** But the tenants seized his slaves and beat one, killed another, and stoned another.”^{*} **36** Again he sent other slaves, more than the first, and they treated them in the same way. **37** Then he sent his son to them, saying, ‘They will respect my son.’ **38** But when the tenants saw the son, they said to themselves, ‘This is the heir; come, let us kill him and get his inheritance.’^{*} **39** So they seized him, threw him out of the vineyard, and killed him. **40** Now when the owner of the vineyard comes, what will he do to those tenants?” **41** They said to him, “He will put those wretches to a miserable death and lease the vineyard to other tenants who will give him the produce at the harvest time.”^{*}

42 Jesus said to them, “Have you never read in the scriptures:

‘The stone that the builders rejected

has become the cornerstone;^s

this was the Lord’s doing,

and it is amazing in our eyes’?”^{*}

⁴³“Therefore I tell you, the kingdom of God will be taken away from you and given to a people that produces its fruits.”⁴⁴The one who falls on this stone will be broken to pieces, and it will crush anyone on whom it falls.”^t

45 When the chief priests and the Pharisees heard his parables, they realized that he was speaking about them.⁴⁶They wanted to arrest him, but they feared the crowds, because they regarded him as a prophet.^{*}

Matthew 22

THE PARABLE OF THE WEDDING BANQUET

1 Once more Jesus spoke to them in parables, saying: ²“The kingdom of heaven may be compared to a king who gave a wedding banquet for his son.* ³He sent his slaves to call those who had been invited to the wedding banquet, but they would not come.* ⁴Again he sent other slaves, saying, ‘Tell those who have been invited: Look, I have prepared my dinner, my oxen and my fat calves have been slaughtered, and everything is ready; come to the wedding banquet.’* ⁵But they made light of it and went away, one to his farm, another to his business, ⁶while the rest seized his slaves, mistreated them, and killed them. ⁷The king was enraged. He sent his troops, destroyed those murderers, and burned their city.* ⁸Then he said to his slaves, ‘The wedding is ready, but those invited were not worthy.* ⁹Go therefore into the main streets, and invite everyone you find to the wedding banquet.’ ¹⁰Those slaves went out into the streets and gathered all whom they found, both good and bad, so the wedding hall was filled with guests.*

11 “But when the king came in to see the guests, he noticed a man there who was not wearing a wedding robe,* ¹²and he said to him, ‘Friend, how did you get in here without a wedding robe?’ And he was speechless.* ¹³Then the king said to the attendants, ‘Bind him hand and foot, and throw him into the outer darkness, where there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth.’* ¹⁴For many are called, but few are chosen.”

THE QUESTION ABOUT PAYING TAXES

15 Then the Pharisees went and plotted to entrap him in what he said. ¹⁶So they sent their disciples to him, along with the Herodians, saying, “Teacher, we know that you are sincere, and teach the way of God in accordance with truth, and show deference to no one, for you do not regard people with partiality.* ¹⁷Tell us, then, what you think. Is it lawful to pay taxes to Caesar or not?”* ¹⁸But Jesus, aware of their malice, said, “Why are you putting me to the test, you hypocrites? ¹⁹Show me the coin used for the

tax.” And they brought him a denarius. ²⁰Then he said to them, “Whose head is this and whose title?” ²¹They answered, “Caesar’s.” Then he said to them, “Give therefore to Caesar the things that are Caesar’s and to God the things that are God’s.”* ²²When they heard this, they were amazed, and they left him and went away.

THE QUESTION ABOUT THE RESURRECTION

23 The same day some Sadducees came to him saying there is no resurrection,^u and they asked him a question: * ²⁴“Teacher, Moses said, ‘If a man dies childless, his brother shall marry the widow and raise up children for his brother.’” * ²⁵Now there were seven brothers among us; the first married and died childless, leaving the widow to his brother. ²⁶The second did the same, so also the third, down to the seventh. ²⁷Last of all, the woman herself died. ²⁸In the resurrection, then, whose wife of the seven will she be? For all of them had married her.”

29 Jesus answered them, “You are wrong because you know neither the scriptures nor the power of God.” * ³⁰For in the resurrection people neither marry nor are given in marriage but are like angels of God^v in heaven. ³¹And as for the resurrection of the dead, have you not read what was said to you by God, ³²‘I am the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob’? He is God not of the dead but of the living.”* ³³And when the crowds heard it, they were astounded at his teaching.*

THE GREATEST COMMANDMENT

34 When the Pharisees heard that he had silenced the Sadducees, they gathered together, ³⁵and one of them, an expert in the law, asked him a question to test him.* ³⁶“Teacher, which commandment in the law is the greatest?” ³⁷He said to him, “ ‘You shall love the Lord your God with all your heart and with all your soul and with all your mind.’” * ³⁸This is the greatest and first commandment. ³⁹And a second is like it: ‘You shall love your neighbor as yourself.’” * ⁴⁰On these two commandments hang all the Law and the Prophets.”*

THE QUESTION ABOUT DAVID'S SON

41 Now while the Pharisees were gathered together, Jesus asked them this question: ⁴²“What do you think of the Messiah?^w Whose son is he?” They said to him, “The son of David.”^{*} ⁴³He said to them, “How is it then that David by the Spirit^x calls him Lord, saying,

⁴⁴‘The Lord said to my Lord,

“Sit at my right hand,

until I put your enemies under your feet” ’?^{*}

⁴⁵“If David thus calls him Lord, how can he be his son?” ⁴⁶No one was able to give him an answer, nor from that day did anyone dare to ask him any more questions.^{*}

Matthew 23

JESUS DENOUNCES SCRIBES AND PHARISEES

1 Then Jesus said to the crowds and to his disciples, ²“The scribes and the Pharisees sit on Moses’s seat; ^{*} ³therefore, do whatever they teach you and follow it, but do not do as they do, for they do not practice what they teach. ⁴They tie up heavy burdens, hard to bear,^y and lay them on the shoulders of others, but they themselves are unwilling to lift a finger to move them.^{*} ⁵They do all their deeds to be seen by others, for they make their phylacteries broad and their fringes long.^{*} ⁶They love to have the place of honor at banquets and the best seats in the synagogues^{*} ⁷and to be greeted with respect in the marketplaces and to have people call them rabbi. ⁸But you are not to be called rabbi, for you have one teacher, and you are all brothers and sisters.^{*} ⁹And call no one your father on earth, for you have one Father, the one in heaven.^{*} ¹⁰Nor are you to be called instructors, for you have one instructor, the Messiah.^z ¹¹The greatest among you will be your servant.^{*} ¹²All who exalt themselves will be humbled, and all who humble themselves will be exalted.^{*}

13 “But woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! For you lock people out of the kingdom of heaven. For you do not go in yourselves, and when others are going in you stop them.^{a,*} ¹⁵Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! For you cross sea and land to make a single convert, and you make the new convert twice as much a child of hell^b as yourselves.

16 “Woe to you, blind guides who say, ‘Whoever swears by the sanctuary is bound by nothing, but whoever swears by the gold of the sanctuary is bound by the oath.’^{*} ¹⁷You blind fools! For which is greater, the gold or the sanctuary that has made the gold sacred?^{*} ¹⁸And you say, ‘Whoever swears by the altar is bound by nothing, but whoever swears by the gift that is on the altar is bound by the oath.’ ¹⁹How blind you are! For which is greater, the gift or the altar that makes the gift sacred?^{*} ²⁰So whoever swears by the altar swears by it and by everything on it, ²¹and whoever swears by the sanctuary swears by it and by the one who dwells in it, ²²and whoever

swears by heaven swears by the throne of God and by the one who is seated upon it.*

23 “Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! For you tithe mint, dill, and cumin and have neglected the weightier matters of the law: justice and mercy and faith. It is these you ought to have practiced without neglecting the others.* ²⁴You blind guides! You strain out a gnat but swallow a camel!

25 “Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! For you clean the outside of the cup and of the plate, but inside they are full of greed and self-indulgence. ²⁶You blind Pharisee! First clean the inside of the cup and of the plate,^c so that the outside also may become clean.

27 “Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! For you are like whitewashed tombs, which on the outside look beautiful but inside are full of the bones of the dead and of all kinds of uncleanness. ²⁸So you also on the outside look righteous to others, but inside you are full of hypocrisy and lawlessness.

29 “Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! For you build the tombs of the prophets and decorate the graves of the righteous, ³⁰and you say, ‘If we had lived in the days of our ancestors, we would not have taken part with them in shedding the blood of the prophets.’ ³¹Thus you testify against yourselves that you are descendants of those who murdered the prophets. ³²Fill up, then, the measure of your ancestors. ³³You snakes, you brood of vipers! How can you escape the judgment of hell?^d ³⁴For this reason I send you prophets, sages, and scribes, some of whom you will kill and crucify, and some you will flog in your synagogues and pursue from town to town, ³⁵so that upon you may come all the righteous blood shed on earth, from the blood of righteous Abel to the blood of Zechariah son of Barachiah, whom you murdered between the sanctuary and the altar. ³⁶Truly I tell you, all this will come upon this generation.

THE LAMENT OVER JERUSALEM

37 “Jerusalem, Jerusalem, the city that kills the prophets and stones those who are sent to it! How often have I desired to gather your children together as a hen gathers her brood under her wings, and you were not willing!

³⁸See, your house is left to you, desolate.^e ³⁹For I tell you, you will not see me again until you say, ‘Blessed is the one who comes in the name of the Lord.’ ”*

Matthew 24

THE DESTRUCTION OF THE TEMPLE FORETOLD

1 As Jesus came out of the temple and was going away, his disciples came to point out to him the buildings of the temple.* **2** Then he asked them, “You see all these, do you not? Truly I tell you, not one stone will be left here upon another; all will be thrown down.”*

SIGNS OF THE END OF THE AGE

3 When he was sitting on the Mount of Olives, the disciples came to him privately, saying, “Tell us, when will this be, and what will be the sign of your coming and of the end of the age?” **4** Jesus answered them, “Beware that no one leads you astray.* **5** For many will come in my name, saying, ‘I am the Messiah!’^f and they will lead many astray. **6** And you will hear of wars and rumors of wars; see that you are not alarmed, for this must take place, but the end is not yet. **7** For nation will rise against nation and kingdom against kingdom, and there will be famines^g and earthquakes in various places.* **8** all this is but the beginning of the birth pangs.

PERSECUTIONS FORETOLD

9 “Then they will hand you over to be tortured and will put you to death, and you will be hated by all nations because of my name.* **10** Then many will fall away,^h and they will betray one another and hate one another.* **11** And many false prophets will arise and lead many astray.* **12** And because of the increase of lawlessness, the love of many will grow cold. **13** But the one who endures to the end will be saved.* **14** And this good newsⁱ of the kingdom will be proclaimed throughout the world, as a testimony to all the nations, and then the end will come.*

THE DESOLATING SACRILEGE

15 “So when you see the desolating sacrilege, spoken of by the prophet Daniel, standing in the holy place (let the reader understand),^{*} ¹⁶then those in Judea must flee to the mountains; ¹⁷the one on the housetop must not go down to take things from the house; ¹⁸the one in the field must not turn back to get a coat. ¹⁹Woe to those who are pregnant and to those who are nursing infants in those days! ²⁰Pray that your flight may not be in winter or on a Sabbath. ²¹For at that time there will be great suffering, such as has not been from the beginning of the world until now, no, and never will be.^{*} ²²And if those days had not been cut short, no one would be saved, but for the sake of the elect those days will be cut short.^{*} ²³Then if anyone says to you, ‘Look! Here is the Messiah!’^j or ‘There he is!’—do not believe it.^{*} ²⁴For false messiahs^k and false prophets will appear and produce great signs and wonders, to lead astray, if possible, even the elect.^{*} ²⁵Take note, I have told you beforehand. ²⁶So, if they say to you, ‘Look! He is in the wilderness,’ do not go out. If they say, ‘Look! He is in the inner rooms,’ do not believe it. ²⁷For as the lightning comes from the east and flashes as far as the west, so will be the coming of the Son of Man.^{*} ²⁸Wherever the corpse is, there the eagles will gather.

THE COMING OF THE SON OF MAN

29 “Immediately after the suffering of those days
the sun will be darkened,
and the moon will not give its light;
the stars will fall from heaven,
and the powers of heaven will be shaken.^{*}

³⁰“Then the sign of the Son of Man will appear in heaven, and then all the tribes of the earth will mourn, and they will see ‘the Son of Man coming on the clouds of heaven’ with power and great glory.^{*} ³¹And he will send out his angels with a loud trumpet call, and they will gather his elect from the four winds, from one end of heaven to the other.^{*}

THE LESSON OF THE FIG TREE

32 “From the fig tree learn its lesson: as soon as its branch becomes tender and puts forth its leaves, you know that summer is near. ³³So also, when you see all these things, you know that he^l is near, at the very gates. ³⁴Truly I tell you, this generation will not pass away until all these things have taken place. * ³⁵Heaven and earth will pass away, but my words will not pass away.*

THE NECESSITY FOR WATCHFULNESS

36 “But about that day and hour no one knows, neither the angels of heaven, nor the Son,^m but only the Father. ³⁷For as the days of Noah were, so will be the coming of the Son of Man. * ³⁸For as in the days before the flood they were eating and drinking, marrying and giving in marriage, until the day Noah entered the ark, ³⁹and they knew nothing until the flood came and swept them all away, so, too, will be the coming of the Son of Man. ⁴⁰Then two will be in the field; one will be taken, and one will be left.* ⁴¹Two women will be grinding meal together; one will be taken, and one will be left. ⁴²Keep awake, therefore, for you do not know on what dayⁿ your Lord is coming. * ⁴³But understand this: if the owner of the house had known in what part of the night the thief was coming, he would have stayed awake and would not have let his house be broken into. * ⁴⁴Therefore you also must be ready, for the Son of Man is coming at an hour you do not expect.*

THE FAITHFUL OR THE UNFAITHFUL SLAVE

45 “Who, then, is the faithful and wise slave whom his master has put in charge of his household, to give the other slaves^o their allowance of food at the proper time? * ⁴⁶Blessed is that slave whom his master will find at work when he arrives. * ⁴⁷Truly I tell you, he will put that one in charge of all his possessions. * ⁴⁸But if that wicked slave says to himself, ‘My master is delayed,’ ⁴⁹and begins to beat his fellow slaves and eats and drinks with drunkards, ⁵⁰the master of that slave will come on a day when he does not expect him and at an hour that he does not know. ⁵¹He will cut him in pieces^p and put him with the hypocrites, where there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth.*

Matthew 25

THE PARABLE OF THE TEN BRIDESMAIDS

1 “Then the kingdom of heaven will be like this. Ten young women^q took their lamps and went to meet the bridegroom.^{r,*} **2** Five of them were foolish, and five were wise.^{*} **3** When the foolish took their lamps, they took no oil with them, **4** but the wise took flasks of oil with their lamps. **5** As the bridegroom was delayed, all of them became drowsy and slept.^{*} **6** But at midnight there was a shout, ‘Look! Here is the bridegroom! Come out to meet him.’ **7** Then all those young women^s got up and trimmed their lamps.^{*} **8** The foolish said to the wise, ‘Give us some of your oil, for our lamps are going out.’ **9** But the wise replied, ‘No! there will not be enough for you and for us; you had better go to the dealers and buy some for yourselves.’ **10** And while they went to buy it, the bridegroom came, and those who were ready went with him into the wedding banquet, and the door was shut.^{*} **11** Later the other young women^t came also, saying, ‘Lord, lord, open to us.’^{*} **12** But he replied, ‘Truly I tell you, I do not know you.’ **13** Keep awake, therefore, for you know neither the day nor the hour.^{u,*}

THE PARABLE OF THE TALENTS

14 “For it is as if a man, going on a journey, summoned his slaves and entrusted his property to them;^{*} **15** to one he gave five talents, to another two, to another one, to each according to his ability. Then he went away. At once^{*} **16** the one who had received the five talents went off and traded with them and made five more talents. **17** In the same way, the one who had the two talents made two more talents. **18** But the one who had received the one talent went off and dug a hole in the ground and hid his master’s money. **19** After a long time the master of those slaves came and settled accounts with them.^{*} **20** Then the one who had received the five talents came forward, bringing five more talents, saying, ‘Master, you handed over to me five talents; see, I have made five more talents.’ **21** His master said to him, ‘Well done, good and trustworthy slave; you have been trustworthy in a few

things; I will put you in charge of many things; enter into the joy of your master.’^{* 22}And the one with the two talents also came forward, saying, ‘Master, you handed over to me two talents; see, I have made two more talents.’²³His master said to him, ‘Well done, good and trustworthy slave; you have been trustworthy in a few things; I will put you in charge of many things; enter into the joy of your master.’²⁴Then the one who had received the one talent also came forward, saying, ‘Master, I knew that you were a harsh man, reaping where you did not sow and gathering where you did not scatter,’^{* 25}so I was afraid, and I went and hid your talent in the ground. Here you have what is yours.’²⁶But his master replied, ‘You wicked and lazy slave! You knew, did you, that I reap where I did not sow and gather where I did not scatter?’²⁷Then you ought to have invested my money with the bankers, and on my return I would have received what was my own with interest.’^{* 28}So take the talent from him, and give it to the one with the ten talents.²⁹For to all those who have, more will be given, and they will have an abundance, but from those who have nothing, even what they have will be taken away.’^{* 30}As for this worthless slave, throw him into the outer darkness, where there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth.’^{*}

THE JUDGMENT OF THE NATIONS

31 “When the Son of Man comes in his glory and all the angels with him, then he will sit on the throne of his glory.’^{* 32}All the nations will be gathered before him, and he will separate people one from another as a shepherd separates the sheep from the goats,’^{* 33}and he will put the sheep at his right hand and the goats at the left.³⁴Then the king will say to those at his right hand, ‘Come, you who are blessed by my Father, inherit the kingdom prepared for you from the foundation of the world,’^{* 35}for I was hungry and you gave me food, I was thirsty and you gave me something to drink, I was a stranger and you welcomed me,’^{* 36}I was naked and you gave me clothing, I was sick and you took care of me, I was in prison and you visited me.’^{* 37}Then the righteous will answer him, ‘Lord, when was it that we saw you hungry and gave you food or thirsty and gave you something to drink?’³⁸And when was it that we saw you a stranger and welcomed you or naked and gave you clothing?’³⁹And when was it that we saw you sick or in prison and visited you?’⁴⁰And the king will answer them, ‘Truly I tell you, just as

you did it to one of the least of these brothers and sisters of mine, you did it to me.’* ⁴¹Then he will say to those at his left hand, ‘You who are accursed, depart from me into the eternal fire prepared for the devil and his angels,’* ⁴²for I was hungry and you gave me no food, I was thirsty and you gave me nothing to drink, ⁴³I was a stranger and you did not welcome me, naked and you did not give me clothing, sick and in prison and you did not visit me.’ ⁴⁴Then they also will answer, ‘Lord, when was it that we saw you hungry or thirsty or a stranger or naked or sick or in prison and did not take care of you?’ ⁴⁵Then he will answer them, ‘Truly I tell you, just as you did not do it to one of the least of these, you did not do it to me.’* ⁴⁶And these will go away into eternal punishment but the righteous into eternal life.’*

Matthew 26

THE PLOT TO KILL JESUS

1 When Jesus had finished saying all these things, he said to his disciples,
2“You know that after two days the Passover is coming, and the Son of Man will be handed over to be crucified.”*

3 Then the chief priests and the elders of the people gathered in the courtyard of the high priest, who was called Caiaphas,* **4**and they conspired to arrest Jesus by stealth and kill him.* **5**But they said, “Not during the festival, or there may be a riot among the people.”*

THE ANOINTING AT BETHANY

6 Now while Jesus was at Bethany in the house of Simon the leper,^{v,*} **7**a woman came to him with an alabaster jar of very costly ointment, and she poured it on his head as he sat at the table. **8**But when the disciples saw it, they were angry and said, “Why this waste? **9**For this ointment could have been sold for a large sum and the money given to the poor.” **10**But Jesus, aware of this, said to them, “Why do you trouble the woman? She has performed a good service for me. **11**For you always have the poor with you, but you will not always have me.* **12**By pouring this ointment on my body she has prepared me for burial.* **13**Truly I tell you, wherever this good news^w is proclaimed in the whole world, what she has done will be told in remembrance of her.”

JUDAS AGREES TO BETRAY JESUS

14 Then one of the twelve, who was called Judas Iscariot, went to the chief priests **15**and said, “What will you give me if I betray him to you?” They paid him thirty pieces of silver.* **16**And from that moment he began to look for an opportunity to betray him.

THE PASSOVER WITH THE DISCIPLES

17 On the first day of Unleavened Bread the disciples came to Jesus, saying, “Where do you want us to make the preparations for you to eat the Passover?” ¹⁸He said, “Go into the city to a certain man and say to him, ‘The Teacher says, My time is near; I will keep the Passover at your house with my disciples.’ ”* ¹⁹So the disciples did as Jesus had directed them, and they prepared the Passover meal.*

20 When it was evening, he took his place with the twelve disciples,^x ²¹and while they were eating he said, “Truly I tell you, one of you will betray me.” ²²And they became greatly distressed and began to say to him one after another, “Surely not I, Lord?” ²³He answered, “The one who has dipped his hand into the bowl with me will betray me.”* ²⁴The Son of Man goes as it is written of him, but woe to that one by whom the Son of Man is betrayed! It would have been better for that one not to have been born.” ²⁵Judas, who betrayed him, said, “Surely not I, Rabbi?” He replied, “You have said so.”

THE INSTITUTION OF THE LORD’S SUPPER

26 While they were eating, Jesus took a loaf of bread, and after blessing it^y he broke it, gave it to the disciples, and said, “Take, eat; this is my body.”* ²⁷Then he took a cup, and after giving thanks he gave it to them, saying, “Drink from it, all of you, ²⁸for this is my blood of the^z covenant, which is poured out for many for the forgiveness of sins.”* ²⁹I tell you, I will never again drink of this fruit of the vine until that day when I drink it new with you in my Father’s kingdom.”*

30 When they had sung the hymn, they went out to the Mount of Olives.*

PETER’S DENIAL FORETOLD

31 Then Jesus said to them, “You will all fall away^a because of me this night, for it is written,

‘I will strike the shepherd,

and the sheep of the flock will be scattered.’*

³²“But after I am raised up, I will go ahead of you to Galilee.”* ³³Peter said to him, “Even if all fall away^b because of you, I will never fall away.”^c

³⁴Jesus said to him, “Truly I tell you, this very night, before the cock crows, you will deny me three times.”^{*} ³⁵Peter said to him, “Even though I must die with you, I will not deny you.” And so said all the disciples.^{*}

JESUS PRAYS IN GETHSEMANE

36 Then Jesus went with them to a place called Gethsemane, and he said to his disciples, “Sit here while I go over there and pray.” ³⁷He took with him Peter and the two sons of Zebedee and began to be grieved and agitated.^{*} ³⁸Then he said to them, “My soul is deeply grieved, even to death; remain here, and stay awake with me.”^{*} ³⁹And going a little farther, he threw himself on the ground and prayed, “My Father, if it is possible, let this cup pass from me, yet not what I want but what you want.”^{*} ⁴⁰Then he came to the disciples and found them sleeping, and he said to Peter, “So, could you not stay awake with me one hour?”^{*} ⁴¹Stay awake and pray that you may not come into the time of trial;^d the spirit indeed is willing, but the flesh is weak.”^{*} ⁴²Again he went away for the second time and prayed, “My Father, if this cannot pass unless I drink it, your will be done.”^{*} ⁴³Again he came and found them sleeping, for their eyes were heavy. ⁴⁴So leaving them again, he went away and prayed for the third time, saying the same words. ⁴⁵Then he came to the disciples and said to them, “Are you still sleeping and taking your rest? Now the hour is at hand, and the Son of Man is betrayed into the hands of sinners.”^{*} ⁴⁶Get up, let us be going. Look, my betrayer is at hand.”

THE BETRAYAL AND ARREST OF JESUS

47 While he was still speaking, Judas, one of the twelve, arrived; with him was a large crowd with swords and clubs, from the chief priests and the elders of the people. ⁴⁸Now the betrayer had given them a sign, saying, “The one I will kiss is the man; arrest him.” ⁴⁹At once he came up to Jesus and said, “Greetings, Rabbi!” and kissed him.^{*} ⁵⁰Jesus said to him, “Friend, do what you are here to do.”^e Then they came and laid hands on Jesus and arrested him.^{*} ⁵¹Suddenly one of those with Jesus put his hand on his sword, drew it, and struck the slave of the high priest, cutting off his ear. ⁵²Then Jesus said to him, “Put your sword back into its place, for all who

take the sword will die by the sword.* ⁵³Do you think that I cannot appeal to my Father, and he will at once send me more than twelve legions of angels? * ⁵⁴But how then would the scriptures be fulfilled, which say it must happen in this way? ” * ⁵⁵At that hour Jesus said to the crowds, “Have you come out with swords and clubs to arrest me as though I were a rebel? Day after day I sat in the temple teaching, and you did not arrest me. ⁵⁶But all this has taken place, so that the scriptures of the prophets may be fulfilled.” Then all the disciples deserted him and fled.*

JESUS BEFORE THE HIGH PRIEST

57 Those who had arrested Jesus took him to Caiaphas the high priest, where the scribes and the elders had gathered. ⁵⁸But Peter was following him at a distance, as far as the courtyard of the high priest, and going inside he sat with the guards in order to see how this would end. * ⁵⁹Now the chief priests and the whole council were looking for false testimony against Jesus so that they might put him to death, ⁶⁰but they found none, though many false witnesses came forward. At last two came forward * ⁶¹and said, “This fellow said, ‘I am able to destroy the temple of God and to build it in three days.’ ” * ⁶²The high priest stood up and said, “Have you no answer? What is it that they testify against you?” ⁶³But Jesus was silent. Then the high priest said to him, “I put you under oath before the living God, tell us if you are the Messiah,^f the Son of God.” * ⁶⁴Jesus said to him, “You have said so. But I tell you,

From now on you will see the Son of Man
seated at the right hand of Power
and coming on the clouds of heaven.”*

⁶⁵Then the high priest tore his clothes and said, “He has blasphemed! Why do we still need witnesses? You have now heard his blasphemy. * ⁶⁶What do you think?” They answered, “He deserves death.” * ⁶⁷Then they spat in his face and struck him, and some slapped him, * ⁶⁸saying, “Prophecy to us, you Messiah!^g Who is it that struck you?”

PETER’S DENIAL OF JESUS

69 Now Peter was sitting outside in the courtyard. A female servant came to him and said, “You also were with Jesus the Galilean.” ⁷⁰But he denied it before all of them, saying, “I do not know what you are talking about.” ⁷¹When he went out to the porch, another female servant saw him, and she said to the bystanders, “This man was with Jesus the Nazarene.”^h ⁷²Again he denied it with an oath, “I do not know the man.” ⁷³After a little while the bystanders came up and said to Peter, “Certainly you are also one of them, for your accent betrays you.” ⁷⁴Then he began to curse, and he swore an oath, “I do not know the man!” At that moment the cock crowed. ⁷⁵Then Peter remembered what Jesus had said: “Before the cock crows, you will deny me three times.” And he went out and wept bitterly.*

Matthew 27

JESUS BROUGHT BEFORE PILATE

1 When morning came, all the chief priests and the elders of the people conferred together against Jesus in order to bring about his death. ²They bound him, led him away, and handed him over to Pilate the governor.*

THE SUICIDE OF JUDAS

3 When Judas, his betrayer, saw that Jesusⁱ was condemned, he repented and brought back the thirty pieces of silver to the chief priests and the elders.* ⁴He said, “I have sinned by betraying innocent^j blood.” But they said, “What is that to us? See to it yourself.”* ⁵Throwing down the pieces of silver in the temple, he departed, and he went and hanged himself.* ⁶But the chief priests, taking the pieces of silver, said, “It is not lawful to put them into the treasury, since they are blood money.” ⁷After conferring together, they used them to buy the potter’s field as a place to bury foreigners. ⁸For this reason that field has been called the Field of Blood to this day.* ⁹Then was fulfilled what had been spoken through the prophet Jeremiah,^k “And they took^l the thirty pieces of silver, the price of the one on whom a price had been set,^m on whom some of the people of Israel had set a price,* ¹⁰and they gaveⁿ them for the potter’s field, as the Lord commanded me.”

PILATE QUESTIONS JESUS

11 Now Jesus stood before the governor, and the governor asked him, “Are you the king of the Jews?” Jesus said, “You say so.” ¹²But when he was accused by the chief priests and elders, he did not answer.* ¹³Then Pilate said to him, “Do you not hear how many accusations they make against you?”* ¹⁴But he gave him no answer, not even to a single charge, so that the governor was greatly amazed.*

BARABBAS OR JESUS?

15 Now at the festival the governor was accustomed to release a prisoner for the crowd, anyone whom they wanted. ¹⁶At that time they had a notorious prisoner called Jesus^o Barabbas. ¹⁷So after they had gathered, Pilate said to them, “Whom do you want me to release for you, Jesus^p Barabbas or Jesus who is called the Messiah?”^q ¹⁸For he realized that it was out of jealousy that they had handed him over. ¹⁹While he was sitting on the judgment seat, his wife sent word to him, “Have nothing to do with that innocent man, for today I have suffered a great deal because of a dream about him.”^{*} ²⁰Now the chief priests and the elders persuaded the crowds to ask for Barabbas and to have Jesus killed.^{*} ²¹The governor again said to them, “Which of the two do you want me to release for you?” And they said, “Barabbas.” ²²Pilate said to them, “Then what should I do with Jesus who is called the Messiah?”^r All of them said, “Let him be crucified!” ²³Then he asked, “Why, what evil has he done?” But they shouted all the more, “Let him be crucified!”

PILATE HANDS JESUS OVER TO BE CRUCIFIED

24 So when Pilate saw that he could do nothing but rather that a riot was beginning, he took some water and washed his hands before the crowd, saying, “I am innocent of this man’s blood;^s see to it yourselves.”^{*} ²⁵Then the people as a whole answered, “His blood be on us and on our children!”^{*} ²⁶So he released Barabbas for them, and after flogging Jesus he handed him over to be crucified.^{*}

THE SOLDIERS MOCK JESUS

27 Then the soldiers of the governor took Jesus into the governor’s headquarters,^t and they gathered the whole cohort around him.^{*} ²⁸They stripped him and put a scarlet robe on him,²⁹ and after twisting some thorns into a crown they put it on his head. They put a reed in his right hand and knelt before him and mocked him, saying, “Hail, King of the Jews!”^{*} ³⁰They spat on him and took the reed and struck him on the head.^{*} ³¹After mocking him, they stripped him of the robe and put his own clothes on him. Then they led him away to crucify him.^{*}

THE CRUCIFIXION OF JESUS

32 As they went out, they came upon a man from Cyrene named Simon; they compelled this man to carry his cross.* ³³And when they came to a place called Golgotha (which means Place of a Skull), ³⁴they offered him wine to drink, mixed with gall, but when he tasted it, he would not drink it.* ³⁵And when they had crucified him, they divided his clothes among themselves by casting lots;^{u,*} ³⁶then they sat down there and kept watch over him.* ³⁷Over his head they put the charge against him, which read, “This is Jesus, the King of the Jews.”

38 Then two rebels were crucified with him, one on his right and one on his left.* ³⁹Those who passed by derided^v him, shaking their heads* ⁴⁰and saying, “You who would destroy the temple and build it in three days, save yourself! If you are the Son of God, come down from the cross.”* ⁴¹In the same way the chief priests also, along with the scribes and elders, were mocking him, saying, ⁴²“He saved others; he cannot save himself.^w He is the King of Israel; let him come down from the cross now, and we will believe in him.* ⁴³He trusts in God; let God deliver him now, if he wants to, for he said, ‘I am God’s Son.’ ”* ⁴⁴The rebels who were crucified with him also taunted him in the same way.

THE DEATH OF JESUS

45 From noon on, darkness came over the whole land^x until three in the afternoon.* ⁴⁶And about three o’clock Jesus cried with a loud voice, “Eli, Eli, lema sabachthani?” that is, “My God, my God, why have you forsaken me?”* ⁴⁷When some of the bystanders heard it, they said, “This man is calling for Elijah.” ⁴⁸At once one of them ran and got a sponge, filled it with sour wine, put it on a stick, and gave it to him to drink.* ⁴⁹But the others said, “Wait, let us see whether Elijah will come to save him.”^y ⁵⁰Then Jesus cried again with a loud voice and breathed his last.^z ⁵¹At that moment the curtain of the temple was torn in two, from top to bottom. The earth shook, and the rocks were split.* ⁵²The tombs also were opened, and many bodies of the saints who had fallen asleep were raised. ⁵³After his resurrection they came out of the tombs and entered the holy city and appeared to many. ⁵⁴Now when the centurion and those with him, who were

keeping watch over Jesus, saw the earthquake and what took place, they were terrified and said, “Truly this man was God’s Son!”^{a,*}

55 Many women were also there, looking on from a distance; they had followed Jesus from Galilee, ministering to him.^{*} ⁵⁶Among them were Mary Magdalene, and Mary the mother of James and Joseph,^b and the mother of the sons of Zebedee.^{*}

THE BURIAL OF JESUS

57 When it was evening, there came a rich man from Arimathea named Joseph, who also was himself a disciple of Jesus.^{*} ⁵⁸He went to Pilate and asked for the body of Jesus; then Pilate ordered it to be given to him. ⁵⁹So Joseph took the body and wrapped it in a clean linen cloth ⁶⁰and laid it in his new tomb, which he had hewn in the rock. He then rolled a great stone to the door of the tomb and went away.^{*} ⁶¹Mary Magdalene and the other Mary were there, sitting opposite the tomb.

THE GUARD AT THE TOMB

62 The next day, that is, after the day of Preparation, the chief priests and the Pharisees gathered before Pilate ⁶³and said, “Sir, we remember what that impostor said while he was still alive, ‘After three days I will rise again.’^{*} ⁶⁴Therefore command the tomb to be made secure until the third day; otherwise, his disciples may go and steal him away and tell the people, ‘He has been raised from the dead,’ and the last deception would be worse than the first.” ⁶⁵Pilate said to them, “You have a guard^c of soldiers; go, make it as secure as you can.”^{d,*} ⁶⁶So they went with the guard and made the tomb secure by sealing the stone.^{*}

Matthew 28

THE RESURRECTION OF JESUS

1 After the Sabbath, as the first day of the week was dawning, Mary Magdalene and the other Mary went to see the tomb.* **2** And suddenly there was a great earthquake, for an angel of the Lord, descending from heaven, came and rolled back the stone and sat on it.* **3** His appearance was like lightning and his clothing white as snow. **4** For fear of him the guards shook and became like dead men. **5** But the angel said to the women, “Do not be afraid, for I know that you are looking for Jesus who was crucified.* **6** He is not here, for he has been raised, as he said. Come, see the place where he^e lay.* **7** Then go quickly and tell his disciples, ‘He has been raised from the dead,^f and indeed he is going ahead of you to Galilee; there you will see him.’ This is my message for you.”* **8** So they left the tomb quickly with fear and great joy and ran to tell his disciples. **9** Suddenly Jesus met them and said, “Greetings!” And they came to him, took hold of his feet, and worshiped him.* **10** Then Jesus said to them, “Do not be afraid; go and tell my brothers and sisters to go to Galilee; there they will see me.”*

THE REPORT OF THE GUARD

11 While they were going, some of the guard went into the city and told the chief priests everything that had happened.* **12** After the priests^g had assembled with the elders, they devised a plan to give a large sum of money to the soldiers, **13** telling them, “You must say, ‘His disciples came by night and stole him away while we were asleep.’ **14** If this comes to the governor’s ears, we will satisfy him and keep you out of trouble.”* **15** So they took the money and did as they were directed. And this story is still told among the Judeans to this day.

THE COMMISSIONING OF THE DISCIPLES

16 Now the eleven disciples went to Galilee, to the mountain to which Jesus had directed them.* **17** When they saw him, they worshiped him, but

they doubted. ¹⁸And Jesus came and said to them, “All authority in heaven and on earth has been given to me.” ¹⁹Go therefore and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit ²⁰and teaching them to obey everything that I have commanded you. And remember, I am with you always, to the end of the age.”^h

The Gospel according to Mark

Mark 1

THE PROCLAMATION OF JOHN THE BAPTIST

1 The beginning of the good news^a of Jesus Christ.^{b,*}

2 As it is written in the prophet Isaiah,^c

“See, I am sending my messenger ahead of you,^d
who will prepare your way,^{*}

³the voice of one crying out in the wilderness:

‘Prepare the way of the Lord;
make his paths straight,’ ”^{*}

⁴so John the baptizer appeared^e in the wilderness, proclaiming a baptism of repentance for the forgiveness of sins.^{*} ⁵And the whole Judean region and all the people of Jerusalem were going out to him and were baptized by him in the River Jordan, confessing their sins. ⁶Now John was clothed with camel’s hair, with a leather belt around his waist, and he ate locusts and wild honey.^{*} ⁷He proclaimed, “The one who is more powerful than I is coming after me; I am not worthy to stoop down and untie the strap of his sandals.” ⁸I have baptized you with^f water, but he will baptize you with^g the Holy Spirit.”^{*}

THE BAPTISM OF JESUS

9 In those days Jesus came from Nazareth of Galilee and was baptized by John in the Jordan.^{*} ¹⁰And just as he was coming up out of the water, he saw the heavens torn apart and the Spirit descending like a dove upon him.^{*} ¹¹And a voice came from the heavens, “You are my Son, the Beloved;^h with you I am well pleased.”^{*}

THE TESTING OF JESUS

12 And the Spirit immediately drove him out into the wilderness. ¹³He was in the wilderness forty days, tested by Satan, and he was with the wild beasts, and the angels waited on him.

THE BEGINNING OF THE GALILEAN MINISTRY

14 Now after John was arrested, Jesus came to Galilee proclaiming the good newsⁱ of^j God^{*} ¹⁵and saying, “The time is fulfilled, and the kingdom of God has come near;^k repent, and believe in the good news.”^{l,*}

JESUS CALLS THE FIRST DISCIPLES

16 As Jesus passed along the Sea of Galilee, he saw Simon and his brother Andrew casting a net into the sea, for they were fishers. ¹⁷And Jesus said to them, “Follow me, and I will make you fishers of people.” ¹⁸And immediately they left their nets and followed him.^{*} ¹⁹As he went a little farther, he saw James son of Zebedee and his brother John, who were in their boat mending the nets. ²⁰Immediately he called them, and they left their father Zebedee in the boat with the hired men and followed him.

THE MAN WITH AN UNCLEAN SPIRIT

21 They went to Capernaum, and when the Sabbath came, he entered the synagogue and taught.^{*} ²²They were astounded at his teaching, for he taught them as one having authority and not as the scribes.^{*} ²³Just then there was in their synagogue a man with an unclean spirit, ²⁴and he cried out, “What have you to do with us, Jesus of Nazareth? Have you come to destroy us? I know who you are, the Holy One of God.”^{*} ²⁵But Jesus rebuked him, saying, “Be quiet and come out of him!”^{*} ²⁶And the unclean spirit, convulsing him and crying with a loud voice, came out of him. ²⁷They were all amazed, and they kept on asking one another, “What is this? A new teaching—with authority! He^m commands even the unclean spirits, and they obey him.”^{*} ²⁸At once his fame began to spread throughout the surrounding region of Galilee.

JESUS HEALS MANY AT SIMON'S HOUSE

29 As soon as theyⁿ left the synagogue, they entered the house of Simon and Andrew, with James and John.* ³⁰Now Simon's mother-in-law was in bed with a fever, and they told him about her at once. ³¹He came and took her by the hand and lifted her up. Then the fever left her, and she began to serve them.

32 That evening, at sunset, they brought to him all who were sick or possessed by demons.* ³³And the whole city was gathered around the door. ³⁴And he cured many who were sick with various diseases and cast out many demons, and he would not permit the demons to speak, because they knew him.*

A PREACHING TOUR IN GALILEE

35 In the morning, while it was still very dark, he got up and went out to a deserted place, and there he prayed.* ³⁶And Simon and his companions hunted for him. ³⁷When they found him, they said to him, "Everyone is searching for you." ³⁸He answered, "Let us go on to the neighboring towns, so that I may proclaim the message there also, for that is what I came out to do."* ³⁹And he went throughout all Galilee, proclaiming the message in their synagogues and casting out demons.*

JESUS CLEANSSES A MAN WITH A SKIN DISEASE

40 A man with a skin disease came to him begging him, and kneeling^o he said to him, "If you are willing, you can make me clean."* ⁴¹Moved with pity,^p Jesus^q stretched out his hand and touched him and said to him, "I am willing. Be made clean!" ⁴²Immediately the skin disease left him, and he was made clean. ⁴³After sternly warning him he sent him away at once, ⁴⁴saying to him, "See that you say nothing to anyone, but go, show yourself to the priest, and offer for your cleansing what Moses commanded as a testimony to them."* ⁴⁵But he went out and began to proclaim it freely and to spread the word, so that Jesus^r could no longer go into a town openly but stayed out in the country, and people came to him from every quarter.*

Mark 2

JESUS HEALS A PARALYTIC

1 When he returned to Capernaum after some days, it was reported that he was at home. **2** So many gathered around that there was no longer room for them, not even in front of the door, and he was speaking the word to them.* **3** Then some people^s came, bringing to him a paralyzed man, carried by four of them.* **4** And when they could not bring him to Jesus because of the crowd, they removed the roof above him, and after having dug through it, they let down the mat on which the paralytic lay. **5** When Jesus saw their faith, he said to the paralytic, “Child, your sins are forgiven.” **6** Now some of the scribes were sitting there questioning in their hearts, **7** “Why does this fellow speak in this way? It is blasphemy! Who can forgive sins but God alone?”* **8** At once Jesus perceived in his spirit that they were discussing these questions among themselves, and he said to them, “Why do you raise such questions in your hearts? **9** Which is easier: to say to the paralytic, ‘Your sins are forgiven,’ or to say, ‘Stand up and take your mat and walk’? **10** But so that you may know that the Son of Man has authority on earth to forgive sins”—he said to the paralytic—**11** “I say to you, stand up, take your mat, and go to your home.” **12** And he stood up and immediately took the mat and went out before all of them, so that they were all amazed and glorified God, saying, “We have never seen anything like this!”*

JESUS CALLS LEVI

13 Jesus^t went out again beside the sea; the whole crowd gathered around him, and he taught them.* **14** As he was walking along, he saw Levi son of Alphaeus sitting at the tax-collection station, and he said to him, “Follow me.” And he got up and followed him.*

15 And as he sat at dinner^u in Levi’s^v house, many tax collectors and sinners were also sitting^w with Jesus and his disciples, for there were many who followed him. **16** When the scribes of^x the Pharisees saw that he was eating with sinners and tax collectors, they said to his disciples, “Why does

he eat^y with tax collectors and sinners?”^{*} ¹⁷When Jesus heard this, he said to them, “Those who are well have no need of a physician but those who are sick; I have not come to call the righteous but sinners.”^{*}

THE QUESTION ABOUT FASTING

18 Now John’s disciples and the Pharisees were fasting, and people^z came and said to him, “Why do John’s disciples and the disciples of the Pharisees fast, but your disciples do not fast?” ¹⁹Jesus said to them, “The wedding attendants cannot fast while the bridegroom is with them, can they? As long as they have the bridegroom with them, they cannot fast. ²⁰The days will come when the bridegroom is taken away from them, and then they will fast on that day.”^{*}

21 “No one sews a piece of unshrunk cloth on an old cloak; otherwise, the patch pulls away from it, the new from the old, and a worse tear is made. ²²Similarly, no one puts new wine into old wineskins; otherwise, the wine will burst the skins, and the wine is lost, and so are the skins, but one puts new wine into fresh wineskins.”^a

PRONOUNCEMENT ABOUT THE SABBATH

23 One Sabbath he was going through the grain fields, and as they made their way his disciples began to pluck heads of grain.^{*} ²⁴The Pharisees said to him, “Look, why are they doing what is not lawful on the Sabbath?” ²⁵And he said to them, “Have you never read what David did when he and his companions were hungry and in need of food, ²⁶how he entered the house of God when Abiathar was high priest and ate the bread of the Presence, which it is not lawful for any but the priests to eat, and he gave some to his companions?”^{*} ²⁷Then he said to them, “The Sabbath was made for humankind and not humankind for the Sabbath,^{*} ²⁸so the Son of Man is lord even of the Sabbath.”

Mark 3

THE MAN WITH A WITHERED HAND

1 Again he entered the synagogue, and a man was there who had a withered hand.* **2**They were watching him to see whether he would cure him on the Sabbath, so that they might accuse him.* **3**And he said to the man who had the withered hand, “Come forward.” **4**Then he said to them, “Is it lawful to do good or to do harm on the Sabbath, to save life or to kill?” But they were silent. **5**He looked around at them with anger; he was grieved at their hardness of heart and said to the man, “Stretch out your hand.” He stretched it out, and his hand was restored. **6**The Pharisees went out and immediately conspired with the Herodians against him, how to destroy him.*

A MULTITUDE AT THE SEASIDE

7 Jesus departed with his disciples to the sea, and a great multitude from Galilee followed him;* **8**hearing all that he was doing, they came to him in great numbers from Judea, Jerusalem, Idumea, beyond the Jordan, and the region around Tyre and Sidon.* **9**He told his disciples to have a boat ready for him because of the crowd, so that they would not crush him, **10**for he had cured many, so that all who had diseases pressed upon him to touch him.* **11**Whenever the unclean spirits saw him, they fell down before him and shouted, “You are the Son of God!”* **12**But he sternly ordered them not to make him known.*

JESUS APPOINTS THE TWELVE

13 He went up the mountain and called to him those whom he wanted, and they came to him.* **14**And he appointed twelve^b to be with him and to be sent out to preach **15**and to have authority to cast out demons. **16**So he appointed the twelve:^c Simon (to whom he gave the name Peter),* **17**James son of Zebedee and John the brother of James (to whom he gave the name Boanerges, that is, Sons of Thunder), **18**and Andrew, and Philip, and Bartholomew, and Matthew, and Thomas, and James son of Alphaeus, and

Thaddaeus, and Simon the Cananaean,¹⁹ and Judas Iscariot, who handed him over.

JESUS AND BEELZEBUL

20 Then he went home, and the crowd came together again, so that they could not even eat.* ²¹When his family heard it, they went out to restrain him, for people were saying, “He has gone out of his mind.”* ²²And the scribes who came down from Jerusalem said, “He has Beelzebul, and by the ruler of the demons he casts out demons.”* ²³And he called them to him and spoke to them in parables, “How can Satan cast out Satan?”* ²⁴If a kingdom is divided against itself, that kingdom cannot stand. ²⁵And if a house is divided against itself, that house will not be able to stand. ²⁶And if Satan has risen up against himself and is divided, he cannot stand, but his end has come. ²⁷But no one can enter a strong man’s house and plunder his property without first tying up the strong man; then indeed the house can be plundered.*

28 “Truly I tell you, people will be forgiven for their sins and whatever blasphemies they utter,* ²⁹but whoever blasphemes against the Holy Spirit can never have forgiveness but is guilty of an eternal sin”—³⁰for they had said, “He has an unclean spirit.”

THE TRUE KINDRED OF JESUS

31 Then his mother and his brothers came, and standing outside they sent to him and called him.* ³²A crowd was sitting around him, and they said to him, “Your mother and your brothers^d are outside asking for you.” ³³And he replied, “Who are my mother and my brothers?” ³⁴And looking at those who sat around him, he said, “Here are my mother and my brothers! ³⁵Whoever does the will of God is my brother and sister and mother.”

Mark 4

THE PARABLE OF THE SOWER

1 Again he began to teach beside the sea. Such a very large crowd gathered around him that he got into a boat on the sea and sat there, while the whole crowd was beside the sea on the land.* **2**He began to teach them many things in parables, and in his teaching he said to them:* **3**“Listen! A sower went out to sow. **4**And as he sowed, some seed fell on a path, and the birds came and ate it up. **5**Other seed fell on rocky ground, where it did not have much soil, and it sprang up quickly, since it had no depth of soil. **6**And when the sun rose, it was scorched, and since it had no root it withered away. **7**Other seed fell among thorns, and the thorns grew up and choked it, and it yielded no grain. **8**Other seed fell into good soil and brought forth grain, growing up and increasing and yielding thirty and sixty and a hundredfold.”* **9**And he said, “If you have ears to hear, then hear!”*

THE PURPOSE OF THE PARABLES

10 When he was alone, those who were around him along with the twelve asked him about the parables. **11**And he said to them, “To you has been given the secret^e of the kingdom of God, but for those outside everything comes in parables,* **12**in order that

‘they may indeed look but not perceive,

and may indeed hear but not understand;

so that they may not turn again and be forgiven.’ ”*

13 And he said to them, “Do you not understand this parable? Then how will you understand all the parables? **14**The sower sows the word. **15**These are the ones on the path where the word is sown: when they hear, Satan immediately comes and takes away the word that is sown in them.* **16**And these are the ones sown on rocky ground: when they hear the word, they immediately receive it with joy. **17**But they have no root and endure only for a while; then, when trouble or persecution arises on account of the word, immediately they fall away.^f **18**And others are those sown among the thorns:

these are the ones who hear the word,¹⁹ but the cares of the age and the lure of wealth and the desire for other things come in and choke the word, and it yields nothing.²⁰ And these are the ones sown on the good soil: they hear the word and accept it and bear fruit, thirty and sixty and a hundredfold.”

A LAMP UNDER A BUSHEL BASKET

21 He said to them, “Is a lamp brought in to be put under the bushel basket or under the bed and not on the lampstand?²² For there is nothing hidden, except to be disclosed; nor is anything secret, except to come to light.*²³ If you have ears to hear, then hear!”*²⁴ And he said to them, “Pay attention to what you hear; the measure you give will be the measure you get, and it will be added to you.*²⁵ For to those who have, more will be given, and from those who have nothing, even what they have will be taken away.”*

THE PARABLE OF THE GROWING SEED

26 He also said, “The kingdom of God is as if someone would scatter seed on the ground*²⁷ and would sleep and rise night and day, and the seed would sprout and grow, he does not know how.²⁸ The earth produces of itself first the stalk, then the head, then the full grain in the head.²⁹ But when the grain is ripe, at once he goes in with his sickle because the harvest has come.”*

THE PARABLE OF THE MUSTARD SEED

30 He also said, “With what can we compare the kingdom of God, or what parable will we use for it? *³¹ It is like a mustard seed, which, when sown upon the ground, is the smallest of all the seeds on earth,³² yet when it is sown it grows up and becomes the greatest of all shrubs and puts forth large branches, so that the birds of the air can make nests in its shade.”

THE USE OF PARABLES

33 With many such parables he spoke the word to them as they were able to hear it; *³⁴ he did not speak to them except in parables, but he explained

everything in private to his disciples.*

JESUS STILLS A STORM

35 On that day, when evening had come, he said to them, “Let us go across to the other side.” ³⁶And leaving the crowd behind, they took him with them in the boat, just as he was. Other boats were with him.* ³⁷A great windstorm arose, and the waves beat into the boat, so that the boat was already being swamped. ³⁸But he was in the stern, asleep on the cushion, and they woke him up and said to him, “Teacher, do you not care that we are perishing?” ³⁹And waking up, he rebuked the wind and said to the sea, “Be silent! Be still!” Then the wind ceased, and there was a dead calm. ⁴⁰He said to them, “Why are you afraid? Have you still no faith?”* ⁴¹And they were filled with great fear and said to one another, “Who then is this, that even the wind and the sea obey him?”

Mark 5

JESUS HEALS A MAN POSSESSED BY DEMONS

1 They came to the other side of the sea, to the region of the Gerasenes.^g
2 And when he had stepped out of the boat, immediately a man from the tombs with an unclean spirit met him.* **3** He lived among the tombs, and no one could restrain him any more, even with a chain,⁴ for he had often been restrained with shackles and chains, but the chains he wrenched apart, and the shackles he broke in pieces, and no one had the strength to subdue him.
5 Night and day among the tombs and on the mountains he was always howling and bruising himself with stones. **6** When he saw Jesus from a distance, he ran and bowed down before him,* **7** and he shouted at the top of his voice, “What have you to do with me, Jesus, Son of the Most High God? I adjure you by God, do not torment me.”* **8** For he had said to him, “Come out of the man, you unclean spirit!” **9** Then Jesus^h asked him, “What is your name?” He replied, “My name is Legion, for we are many.” **10** He begged him earnestly not to send them out of the region. **11** Now there on the hillside a great herd of swine was feeding, **12** and the unclean spiritsⁱ begged him, “Send us into the swine; let us enter them.” **13** So he gave them permission. And the unclean spirits came out and entered the swine, and the herd, numbering about two thousand, stampeded down the steep bank into the sea and were drowned in the sea.

14 The swineherds ran off and told it in the city and in the country. Then people came to see what it was that had happened. **15** They came to Jesus and saw the man possessed by demons sitting there, clothed and in his right mind, the very man who had had the legion, and they became frightened.* **16** Those who had seen what had happened to the man possessed by demons and to the swine reported it. **17** Then they began to beg Jesus^j to leave their neighborhood.* **18** As he was getting into the boat, the man who had been possessed by demons begged him that he might be with him. **19** But Jesus^k refused and said to him, “Go home to your own people, and tell them how much the Lord has done for you and what mercy he has shown you.” **20** And

he went away and began to proclaim in the Decapolis how much Jesus had done for him, and everyone was amazed.*

A GIRL RESTORED TO LIFE AND A WOMAN HEALED

21 When Jesus had crossed again in the boat^l to the other side, a great crowd gathered around him, and he was by the sea.* **22** Then one of the leaders of the synagogue, named Jairus, came and, when he saw him, fell at his feet* **23** and pleaded with him repeatedly, “My little daughter is at the point of death. Come and lay your hands on her, so that she may be made well and live.”* **24** So he went with him.

And a large crowd followed him and pressed in on him. **25** Now there was a woman who had been suffering from a flow of blood for twelve years.* **26** She had endured much under many physicians and had spent all that she had, and she was no better but rather grew worse. **27** She had heard about Jesus and came up behind him in the crowd and touched his cloak, **28** for she said, “If I but touch his cloak, I will be made well.” **29** Immediately her flow of blood stopped, and she felt in her body that she was healed of her disease. **30** Immediately aware that power had gone forth from him, Jesus turned about in the crowd and said, “Who touched my cloak?” **31** And his disciples said to him, “You see the crowd pressing in on you; how can you say, ‘Who touched me?’ ” **32** He looked all around to see who had done it. **33** But the woman, knowing what had happened to her, came in fear and trembling, fell down before him, and told him the whole truth. **34** He said to her, “Daughter, your faith has made you well; go in peace, and be healed of your disease.”

35 While he was still speaking, some people came from the synagogue leader’s house to say, “Your daughter is dead. Why trouble the teacher any further?” **36** But overhearing^m what they said, Jesus said to the synagogue leader, “Do not be afraid; only believe.” **37** He allowed no one to follow him except Peter, James, and John, the brother of James. **38** When they came to the synagogue leader’s house, he saw a commotion, people weeping and wailing loudly. **39** When he had entered, he said to them, “Why do you make a commotion and weep? The child is not dead but sleeping.” **40** And they laughed at him. Then he put them all outside and took the child’s father and

mother and those who were with him and went in where the child was.
⁴¹Taking her by the hand, he said to her, “Talitha kum,” which means,
“Little girl, get up!” ⁴²And immediately the girl stood up and began to walk
about (she was twelve years of age). At this they were overcome with
amazement. ⁴³He strictly ordered them that no one should know this and
told them to give her something to eat.

Mark 6

THE REJECTION OF JESUS AT NAZARETH

1 He left that place and came to his hometown, and his disciples followed him. **2**On the Sabbath he began to teach in the synagogue, and many who heard him were astounded. They said, “Where did this man get all this? What is this wisdom that has been given to him? What deeds of power are being done by his hands!” **3**Is not this the carpenter, the son of Maryⁿ and brother of James and Joses and Judas and Simon, and are not his sisters here with us?” And they took offense^o at him. **4**Then Jesus said to them, “Prophets are not without honor, except in their hometown and among their own kin and in their own house.”^{*} **5**And he could do no deed of power there, except that he laid his hands on a few sick people and cured them.^{*} **6**And he was amazed at their unbelief.

THE MISSION OF THE TWELVE

Then he went about among the villages teaching.^{*} **7**He called the twelve and began to send them out two by two and gave them authority over the unclean spirits.^{*} **8**He ordered them to take nothing for their journey except a staff: no bread, no bag, no money in their belts,⁹ but to wear sandals and not to put on two tunics. **10**He said to them, “Wherever you enter a house, stay there until you leave the place. **11**If any place will not welcome you and they refuse to hear you, as you leave, shake off the dust that is on your feet as a testimony against them.” **12**So they went out and proclaimed that all should repent.^{*} **13**They cast out many demons and anointed with oil many who were sick and cured them.^{*}

THE DEATH OF JOHN THE BAPTIST

14 King Herod heard of it, for Jesus’s^p name had become known. Some were^q saying, “John the baptizer has been raised from the dead, and for this reason these powers are at work in him.” **15**But others said, “It is Elijah.” And others said, “It is a prophet, like one of the prophets of old.”^{*} **16**But

when Herod heard of it, he said, “John, whom I beheaded, has been raised.”*

17 For Herod himself had sent men who arrested John, bound him, and put him in prison on account of Herodias, his brother Philip’s wife, because Herod^r had married her. ¹⁸For John had been telling Herod, “It is not lawful for you to have your brother’s wife.”* ¹⁹And Herodias had a grudge against him and wanted to kill him. But she could not, ²⁰for Herod feared John, knowing that he was a righteous and holy man, and he protected him. When he heard him, he was greatly perplexed,^s and yet he liked to listen to him.* ²¹But an opportunity came when Herod on his birthday gave a banquet for his courtiers and officers and for the leaders of Galilee.* ²²When his daughter Herodias^t came in and danced, she pleased Herod and his guests, and the king said to the girl, “Ask me for whatever you wish, and I will give it.” ²³And he swore^u to her, “Whatever you ask me, I will give you, even half of my kingdom.”* ²⁴She went out and said to her mother, “What should I ask for?” She replied, “The head of John the baptizer.” ²⁵Immediately she rushed back to the king and requested, “I want you to give me at once the head of John the Baptist on a platter.” ²⁶The king was deeply grieved, yet out of regard for his oaths and for the guests, he did not want to refuse her. ²⁷Immediately the king sent a soldier of the guard with orders to bring John’s^v head. He went and beheaded him in the prison, ²⁸brought his head on a platter, and gave it to the girl. Then the girl gave it to her mother. ²⁹When his disciples heard about it, they came and took his body and laid it in a tomb.

FEEDING THE FIVE THOUSAND

30 The apostles gathered around Jesus and told him all that they had done and taught. ³¹He said to them, “Come away to a deserted place all by yourselves and rest a while.” For many were coming and going, and they had no leisure even to eat.* ³²And they went away in the boat to a deserted place by themselves.* ³³Now many saw them going and recognized them, and they hurried there on foot from all the towns and arrived ahead of them. ³⁴As he went ashore, he saw a great crowd, and he had compassion for them, because they were like sheep without a shepherd, and he began to

teach them many things.* ³⁵When it grew late, his disciples came to him and said, “This is a deserted place, and the hour is now very late; ³⁶send them away so that they may go into the surrounding country and villages and buy something for themselves to eat.” ³⁷But he answered them, “You give them something to eat.” They said to him, “Are we to go and buy two hundred denarii worth of bread and give it to them to eat?”* ³⁸And he said to them, “How many loaves have you? Go and see.” When they had found out, they said, “Five, and two fish.”* ³⁹Then he ordered them to get all the people to sit down in groups on the green grass. ⁴⁰So they sat down in groups of hundreds and of fifties. ⁴¹Taking the five loaves and the two fish, he looked up to heaven and blessed and broke the loaves and gave them to his disciples to set before the people, and he divided the two fish among them all.* ⁴²And all ate and were filled, ⁴³and they took up twelve baskets full of broken pieces and of the fish. ⁴⁴Those who had eaten the loaves numbered five thousand men.

JESUS WALKS ON THE WATER

45 Immediately he made his disciples get into the boat and go on ahead to the other side, to Bethsaida, while he dismissed the crowd.* ⁴⁶After saying farewell to them, he went up on the mountain to pray.

47 When evening came, the boat was out on the sea, and he was alone on the land. ⁴⁸When he saw that they were straining at the oars against an adverse wind, he came toward them early in the morning, walking on the sea. He intended to pass them by.* ⁴⁹But when they saw him walking on the sea, they thought it was a ghost and cried out, ⁵⁰for they all saw him and were terrified. But immediately he spoke to them and said, “Take heart, it is I; do not be afraid.”* ⁵¹Then he got into the boat with them, and the wind ceased. And they were utterly astounded,* ⁵²for they did not understand about the loaves, but their hearts were hardened.*

HEALING THE SICK IN GENNESARET

53 When they had crossed over, they came to land at Gennesaret and moored the boat.* ⁵⁴When they got out of the boat, people at once recognized him ⁵⁵and rushed about that whole region and began to bring the

sick on mats to wherever they heard he was. ⁵⁶And wherever he went, into villages or cities or farms, they laid the sick in the marketplaces and begged him that they might touch even the fringe of his cloak, and all who touched it were healed.*

Mark 7

THE TRADITION OF THE ELDERS

1 Now when the Pharisees and some of the scribes who had come from Jerusalem gathered around him, ²they noticed that some of his disciples were eating with defiled hands, that is, without washing them. ³(For the Pharisees, and all the Jews, do not eat unless they wash their hands,^w thus observing the tradition of the elders,^{*} ⁴and they do not eat anything from the market unless they wash,^x and there are also many other traditions that they observe: the washing of cups and pots and bronze kettles and beds.)^y ⁵So the Pharisees and the scribes asked him, “Why do your disciples not walk according to the tradition of the elders but eat with defiled hands?”^{*} ⁶He said to them, “Isaiah prophesied rightly about you hypocrites, as it is written,

‘This people honors me with their lips,
but their hearts are far from me;^{*}
⁷in vain do they worship me,
teaching human precepts as doctrines.’

⁸“You abandon the commandment of God and hold to human tradition.”^{*}

9 Then he said to them, “You have a fine way of rejecting the commandment of God in order to keep your tradition!”^{*} ¹⁰For Moses said, ‘Honor your father and your mother,’ and, ‘Whoever speaks evil of father or mother must surely die.’^{*} ¹¹But you say that if anyone tells father or mother, ‘Whatever support you might have had from me is Corban’ (that is, an offering to God^z),^{*} ¹²then you no longer permit doing anything for a father or mother, ¹³thus nullifying the word of God through your tradition that you have handed on. And you do many things like this.”

14 Then he called the crowd again and said to them, “Listen to me, all of you, and understand: ¹⁵there is nothing outside a person that by going in can defile, but the things that come out are what defile.”^a

17 When he had left the crowd and entered the house, his disciples asked him about the parable. ¹⁸He said to them, “So, are you also without

understanding? Do you not see that whatever goes into a person from outside cannot defile, ¹⁹since it enters not the heart but the stomach and goes out into the sewer?” (Thus he declared all foods clean.) ²⁰And he said, “It is what comes out of a person that defiles. ²¹For it is from within, from the human heart, that evil intentions come: sexual immorality, theft, murder, ²²adultery, avarice, wickedness, deceit, debauchery, envy, slander, pride, folly. ²³All these evil things come from within, and they defile a person.”

THE SYROPHOENICIAN WOMAN’S FAITH

24 From there he set out and went away to the region of Tyre.^b He entered a house and did not want anyone to know he was there. Yet he could not escape notice, ²⁵but a woman whose little daughter had an unclean spirit immediately heard about him, and she came and bowed down at his feet. ²⁶Now the woman was a gentile, of Syrophoenician origin. She begged him to cast the demon out of her daughter. ²⁷He said to her, “Let the children be fed first, for it is not fair to take the children’s food and throw it to the dogs.” ²⁸But she answered him, “Sir,^c even the dogs under the table eat the children’s crumbs.” ²⁹Then he said to her, “For saying that, you may go—the demon has left your daughter.” ³⁰And when she went home, she found the child lying on the bed and the demon gone.

JESUS CURES A DEAF MAN

31 Then he returned from the region of Tyre and went by way of Sidon toward the Sea of Galilee, in the region of the Decapolis. ³²They brought to him a deaf man who had an impediment in his speech, and they begged him to lay his hand on him.* ³³He took him aside in private, away from the crowd, and put his fingers into his ears, and he spat and touched his tongue.* ³⁴Then looking up to heaven, he sighed and said to him, “Ephphatha,” that is, “Be opened.”* ³⁵And his ears were opened, his tongue was released, and he spoke plainly.* ³⁶Then Jesus^d ordered them to tell no one, but the more he ordered them, the more zealously they proclaimed it.* ³⁷They were astounded beyond measure, saying, “He has done everything well; he even makes the deaf to hear and the mute to speak.”

Mark 8

FEEDING THE FOUR THOUSAND

1 In those days when there was again a great crowd without anything to eat, he called his disciples and said to them, ²“I have compassion for the crowd because they have been with me now for three days and have nothing to eat.” ³If I send them away hungry to their homes, they will faint on the way—and some of them have come from a great distance.” ⁴His disciples replied, “How can one feed these people with bread here in the desert?” ⁵He asked them, “How many loaves do you have?” They said, “Seven.” ⁶Then he ordered the crowd to sit down on the ground, and he took the seven loaves, and after giving thanks he broke them and gave them to his disciples to distribute, and they distributed them to the crowd. ⁷They had also a few small fish, and after blessing them he ordered that these, too, should be distributed. ⁸They ate and were filled, and they took up the broken pieces left over, seven baskets full. ⁹Now there were about four thousand people. And he sent them away. ¹⁰And immediately he got into the boat with his disciples and went to the district of Dalmanutha.^e

THE DEMAND FOR A SIGN

11 The Pharisees came and began to argue with him, asking him for a sign from heaven, to test him. ¹²And he sighed deeply in his spirit and said, “Why does this generation ask for a sign? Truly I tell you, no sign will be given to this generation.” ¹³And he left them, and getting into the boat again he went across to the other side.

THE YEAST OF THE PHARISEES AND OF HEROD

14 Now the disciples^f had forgotten to bring any bread, and they had only one loaf with them in the boat. ¹⁵And he cautioned them, saying, “Watch out—beware of the yeast of the Pharisees and the yeast of Herod.”^{g,*} ¹⁶They said to one another, “It is because we have no bread.” ¹⁷And becoming aware of it, Jesus said to them, “Why are you talking about

having no bread? Do you still not perceive or understand? Are your hearts hardened? ^{*} 18 Do you have eyes and fail to see? Do you have ears and fail to hear? And do you not remember? ¹⁹ When I broke the five loaves for the five thousand, how many baskets full of broken pieces did you collect? They said to him, “Twelve.” ^{*} 20 “And the seven for the four thousand, how many baskets full of broken pieces did you collect?” And they said to him, “Seven.” ^{*} 21 Then he said to them, “Do you not yet understand?” ^{*}

JESUS CURES A BLIND MAN AT BETHSAIDA

22 They came to Bethsaida. Some people ^h brought a blind man to him and begged him to touch him. ^{*} 23 He took the blind man by the hand and led him out of the village, and when he had put saliva on his eyes and laid his hands on him, he asked him, “Can you see anything?” ^{*} 24 And the man ⁱ looked up and said, “I can see people, but they look like trees, walking.” ²⁵ Then Jesus ^j laid his hands on his eyes again, and he looked intently, and his sight was restored, and he saw everything clearly. ²⁶ Then he sent him away to his home, saying, “Do not even go into the village.” ^{k,*}

PETER’S DECLARATION ABOUT JESUS

27 Jesus went on with his disciples to the villages of Caesarea Philippi, and on the way he asked his disciples, “Who do people say that I am?” ^{*} 28 And they answered him, “John the Baptist; and others, Elijah; and still others, one of the prophets.” ^{*} 29 He asked them, “But who do you say that I am?” Peter answered him, “You are the Messiah.” ^{l,*} 30 And he sternly ordered them not to tell anyone about him. ^{*}

JESUS FORETELLS HIS DEATH AND RESURRECTION

31 Then he began to teach them that the Son of Man must undergo great suffering and be rejected by the elders, the chief priests, and the scribes and be killed and after three days rise again. ³² He said all this quite openly. And Peter took him aside and began to rebuke him. ^{*} 33 But turning and looking at his disciples, he rebuked Peter and said, “Get behind me, Satan! For you are setting your mind not on divine things but on human things.” ^{*}

34 He called the crowd with his disciples and said to them, “If any wish to come^m after me, let them deny themselves and take up their cross and follow me.* ³⁵For those who want to save their life will lose it, and those who lose their life for my sake, and for the sake of the gospel,ⁿ will save it.* ³⁶For what will it profit them to gain the whole world and forfeit their life? ³⁷Indeed, what can they give in return for their life? ³⁸Those who are ashamed of me and of my words^o in this adulterous and sinful generation, of them the Son of Man will also be ashamed when he comes in the glory of his Father with the holy angels.”*

Mark 9

1 And he said to them, “Truly I tell you, there are some standing here who will not taste death until they see that the kingdom of God has come with^p power.”*

THE TRANSFIGURATION

2 Six days later, Jesus took with him Peter and James and John and led them up a high mountain apart, by themselves. And he was transfigured before them,* ³and his clothes became dazzling bright, such as no one^q on earth could brighten them.* ⁴And there appeared to them Elijah with Moses, who were talking with Jesus. ⁵Then Peter said to Jesus, “Rabbi, it is good for us to be here; let us set up three tents: one for you, one for Moses, and one for Elijah.”* ⁶He did not know what to say, for they were terrified. ⁷Then a cloud overshadowed them, and from the cloud there came a voice, “This is my Son, the Beloved;^r listen to him!”* ⁸Suddenly when they looked around, they saw no one with them any more, but only Jesus.

THE COMING OF ELIJAH

9 As they were coming down the mountain, he ordered them to tell no one about what they had seen, until after the Son of Man had risen from the dead. ¹⁰So they kept the matter to themselves, questioning what this rising from the dead could mean. ¹¹Then they asked him, “Why do the scribes say that Elijah must come first?” ¹²He said to them, “Elijah is indeed coming first to restore all things. How then is it written about the Son of Man, that he is to go through many sufferings and be treated with contempt? ¹³But I tell you that Elijah has come, and they did to him whatever they pleased, as it is written about him.”

THE HEALING OF A BOY WITH A SPIRIT

14 When they came to the disciples, they saw a great crowd around them and some scribes arguing with them. ¹⁵When the whole crowd saw him,

they were immediately overcome with awe, and they ran forward to greet him. ¹⁶He asked them, “What are you arguing about with them?” ¹⁷Someone from the crowd answered him, “Teacher, I brought you my son; he has a spirit that makes him unable to speak, ¹⁸and whenever it seizes him, it dashes him down, and he foams and grinds his teeth and becomes rigid, and I asked your disciples to cast it out, but they could not do so.” ¹⁹He answered them, “You faithless generation, how much longer must I be with you? How much longer must I put up with you? Bring him to me.” ²⁰And they brought the boy^s to him. When the spirit saw him, immediately it convulsed the boy,^t and he fell on the ground and rolled about, foaming at the mouth. ²¹Jesus^u asked the father, “How long has this been happening to him?” And he said, “From childhood. ²²It has often cast him into the fire and into the water, to destroy him; but if you are able to do anything, help us! Have compassion on us!” ²³Jesus said to him, “If you are able! All things can be done for the one who believes.” ²⁴Immediately the father of the child cried out,^v “I believe; help my unbelief!” ²⁵When Jesus saw that a crowd came running together, he rebuked the unclean spirit, saying to it, “You spirit that keeps this boy from speaking and hearing, I command you, come out of him, and never enter him again!” ²⁶After crying out and convulsing him terribly, it came out, and the boy was like a corpse, so that most of them said, “He is dead.” ²⁷But Jesus took him by the hand and lifted him up, and he was able to stand. ²⁸When he had entered the house, his disciples asked him privately, “Why could we not cast it out?”^{*} ²⁹He said to them, “This kind can come out only through prayer.”^w

JESUS AGAIN FORETELLS HIS DEATH AND RESURRECTION

30 They went on from there and passed through Galilee. He did not want anyone to know it, ³¹for he was teaching his disciples, saying to them, “The Son of Man is to be betrayed into human hands, and they will kill him, and three days after being killed, he will rise again.”^{*} ³²But they did not understand what he was saying and were afraid to ask him.^{*}

WHO IS THE GREATEST?

33 Then they came to Capernaum, and when he was in the house he asked them, “What were you arguing about on the way?” ³⁴But they were silent, for on the way they had argued with one another who was the greatest.* ³⁵He sat down, called the twelve, and said to them, “Whoever wants to be first must be last of all and servant of all.”* ³⁶Then he took a little child and put it among them, and taking it in his arms he said to them,* ³⁷“Whoever welcomes one such child in my name welcomes me, and whoever welcomes me welcomes not me but the one who sent me.”*

ANOTHER EXORCIST

38 John said to him, “Teacher, we saw someone casting out demons in your name,^x and we tried to stop him because he was not following us.”* ³⁹But Jesus said, “Do not stop him, for no one who does a deed of power in my name will be able soon afterward to speak evil of me.” ⁴⁰Whoever is not against us is for us.* ⁴¹For truly I tell you, whoever gives you a cup of water to drink because you bear the name of Christ will by no means lose the reward.*

TEMPTATIONS TO SIN

42 “If any of you cause one of these little ones who believe in me^y to sin,^z it would be better for you if a great millstone were hung around your neck and you were thrown into the sea.”* ⁴³If your hand causes you to sin,^a cut it off; it is better for you to enter life maimed than to have two hands and to go to hell,^b to the unquenchable fire.^{c,*} ⁴⁵And if your foot causes you to sin,^d cut it off; it is better for you to enter life lame than to have two feet and to be thrown into hell.^{e,f,*} ⁴⁷And if your eye causes you to sin,^g tear it out; it is better for you to enter the kingdom of God with one eye than to have two eyes and to be thrown into hell,^{h,*} ⁴⁸where their worm never dies and the fire is never quenched.*

49 “For everyone will be salted with fire.^{i,*} ⁵⁰Salt is good, but if salt has lost its saltiness, how can you season it?^j Have salt in yourselves, and be at peace with one another.”*

Mark 10

TEACHING ABOUT DIVORCE

1 He left that place and went to the region of Judea and^k beyond the Jordan. And crowds again gathered around him, and, as was his custom, he again taught them.*

2 Some,^l testing him, asked, “Is it lawful for a man to divorce his wife?”
3He answered them, “What did Moses command you?” **4**They said, “Moses allowed a man to write a certificate of dismissal and to divorce her.”* **5**But Jesus said to them, “Because of your hardness of heart he wrote this commandment for you. **6**But from the beginning of creation, ‘God made them male and female.’* **7**For this reason a man shall leave his father and mother and be joined to his wife,^{m,*} **8**and the two shall become one flesh.’ So they are no longer two but one flesh.* **9**Therefore what God has joined together, let no one separate.”

10 Then in the house the disciples asked him again about this matter. **11**He said to them, “Whoever divorces his wife and marries another commits adultery against her,* **12**and if she divorces her husband and marries another, she commits adultery.”

JESUS BLESSES LITTLE CHILDREN

13 People were bringing children to him in order that he might touch them, and the disciples spoke sternly to them. **14**But when Jesus saw this, he was indignant and said to them, “Let the children come to me; do not stop them, for it is to such as these that the kingdom of God belongs. **15**Truly I tell you, whoever does not receive the kingdom of God as a little child will never enter it.”* **16**And he took them up in his arms, laid his hands on them, and blessed them.*

THE RICH MAN

17 As he was setting out on a journey, a man ran up and knelt before him and asked him, “Good Teacher, what must I do to inherit eternal life?”*
¹⁸Jesus said to him, “Why do you call me good? No one is good but God alone. ¹⁹You know the commandments: ‘You shall not murder. You shall not commit adultery. You shall not steal. You shall not bear false witness. You shall not defraud. Honor your father and mother.’ ”* ²⁰He said to him, “Teacher, I have kept all these since my youth.” ²¹Jesus, looking at him, loved him and said, “You lack one thing; go, sell what you own, and give the moneyⁿ to the poor, and you will have treasure in heaven; then come, follow me.”* ²²When he heard this, he was shocked and went away grieving, for he had many possessions.

23 Then Jesus looked around and said to his disciples, “How hard it will be for those who have wealth to enter the kingdom of God!”* ²⁴And the disciples were perplexed at these words. But Jesus said to them again, “Children, how hard it is^o to enter the kingdom of God!* ²⁵It is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle than for someone who is rich to enter the kingdom of God.” ²⁶They were greatly astounded and said to one another,^p “Then who can be saved?” ²⁷Jesus looked at them and said, “For mortals it is impossible, but not for God; for God all things are possible.”*

28 Peter began to say to him, “Look, we have left everything and followed you.”* ²⁹Jesus said, “Truly I tell you, there is no one who has left house or brothers or sisters or mother or father or children or fields for my sake and for the sake of the good news^{q,*} ³⁰who will not receive a hundredfold now in this age—houses, brothers and sisters, mothers and children, and fields, with persecutions—and in the age to come eternal life. ³¹But many who are first will be last, and the last will be first.”*

A THIRD TIME JESUS FORETELLS HIS DEATH AND RESURRECTION

32 They were on the road, going up to Jerusalem, and Jesus was walking ahead of them; they were amazed, and those who followed were afraid. He took the twelve aside again and began to tell them what was to happen to him, ³³saying, “Look, we are going up to Jerusalem, and the Son of Man will be handed over to the chief priests and the scribes, and they will

condemn him to death; then they will hand him over to the gentiles;^{* 34} they will mock him and spit upon him and flog him and kill him, and after three days he will rise again.”^{*}

THE REQUEST OF JAMES AND JOHN

35 James and John, the sons of Zebedee, came forward to him and said to him, “Teacher, we want you to do for us whatever we ask of you.”³⁶ And he said to them, “What is it you want me to do for you?”³⁷ And they said to him, “Appoint us to sit, one at your right hand and one at your left, in your glory.”^{* 38} But Jesus said to them, “You do not know what you are asking. Are you able to drink the cup that I drink or be baptized with the baptism that I am baptized with?”^{* 39} They replied, “We are able.” Then Jesus said to them, “The cup that I drink you will drink, and with the baptism with which I am baptized you will be baptized,^{*} ⁴⁰ but to sit at my right hand or at my left is not mine to appoint, but it is for those for whom it has been prepared.”

41 When the ten heard this, they began to be angry with James and John.⁴² So Jesus called them and said to them, “You know that among the gentiles those whom they recognize as their rulers lord it over them, and their great ones are tyrants over them.⁴³ But it is not so among you; instead, whoever wishes to become great among you must be your servant,^{*} ⁴⁴ and whoever wishes to be first among you must be slave of all.⁴⁵ For the Son of Man came not to be served but to serve and to give his life a ransom for many.”^{*}

THE HEALING OF BLIND BARTIMAEUS

46 They came to Jericho. As he and his disciples and a large crowd were leaving Jericho, Bartimaeus son of Timaeus, a blind beggar, was sitting by the roadside.⁴⁷ When he heard that it was Jesus of Nazareth, he began to shout out and say, “Jesus, Son of David, have mercy on me!”^{* 48} Many sternly ordered him to be quiet, but he cried out even more loudly, “Son of David, have mercy on me!”⁴⁹ Jesus stood still and said, “Call him here.” And they called the blind man, saying to him, “Take heart; get up, he is calling you.”⁵⁰ So throwing off his cloak, he sprang up and came to Jesus.⁵¹ Then Jesus said to him, “What do you want me to do for you?” The blind

man said to him, “My teacher,^r let me see again.”^{*} ⁵²Jesus said to him, “Go; your faith has made you well.” Immediately he regained his sight and followed him on the way.^{*}

Mark 11

JESUS'S TRIUMPHAL ENTRY INTO JERUSALEM

1 When they were approaching Jerusalem, at Bethphage and Bethany, near the Mount of Olives, he sent two of his disciples^{*} **2** and said to them, “Go into the village ahead of you, and immediately as you enter it you will find tied there a colt that has never been ridden; untie it and bring it. **3** If anyone says to you, ‘Why are you doing this?’ just say this: ‘The Lord needs it and will send it back here immediately.’ ” **4** They went away and found a colt tied near a door, outside in the street. As they were untying it,^{*} **5** some of the bystanders said to them, “What are you doing, untying the colt?” **6** They told them what Jesus had said, and they allowed them to take it. **7** Then they brought the colt to Jesus and threw their cloaks on it, and he sat on it. **8** Many people spread their cloaks on the road, and others spread leafy branches that they had cut in the fields. **9** Then those who went ahead and those who followed were shouting,

“Hosanna!

Blessed is the one who comes in the name of the Lord!”^{*}

10 Blessed is the coming kingdom of our ancestor David!

Hosanna in the highest heaven!”

11 Then he entered Jerusalem and went into the temple, and when he had looked around at everything, as it was already late, he went out to Bethany with the twelve.^{*}

JESUS CURSES THE FIG TREE

12 On the following day, when they came from Bethany, he was hungry. **13** Seeing in the distance a fig tree in leaf, he went to see whether perhaps he would find anything on it. When he came to it, he found nothing but leaves, for it was not the season for figs.^{*} **14** He said to it, “May no one ever eat fruit from you again.” And his disciples heard it.

JESUS CLEANSSES THE TEMPLE

15 Then they came to Jerusalem. And he entered the temple and began to drive out those who were selling and those who were buying in the temple, and he overturned the tables of the money changers and the seats of those who sold doves, ¹⁶and he would not allow anyone to carry anything through the temple. ¹⁷He was teaching and saying, “Is it not written,

‘My house shall be called a house of prayer for all the nations’?

But you have made it a den of robbers.”*

¹⁸And when the chief priests and the scribes heard it, they kept looking for a way to kill him, for they were afraid of him because the whole crowd was spellbound by his teaching.* ¹⁹And when evening came, Jesus and his disciples^s went out of the city.

THE LESSON FROM THE WITHERED FIG TREE

20 In the morning as they passed by, they saw the fig tree withered away to its roots.* ²¹Then Peter remembered and said to him, “Rabbi, look! The fig tree that you cursed has withered.”* ²²Jesus answered them, “Have faith in God.^{t,*} ²³Truly I tell you, if you say to this mountain, ‘Be taken up and thrown into the sea,’ and if you do not doubt in your heart but believe that what you say will come to pass, it will be done for you.* ²⁴So I tell you, whatever you ask for in prayer, believe that you have received^u it, and it will be yours.*

25 “Whenever you stand praying, forgive, if you have anything against anyone, so that your Father in heaven may also forgive you your trespasses.”^{v,*}

JESUS’S AUTHORITY IS QUESTIONED

27 Again they came to Jerusalem. As he was walking in the temple, the chief priests, the scribes, and the elders came to him ²⁸and said, “By what authority are you doing these things? Who gave you this authority to do them?” ²⁹Jesus said to them, “I will ask you one question; answer me, and I will tell you by what authority I do these things. ³⁰Did the baptism of John come from heaven, or was it of human origin? Answer me.” ³¹They argued

with one another, “What should we say?^w If we say, ‘From heaven,’ he will say, ‘Why then did you not believe him?’ ³²But shall we say, ‘Of human origin’?”—they were afraid of the crowd, for all regarded John as truly a prophet.^{*} ³³So they answered Jesus, “We do not know.” And Jesus said to them, “Neither will I tell you by what authority I am doing these things.”

Mark 12

THE PARABLE OF THE WICKED TENANTS

1 Then he began to speak to them in parables. “A man planted a vineyard, put a fence around it, dug a pit for the winepress, and built a watchtower; then he leased it to tenants and went away.* **2** When the season came, he sent a slave to the tenants to collect from them his share of the produce of the vineyard. **3** But they seized him and beat him and sent him away empty-handed. **4** And again he sent another slave to them; this one they beat over the head and insulted. **5** Then he sent another, and that one they killed. And so it was with many others; some they beat, and others they killed. **6** He had still one other, a beloved son. Finally he sent him to them, saying, ‘They will respect my son.’ **7** But those tenants said to one another, ‘This is the heir; come, let us kill him, and the inheritance will be ours.’ **8** So they seized him, killed him, and threw him out of the vineyard. **9** What then will the owner of the vineyard do? He will come and destroy the tenants and give the vineyard to others. **10** Have you not read this scripture:

‘The stone that the builders rejected

has become the cornerstone;^{x,*}

¹¹this was the Lord’s doing,

and it is amazing in our eyes’?”

12 When they realized that he had told this parable against them, they wanted to arrest him, but they feared the crowd. So they left him and went away.*

THE QUESTION ABOUT PAYING TAXES

13 Then they sent to him some Pharisees and some Herodians to trap him in what he said.* **14** And they came and said to him, “Teacher, we know that you are sincere and show deference to no one, for you do not regard people with partiality but teach the way of God in accordance with truth. Is it lawful to pay taxes to Caesar or not? **15** Should we pay them, or should we not?” But knowing their hypocrisy, he said to them, “Why are you putting

me to the test? Bring me a denarius and let me see it.” ¹⁶And they brought one. Then he said to them, “Whose head is this and whose title?” They answered, “Caesar’s.” ¹⁷Jesus said to them, “Give to Caesar the things that are Caesar’s and to God the things that are God’s.” And they were utterly amazed at him.*

THE QUESTION ABOUT THE RESURRECTION

18 Some Sadducees, who say there is no resurrection, came to him and asked him a question, saying, ¹⁹“Teacher, Moses wrote for us that if a man’s brother dies, leaving a wife but no child, the man^y shall marry the widow and raise up children for his brother.* ²⁰There were seven brothers; the first married and, when he died, left no children, ²¹and the second married the widow^z and died, leaving no children, and the third likewise; ²²none of the seven left children. Last of all the woman herself died. ²³In the resurrection, when they rise,^a whose wife will she be? For all seven had married her.”

24 Jesus said to them, “Is not this the reason you are wrong, that you know neither the scriptures nor the power of God? ²⁵For when people rise from the dead, they neither marry nor are given in marriage but are like angels in heaven.* ²⁶And as for the dead being raised, have you not read in the book of Moses, in the story about the bush, how God said to him, ‘I am the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob’? ²⁷He is God not of the dead but of the living; you are quite wrong.”

THE FIRST COMMANDMENT

28 One of the scribes came near and heard them disputing with one another, and seeing that he answered them well he asked him, “Which commandment is the first of all?”* ²⁹Jesus answered, “The first is, ‘Hear, O Israel: the Lord our God, the Lord is one;’ ³⁰you shall love the Lord your God with all your heart and with all your soul and with all your mind and with all your strength.’ ³¹The second is this, ‘You shall love your neighbor as yourself.’ There is no other commandment greater than these.”* ³²Then the scribe said to him, “You are right, Teacher; you have truly said that ‘he is one, and besides him there is no other’; ³³and ‘to love him with all the heart and with all the understanding and with all the strength’ and ‘to love

one's neighbor as oneself'—this is much more important than all whole burnt offerings and sacrifices.”* ³⁴When Jesus saw that he answered wisely, he said to him, “You are not far from the kingdom of God.” After that no one dared to ask him any question.*

THE QUESTION ABOUT DAVID'S SON

35 While Jesus was teaching in the temple, he said, “How can the scribes say that the Messiah^b is the son of David?”* ³⁶David himself, by the Holy Spirit, declared,

‘The Lord said to my Lord,

“Sit at my right hand,

until I put your enemies under your feet.”’*

³⁷“David himself calls him Lord, so how can he be his son?” And the large crowd was listening to him with delight.*

JESUS DENOUNCES THE SCRIBES

38 As he taught, he said, “Beware of the scribes, who like to walk around in long robes and to be greeted with respect in the marketplaces* ³⁹and to have the best seats in the synagogues and places of honor at banquets! ⁴⁰They devour widows' houses and for the sake of appearance say long prayers. They will receive the greater condemnation.”

THE WIDOW'S OFFERING

41 He sat down opposite the treasury and watched the crowd putting money into the treasury. Many rich people put in large sums.* ⁴²A poor widow came and put in two small copper coins, which are worth a penny. ⁴³Then he called his disciples and said to them, “Truly I tell you, this poor widow has put in more than all those who are contributing to the treasury.* ⁴⁴For all of them have contributed out of their abundance, but she out of her poverty has put in everything she had, all she had to live on.”

Mark 13

THE DESTRUCTION OF THE TEMPLE FORETOLD

1 As he came out of the temple, one of his disciples said to him, “Look, Teacher, what large stones and what large buildings!” **2** Then Jesus asked him, “Do you see these great buildings? Not one stone will be left here upon another; all will be thrown down.”*

3 When he was sitting on the Mount of Olives opposite the temple, Peter, James, John, and Andrew asked him privately,* **4** “Tell us, when will this be, and what will be the sign that all these things are about to be accomplished?” **5** Then Jesus began to say to them, “Beware that no one leads you astray.* **6** Many will come in my name and say, ‘I am he!’^c and they will lead many astray.* **7** When you hear of wars and rumors of wars, do not be alarmed; this must take place, but the end is still to come. **8** For nation will rise against nation and kingdom against kingdom; there will be earthquakes in various places; there will be famines. This is but the beginning of the birth pangs.

PERSECUTION FORETOLD

9 “As for yourselves, beware, for they will hand you over to councils, and you will be beaten in synagogues, and you will stand before governors and kings because of me, as a testimony to them.* **10** And the good news^d must first be proclaimed to all nations. **11** When they bring you to trial and hand you over, do not worry beforehand about what you are to say, but say whatever is given you at that time, for it is not you who speak but the Holy Spirit.* **12** Sibling will betray sibling to death and a father his child, and children will rise against parents and have them put to death,* **13** and you will be hated by all because of my name. But the one who endures to the end will be saved.*

THE DESOLATING SACRILEGE

14 “But when you see the desolating sacrilege set up where it ought not to be (let the reader understand), then those in Judea must flee to the mountains; ^{*} **15** the one on the housetop must not go down or enter to take anything from the house; **16** the one in the field must not turn back to get a coat. **17** Woe to those who are pregnant and to those who are nursing infants in those days! ^{*} **18** Pray that it may not be in winter. **19** For in those days there will be suffering, such as has not been from the beginning of the creation that God created until now and never will be. ^{*} **20** And if the Lord had not cut short those days, no one would be saved, but for the sake of the elect, whom he chose, he has cut short those days. **21** And if anyone says to you at that time, ‘Look! Here is the Messiah!’^e or ‘Look! There he is!’ —do not believe it. ^{*} **22** False messiahs^f and false prophets will appear and produce signs and wonders, to lead astray, if possible, the elect. ^{*} **23** But be alert; I have already told you everything.^{*}

THE COMING OF THE SON OF MAN

24 “But in those days, after that suffering,
the sun will be darkened,

and the moon will not give its light,^{*}

25 and the stars will be falling from heaven,

and the powers in the heavens will be shaken.

26 “Then they will see ‘the Son of Man coming in clouds’ with great power and glory. ^{*} **27** Then he will send out the angels and gather the^g elect from the four winds, from the ends of the earth to the ends of heaven.

THE LESSON OF THE FIG TREE

28 “From the fig tree learn its lesson: as soon as its branch becomes tender and puts forth its leaves, you know that summer is near. **29** So also, when you see these things taking place, you know that he^h is near, at the very gates. **30** Truly I tell you, this generation will not pass away until all these things have taken place. ^{*} **31** Heaven and earth will pass away, but my words will not pass away.^{*}

THE NECESSITY FOR WATCHFULNESS

32 “But about that day or hour no one knows, neither the angels in heaven nor the Son, but only the Father.* ³³Beware, keep alert,ⁱ for you do not know when the time will come.* ³⁴It is like a man going on a journey, when he leaves home and puts his slaves in charge, each with his work, and commands the doorkeeper to be on the watch.* ³⁵Therefore, keep awake, for you do not know when the master of the house will come, in the evening or at midnight or at cockcrow or at dawn,* ³⁶or else he may find you asleep when he comes suddenly. ³⁷And what I say to you I say to all: Keep awake.”

Mark 14

THE PLOT TO KILL JESUS

1 It was two days before the Passover and the Festival of Unleavened Bread. The chief priests and the scribes were looking for a way to arrest Jesus^j by stealth and kill him,* ²for they said, “Not during the festival, or there may be a riot among the people.”

THE ANOINTING AT BETHANY

3 While he was at Bethany in the house of Simon the leper,^k as he sat at the table, a woman came with an alabaster jar of very costly ointment of nard, and she broke open the jar and poured the ointment on his head.* ⁴But some were there who said to one another in anger, “Why was the ointment wasted in this way? ⁵For this ointment could have been sold for more than three hundred denarii and the money given to the poor.” And they scolded her. ⁶But Jesus said, “Let her alone; why do you trouble her? She has performed a good service for me. ⁷For you always have the poor with you, and you can show kindness to them whenever you wish, but you will not always have me.* ⁸She has done what she could; she has anointed my body beforehand for its burial.* ⁹Truly I tell you, wherever the good news^l is proclaimed in the whole world, what she has done will be told in remembrance of her.”

JUDAS AGREES TO BETRAY JESUS

10 Then Judas Iscariot, who was one of the twelve, went to the chief priests in order to betray him to them.* ¹¹When they heard it, they were greatly pleased and promised to give him money. So he began to look for an opportunity to betray him.

THE PASSOVER WITH THE DISCIPLES

12 On the first day of Unleavened Bread, when the Passover lamb is sacrificed, his disciples said to him, “Where do you want us to go and make

the preparations for you to eat the Passover?”* ¹³So he sent two of his disciples, saying to them, “Go into the city, and a man carrying a jar of water will meet you; follow him, ¹⁴and wherever he enters, say to the owner of the house, ‘The Teacher asks: Where is my guest room where I may eat the Passover with my disciples?’ ¹⁵He will show you a large room upstairs, furnished and ready. Make preparations for us there.” ¹⁶So the disciples set out and went to the city and found everything as he had told them, and they prepared the Passover meal.

17 When it was evening, he came with the twelve. ¹⁸And when they had taken their places and were eating, Jesus said, “Truly I tell you, one of you will betray me, one who is eating with me.”* ¹⁹They began to be distressed and to say to him one after another, “Surely, not I?” ²⁰He said to them, “It is one of the twelve, one who is dipping bread^m into the bowlⁿ with me. ²¹For the Son of Man goes as it is written of him, but woe to that one by whom the Son of Man is betrayed! It would have been better for that one not to have been born.”

THE INSTITUTION OF THE LORD'S SUPPER

22 While they were eating, he took a loaf of bread, and after blessing it he broke it, gave it to them, and said, “Take; this is my body.”* ²³Then he took a cup, and after giving thanks he gave it to them, and all of them drank from it.* ²⁴He said to them, “This is my blood of the^o covenant, which is poured out for many.* ²⁵Truly I tell you, I will never again drink of the fruit of the vine until that day when I drink it new in the kingdom of God.”

PETER'S DENIAL FORETOLD

26 When they had sung the hymn, they went out to the Mount of Olives.^{*}
²⁷And Jesus said to them, “You will all fall away,^P for it is written,
‘I will strike the shepherd,
and the sheep will be scattered.’^{*}

28“**But after I am raised up, I will go before you to Galilee.**”* 29Peter said to him, “**Even though all fall away,⁹ I will not.**”* 30Jesus said to him, “**Truly I tell you, this day, this very night, before the cock crows twice, you will**

deny me three times.”* ³¹But he said vehemently, “Even though I must die with you, I will not deny you.” And all of them said the same.

JESUS PRAYS IN GETHSEMANE

32 They went to a place called Gethsemane, and he said to his disciples, “Sit here while I pray.” ³³He took with him Peter and James and John and began to be distressed and agitated. ³⁴And he said to them, “My soul is deeply grieved, even to death; remain here, and keep awake.”* ³⁵And going a little farther, he threw himself on the ground and prayed that, if it were possible, the hour might pass from him.* ³⁶He said, “Abba,^r Father, for you all things are possible; remove this cup from me, yet not what I want but what you want.”* ³⁷He came and found them sleeping, and he said to Peter, “Simon, are you asleep? Could you not keep awake one hour? ³⁸Keep awake and pray that you may not come into the time of trial;^s the spirit indeed is willing, but the flesh is weak.”* ³⁹And again he went away and prayed, saying the same words. ⁴⁰And once more he came and found them sleeping, for their eyes were very heavy, and they did not know what to say to him. ⁴¹He came a third time and said to them, “Are you still sleeping and taking your rest? Enough! The hour has come; the Son of Man is betrayed into the hands of sinners.* ⁴²Get up, let us be going. Look, my betrayer is at hand.”

THE BETRAYAL AND ARREST OF JESUS

43 Immediately, while he was still speaking, Judas, one of the twelve, arrived, and with him there was a crowd with swords and clubs, from the chief priests, the scribes, and the elders. ⁴⁴Now the betrayer had given them a sign, saying, “The one I will kiss is the man; arrest him and lead him away under guard.” ⁴⁵So when he came, he went up to him at once and said, “Rabbi!” and kissed him.* ⁴⁶Then they laid hands on him and arrested him. ⁴⁷But one of those who stood near drew his sword and struck the slave of the high priest, cutting off his ear. ⁴⁸Then Jesus said to them, “Have you come out with swords and clubs to arrest me as though I were a rebel? ⁴⁹Day after day I was with you in the temple teaching, and you did not

arrest me. But let the scriptures be fulfilled.”* ⁵⁰All of them deserted him and fled.*

51 A certain young man was following him, wearing nothing but a linen cloth. They caught hold of him, ⁵²but he left the linen cloth and ran off naked.

JESUS BEFORE THE COUNCIL

53 They took Jesus to the high priest, and all the chief priests, the elders, and the scribes were assembled. ⁵⁴Peter had followed him at a distance, right into the courtyard of the high priest, and he was sitting with the guards, warming himself at the fire.* ⁵⁵Now the chief priests and the whole council were looking for testimony against Jesus to put him to death, but they found none. ⁵⁶For many gave false testimony against him, and their testimony did not agree. ⁵⁷Some stood up and gave false testimony against him, saying, ⁵⁸“We heard him say, ‘I will destroy this temple that is made with hands, and in three days I will build another, not made with hands.’ ”* ⁵⁹But even on this point their testimony did not agree. ⁶⁰Then the high priest stood up before them and asked Jesus, “Have you no answer? What is it that they testify against you?” ⁶¹But he was silent and did not answer. Again the high priest asked him, “Are you the Messiah,^t the Son of the Blessed One?”* ⁶²Jesus said, “I am, and

‘you will see the Son of Man
seated at the right hand of the Power’
and ‘coming with the clouds of heaven.’ ”*

⁶³Then the high priest tore his clothes and said, “Why do we still need witnesses?”* ⁶⁴You have heard his blasphemy! What is your decision?” All of them condemned him as deserving death.* ⁶⁵Some began to spit on him, to blindfold him, and to strike him, saying to him, “Prophecy!” The guards also took him and beat him.*

PETER DENIES JESUS

66 While Peter was below in the courtyard, one of the female servants of the high priest came by.* ⁶⁷When she saw Peter warming himself, she stared

at him and said, "You also were with Jesus, the man from Nazareth."* ⁶⁸But he denied it, saying, "I do not know or understand what you are talking about." And he went out into the forecourt.^u Then the cock crowed.^{v,*} ⁶⁹And the female servant, on seeing him, began again to say to the bystanders, "This man is one of them." ⁷⁰But again he denied it. Then after a little while the bystanders again said to Peter, "Certainly you are one of them, for you are a Galilean, and you talk like one."^{w,*} ⁷¹But he began to curse, and he swore an oath, "I do not know this man you are talking about." ⁷²At that moment the cock crowed for the second time. Then Peter remembered that Jesus had said to him, "Before the cock crows twice, you will deny me three times." And he broke down and wept.*

Mark 15

JESUS BEFORE PILATE

1 As soon as it was morning, the chief priests held a consultation with the elders and scribes and the whole council. They bound Jesus, led him away, and handed him over to Pilate.* **2** Pilate asked him, “Are you the King of the Jews?” He answered him, “You say so.” **3** Then the chief priests accused him of many things. **4** Pilate asked him again, “Have you no answer? See how many charges they bring against you.” **5** But Jesus made no further reply, so that Pilate was amazed.*

PILATE HANDS JESUS OVER TO BE CRUCIFIED

6 Now at the festival he used to release a prisoner for them, anyone for whom they asked.* **7** Now a man called Barabbas was in prison with the insurrectionists who had committed murder during the insurrection. **8** So the crowd came and began to ask Pilate to do for them according to his custom. **9** Then he answered them, “Do you want me to release for you the King of the Jews?” **10** For he realized that it was out of jealousy that the chief priests had handed him over. **11** But the chief priests stirred up the crowd to have him release Barabbas for them instead.* **12** Pilate spoke to them again, “Then what do you wish me to do^x with the man you call^y the King of the Jews?” **13** They shouted back, “Crucify him!” **14** Pilate asked them, “Why, what evil has he done?” But they shouted all the more, “Crucify him!” **15** So Pilate, wishing to satisfy the crowd, released Barabbas for them, and after flogging Jesus he handed him over to be crucified.*

THE SOLDIERS MOCK JESUS

16 Then the soldiers led him into the courtyard of the palace (that is, the governor’s headquarters), and they called together the whole cohort.* **17** And they clothed him in a purple cloak, and after twisting some thorns into a crown they put it on him. **18** And they began saluting him, “Hail, King of the Jews!” **19** They struck his head with a reed, spat upon him, and knelt down

in homage to him. ²⁰After mocking him, they stripped him of the purple cloak and put his own clothes on him. Then they led him out to crucify him.

THE CRUCIFIXION OF JESUS

21 They compelled a passer-by, who was coming in from the country, to carry his cross; it was Simon of Cyrene, the father of Alexander and Rufus.^{*} ²²Then they brought Jesus^z to the place called Golgotha (which means Place of a Skull). ²³And they offered him wine mixed with myrrh, but he did not take it. ²⁴And they crucified him and divided his clothes among them, casting lots to decide what each should take.^{*}

25 It was nine o'clock in the morning when they crucified him. ²⁶The inscription of the charge against him read, "The King of the Jews." ²⁷And with him they crucified two rebels, one on his right and one on his left.^a ²⁹Those who passed by derided^b him, shaking their heads and saying, "Aha! You who would destroy the temple and build it in three days,^{*} ³⁰save yourself, and come down from the cross!" ³¹In the same way the chief priests, along with the scribes, were also mocking him among themselves and saying, "He saved others; he cannot save himself."^{*} ³²Let the Messiah,^c the King of Israel, come down from the cross now, so that we may see and believe." Those who were crucified with him also taunted him.^{*}

THE DEATH OF JESUS

33 When it was noon, darkness came over the whole land^d until three in the afternoon. ³⁴At three o'clock Jesus cried out with a loud voice, "Eloi, Eloi, lema sabachthani?" which means, "My God, my God, why have you forsaken me?"^{e,*} ³⁵When some of the bystanders heard it, they said, "Listen, he is calling for Elijah." ³⁶And someone ran, filled a sponge with sour wine, put it on a stick, and gave it to him to drink, saying, "Wait, let us see whether Elijah will come to take him down."^{*} ³⁷Then Jesus gave a loud cry and breathed his last. ³⁸And the curtain of the temple was torn in two, from top to bottom.^{*} ³⁹Now when the centurion who stood facing him saw that in this way he^f breathed his last, he said, "Truly this man was God's Son!"^{g,*}

40 There were also women looking on from a distance. Among them were Mary Magdalene, and Mary the mother of James the younger and of Joses, and Salome,* ⁴¹who followed him when he was in Galilee and ministered to him, and there were many other women who had come up with him to Jerusalem.*

THE BURIAL OF JESUS

42 When evening had come, and since it was the day of Preparation, that is, the day before the Sabbath,* ⁴³Joseph of Arimathea, a respected member of the council who was also himself waiting expectantly for the kingdom of God, went boldly to Pilate and asked for the body of Jesus.* ⁴⁴Then Pilate wondered if he were already dead, and summoning the centurion he asked him whether he had been dead for some time. ⁴⁵When he learned from the centurion that he was dead, he granted the body to Joseph.* ⁴⁶Then Joseph^h bought a linen cloth and, taking down the body,ⁱ wrapped it in the linen cloth and laid it in a tomb that had been hewn out of rock. He then rolled a stone against the door of the tomb. ⁴⁷Mary Magdalene and Mary the mother of Joses saw where the body^j was laid.

Mark 16

THE RESURRECTION OF JESUS

1 When the Sabbath was over, Mary Magdalene and Mary the mother of James and Salome bought spices, so that they might go and anoint him.*
2 And very early on the first day of the week, when the sun had risen, they went to the tomb. **3** They had been saying to one another, “Who will roll away the stone for us from the entrance to the tomb?”* **4** When they looked up, they saw that the stone, which was very large, had already been rolled back. **5** As they entered the tomb, they saw a young man dressed in a white robe sitting on the right side, and they were alarmed.* **6** But he said to them, “Do not be alarmed; you are looking for Jesus of Nazareth, who was crucified. He has been raised; he is not here. Look, there is the place they laid him.* **7** But go, tell his disciples and Peter that he is going ahead of you to Galilee; there you will see him, just as he told you.”* **8** So they went out and fled from the tomb, for terror and amazement had seized them, and they said nothing to anyone, for they were afraid.^k

THE INTERMEDIATE ENDING OF MARK

[[And all that had been commanded them they told briefly to those around Peter. And afterward Jesus himself sent out through them, from east to west, the sacred and imperishable proclamation of eternal salvation. Amen.^l]]

THE LONG ENDING OF MARK

JESUS APPEARS TO MARY MAGDALENE

[[**9** Now after he rose early on the first day of the week, he appeared first to Mary Magdalene, from whom he had cast out seven demons. ¹⁰She went out and told those who had been with him, while they were mourning and weeping. ¹¹But when they heard that he was alive and had been seen by her, they would not believe it.

JESUS APPEARS TO TWO DISCIPLES

12 After this he appeared in another form to two of them, as they were walking into the country. ¹³And they went back and told the rest, but they did not believe them.

JESUS COMMISSIONS THE DISCIPLES

14 Later he appeared to the eleven themselves as they were sitting at the table, and he upbraided them for their lack of faith and stubbornness, because they had not believed those who saw him after he had risen.^m ¹⁵And he said to them, “Go into all the world and proclaim the good newsⁿ to the whole creation. ¹⁶The one who believes and is baptized will be saved, but the one who does not believe will be condemned. ¹⁷And these signs will accompany those who believe: by using my name they will cast out demons; they will speak in new tongues; ¹⁸they will pick up snakes,^o and if they drink any deadly thing, it will not hurt them; they will lay their hands on the sick, and they will recover.”

THE ASCENSION OF JESUS

19 So then the Lord Jesus, after he had spoken to them, was taken up into heaven and sat down at the right hand of God. ²⁰And they went out and proclaimed the good news everywhere, while the Lord worked with them and confirmed the message by the signs that accompanied it.^p]]

The Gospel according to Luke

Luke 1

DEDICATION TO THEOPHILUS

1 Since many have undertaken to compile a narrative about the events that have been fulfilled among us, ²just as they were handed on to us by those who from the beginning were eyewitnesses and servants of the word,* ³I, too, decided, as one having a grasp of everything from the start,^a to write a well-ordered account for you, most excellent Theophilus,* ⁴so that you may have a firm grasp of the words in which you have been instructed.

THE BIRTH OF JOHN THE BAPTIST FORETOLD

5 In the days of King Herod of Judea, there was a priest named Zechariah, who belonged to the priestly order of Abijah. His wife was descended from the daughters of Aaron, and her name was Elizabeth.* ⁶Both of them were righteous before God, living blamelessly according to all the commandments and regulations of the Lord.* ⁷But they had no children because Elizabeth was barren, and both were getting on in years.

8 Once when he was serving as priest before God during his section's turn of duty,* ⁹he was chosen by lot, according to the custom of the priesthood, to enter the sanctuary of the Lord to offer incense.* ¹⁰Now at the time of the incense offering, the whole assembly of the people was praying outside.* ¹¹Then there appeared to him an angel of the Lord, standing at the right side of the altar of incense. ¹²When Zechariah saw him, he was terrified, and fear overwhelmed him. ¹³But the angel said to him, "Do not be afraid, Zechariah, for your prayer has been heard. Your wife Elizabeth will bear you a son, and you will name him John.* ¹⁴You will have joy and gladness, and many will rejoice at his birth,* ¹⁵for he will be great in the sight of the Lord. He must never drink wine or strong drink; even before his birth he will be filled with the Holy Spirit.* ¹⁶He will turn many of the

people of Israel to the Lord their God.* ¹⁷With the spirit and power of Elijah he will go before him, to turn the hearts of parents to their children and the disobedient to the wisdom of the righteous, to make ready a people prepared for the Lord.”* ¹⁸Zechariah said to the angel, “How can I know that this will happen? For I am an old man, and my wife is getting on in years.”* ¹⁹The angel replied, “I am Gabriel. I stand in the presence of God, and I have been sent to speak to you and to bring you this good news.* ²⁰But now, because you did not believe my words, which will be fulfilled in their time, you will become mute, unable to speak, until the day these things occur.”*

21 Meanwhile the people were waiting for Zechariah and wondering at his delay in the sanctuary. ²²When he did come out, he was unable to speak to them, and they realized that he had seen a vision in the sanctuary. He kept motioning to them and remained unable to speak. ²³When his time of service was ended, he returned to his home.

24 After those days his wife Elizabeth conceived, and for five months she remained in seclusion. She said, ²⁵“This is what the Lord has done for me in this time, when he looked favorably on me and took away the disgrace I have endured among my people.”*

THE BIRTH OF JESUS FORETOLD

26 In the sixth month the angel Gabriel was sent by God to a town in Galilee called Nazareth,* ²⁷to a virgin engaged to a man whose name was Joseph, of the house of David. The virgin’s name was Mary.* ²⁸And he came to her and said, “Greetings, favored one! The Lord is with you.”^{b,*} ²⁹But she was much perplexed by his words and pondered what sort of greeting this might be. ³⁰The angel said to her, “Do not be afraid, Mary, for you have found favor with God. ³¹And now, you will conceive in your womb and bear a son, and you will name him Jesus.* ³²He will be great and will be called the Son of the Most High, and the Lord God will give to him the throne of his ancestor David.* ³³He will reign over the house of Jacob forever, and of his kingdom there will be no end.”* ³⁴Mary said to the angel, “How can this be, since I am a virgin?”^c ³⁵The angel said to her, “The Holy Spirit will come upon you, and the power of the Most High will

overshadow you; therefore the child to be born^d will be holy; he will be called Son of God.*³⁶ And now, your relative Elizabeth in her old age has also conceived a son, and this is the sixth month for her who was said to be barren.³⁷ For nothing will be impossible with God.”*³⁸ Then Mary said, “Here am I, the servant of the Lord; let it be with me according to your word.” Then the angel departed from her.

MARY VISITS ELIZABETH

39 In those days Mary set out and went with haste to a Judean town in the hill country,⁴⁰ where she entered the house of Zechariah and greeted Elizabeth.⁴¹ When Elizabeth heard Mary’s greeting, the child leaped in her womb. And Elizabeth was filled with the Holy Spirit⁴² and exclaimed with a loud cry, “Blessed are you among women, and blessed is the fruit of your womb.*⁴³ And why has this happened to me, that the mother of my Lord comes to me?”⁴⁴ For as soon as I heard the sound of your greeting, the child in my womb leaped for joy.⁴⁵ And blessed is she who believed that there would be^e a fulfillment of what was spoken to her by the Lord.”

MARY’S SONG OF PRAISE

46 And Mary^f said,

“My soul magnifies the Lord,*

⁴⁷and my spirit rejoices in God my Savior,*

⁴⁸for he has looked with favor on the lowly state of his servant.

Surely from now on all generations will call me blessed,*

⁴⁹for the Mighty One has done great things for me,

and holy is his name;*

⁵⁰indeed, his mercy is for those who fear him

from generation to generation.*

⁵¹He has shown strength with his arm;

he has scattered the proud in the imagination of their hearts.*

⁵²He has brought down the powerful from their thrones

and lifted up the lowly;*
⁵³he has filled the hungry with good things
and sent the rich away empty.*
⁵⁴He has come to the aid of his child Israel,
in remembrance of his mercy,*
⁵⁵according to the promise he made to our ancestors,
to Abraham and to his descendants forever.”*

56 And Mary remained with her about three months and then returned to her home.

THE BIRTH OF JOHN THE BAPTIST

57 Now the time came for Elizabeth to give birth, and she bore a son.
⁵⁸Her neighbors and relatives heard that the Lord had shown his great mercy to her, and they rejoiced with her.*

59 On the eighth day they came to circumcise the child, and they were going to name him Zechariah after his father.* ⁶⁰But his mother said, “No; he is to be called John.” ⁶¹They said to her, “None of your relatives has this name.” ⁶²Then they began motioning to his father to find out what name he wanted to give him. ⁶³He asked for a writing tablet and wrote, “His name is John.” And all of them were amazed. ⁶⁴Immediately his mouth was opened and his tongue freed, and he began to speak, praising God. ⁶⁵Fear came over all their neighbors, and all these things were talked about throughout the entire hill country of Judea. ⁶⁶All who heard them pondered them and said, “What then will this child become?” For indeed the hand of the Lord was with him.*

ZECHARIAH’S PROPHECY

67 Then his father Zechariah was filled with the Holy Spirit and prophesied:*

⁶⁸“Blessed be the Lord God of Israel,
for he has looked favorably on^g his people and redeemed
them.*

⁶⁹He has raised up a mighty savior^h for us
in the house of his child David,*

⁷⁰as he spoke through the mouth of his holy prophets from of
old,*

⁷¹that we would be saved from our enemies and from the hand
of all who hate us.

⁷²Thus he has shown the mercy promised to our ancestors
and has remembered his holy covenant,*

⁷³the oath that he swore to our ancestor Abraham,
to grant us ⁷⁴that we, being rescued from the hands of our
enemies,

might serve him without fear,* ⁷⁵in holiness and righteousness
in his presence all our days.*

⁷⁶And you, child, will be called the prophet of the Most High,
for you will go before the Lord to prepare his ways,*

⁷⁷to give his people knowledge of salvation
by the forgiveness of their sins.*

⁷⁸Because of the tender mercy of our God,
the dawn from on high will breakⁱ upon^j us,

⁷⁹to shine upon those who sit in darkness and in the shadow of
death,

to guide our feet into the way of peace.”*

80 The child grew and became strong in spirit, and he was in the
wilderness until the day he appeared publicly to Israel.*

Luke 2

THE BIRTH OF JESUS

1 In those days a decree went out from Caesar Augustus that all the world should be registered. **2**This was the first registration and was taken while Quirinius was governor of Syria. **3**All went to their own towns to be registered. **4**Joseph also went from the town of Nazareth in Galilee to Judea, to the city of David called Bethlehem, because he was descended from the house and family of David. ^{*}**5**He went to be registered with Mary, to whom he was engaged and who was expecting a child. **6**While they were there, the time came for her to deliver her child. **7**And she gave birth to her firstborn son and wrapped him in bands of cloth and laid him in a manger, because there was no place in the guest room.^k

THE SHEPHERDS AND THE ANGELS

8 Now in that same region there were shepherds living in the fields, keeping watch over their flock by night. **9**Then an angel of the Lord stood before them, and the glory of the Lord shone around them, and they were terrified. **10**But the angel said to them, “Do not be afraid, for see, I am bringing you good news of great joy for all the people: ^{*}**11**to you is born this day in the city of David a Savior, who is the Messiah,^l the Lord.” ^{*}**12**This will be a sign for you: you will find a child wrapped in bands of cloth and lying in a manger.” ^{*}**13**And suddenly there was with the angel a multitude of the heavenly host,^m praising God and saying, ^{*}

¹⁴“Glory to God in the highest heaven,

and on earth peace among those whom he favors!”^{n,*}

15 When the angels had left them and gone into heaven, the shepherds said to one another, “Let us go now to Bethlehem and see this thing that has taken place, which the Lord has made known to us.” **16**So they went with haste and found Mary and Joseph and the child lying in the manger. **17**When they saw this, they made known what had been told them about this child, ¹⁸and all who heard it were amazed at what the shepherds told them, ¹⁹and

Mary treasured all these words and pondered them in her heart.* ²⁰The shepherds returned, glorifying and praising God for all they had heard and seen, just as it had been told them.*

JESUS IS NAMED

21 When the eighth day came, it was time to circumcise the child,^o and he was called Jesus, the name given by the angel before he was conceived in the womb.*

JESUS IS PRESENTED IN THE TEMPLE

22 When the time came for their purification according to the law of Moses, they brought him up to Jerusalem to present him to the Lord* ²³(as it is written in the law of the Lord, “Every firstborn male shall be designated as holy to the Lord”),* ²⁴and they offered a sacrifice according to what is stated in the law of the Lord, “a pair of turtledoves or two young pigeons.”

25 Now there was a man in Jerusalem whose name was Simeon; this man was righteous and devout, looking forward to the consolation of Israel, and the Holy Spirit rested on him.* ²⁶It had been revealed to him by the Holy Spirit that he would not see death before he had seen the Lord’s Messiah.^{p,*}
²⁷Guided by the Spirit, Simeon^q came into the temple, and when the parents brought in the child Jesus to do for him what was customary under the law,*
²⁸Simeon^r took him in his arms and praised God, saying,

²⁹“Master, now you are dismissing your servant in peace,

according to your word,*

³⁰for my eyes have seen your salvation,*

³¹which you have prepared in the presence of all peoples,

³²a light for revelation to the gentiles

and for glory to your people Israel.”*

33 And the child’s father and mother were amazed at what was being said about him. ³⁴Then Simeon blessed them and said to his mother Mary, “This child is destined for the falling and the rising of many in Israel and to be a

sign that will be opposed^{*} ³⁵so that the inner thoughts of many will be revealed—and a sword will pierce your own soul, too.”

36 There was also a prophet, Anna the daughter of Phanuel, of the tribe of Asher. She was of a great age, having lived with her husband seven years after her marriage, ^{*} ³⁷then as a widow to the age of eighty-four. She never left the temple but worshiped there with fasting and prayer night and day.^{*} ³⁸At that moment she came and began to praise God and to speak about the child^s to all who were looking for the redemption of Jerusalem.^{*}

THE RETURN TO NAZARETH

39 When they had finished everything required by the law of the Lord, they returned to Galilee, to their own town of Nazareth.^{*} ⁴⁰The child grew and became strong, filled with wisdom, and the favor of God was upon him.^{*}

THE BOY JESUS IN THE TEMPLE

41 Now every year his parents went to Jerusalem for the festival of the Passover.^{*} ⁴²And when he was twelve years old, they went up as usual for the festival. ⁴³When the festival was ended and they started to return, the boy Jesus stayed behind in Jerusalem, but his parents were unaware of this. ⁴⁴Assuming that he was in the group of travelers, they went a day’s journey. Then they started to look for him among their relatives and friends. ⁴⁵When they did not find him, they returned to Jerusalem to search for him. ⁴⁶After three days they found him in the temple, sitting among the teachers, listening to them and asking them questions. ⁴⁷And all who heard him were amazed at his understanding and his answers.^{*} ⁴⁸When his parents^t saw him they were astonished, and his mother said to him, “Child, why have you treated us like this? Your father and I have been anxiously looking for you.”^{*} ⁴⁹He said to them, “Why were you searching for me? Did you not know that I must be in my Father’s house?”^{u,*} ⁵⁰But they did not understand what he said to them.^{*} ⁵¹Then he went down with them and came to Nazareth and was obedient to them, and his mother treasured all these things in her heart.^{*}

52 And Jesus increased in wisdom and in years^v and in divine and human favor.*

Luke 3

THE PROCLAMATION OF JOHN THE BAPTIST

1 In the fifteenth year of the reign of Tiberius Caesar, when Pontius Pilate was governor of Judea, and Herod was ruler of Galilee, and his brother Philip ruler of the region of Ituraea and Trachonitis, and Lysanias ruler of Abilene,* ²during the high priesthood of Annas and Caiaphas, the word of God came to John son of Zechariah in the wilderness.* ³He went into all the region around the Jordan, proclaiming a baptism of repentance for the forgiveness of sins,⁴ as it is written in the book of the words of the prophet Isaiah,

“The voice of one crying out in the wilderness:

‘Prepare the way of the Lord;

make his paths straight.*

⁵Every valley shall be filled,

and every mountain and hill shall be made low,

and the crooked shall be made straight,

and the rough ways made smooth,

⁶and all flesh shall see the salvation of God.’ ”*

7 John said to the crowds coming out to be baptized by him, “You brood of vipers! Who warned you to flee from the coming wrath?”* ⁸Therefore, bear fruits worthy of repentance, and do not begin to say to yourselves, ‘We have Abraham as our ancestor,’ for I tell you, God is able from these stones to raise up children to Abraham.* ⁹Even now the ax is lying at the root of the trees; therefore every tree that does not bear good fruit will be cut down and thrown into the fire.”*

10 And the crowds asked him, “What, then, should we do?”* ¹¹In reply he said to them, “Whoever has two coats must share with anyone who has none, and whoever has food must do likewise.”* ¹²Even tax collectors came to be baptized, and they asked him, “Teacher, what should we do?”* ¹³He said to them, “Collect no more than the amount prescribed for you.”*

¹⁴Soldiers also asked him, “And we, what should we do?” He said to them, “Do not extort money from anyone by threats or false accusation, and be satisfied with your wages.”*

15 As the people were filled with expectation and all were questioning in their hearts concerning John, whether he might be the Messiah,^{w,*} ¹⁶John answered all of them by saying, “I baptize you with water, but one who is more powerful than I is coming; I am not worthy to untie the strap of his sandals. He will baptize you with^x the Holy Spirit and fire.* ¹⁷His winnowing fork is in his hand to clear his threshing floor and to gather the wheat into his granary, but the chaff he will burn with unquenchable fire.”*

18 So with many other exhortations he proclaimed the good news to the people. ¹⁹But Herod the ruler, who had been rebuked by him because of Herodias, his brother’s wife, and because of all the evil things that Herod had done, * ²⁰added to them all by shutting up John in prison.

THE BAPTISM OF JESUS

21 Now when all the people were baptized and when Jesus also had been baptized and was praying, the heaven was opened,* ²²and the Holy Spirit descended upon him in bodily form like a dove. And a voice came from heaven, “You are my Son, the Beloved;^y with you I am well pleased.”^{z,*}

THE ANCESTORS OF JESUS

23 Jesus was about thirty years old when he began his work. He was the son (as was thought) of Joseph son of Heli,* ²⁴son of Matthat, son of Levi, son of Melchi, son of Jannai, son of Joseph, ²⁵son of Mattathias, son of Amos, son of Nahum, son of Esli, son of Naggai, ²⁶son of Maath, son of Mattathias, son of Semein, son of Josech, son of Joda, ²⁷son of Joanan, son of Rhesa, son of Zerubbabel, son of Shealtiel, son of Neri,* ²⁸son of Melchi, son of Addi, son of Cosam, son of Elmadam, son of Er, ²⁹son of Joshua, son of Eliezer, son of Jorim, son of Matthat, son of Levi, ³⁰son of Simeon, son of Judah, son of Joseph, son of Jonam, son of Eliakim, ³¹son of Melea, son of Menna, son of Mattatha, son of Nathan, son of David,* ³²son of Jesse, son of Obed, son of Boaz, son of Sala,^a son of Nahshon,* ³³son of

Amminadab, son of Admin, son of Arni,^b son of Hezron, son of Perez, son of Judah,³⁴son of Jacob, son of Isaac, son of Abraham, son of Terah, son of Nahor,^{*} ³⁵son of Serug, son of Reu, son of Peleg, son of Eber, son of Shelah,³⁶son of Cainan, son of Arphaxad, son of Shem, son of Noah, son of Lamech,^{*} ³⁷son of Methuselah, son of Enoch, son of Jared, son of Mahalaleel, son of Cainan,³⁸son of Enos, son of Seth, son of Adam, son of God.^{*}

Luke 4

THE TESTING OF JESUS

1 Jesus, full of the Holy Spirit, returned from the Jordan and was led by the Spirit in the wilderness, ^{*} **2**where for forty days he was tested by the devil. He ate nothing at all during those days, and when they were over he was famished. ^{*} **3**The devil said to him, “If you are the Son of God, command this stone to become a loaf of bread.” **4**Jesus answered him, “It is written, ‘One does not live by bread alone.’” ^{*}

5 Then the devil^c led him up and showed him in an instant all the kingdoms of the world. **6**And the devil^d said to him, “To you I will give all this authority and their glory, for it has been given over to me, and I give it to anyone I please. ^{*} **7**If you, then, will worship me, it will all be yours.” **8**Jesus answered him, “It is written,

‘Worship the Lord your God,
and serve only him.’” ^{*}

9 Then the devil^c led him to Jerusalem and placed him on the pinnacle of the temple and said to him, “If you are the Son of God, throw yourself down from here, ¹⁰for it is written,

‘He will command his angels concerning you,
to protect you,’ ^{*}

¹¹and

‘On their hands they will bear you up,
so that you will not dash your foot against a stone.’”

¹²Jesus answered him, “It is said, ‘Do not put the Lord your God to the test.’” ^{*} ¹³When the devil had finished every test, he departed from him until an opportune time. ^{*}

THE BEGINNING OF THE GALILEAN MINISTRY

14 Then Jesus, in the power of the Spirit, returned to Galilee, and a report about him spread through all the surrounding region.* **15**He began to teach in their synagogues and was praised by everyone.*

THE REJECTION OF JESUS AT NAZARETH

16 When he came to Nazareth, where he had been brought up, he went to the synagogue on the Sabbath day, as was his custom. He stood up to read,* **17**and the scroll of the prophet Isaiah was given to him. He unrolled the scroll and found the place where it was written:

18“The Spirit of the Lord is upon me,

because he has anointed me

to bring good news to the poor.

He has sent me to proclaim release to the captives

and recovery of sight to the blind,

to set free those who are oppressed,*

19to proclaim the year of the Lord’s favor.”*

20And he rolled up the scroll, gave it back to the attendant, and sat down. The eyes of all in the synagogue were fixed on him.* **21**Then he began to say to them, “Today this scripture has been fulfilled in your hearing.” **22**All spoke well of him and were amazed at the gracious words that came from his mouth. They said, “Is this not Joseph’s son?”* **23**He said to them, “Doubtless you will quote to me this proverb, ‘Doctor, cure yourself!’ And you will say, ‘Do here also in your hometown the things that we have heard you did at Capernaum.’”* **24**And he said, “Truly I tell you, no prophet is accepted in his hometown.* **25**But the truth is, there were many widows in Israel in the time of Elijah, when the heaven was shut up three years and six months and there was a severe famine over all the land,* **26**yet Elijah was sent to none of them except to a widow at Zarephath in Sidon. **27**There were also many with a skin disease in Israel in the time of the prophet Elisha, and none of them was cleansed except Naaman the Syrian.”* **28**When they heard this, all in the synagogue were filled with rage. **29**They got up, drove him out of the town, and led him to the brow of the hill on which their town was

built, so that they might hurl him off the cliff.* ³⁰But he passed through the midst of them and went on his way.*

THE MAN WITH AN UNCLEAN SPIRIT

31 He went down to Capernaum, a city in Galilee, and was teaching them on the Sabbath.* ³²They were astounded at his teaching because he spoke with authority.* ³³In the synagogue there was a man who had the spirit of an unclean demon, and he cried out with a loud voice, ³⁴“Leave us alone! What have you to do with us, Jesus of Nazareth? Have you come to destroy us? I know who you are, the Holy One of God.”* ³⁵But Jesus rebuked him, saying, “Be quiet and come out of him!” Then the demon, throwing the man down before them, came out of him without doing him any harm.* ³⁶They were all astounded and kept saying to one another, “What kind of word is this, that with authority and power he commands the unclean spirits and they come out?”* ³⁷And news about him began to reach every place in the region.*

HEALINGS AT SIMON’S HOUSE

38 After leaving the synagogue he entered Simon’s house. Now Simon’s mother-in-law was suffering from a high fever, and they asked him about her. ³⁹Then he stood over her and rebuked the fever, and it left her. Immediately she got up and began to serve them.*

40 As the sun was setting, all those caring for any who were sick with various kinds of diseases brought them to him, and he laid his hands on each of them and cured them.* ⁴¹Moreover, demons also came out of many, shouting, “You are the Son of God!” But he rebuked them and would not allow them to speak, because they knew that he was the Messiah.^{f,*}

JESUS PREACHES IN THE SYNAGOGUES

42 At daybreak he departed and went into a deserted place. And the crowds began looking for him, and when they reached him they tried to keep him from leaving them.* ⁴³But he said to them, “I must proclaim the good news of the kingdom of God to the other cities also, for I was sent for

this purpose.” ⁴⁴So he continued proclaiming the message in the
synagogues of Judea.^{g,*}

Luke 5

JESUS CALLS THE FIRST DISCIPLES

1 Once while Jesus^h was standing beside the Lake of Gennesaret and the crowd was pressing in on him to hear the word of God, ²he saw two boats there at the shore of the lake; the fishermen had gotten out of them and were washing their nets. ³He got into one of the boats, the one belonging to Simon, and asked him to put out a little way from the shore. Then he sat down and taught the crowds from the boat.* ⁴When he had finished speaking, he said to Simon, “Put out into the deep water and let down your nets for a catch.”* ⁵Simon answered, “Master, we have worked all night long but have caught nothing. Yet if you say so, I will let down the nets.”* ⁶When they had done this, they caught so many fish that their nets were beginning to burst. ⁷So they signaled their partners in the other boat to come and help them. And they came and filled both boats, so that they began to sink. ⁸But when Simon Peter saw it, he fell down at Jesus’s knees, saying, “Go away from me, Lord, for I am a sinful man!” ⁹For he and all who were with him were astounded at the catch of fish that they had taken, ¹⁰and so also were James and John, sons of Zebedee, who were partners with Simon. Then Jesus said to Simon, “Do not be afraid; from now on you will be catching people.”* ¹¹When they had brought their boats to shore, they left everything and followed him.*

JESUS CLEANSSES A MAN WITH A SKIN DISEASE

12 Once when he was in one of the cities, a man covered with a skin disease was there. When he saw Jesus, he bowed with his face to the ground and begged him, “Lord, if you are willing, you can make me clean.”* ¹³Then Jesusⁱ stretched out his hand, touched him, and said, “I am willing. Be made clean.” Immediately the skin disease left him. ¹⁴And he ordered him to tell no one. “But go, show yourself to the priest, and, as Moses commanded, make an offering for your cleansing, as a testimony to them.”* ¹⁵But now more than ever the word about Jesus^j spread abroad; many

crowds were gathering to hear him and to be cured of their diseases.*
16Meanwhile, he would slip away to deserted places and pray.*

JESUS HEALS A PARALYTIC

17 One day while he was teaching, Pharisees and teachers of the law who had come from every village of Galilee and Judea and from Jerusalem were sitting nearby, and the power of the Lord was with him to heal.^{k,*} **18** Just then some men came carrying a paralyzed man on a stretcher. They were trying to bring him in and lay him before Jesus,^l **19** but, finding no way to bring him in because of the crowd, they went up on the roof and let him down on the stretcher through the tiles into the middle of the crowd^m in front of Jesus.* **20** When he saw their faith, he said, “Friend,ⁿ your sins are forgiven you.”* **21** Then the scribes and the Pharisees began to question, “Who is this who is speaking blasphemies? Who can forgive sins but God alone?”* **22** When Jesus perceived their questionings, he answered them, “Why do you raise such questions in your hearts? **23** Which is easier: to say, ‘Your sins are forgiven you,’ or to say, ‘Stand up and walk’? **24** But so that you may know that the Son of Man has authority on earth to forgive sins”—he said to the one who was paralyzed—“I say to you, stand up and take your stretcher and go to your home.” **25** Immediately he stood up before them, took what he had been lying on, and went to his home, glorifying God. **26** Amazement seized all of them, and they glorified God and were filled with fear, saying, “We have seen incredible things today.”*

JESUS CALLS LEVI

27 After this he went out and saw a tax collector named Levi sitting at the tax-collection station, and he said to him, “Follow me.” **28** And he got up, left everything, and followed him.*

29 Then Levi gave a great banquet for him in his house, and there was a large crowd of tax collectors and others reclining at the table with them.* **30** The Pharisees and their scribes were complaining to his disciples, saying, “Why do you eat and drink with tax collectors and sinners?”* **31** Jesus answered them, “Those who are well have no need of a physician but those

who are sick; ³²I have not come to call the righteous but sinners to repentance.”*

THE QUESTION ABOUT FASTING

33 Then they said to him, “John’s disciples, like the disciples of the Pharisees, frequently fast and pray, but your disciples eat and drink.”*

³⁴Jesus said to them, “You cannot make wedding attendants fast while the bridegroom is with them, can you? ³⁵The days will come when the bridegroom will be taken away from them, and then they will fast in those days.”*

³⁶He also told them a parable: “No one tears a piece from a new garment and sews it on an old garment; otherwise, not only will one tear the new garment, but the piece from the new will not match the old garment.

³⁷Similarly, no one puts new wine into old wineskins; otherwise, the new wine will burst the skins and will spill out, and the skins will be ruined.

³⁸But new wine must be put into fresh wineskins.° ³⁹And no one after drinking old wine desires new wine but says, ‘The old is good.’ ”p

Luke 6

THE QUESTION ABOUT THE SABBATH

1 One Sabbath^q while Jesus^r was going through some grain fields, his disciples plucked some heads of grain, rubbed them in their hands, and ate them.* **2**But some of the Pharisees said, “Why are you doing what is not lawful^s on the Sabbath?”* **3**Jesus answered, “Have you not read what David did when he and his companions were hungry?”* **4**How he entered the house of God and took and ate the bread of the Presence, which it is not lawful for any but the priests to eat, and gave some to his companions?”* **5**Then he said to them, “The Son of Man is lord of the Sabbath.”

THE MAN WITH A WITHERED HAND

6 On another Sabbath he entered the synagogue and taught, and there was a man there whose right hand was withered.* **7**The scribes and the Pharisees were watching him to see whether he would cure on the Sabbath, so that they might find grounds to bring an accusation against him. **8**But he knew what they were thinking, and he said to the man who had the withered hand, “Come and stand in the middle.” He got up and stood there.* **9**Then Jesus said to them, “I ask you, is it lawful to do good or to do harm on the Sabbath, to save life or to destroy it?” **10**After looking around at all of them, he said to him, “Stretch out your hand.” He did so, and his hand was restored. **11**But they were filled with fury and began discussing with one another what they might do to Jesus.

JESUS CHOOSES THE TWELVE APOSTLES

12 Now during those days he went out to the mountain to pray, and he spent the night in prayer to God.* **13**And when day came, he called his disciples and chose twelve of them, whom he also named apostles:* **14**Simon, whom he named Peter, and his brother Andrew, and James, and John, and Philip, and Bartholomew, **15**and Matthew, and Thomas, and James

son of Alphaeus, and Simon, who was called the Zealot, ¹⁶and Judas son of James, and Judas Iscariot, who became a traitor.*

JESUS TEACHES AND HEALS

17 He came down with them and stood on a level place with a great crowd of his disciples and a great multitude of people from all Judea, Jerusalem, and the coast of Tyre and Sidon.* ¹⁸They had come to hear him and to be healed of their diseases, and those who were troubled with unclean spirits were cured. ¹⁹And everyone in the crowd was trying to touch him, for power came out from him and healed all of them.*

BLESSINGS AND WOES

20 Then he looked up at his disciples and said:

“Blessed are you who are poor,
for yours is the kingdom of God.

²¹“Blessed are you who are hungry now,
for you will be filled.

“Blessed are you who weep now,
for you will laugh.*

22 “Blessed are you when people hate you and when they exclude you, revile you, and defame you^t on account of the Son of Man.* ²³Rejoice on that day and leap for joy, for surely your reward is great in heaven, for that is how their ancestors treated the prophets.*

²⁴“But woe to you who are rich,
for you have received your consolation.*

²⁵“Woe to you who are full now,
for you will be hungry.

“Woe to you who are laughing now,
for you will mourn and weep.*

26 “Woe to you when all speak well of you, for that is how their ancestors treated the false prophets.*

LOVE FOR ENEMIES

27 “But I say to you who are listening: Love your enemies; do good to those who hate you; ^{*} **28** bless those who curse you; pray for those who mistreat you. ^{*} **29** If anyone strikes you on the cheek, offer the other also, and from anyone who takes away your coat do not withhold even your shirt. **30** Give to everyone who asks of you, and if anyone takes away what is yours, do not ask for it back again. ^{*} **31** Do to others as you would have them do to you. ^{*}

32 “If you love those who love you, what credit is that to you? For even sinners love those who love them. **33** If you do good to those who do good to you, what credit is that to you? For even sinners do the same. **34** If you lend to those from whom you expect to receive payment, what credit is that to you? Even sinners lend to sinners, to receive as much again. **35** Instead, love your enemies, do good, and lend, expecting nothing in return. ^u Your reward will be great, and you will be children of the Most High, for he himself is kind to the ungrateful and the wicked. ^{*} **36** Be merciful, just as your Father is merciful.

JUDGING OTHERS

37 “Do not judge, and you will not be judged; do not condemn, and you will not be condemned. Forgive, and you will be forgiven; ^{*} **38** give, and it will be given to you. A good measure, pressed down, shaken together, running over, will be put into your lap, for the measure you give will be the measure you get back.” ^{*}

39 He also told them a parable: “Can a blind person guide a blind person? Will not both fall into a pit? ^{*} **40** A disciple is not above the teacher, but every disciple who is fully qualified will be like the teacher. ^{*} **41** Why do you see the speck in your neighbor’s eye but do not notice the log in your own eye? **42** Or how can you say to your neighbor, ‘Friend, let me take out the speck in your eye,’ when you yourself do not see the log in your own eye? You hypocrite, first take the log out of your own eye, and then you will see clearly to take the speck out of your neighbor’s eye.

A TREE AND ITS FRUIT

43 “No good tree bears bad fruit, nor again does a bad tree bear good fruit; ^{*} ⁴⁴for each tree is known by its own fruit. For people do not gather figs from thorns, nor do they pick grapes from a bramble bush. ^{*} ⁴⁵The good person out of the good treasure of the heart produces good, and the evil person out of evil treasure produces evil, for it is out of the abundance of the heart that the mouth speaks. ^{*}

THE TWO FOUNDATIONS

46 “Why do you call me ‘Lord, Lord,’ and do not do what I tell you? ^{*} ⁴⁷I will show you what someone is like who comes to me, hears my words, and acts on them. ^{*} ⁴⁸That one is like a man building a house who dug deeply and laid the foundation on rock; when a flood arose, the river burst against that house but could not shake it because it had been well built. ^v ⁴⁹But the one who hears and does not act is like a man who built a house on the ground without a foundation. When the river burst against it, it quickly collapsed, and great was the ruin of that house.”

Luke 7

JESUS HEALS A CENTURION'S SLAVE

1 After Jesus^w had finished all his sayings in the hearing of the people, he entered Capernaum.* **2**A centurion there had a slave whom he valued highly and who was ill and close to death. **3**When he heard about Jesus, he sent some Jewish elders to him, asking him to come and heal his slave. **4**When they came to Jesus, they appealed to him earnestly, saying, "He is worthy to have you do this for him, ⁵for he loves our people, and it is he who built our synagogue for us." **6**And Jesus went with them, but when he was not far from the house, the centurion sent friends to say to him, "Lord, do not trouble yourself, for I am not worthy to have you come under my roof; ⁷therefore I did not presume to come to you. But only speak the word, and let my servant be healed. **8**For I also am a man set under authority, with soldiers under me, and I say to one, 'Go,' and he goes, and to another, 'Come,' and he comes, and to my slave, 'Do this,' and the slave does it." **9**When Jesus heard this he was amazed at him, and, turning to the crowd following him, he said, "I tell you, not even in Israel have I found such faith."* **10**When those who had been sent returned to the house, they found the slave in good health.

JESUS RAISES THE WIDOW'S SON AT NAIN

11 Soon afterward^x he went to a town called Nain, and his disciples and a large crowd went with him.* **12**As he approached the gate of the town, a man who had died was being carried out. He was his mother's only son, and she was a widow, and with her was a large crowd from the town. **13**When the Lord saw her, he was moved with compassion for her and said to her, "Do not cry."* **14**Then he came forward and touched the bier, and the bearers stopped. And he said, "Young man, I say to you, rise!"* **15**The dead man sat up and began to speak, and Jesus^y gave him to his mother. **16**Fear seized all of them, and they glorified God, saying, "A great prophet has risen among us!" and "God has visited his people!"* **17**This word about him spread throughout the whole of Judea and all the surrounding region.

MESSENGERS FROM JOHN THE BAPTIST

18 The disciples of John reported all these things to him. So John summoned two of his disciples ¹⁹and sent them to the Lord to ask, “Are you the one who is to come, or are we to expect someone else?” ²⁰When the men had come to him, they said, “John the Baptist has sent us to you to ask, ‘Are you the one who is to come, or are we to expect someone else?’ ” ²¹Jesus^z had just then cured many people of diseases, afflictions, and evil spirits and had given sight to many who were blind. ^{*} ²²And he answered them, “Go and tell John what you have seen and heard: the blind receive their sight; the lame walk; those with a skin disease are cleansed; the deaf hear; the dead are raised; the poor have good news brought to them. ^{*} ²³And blessed is anyone who takes no offense at me.”

24 When John’s messengers had gone, Jesus^a began to speak to the crowds about John:^b “What did you go out into the wilderness to look at? A reed shaken by the wind? ²⁵What, then, did you go out to see? Someone^c dressed in soft robes? Look, those who put on fine clothing and live in luxury are in royal palaces. ²⁶What, then, did you go out to see? A prophet? Yes, I tell you, and more than a prophet. ²⁷This is the one about whom it is written,

‘See, I am sending my messenger ahead of you,
who will prepare your way before you.’

²⁸“I tell you, among those born of women no one is greater than John, yet the least in the kingdom of God is greater than he.” ²⁹(And all the people who heard this, including the tax collectors, acknowledged the justice of God,^d having been baptized with John’s baptism. ^{*} ³⁰But the Pharisees and the experts in the law, not having been baptized by him, rejected God’s purpose for themselves.)^{*}

31 “To what, then, will I compare the people of this generation, and what are they like? ³²They are like children sitting in the marketplace and calling to one another,

‘We played the flute for you, and you did not dance;
we wailed, and you did not weep.’

³³“For John the Baptist has come eating no bread and drinking no wine, and you say, ‘He has a demon’;” ³⁴the Son of Man has come eating and drinking, and you say, ‘Look, a glutton and a drunkard, a friend of tax collectors and sinners!’” ³⁵Nevertheless, wisdom is vindicated by all her children.”

A SINFUL WOMAN FORGIVEN

36 One of the Pharisees asked Jesus^c to eat with him, and when he went into the Pharisee’s house he reclined to dine. ³⁷And a woman in the city who was a sinner, having learned that he was eating in the Pharisee’s house, brought an alabaster jar of ointment. ³⁸She stood behind him at his feet, weeping, and began to bathe his feet with her tears and to dry them with her hair, kissing his feet and anointing them with the ointment. ³⁹Now when the Pharisee who had invited him saw it, he said to himself, “If this man were a prophet, he would have known who and what kind of woman this is who is touching him, that she is a sinner.” ⁴⁰Jesus spoke up and said to him, “Simon, I have something to say to you.” “Teacher,” he replied, “speak.” ⁴¹“A certain moneylender had two debtors; one owed five hundred denarii, and the other fifty. ⁴²When they could not pay, he canceled the debts for both of them. Now which of them will love him more?” ⁴³Simon answered, “I suppose the one for whom he canceled the greater debt.” And Jesus^f said to him, “You have judged rightly.” ⁴⁴Then turning toward the woman, he said to Simon, “Do you see this woman? I entered your house; you gave me no water for my feet, but she has bathed my feet with her tears and dried them with her hair. ⁴⁵You gave me no kiss, but from the time I came in she has not stopped kissing my feet. ⁴⁶You did not anoint my head with oil, but she has anointed my feet with ointment. ⁴⁷Therefore, I tell you, her many sins have been forgiven; hence she has shown great love. But the one to whom little is forgiven loves little.” ⁴⁸Then he said to her, “Your sins are forgiven.” ⁴⁹But those who were at the table with him began to say among themselves, “Who is this who even forgives sins?” ⁵⁰But he said to the woman, “Your faith has saved you; go in peace.”*

Luke 8

SOME WOMEN ACCOMPANY JESUS

1 Soon afterward he went on through one town and village after another, proclaiming and bringing the good news of the kingdom of God. The twelve were with him,^{*} **2**as well as some women who had been cured of evil spirits and infirmities: Mary, called Magdalene, from whom seven demons had gone out,^{*} **3**and Joanna, the wife of Herod's steward Chuza, and Susanna, and many others, who ministered to them^g out of their own resources.

THE PARABLE OF THE SOWER

4 When a large crowd was gathering, as people were coming to him from town after town, he said in a parable: ⁵“A sower went out to sow his seed, and as he sowed some fell on a path and was trampled on, and the birds of the air ate it up. ⁶Some fell on rock, and as it grew up it withered for lack of moisture. ⁷Some fell among thorns, and the thorns grew with it and choked it. ⁸Some fell into good soil, and when it grew it produced a hundredfold.” As he said this, he called out, “If you have ears to hear, then hear!”^{*}

THE PURPOSE OF THE PARABLES

9 Then his disciples asked him what this parable meant.^{*} ¹⁰He said, “To you it has been given to know the secrets^h of the kingdom of God, but to others I speakⁱ in parables, so that

‘looking they may not perceive
and hearing they may not understand.’

THE PARABLE OF THE SOWER EXPLAINED

11 “Now the parable is this: The seed is the word of God.^{*} ¹²The ones on the path are those who have heard; then the devil comes and takes away the word from their hearts, so that they may not believe and be saved. ¹³The

ones on the rock are those who, when they hear the word, receive it with joy. But these have no root; they believe only for a while and in a time of testing fall away. ¹⁴As for what fell among the thorns, these are the ones who hear, but as they go on their way they are choked by the cares and riches and pleasures of life, and their fruit does not mature. ¹⁵But as for that in the good soil, these are the ones who, when they hear the word, hold it fast in an honest and good heart and bear fruit with endurance.

A LAMP UNDER A JAR

16 “No one after lighting a lamp hides it under a jar or puts it under a bed; rather, one puts it on a lampstand, so that those who enter may see the light.* ¹⁷For nothing is hidden that will not be disclosed, nor is anything secret that will not become known and come to light.* ¹⁸So pay attention to how you listen, for to those who have, more will be given, and from those who do not have, even what they seem to have will be taken away.”*

THE TRUE KINDRED OF JESUS

19 Then his mother and his brothers came to him, but they could not reach him because of the crowd. ²⁰And he was told, “Your mother and your brothers are standing outside, wanting to see you.” ²¹But he said to them, “My mother and my brothers are those who hear the word of God and do it.”*

JESUS CALMS A STORM

22 One day he got into a boat with his disciples, and he said to them, “Let us go across to the other side of the lake.” So they put out,* ²³and while they were sailing he fell asleep. A windstorm swept down on the lake, and the boat was filling with water, and they were in danger. ²⁴They went to him and woke him up, shouting, “Master, Master, we are perishing!” And waking up, he rebuked the wind and the raging waves; they ceased, and there was a calm.* ²⁵Then he said to them, “Where is your faith?” They were terrified and amazed and said to one another, “Who then is this, that he commands even the winds and the water and they obey him?”

JESUS HEALS THE GERASENE DEMONIAK

26 Then they arrived at the region of the Gerasenes,^j which is opposite Galilee. ²⁷As he stepped out on shore, a man from the city who had demons met him. For a long time he had not worn^k any clothes, and he did not live in a house but in the tombs. ²⁸When he saw Jesus, he cried out and fell down before him, shouting, “What have you to do with me, Jesus, Son of the Most High God? I beg you, do not torment me,”^{*} ²⁹for Jesus^l had commanded the unclean spirit to come out of the man. (For many times it had seized him; he was kept under guard and bound with chains and shackles, but he would break the bonds and be driven by the demon into the wilds.) ³⁰Jesus then asked him, “What is your name?” He said, “Legion,” for many demons had entered him. ³¹They begged him not to order them to go back into the abyss.^{*}

32 Now there on the hillside a large herd of swine was feeding, and the demons^m begged Jesusⁿ to let them enter these. So he gave them permission. ³³Then the demons came out of the man and entered the swine, and the herd stampeded down the steep bank into the lake and was drowned.^{*}

34 When the swineherds saw what had happened, they ran off and told it in the city and in the country. ³⁵Then people came out to see what had happened, and when they came to Jesus, they found the man from whom the demons had gone sitting at the feet of Jesus, clothed and in his right mind. And they became frightened.^{*} ³⁶Those who had seen it told them how the one who had been possessed by demons had been healed.^{*} ³⁷Then the whole throng of people of the surrounding region of the Gerasenes^o asked Jesus^p to leave them, for they were seized with great fear. So he got into the boat and returned.^{*} ³⁸The man from whom the demons had gone out begged that he might be with him, but Jesus^q sent him away, saying, ³⁹“Return to your home, and declare how much God has done for you.” So he went away, proclaiming throughout the city how much Jesus had done for him.

A GIRL RESTORED TO LIFE AND A WOMAN HEALED

40 Now when Jesus returned, the crowd welcomed him, for they were all waiting for him. ⁴¹Just then there came a man named Jairus, a leader of the

synagogue. He fell at Jesus's feet and began pleading with him to come to his house, ⁴²for he had an only daughter, about twelve years old, and she was dying.

As he went, the crowds pressed in on him. ⁴³Now there was a woman who had been suffering from a flow of blood for twelve years, and though she had spent all she had on physicians,^r no one could cure her. ⁴⁴She came up behind him and touched the fringe of his cloak, and immediately her flow of blood stopped. ⁴⁵Then Jesus asked, "Who touched me?" When they all denied it, Peter^s said, "Master, the crowds are hemming you in and pressing against you."^{*} ⁴⁶But Jesus said, "Someone touched me, for I noticed that power had gone out from me."^{*} ⁴⁷When the woman realized that she could not remain hidden, she came trembling, and falling down before him, she declared in the presence of all the people why she had touched him and how she had been immediately healed. ⁴⁸He said to her, "Daughter, your faith has made you well; go in peace."^{*}

49 While he was still speaking, someone came from the synagogue leader's house to say, "Your daughter is dead; do not trouble the teacher any longer."^{*} ⁵⁰When Jesus heard this, he replied, "Do not be afraid. Only believe, and she will be saved." ⁵¹When he came to the house, he did not allow anyone to enter with him, except Peter, John, and James and the child's father and mother. ⁵²Everyone was weeping and grieving for her, but he said, "Do not cry, for she is not dead but sleeping."^{*} ⁵³And they laughed at him, knowing that she was dead. ⁵⁴But taking her by the hand, he called out, "Child, get up!"^{*} ⁵⁵Her spirit returned, and she stood up at once, and he directed them to give her something to eat. ⁵⁶Her parents were astounded, but he ordered them to tell no one what had happened.^{*}

Luke 9

THE MISSION OF THE TWELVE

1 Then Jesus^t called the twelve together and gave them power and authority over all demons and to cure diseases,* ²and he sent them out to proclaim the kingdom of God and to heal the sick.* ³He said to them, “Take nothing for your journey: no staff, nor bag, nor bread, nor money—not even an extra tunic.* ⁴Whatever house you enter, stay there, and leave from there. ⁵Wherever they do not welcome you, as you are leaving that town shake the dust off your feet as a testimony against them.”* ⁶So they departed and went through the villages, bringing the good news and curing diseases everywhere.

HEROD'S PERPLEXITY

7 Now Herod the ruler heard about all that had taken place, and he was perplexed because it was said by some that John had been raised from the dead,* ⁸by some that Elijah had appeared, and by others that one of the ancient prophets had arisen.* ⁹Herod said, “John I beheaded, but who is this about whom I hear such things?” And he tried to see him.*

FEEDING THE FIVE THOUSAND

10 On their return the apostles told Jesus^u all they had done. Then, taking them along, he slipped quietly into a city called Bethsaida.* ¹¹When the crowds found out about it, they followed him, and he welcomed them and spoke to them about the kingdom of God and healed those who needed to be cured.

12 The day was drawing to a close, and the twelve came to him and said, “Send the crowd away, so that they may go into the surrounding villages and countryside to lodge and get provisions, for we are here in a deserted place.” ¹³But he said to them, “You give them something to eat.” They said, “We have no more than five loaves and two fish—unless we are to go and buy food for all these people.”* ¹⁴For there were about five thousand men.

And he said to his disciples, “Have them sit down in groups of about fifty each.” ¹⁵They did so and had them all sit down. ¹⁶And taking the five loaves and the two fish, he looked up to heaven and blessed and broke them and gave them to the disciples to set before the crowd.* ¹⁷And all ate and were filled, and what was left over was gathered up, twelve baskets of broken pieces.

PETER’S DECLARATION ABOUT JESUS

18 Once when Jesus^v was praying alone, with only the disciples near him, he asked them, “Who do the crowds say that I am?”* ¹⁹They answered, “John the Baptist; but others, Elijah; and still others, that one of the ancient prophets has arisen.”* ²⁰Then he said to them, “But who do you say that I am?” Peter answered, “The Messiah^w of God.”*

JESUS FORETELLS HIS DEATH AND RESURRECTION

21 He sternly ordered and commanded them not to tell anyone,* ²²saying, “The Son of Man must undergo great suffering and be rejected by the elders, chief priests, and scribes and be killed and on the third day be raised.”*

23 Then he said to them all, “If any wish to come after me, let them deny themselves and take up their cross daily and follow me.* ²⁴For those who want to save their life will lose it, and those who lose their life for my sake will save it.* ²⁵For what does it profit them if they gain the whole world but lose or forfeit themselves?”* ²⁶Those who are ashamed of me and of my words, of them the Son of Man will be ashamed when he comes in his glory and the glory of the Father and of the holy angels.* ²⁷Indeed, truly I tell you, there are some standing here who will not taste death before they see the kingdom of God.”*

THE TRANSFIGURATION

28 Now about eight days after these sayings Jesus^x took with him Peter and John and James and went up on the mountain to pray.* ²⁹And while he was praying, the appearance of his face changed, and his clothes became as

bright as a flash of lightning. ³⁰Suddenly they saw two men, Moses and Elijah, talking to him. ³¹They appeared in glory and were speaking about his exodus, which he was about to fulfill in Jerusalem.* ³²Now Peter and his companions were weighed down with sleep, but as they awoke they saw his glory and the two men who stood with him.* ³³Just as they were leaving him, Peter said to Jesus, “Master, it is good for us to be here; let us set up three tents: one for you, one for Moses, and one for Elijah,” not realizing what he was saying.* ³⁴While he was saying this, a cloud came and overshadowed them, and they were terrified as they entered the cloud. ³⁵Then from the cloud came a voice that said, “This is my Son, my Chosen;^y listen to him!”* ³⁶When the voice had spoken, Jesus was found alone. And they kept silent and in those days told no one any of the things they had seen.*

JESUS HEALS A BOY WITH A DEMON

37 On the next day, when they had come down from the mountain, a great crowd met him. ³⁸Just then a man from the crowd shouted, “Teacher, I beg you to look at my son; he is my only child. ³⁹Suddenly a spirit seizes him, and all at once he^z shrieks. It convulses him until he foams at the mouth; it mauls him and will scarcely leave him. ⁴⁰I begged your disciples to cast it out, but they could not.” ⁴¹Jesus answered, “You faithless and perverse generation, how much longer must I be with you and put up with you? Bring your son here.” ⁴²While he was being brought forward, the demon dashed him to the ground in convulsions. But Jesus rebuked the unclean spirit, healed the boy, and gave him back to his father. ⁴³And all were astounded at the greatness of God.

JESUS AGAIN FORETELLS HIS DEATH

While everyone was amazed at all that he was doing, he said to his disciples,* ⁴⁴“Let these words sink into your ears: The Son of Man is going to be betrayed into human hands.”* ⁴⁵But they did not understand this saying; its meaning remained concealed from them, so that they could not perceive it. And they were afraid to ask him about this saying.*

TRUE GREATNESS

46 An argument arose among them concerning which one of them was the greatest. ⁴⁷But Jesus, aware of their inner thoughts, took a little child and put it by his side ⁴⁸and said to them, “Whoever welcomes this child in my name welcomes me, and whoever welcomes me welcomes the one who sent me, for the least among all of you is the greatest.”*

ANOTHER EXORCIST

49 John answered, “Master, we saw someone casting out demons in your name, and we tried to stop him because he does not follow with us.”* ⁵⁰But Jesus said to him, “Do not stop him, for whoever is not against you is for you.”*

A SAMARITAN VILLAGE REFUSES TO RECEIVE JESUS

51 When the days drew near for him to be taken up, he set his face to go to Jerusalem.* ⁵²And he sent messengers ahead of him. On their way they entered a village of the Samaritans to prepare for his arrival,* ⁵³but they did not receive him because his face was set toward Jerusalem. ⁵⁴When his disciples James and John saw this, they said, “Lord, do you want us to command fire to come down from heaven and consume them?”*^a ⁵⁵But he turned and rebuked them. ⁵⁶Then^b they went on to another village.

WOULD-BE FOLLOWERS OF JESUS

57 As they were going along the road, someone said to him, “I will follow you wherever you go.” ⁵⁸And Jesus said to him, “Foxes have holes, and birds of the air have nests, but the Son of Man has nowhere to lay his head.” ⁵⁹To another he said, “Follow me.” But he said, “Lord, first let me go and bury my father.”* ⁶⁰And Jesus^c said to him, “Let the dead bury their own dead, but as for you, go and proclaim the kingdom of God.” ⁶¹Another said, “I will follow you, Lord, but let me first say farewell to those at my home.” ⁶²And Jesus said to him, “No one who puts a hand to the plow and looks back is fit for the kingdom of God.”

Luke 10

THE MISSION OF THE SEVENTY-TWO

1 After this the Lord appointed seventy-two^d others and sent them on ahead of him in pairs to every town and place where he himself intended to go.*
2 He said to them, “The harvest is plentiful, but the laborers are few; therefore ask the Lord of the harvest to send out laborers into his harvest.*
3 Go on your way; I am sending you out like lambs into the midst of wolves.* **4** Carry no purse, no bag, no sandals, and greet no one on the road.*
5 Whatever house you enter, first say, ‘Peace to this house!’* **6** And if a person of peace is there, your peace will rest on that person, but if not, it will return to you. **7** Remain in the same house, eating and drinking whatever they provide, for the laborer deserves to be paid. Do not move about from house to house.* **8** Whenever you enter a town and its people welcome you, eat what is set before you; **9** cure the sick who are there, and say to them, ‘The kingdom of God has come near to you.’^{e,*} **10** But whenever you enter a town and they do not welcome you, go out into its streets and say, **11** ‘Even the dust of your town that clings to our feet, we wipe off in protest against you. Yet know this: the kingdom of God has come near.’^{f,*} **12** I tell you, on that day it will be more tolerable for Sodom than for that town.*

WOES TO UNREPENTANT CITIES

13 “Woe to you, Chorazin! Woe to you, Bethsaida! For if the deeds of power done in you had been done in Tyre and Sidon, they would have repented long ago, sitting in sackcloth and ashes.* **14** Indeed, at the judgment it will be more tolerable for Tyre and Sidon than for you. **15** And you, Capernaum,

will you be exalted to heaven?

No, you will be brought down to Hades.*

16 “Whoever listens to you listens to me, and whoever rejects you rejects me, and whoever rejects me rejects the one who sent me.”*

THE RETURN OF THE SEVENTY-TWO

17 The seventy-two^g returned with joy, saying, “Lord, in your name even the demons submit to us!”^{*} **18** He said to them, “I watched Satan fall from heaven like a flash of lightning.”^{*} **19** Indeed, I have given you authority to tread on snakes and scorpions and over all the power of the enemy, and nothing will hurt you.^{*} **20** Nevertheless, do not rejoice at this, that the spirits submit to you, but rejoice that your names are written in heaven.”^{*}

JESUS REJOICES

21 At that very hour Jesus^h rejoiced in the Holy Spiritⁱ and said, “I thank^j you, Father, Lord of heaven and earth, because you have hidden these things from the wise and the intelligent and have revealed them to infants; yes, Father, for such was your gracious will.”^{k,*} **22** All things have been handed over to me by my Father, and no one knows who the Son is except the Father or who the Father is except the Son and anyone to whom the Son chooses to reveal him.”^{*}

23 Then turning to the disciples, Jesus^l said to them privately, “Blessed are the eyes that see what you see!”^{*} **24** For I tell you that many prophets and kings desired to see what you see but did not see it and to hear what you hear but did not hear it.”^{*}

THE PARABLE OF THE GOOD SAMARITAN

25 An expert in the law stood up to test Jesus.^m “Teacher,” he said, “what must I do to inherit eternal life?”^{*} **26** He said to him, “What is written in the law? What do you read there?” **27** He answered, “You shall love the Lord your God with all your heart and with all your soul and with all your strength and with all your mind and your neighbor as yourself.”^{*} **28** And he said to him, “You have given the right answer; do this, and you will live.”^{*}

29 But wanting to vindicate himself, he asked Jesus, “And who is my neighbor?”^{*} **30** Jesus replied, “A man was going down from Jerusalem to Jericho and fell into the hands of robbers, who stripped him, beat him, and took off, leaving him half dead. **31** Now by chance a priest was going down that road, and when he saw him he passed by on the other side. **32** So

likewise a Levite, when he came to the place and saw him, passed by on the other side. ³³But a Samaritan while traveling came upon him, and when he saw him he was moved with compassion.* ³⁴He went to him and bandaged his wounds, treating them with oil and wine. Then he put him on his own animal, brought him to an inn, and took care of him. ³⁵The next day he took out two denarii, gave them to the innkeeper, and said, ‘Take care of him, and when I come back I will repay you whatever more you spend.’ ³⁶Which of these three, do you think, was a neighbor to the man who fell into the hands of the robbers?” ³⁷He said, “The one who showed him mercy.” Jesus said to him, “Go and do likewise.”

JESUS VISITS MARTHA AND MARY

38 Now as they went on their way, he entered a certain village where a woman named Martha welcomed him.^{n,*} ³⁹She had a sister named Mary, who sat at Jesus’s^o feet and listened to what he was saying.* ⁴⁰But Martha was distracted by her many tasks, so she came to him and asked, “Lord, do you not care that my sister has left me to do all the work by myself? Tell her, then, to help me.” ⁴¹But the Lord answered her, “Martha, Martha, you are worried and distracted by many things, ⁴²but few things are needed—indeed only one.^p Mary has chosen the better part, which will not be taken away from her.”*

Luke 11

THE LORD'S PRAYER

1 He was praying in a certain place, and after he had finished, one of his disciples said to him, “Lord, teach us to pray, as John taught his disciples.”*

2 So he said to them, “When you pray, say:

Father,^q may your name be revered as holy.

May your kingdom come.^r

3 Give us each day our daily bread.^s

4 And forgive us our sins,

for we ourselves forgive everyone indebted to us.

And do not bring us to the time of trial.”^{t,*}

PERSEVERANCE IN PRAYER

5 And he said to them, “Suppose one of you has a friend, and you go to him at midnight and say to him, ‘Friend, lend me three loaves of bread, ⁶for a friend of mine has arrived, and I have nothing to set before him.’ ⁷And he answers from within, ‘Do not bother me; the door has already been locked, and my children are with me in bed; I cannot get up and give you anything.’ ⁸I tell you, even though he will not get up and give him anything out of friendship, at least because of his persistence he will get up and give him whatever he needs.*

9 “So I say to you, Ask, and it will be given to you; search, and you will find; knock, and the door will be opened for you.* ¹⁰For everyone who asks receives, and everyone who searches finds, and for everyone who knocks, the door will be opened. ¹¹Is there anyone among you who, if your child asked for^u a fish, would give a snake instead of a fish? ¹²Or if the child asked for an egg, would give a scorpion? ¹³If you, then, who are evil, know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will the heavenly Father give the Holy Spirit^v to those who ask him!”

JESUS AND BEELZEBUL

14 Now he was casting out a demon that was mute; when the demon had gone out, the one who had been mute spoke, and the crowds were amazed.*
¹⁵But some of them said, “He casts out demons by Beelzebul, the ruler of the demons.” ¹⁶Others, to test him, kept demanding from him a sign from heaven.* ¹⁷But he knew what they were thinking and said to them, “Every kingdom divided against itself is laid waste, and a divided household falls.*
¹⁸If Satan also is divided against himself, how will his kingdom stand?—for you say that I cast out the demons by Beelzebul. ¹⁹Now if I cast out the demons by Beelzebul, by whom do your exorcists^w cast them out? Therefore they will be your judges. ²⁰But if it is by the finger of God that I cast out the demons, then the kingdom of God has come upon you.* ²¹When a strong man, fully armed, guards his castle, his property is safe. ²²But when one stronger than he attacks him and overpowers him, he takes away his armor in which he trusted and divides his plunder. ²³Whoever is not with me is against me, and whoever does not gather with me scatters.*

THE RETURN OF THE UNCLEAN SPIRIT

24 “When the unclean spirit has gone out of a person, it wanders through waterless regions looking for a resting place, but not finding any it says, ‘I will return to my house from which I came.’ ²⁵When it returns, it finds it swept and put in order. ²⁶Then it goes and brings seven other spirits more evil than itself, and they enter and live there, and the last state of that person is worse than the first.”*

TRUE BLESSEDNESS

27 While he was saying this, a woman in the crowd raised her voice and said to him, “Blessed is the womb that bore you and the breasts that nursed you!”* ²⁸But he said, “Blessed rather are those who hear the word of God and obey it!”*

THE SIGN OF JONAH

29 When the crowds were increasing, he began to say, “This generation is an evil generation; it asks for a sign, but no sign will be given to it except the sign of Jonah.* ³⁰For just as Jonah became a sign to the people of Nineveh, so the Son of Man will be to this generation. ³¹The queen of the South will rise at the judgment with the people of this generation and condemn them, because she came from the ends of the earth to listen to the wisdom of Solomon, and indeed, something greater than Solomon is here!.* ³²The people of Nineveh will rise up at the judgment with this generation and condemn it, because they repented at the proclamation of Jonah, and indeed, something greater than Jonah is here!.*

THE LIGHT OF THE BODY

33 “No one after lighting a lamp puts it in a cellar or under a bushel basket;^x rather, one puts it on the lampstand so that those who enter may see the light.* ³⁴Your eye is the lamp of your body. If your eye is healthy, your whole body is full of light, but if it is unhealthy, your body is full of darkness.* ³⁵Therefore consider whether the light in you is not darkness. ³⁶But if your whole body is full of light, with no part of it in darkness, it will be as full of light as when a lamp gives you light with its rays.”

JESUS DENOUNCES PHARISEES AND EXPERTS IN THE LAW

37 While he was speaking, a Pharisee invited him to dine with him, so he went in and took his place at the table.* ³⁸The Pharisee was amazed to see that he did not first wash before dinner.* ³⁹Then the Lord said to him, “Now you Pharisees clean the outside of the cup and of the dish, but inside you are full of greed and wickedness.* ⁴⁰You fools! Did not the one who made the outside make the inside also? ⁴¹So give as alms those things that are within and then everything will be clean for you.*

42 “But woe to you Pharisees! For you tithe mint and rue and herbs of all kinds and neglect justice and the love of God; it is these you ought to have practiced, without neglecting the others.* ⁴³Woe to you Pharisees! For you love to have the seat of honor in the synagogues and to be greeted with respect in the marketplaces.* ⁴⁴Woe to you! For you are like unmarked graves on which people unknowingly walk.”*

45 One of the experts in the law answered him, “Teacher, when you say these things, you insult us, too.” ⁴⁶And he said, “Woe also to you experts in the law! For you load people with burdens hard to bear, and you yourselves do not lift a finger to ease them.” ⁴⁷Woe to you! For you build the tombs of the prophets whom your ancestors killed.” ⁴⁸So you are witnesses and approve of the deeds of your ancestors, for they killed them, and you build their tombs. ⁴⁹For this reason the Wisdom of God said, ‘I will send them prophets and apostles, some of whom they will kill and persecute,’ ⁵⁰so that this generation may be charged with the blood of all the prophets shed since the foundation of the world, ⁵¹from the blood of Abel to the blood of Zechariah, who perished between the altar and the sanctuary. Yes, I tell you, it will be charged against this generation.” ⁵²Woe to you experts in the law! For you have taken away the key of knowledge; you did not enter yourselves, and you hindered those who were entering.”*

53 When he went outside, the scribes and the Pharisees became hostile to him and began to interrogate him about many things, ⁵⁴lying in wait for him, to catch him in something he might say.*

Luke 12

A WARNING AGAINST HYPOCRISY

1 Meanwhile, when the crowd had gathered by the thousands, so that they trampled on one another, he began to speak first to his disciples, “Beware of the yeast of the Pharisees, that is, their hypocrisy.* **2** Nothing is covered up that will not be uncovered and nothing secret that will not become known.* **3** Therefore whatever you have said in the dark will be heard in the light, and what you have whispered behind closed doors will be proclaimed from the housetops.

EXHORTATION TO FEARLESS CONFESSION

4 “I tell you, my friends, do not fear those who kill the body and after that can do nothing more.* **5** But I will show you whom to fear: fear the one who, after killing, has authority^y to cast into hell.^z Yes, I tell you, fear that one!* **6** Are not five sparrows sold for two pennies? Yet not one of them is forgotten in God’s sight. **7** But even the hairs of your head are all numbered. Do not be afraid; you are of more value than many sparrows.*

8 “And I tell you, everyone who acknowledges me before others, the Son of Man also will acknowledge before the angels of God,* **9** but whoever denies me before others will be denied before the angels of God. **10** And everyone who speaks a word against the Son of Man will be forgiven, but whoever blasphemes against the Holy Spirit will not be forgiven.* **11** When they bring you before the synagogues, the rulers, and the authorities, do not worry about how or what^a you will answer or what you are to say,* **12** for the Holy Spirit will teach you at that very hour what you ought to say.”

THE PARABLE OF THE RICH FOOL

13 Someone in the crowd said to him, “Teacher, tell my brother to divide the family inheritance with me.” **14** But he said to him, “Friend, who set me to be a judge or arbitrator over you?”* **15** And he said to them, “Take care! Be on your guard against all kinds of greed, for one’s life does not consist

in the abundance of possessions.”* ¹⁶Then he told them a parable: “The land of a rich man produced abundantly. ¹⁷And he thought to himself, ‘What should I do, for I have no place to store my crops?’ ¹⁸Then he said, ‘I will do this: I will pull down my barns and build larger ones, and there I will store all my grain and my goods. ¹⁹And I will say to my soul, Soul, you have ample goods laid up for many years; relax, eat, drink, be merry.’* ²⁰But God said to him, ‘You fool! This very night your life is being demanded of you. And the things you have prepared, whose will they be?’* ²¹So it is with those who store up treasures for themselves but are not rich toward God.”*

DO NOT WORRY

22 He said to his disciples, “Therefore I tell you, do not worry about your life, what you will eat, or about your body, what you will wear. ²³For life is more than food and the body more than clothing. ²⁴Consider the ravens: they neither sow nor reap, they have neither storehouse nor barn, and yet God feeds them. Of how much more value are you than the birds!”* ²⁵And which of you by worrying can add a single hour to your span of life?^{b,*} ²⁶If then you are not able to do so small a thing as that, why do you worry about the rest? ²⁷Consider the lilies, how they grow: they neither toil nor spin,^c yet I tell you, even Solomon in all his glory was not clothed like one of these.* ²⁸But if God so clothes the grass of the field, which is alive today and tomorrow is thrown into the oven, how much more will he clothe you, you of little faith! ²⁹And do not keep seeking what you are to eat and what you are to drink, and do not keep worrying. ³⁰For it is the nations^d of the world that seek all these things, and your Father knows that you need them.* ³¹Instead, seek his^e kingdom, and these things will be given to you as well.

32 “Do not be afraid, little flock, for it is your Father’s good pleasure to give you the kingdom.* ³³Sell your possessions and give alms. Make purses for yourselves that do not wear out, an unfailing treasure in heaven, where no thief comes near and no moth destroys.* ³⁴For where your treasure is, there your heart will be also.*

WATCHFUL SLAVES

35 “Be dressed for action and have your lamps lit; ^{*} ³⁶be like those who are waiting for their master to return from the wedding banquet, so that they may open the door for him as soon as he comes and knocks. ³⁷Blessed are those slaves whom the master finds alert when he comes; truly I tell you, he will fasten his belt and have them sit down to eat, and he will come and serve them. ^{*} ³⁸If he comes during the middle of the night or near dawn and finds them so, blessed are those slaves.

39 “But know this: if the owner of the house had known at what hour the thief was coming, he^f would not have let his house be broken into. ^{*} ⁴⁰You also must be ready, for the Son of Man is coming at an hour you do not expect.”^{*}

THE FAITHFUL OR THE UNFAITHFUL SLAVE

41 Peter said, “Lord, are you telling this parable for us or for everyone?” ⁴²And the Lord said, “Who, then, is the faithful and prudent manager whom his master will put in charge of his slaves, to give them their allowance of food at the proper time? ^{*} ⁴³Blessed is that slave whom his master will find at work when he arrives. ⁴⁴Truly I tell you, he will put that one in charge of all his possessions. ⁴⁵But if that slave says to himself, ‘My master is delayed in coming,’ and begins to beat the other slaves, men and women, and to eat and drink and get drunk, ⁴⁶the master of that slave will come on a day when he does not expect him and at an hour that he does not know and will cut him in pieces^g and put him with the unfaithful. ⁴⁷That slave who knew what his master wanted but did not prepare himself or do what was wanted will receive a severe beating. ^{*} ⁴⁸But the one who did not know and did what deserved a beating will receive a light beating. From everyone to whom much has been given, much will be required, and from the one to whom much has been entrusted, even more will be demanded.”^{*}

JESUS THE CAUSE OF DIVISION

49 “I have come to cast fire upon the earth, and how I wish it were already ablaze! ⁵⁰I have a baptism with which to be baptized, and what constraint I am under until it is completed! ^{*} ⁵¹Do you think that I have

come to bring peace to the earth? No, I tell you, but rather division!*

⁵²From now on five in one household will be divided, three against two and two against three; ⁵³they will be divided:

father against son

and son against father,

mother against daughter

and daughter against mother,

mother-in-law against her daughter-in-law

and daughter-in-law against mother-in-law.”*

INTERPRETING THE TIME

54 He also said to the crowds, “When you see a cloud rising in the west, you immediately say, ‘It is going to rain,’ and so it happens.* ⁵⁵And when you see the south wind blowing, you say, ‘There will be scorching heat,’ and it happens.* ⁵⁶You hypocrites! You know how to interpret the appearance of earth and sky, but why do you not know how to interpret the present time?*

SETTLING WITH YOUR OPPONENT

57 “And why do you not judge for yourselves what is right? ⁵⁸Thus when you go with your accuser before a magistrate, on the way make an effort to reach a settlement,^h or you may be dragged before the judge, and the judge hand you over to the officer, and the officer throw you in prison.* ⁵⁹I tell you, you will never get out until you have paid the very last penny.”*

Luke 13

REPENT OR PERISH

1 At that very time there were some present who told Jesusⁱ about the Galileans whose blood Pilate had mingled with their sacrifices.* **2**He asked them, “Do you think that because these Galileans suffered in this way they were worse sinners than all other Galileans?”* **3**No, I tell you, but unless you repent you will all perish as they did. **4**Or those eighteen who were killed when the tower of Siloam fell on them—do you think that they were worse offenders than all the other people living in Jerusalem?* **5**No, I tell you, but unless you repent you will all perish just as they did.”

THE PARABLE OF THE BARREN FIG TREE

6 Then he told this parable: “A man had a fig tree planted in his vineyard, and he came looking for fruit on it and found none.* **7**So he said to the man working the vineyard, ‘See here! For three years I have come looking for fruit on this fig tree, and still I find none. Cut it down! Why should it be wasting the soil?’* **8**He replied, ‘Sir, let it alone for one more year, until I dig around it and put manure on it. **9**If it bears fruit next year, well and good, but if not, you can cut it down.’ ”

JESUS HEALS A CRIPPLED WOMAN

10 Now he was teaching in one of the synagogues on the Sabbath. **11**And just then there appeared a woman with a spirit that had crippled her for eighteen years. She was bent over and was quite unable to stand up straight. **12**When Jesus saw her, he called her over and said, “Woman, you are set free from your ailment.” **13**When he laid his hands on her, immediately she stood up straight and began praising God.* **14**But the leader of the synagogue, indignant because Jesus had cured on the Sabbath, kept saying to the crowd, “There are six days on which work ought to be done; come on those days and be cured and not on the Sabbath day.”* **15**But the Lord answered him and said, “You hypocrites! Does not each of you on the

Sabbath untie his ox or his donkey from the manger and lead it to water?*

¹⁶And ought not this woman, a daughter of Abraham whom Satan bound for eighteen long years, be set free from this bondage on the Sabbath day?">*

¹⁷When he said this, all his opponents were put to shame, and the entire crowd was rejoicing at all the wonderful things being done by him.

THE PARABLE OF THE MUSTARD SEED

18 He said therefore, “What is the kingdom of God like? And to what should I compare it? ¹⁹It is like a mustard seed that someone took and sowed in the garden; it grew and became a tree, and the birds of the air made nests in its branches.”

THE PARABLE OF THE YEAST

20 And again he said, “To what should I compare the kingdom of God? ²¹It is like yeast that a woman took and mixed in with three measures of flour until all of it was leavened.”

THE NARROW DOOR

22 Jesus^j went through one town and village after another, teaching as he made his way to Jerusalem.* ²³Someone asked him, “Lord, will only a few be saved?” He said to them, ²⁴“Strive to enter through the narrow door, for many, I tell you, will try to enter and will not be able.* ²⁵Once the owner of the house has got up and shut the door, and you begin to stand outside and to knock at the door, saying, ‘Lord, open to us,’ then in reply he will say to you, ‘I do not know where you come from.’* ²⁶Then you will begin to say, ‘We ate and drank with you, and you taught in our streets.’ ²⁷But he will say to you, ‘I do not know where you come from; go away from me, all you evildoers!’* ²⁸There will be weeping and gnashing of teeth when you see Abraham and Isaac and Jacob and all the prophets in the kingdom of God, and you yourselves thrown out.* ²⁹Then people will come from east and west, from north and south, and take their places at the banquet in the kingdom of God. ³⁰Indeed, some are last who will be first, and some are first who will be last.”*

THE LAMENT OVER JERUSALEM

31 At that very hour some Pharisees came and said to him, “Get away from here, for Herod wants to kill you.” ³²He said to them, “Go and tell that fox for me,^k ‘Listen, I am casting out demons and performing cures today and tomorrow, and on the third day I finish my work.’^{*} ³³Yet today, tomorrow, and the next day I must be on my way, because it is impossible for a prophet to be killed outside of Jerusalem.’ ³⁴Jerusalem, Jerusalem, the city that kills the prophets and stones those who are sent to it! How often have I desired to gather your children together as a hen gathers her brood under her wings, and you were not willing!^{*} ³⁵See, your house is left to you.^l And I tell you, you will not see me until the time comes when^m you say, ‘Blessed is the one who comes in the name of the Lord.’ ”^{*}

Luke 14

JESUS HEALS THE MAN WITH EDEMA

1 On one occasion when Jesusⁿ was going to the house of a leader of the Pharisees to eat a meal on the Sabbath, they were watching him closely.*
2 Just then, in front of him, there was a man who had edema. **3** And Jesus asked the experts in the law and Pharisees, “Is it lawful to cure people on the Sabbath or not?”* **4** But they were silent. So Jesus^o took him and healed him and sent him away. **5** Then he said to them, “If one of you has a child^p or an ox that has fallen into a well, will you not immediately pull it out on a Sabbath day?”* **6** And they could not reply to this.

HUMILITY AND HOSPITALITY

7 When he noticed how the guests chose the places of honor, he told them a parable.* **8** “When you are invited by someone to a wedding banquet, do not sit down at the place of honor, in case someone more distinguished than you has been invited by your host,* **9** and the host who invited both of you may come and say to you, ‘Give this person your place,’ and then in disgrace you would start to take the lowest place. **10** But when you are invited, go and sit down at the lowest place, so that when your host comes, he may say to you, ‘Friend, move up higher’; then you will be honored in the presence of all who sit at the table with you.* **11** For all who exalt themselves will be humbled, and those who humble themselves will be exalted.”*

12 He said also to the one who had invited him, “When you give a luncheon or a dinner, do not invite your friends or your brothers and sisters or your relatives or rich neighbors, in case they may invite you in return, and you would be repaid. **13** But when you give a banquet, invite the poor, the crippled, the lame, and the blind.* **14** And you will be blessed because they cannot repay you, for you will be repaid at the resurrection of the righteous.”

THE PARABLE OF THE GREAT DINNER

15 One of the dinner guests, on hearing this, said to him, “Blessed is anyone who will eat bread in the kingdom of God!”^{*} **16** Then Jesus⁹ said to him, “Someone gave a great dinner and invited many. **17** At the time for the dinner he sent his slave to say to those who had been invited, ‘Come, for everything is ready now.’^{*} **18** But they all alike began to make excuses. The first said to him, ‘I have bought a piece of land, and I must go out and see it; please accept my regrets.’ **19** Another said, ‘I have bought five yoke of oxen, and I am going to try them out; please accept my regrets.’ **20** Another said, ‘I have just been married, and therefore I cannot come.’^{*} **21** So the slave returned and reported this to his master. Then the owner of the house became angry and said to his slave, ‘Go out at once into the streets and lanes of the town and bring in the poor, the crippled, the blind, and the lame.’^{*} **22** And the slave said, ‘Sir, what you ordered has been done, and there is still room.’ **23** Then the master said to the slave, ‘Go out into the roads and lanes, and compel people to come in, so that my house may be filled. **24** For I tell you,^r none of those who were invited will taste my dinner.’ ”^{*}

THE COST OF DISCIPLESHIP

25 Now large crowds were traveling with him, and he turned and said to them, **26** “Whoever comes to me and does not hate father and mother, wife and children, brothers and sisters, yes, and even life itself, cannot be my disciple.^{*} **27** Whoever does not carry the cross and follow me cannot be my disciple.^{*} **28** For which of you, intending to build a tower, does not first sit down and estimate the cost, to see whether he has enough to complete it? **29** Otherwise, when he has laid a foundation and is not able to finish, all who see it will begin to ridicule him, **30** saying, ‘This fellow began to build and was not able to finish.’ **31** Or what king, going out to wage war against another king, will not sit down first and consider whether he is able with ten thousand to oppose the one who comes against him with twenty thousand? **32** If he cannot, then while the other is still far away, he sends a delegation and asks for the terms of peace. **33** So therefore, none of you can become my disciple if you do not give up all your possessions.^{*}

ABOUT SALT

34 “Salt is good, but if salt has lost its taste, how can its saltiness be restored?^{s,*} **35** It is useful neither for the soil nor for the manure pile; they throw it away. If you have ears to hear, then hear!”^{*}

Luke 15

THE PARABLE OF THE LOST SHEEP

1 Now all the tax collectors and sinners were coming near to listen to him.*
2 And the Pharisees and the scribes were grumbling and saying, “This fellow welcomes sinners and eats with them.”*

3 So he told them this parable: ⁴“Which one of you, having a hundred sheep and losing one of them, does not leave the ninety-nine in the wilderness and go after the one that is lost until he finds it? ⁵And when he has found it, he lays it on his shoulders and rejoices. ⁶And when he comes home, he calls together his friends and neighbors, saying to them, ‘Rejoice with me, for I have found my lost sheep.’ ⁷Just so, I tell you, there will be more joy in heaven over one sinner who repents than over ninety-nine righteous persons who need no repentance.*

THE PARABLE OF THE LOST COIN

8 “Or what woman having ten silver coins, if she loses one of them, does not light a lamp, sweep the house, and search carefully until she finds it? ⁹And when she has found it, she calls together her friends and neighbors, saying, ‘Rejoice with me, for I have found the coin that I had lost.’ ¹⁰Just so, I tell you, there is joy in the presence of the angels of God over one sinner who repents.”*

THE PARABLE OF THE PRODIGAL AND HIS BROTHER

11 Then Jesus^t said, “There was a man who had two sons.* ¹²The younger of them said to his father, ‘Father, give me the share of the wealth that will belong to me.’ So he divided his assets between them.* ¹³A few days later the younger son gathered all he had and traveled to a distant region, and there he squandered his wealth in dissolute living. ¹⁴When he had spent everything, a severe famine took place throughout that region, and he began to be in need. ¹⁵So he went and hired himself out to one of the citizens of that region, who sent him to his fields to feed the pigs. ¹⁶He

would gladly have filled his stomach^u with the pods that the pigs were eating, and no one gave him anything. ¹⁷But when he came to his senses he said, ‘How many of my father’s hired hands have bread enough and to spare, but here I am dying of hunger! ¹⁸I will get up and go to my father, and I will say to him, “Father, I have sinned against heaven and before you; ¹⁹I am no longer worthy to be called your son; treat me like one of your hired hands.” ’ ²⁰So he set off and went to his father. But while he was still far off, his father saw him and was filled with compassion; he ran and put his arms around him and kissed him. ²¹Then the son said to him, ‘Father, I have sinned against heaven and before you; I am no longer worthy to be called your son.’^{v,*} ²²But the father said to his slaves, ‘Quickly, bring out a robe—the best one—and put it on him; put a ring on his finger and sandals on his feet.’ ²³And get the fatted calf and kill it, and let us eat and celebrate, ²⁴for this son of mine was dead and is alive again; he was lost and is found!’ And they began to celebrate.*

25 “Now his elder son was in the field, and as he came and approached the house, he heard music and dancing. ²⁶He called one of the slaves and asked what was going on. ²⁷He replied, ‘Your brother has come, and your father has killed the fatted calf because he has got him back safe and sound.’ ²⁸Then he became angry and refused to go in. His father came out and began to plead with him. ²⁹But he answered his father, ‘Listen! For all these years I have been working like a slave for you, and I have never disobeyed your command, yet you have never given me even a young goat so that I might celebrate with my friends. ³⁰But when this son of yours came back, who has devoured your assets with prostitutes, you killed the fatted calf for him!’^{*} ³¹Then the father^w said to him, ‘Son, you are always with me, and all that is mine is yours. ³²But we had to celebrate and rejoice, because this brother of yours was dead and has come to life; he was lost and has been found.’ ”*

Luke 16

THE PARABLE OF THE DISHONEST MANAGER

1 Then Jesus^x said to the disciples, “There was a rich man who had a manager, and charges were brought to him that this man was squandering his property.* **2** So he summoned him and said to him, ‘What is this that I hear about you? Give me an accounting of your management because you cannot be my manager any longer.’ **3** Then the manager said to himself, ‘What will I do, now that my master is taking the position away from me? I am not strong enough to dig, and I am ashamed to beg. **4** I have decided what to do so that, when I am dismissed as manager, people may welcome me into their homes.’ **5** So, summoning his master’s debtors one by one, he asked the first, ‘How much do you owe my master?’ **6** He answered, ‘A hundred jugs of olive oil.’ He said to him, ‘Take your bill, sit down quickly, and make it fifty.’ **7** Then he asked another, ‘And how much do you owe?’ He replied, ‘A hundred containers of wheat.’ He said to him, ‘Take your bill and make it eighty.’ **8** And his master commended the dishonest manager because he had acted shrewdly, for the children of this age are more shrewd in dealing with their own generation than are the children of light.* **9** And I tell you, make friends for yourselves by means of dishonest wealth^y so that when it is gone they may welcome you into the eternal homes.^{z,*}

10 “Whoever is faithful in a very little is faithful also in much, and whoever is dishonest in a very little is dishonest also in much.* **11** If, then, you have not been faithful with the dishonest wealth,^a who will entrust to you the true riches?* **12** And if you have not been faithful with what belongs to another, who will give you what is your own? **13** No slave can serve two masters, for a slave will either hate the one and love the other or be devoted to the one and despise the other. You cannot serve God and wealth.”^{b,*}

THE LAW AND THE KINGDOM OF GOD

14 The Pharisees, who were lovers of money, heard all this, and they ridiculed him.* **15** So he said to them, “You are those who justify yourselves

in the sight of others, but God knows your hearts, for what is prized by humans is an abomination in the sight of God.*

16 “The Law and the Prophets were until John came; since then the good news of the kingdom of God is being proclaimed, and everyone tries to enter it by force.^{c,*} ¹⁷But it is easier for heaven and earth to pass away than for one stroke of a letter in the law to be dropped.*

18 “Anyone who divorces his wife and marries another commits adultery, and whoever marries a woman divorced from her husband commits adultery.*

THE RICH MAN AND LAZARUS

19 “There was a rich man who was dressed in purple and fine linen and who feasted sumptuously every day. ²⁰And at his gate lay a poor man named Lazarus, covered with sores,* ²¹who longed to satisfy his hunger with what fell from the rich man’s table; even the dogs would come and lick his sores. ²²The poor man died and was carried away by the angels to be with Abraham.^d The rich man also died and was buried.* ²³In Hades, where he was being tormented, he lifted up his eyes and saw Abraham far away with Lazarus by his side.^{e,*} ²⁴He called out, ‘Father Abraham, have mercy on me, and send Lazarus to dip the tip of his finger in water and cool my tongue, for I am in agony in these flames.’* ²⁵But Abraham said, ‘Child, remember that during your lifetime you received your good things and Lazarus in like manner evil things, but now he is comforted here, and you are in agony.* ²⁶Besides all this, between you and us a great chasm has been fixed, so that those who might want to pass from here to you cannot do so, and no one can cross from there to us.’ ²⁷He said, ‘Then I beg you, father, to send him to my father’s house—²⁸for I have five brothers—that he may warn them, so that they will not also come into this place of torment.’ ²⁹Abraham replied, ‘They have Moses and the prophets; they should listen to them.’* ³⁰He said, ‘No, father Abraham, but if someone from the dead goes to them, they will repent.’* ³¹He said to him, ‘If they do not listen to Moses and the prophets, neither will they be convinced even if someone rises from the dead.’ ”

Luke 17

SOME SAYINGS OF JESUS

1 Jesus^f said to his disciples, “Occasions for sin^g are bound to come, but woe to anyone through whom they come!”^{*} **2**It would be better for you if a millstone were hung around your neck and you were thrown into the sea than for you to cause one of these little ones to sin.^{h,*} **3**Be on your guard! If a brother or sister sins, you must rebuke the offender, and if there is repentance, you must forgive.^{*} **4**And if the same person sins against you seven times a day and turns back to you seven times and says, ‘I repent,’ you must forgive.”^{*}

5 The apostles said to the Lord, “Increase our faith!”^{*} **6**The Lord replied, “If you had faith the size of aⁱ mustard seed, you could say to this mulberry tree, ‘Be uprooted and planted in the sea,’ and it would obey you.”^{*}

7 “Who among you would say to your slave who has just come in from plowing or tending sheep in the field, ‘Come here at once and take your place at the table’? **8**Would you not rather say to him, ‘Prepare supper for me; put on your apron and serve me while I eat and drink; later you may eat and drink’?”^{*} **9**Do you thank the slave for doing what was commanded? **10**So you also, when you have done all that you were ordered to do, say, ‘We are worthless slaves; we have done only what we ought to have done!’ ”

JESUS CLEANSSES TEN MEN WITH A SKIN DISEASE

11 On the way to Jerusalem Jesus^j was going through the region between Samaria and Galilee.^{*} **12**As he entered a village, ten men with a skin disease approached him. Keeping their distance,^{*} **13**they called out, saying, “Jesus, Master, have mercy on us!” **14**When he saw them, he said to them, “Go and show yourselves to the priests.” And as they went, they were made clean.^{*} **15**Then one of them, when he saw that he was healed, turned back, praising God with a loud voice.^{*} **16**He prostrated himself at Jesus’s^k feet and thanked him. And he was a Samaritan.^{*} **17**Then Jesus asked, “Were not ten made clean? So where are the other nine?” **18**Did none of them return to give glory

to God except this foreigner?” ¹⁹Then he said to him, “Get up and go on your way; your faith has made you well.”*

THE COMING OF THE KINGDOM

20 Once Jesus^l was asked by the Pharisees when the kingdom of God was coming, and he answered, “The kingdom of God is not coming with things that can be observed, ²¹nor will they say, ‘Look, here it is!’ or ‘There it is!’ For, in fact, the kingdom of God is among^m you.”*

22 Then he said to the disciples, “The days are coming when you will long to see one of the days of the Son of Man, and you will not see it.* ²³They will say to you, ‘Look there!’ or ‘Look here!’ Do not go; do not set off in pursuit.* ²⁴For as the lightning flashes and lights up the sky from one side to the other, so will the Son of Man be in his day.^{n,*} ²⁵But first he must endure much suffering and be rejected by this generation.* ²⁶Just as it was in the days of Noah, so, too, it will be in the days of the Son of Man.* ²⁷They were eating and drinking and marrying and being given in marriage until the day Noah entered the ark, and the flood came and destroyed all of them. ²⁸Likewise, just as it was in the days of Lot, they were eating and drinking, buying and selling, planting and building,* ²⁹but on the day that Lot left Sodom it rained fire and sulfur from heaven and destroyed all of them; ³⁰it will be like that on the day that the Son of Man is revealed. ³¹On that day, anyone on the housetop who has belongings in the house must not come down to take them away, and likewise anyone in the field must not turn back. ³²Remember Lot’s wife. ³³Those who try to make their life secure will lose it, but those who lose their life will keep it. ³⁴I tell you, on that night there will be two in one bed; one will be taken and the other left. ³⁵There will be two women grinding meal together; one will be taken and the other left.”^o ³⁷Then they asked him, “Where, Lord?” He said to them, “Where the corpse is, there the eagles will gather.”

Luke 18

THE PARABLE OF THE WIDOW AND THE UNJUST JUDGE

1 Then Jesus^P told them a parable about their need to pray always and not to lose heart. ²He said, “In a certain city there was a judge who neither feared God nor had respect for people. ³In that city there was a widow who kept coming to him and saying, ‘Grant me justice against my accuser.’ ⁴For a while he refused, but later he said to himself, ‘Though I have no fear of God and no respect for anyone, ⁵yet because this widow keeps bothering me, I will grant her justice, so that she may not wear me out by continually coming.’”^Q ⁶And the Lord said, “Listen to what the unjust judge says. ⁷And will not God grant justice to his chosen ones who cry to him day and night? Will he delay long in helping them? ⁸I tell you, he will quickly grant justice to them. And yet, when the Son of Man comes, will he find faith on earth?”

THE PARABLE OF THE PHARISEE AND THE TAX COLLECTOR

9 He also told this parable to some who trusted in themselves that they were righteous and regarded others with contempt: ¹⁰“Two men went up to the temple to pray, one a Pharisee and the other a tax collector. ¹¹The Pharisee, standing by himself, was praying thus, ‘God, I thank you that I am not like other people: thieves, rogues, adulterers, or even like this tax collector. ¹²I fast twice a week; I give a tenth of all my income.’”^{*} ¹³But the tax collector, standing far off, would not even lift up his eyes to heaven but was beating his breast and saying, ‘God, be merciful to me, a sinner!’^{*} ¹⁴I tell you, this man went down to his home justified rather than the other, for all who exalt themselves will be humbled, but all who humble themselves will be exalted.”^{*}

JESUS BLESSES LITTLE CHILDREN

15 People were bringing even infants to him that he might touch them, and when the disciples saw it, they sternly ordered them not to do it. ¹⁶But Jesus called for them and said, “Let the children come to me, and do not

stop them, for it is to such as these that the kingdom of God belongs.
¹⁷Truly I tell you, whoever does not receive the kingdom of God as a little child will never enter it.”*

THE RICH RULER

18 A certain ruler asked him, “Good Teacher, what must I do to inherit eternal life?”* ¹⁹Jesus said to him, “Why do you call me good? No one is good but God alone. ²⁰You know the commandments: ‘You shall not commit adultery. You shall not murder. You shall not steal. You shall not bear false witness. Honor your father and mother.’ ”* ²¹He replied, “I have kept all these since my youth.” ²²When Jesus heard this, he said to him, “There is still one thing lacking. Sell all that you own and distribute the money^r to the poor, and you will have treasure in heaven; then come, follow me.”* ²³But when he heard this, he became sad, for he was very rich. ²⁴Jesus looked at him^s and said, “How hard it is for those who have wealth to enter the kingdom of God!”* ²⁵Indeed, it is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle than for someone who is rich to enter the kingdom of God.”

26 Those who heard it said, “Then who can be saved?” ²⁷He replied, “What is impossible for mortals is possible for God.”*

28 Then Peter said, “Look, we have left our homes and followed you.”* ²⁹And he said to them, “Truly I tell you, there is no one who has left house or wife or brothers or parents or children for the sake of the kingdom of God ³⁰who will not get back very much more in this age and in the age to come eternal life.”*

A THIRD TIME JESUS FORETELLS HIS DEATH AND RESURRECTION

31 Then he took the twelve aside and said to them, “Look, we are going up to Jerusalem, and everything that is written about the Son of Man by the prophets will be accomplished.* ³²For he will be handed over to the gentiles, and he will be mocked and insulted and spat upon.* ³³After they have flogged him, they will kill him, and on the third day he will rise

again.”³⁴ But they understood nothing about all these things; in fact, what he said was hidden from them, and they did not grasp what was said.*

JESUS HEALS A BLIND BEGGAR NEAR JERICHO

35 As he approached Jericho, a blind man was sitting by the roadside begging.³⁶ When he heard a crowd going by, he asked what was happening.³⁷ They told him, “Jesus of Nazareth^t is passing by.”³⁸ Then he shouted, “Jesus, Son of David, have mercy on me!”*³⁹ Those who were in front sternly ordered him to be quiet, but he shouted even more loudly, “Son of David, have mercy on me!”*⁴⁰ Jesus stood still and ordered the man to be brought to him, and when he came near, he asked him,⁴¹ “What do you want me to do for you?” He said, “Lord, let me see again.”⁴² Jesus said to him, “Receive your sight; your faith has saved you.”*⁴³ Immediately he regained his sight and followed him, glorifying God, and all the people, when they saw it, praised God.*

Luke 19

JESUS AND ZACCHAEUS

1 He entered Jericho and was passing through it.* **2**A man was there named Zacchaeus; he was a chief tax collector and was rich. **3**He was trying to see who Jesus was, but on account of the crowd he could not, because he was short in stature. **4**So he ran ahead and climbed a sycamore tree to see him, because he was going to pass that way.* **5**When Jesus came to the place, he looked up and said to him, “Zacchaeus, hurry and come down, for I must stay at your house today.” **6**So he hurried down and was happy to welcome him. **7**All who saw it began to grumble and said, “He has gone to be the guest of one who is a sinner.”* **8**Zacchaeus stood there and said to the Lord, “Look, half of my possessions, Lord, I will give to the poor, and if I have defrauded anyone of anything, I will pay back four times as much.”* **9**Then Jesus said to him, “Today salvation has come to this house, because he, too, is a son of Abraham.* **10**For the Son of Man came to seek out and to save the lost.”

THE PARABLE OF THE TEN POUNDS

11 As they were listening to this, he went on to tell a parable, because he was near Jerusalem and because they supposed that the kingdom of God was to appear immediately.* **12**So he said, “A nobleman went to a distant region to receive royal power for himself and then return.* **13**He summoned ten of his slaves and gave them ten pounds and said to them, ‘Do business with these until I come back.’ **14**But the citizens of his country hated him and sent a delegation after him, saying, ‘We do not want this man to rule over us.’ **15**When he returned, having received royal power, he ordered these slaves to whom he had given the money to be summoned so that he might find out what they had gained by doing business. **16**The first came forward and said, ‘Lord, your pound has made ten more pounds.’ **17**He said to him, ‘Well done, good slave! Because you have been trustworthy in a very small thing, take charge of ten cities.’* **18**Then the second came, saying, ‘Lord, your pound has made five pounds.’ **19**He said to him, ‘And

you, rule over five cities.’ ²⁰Then the other came, saying, ‘Lord, here is your pound. I wrapped it up in a piece of cloth, ²¹for I was afraid of you, because you are a harsh man; you take what you did not deposit and reap what you did not sow.’^{*} ²²He said to him, ‘I will judge you by your own words, you wicked slave! You knew, did you, that I was a harsh man, taking what I did not deposit and reaping what I did not sow?’^{*} ²³Why, then, did you not put my money into the bank? Then when I returned, I could have collected it with interest.’ ²⁴He said to the bystanders, ‘Take the pound from him and give it to the one who has ten pounds.’ ²⁵(And they said to him, ‘Lord, he has ten pounds!’) ²⁶‘I tell you, to all those who have, more will be given, but from those who have nothing, even what they have will be taken away.’^{*} ²⁷But as for these enemies of mine who did not want me to rule over them—bring them here and slaughter them in my presence.’ ”

JESUS’S TRIUMPHAL ENTRY INTO JERUSALEM

28 After he had said this, he went on ahead, going up to Jerusalem.^{*}

29 When he had come near Bethphage and Bethany, at the place called the Mount of Olives, he sent two of the disciples, ³⁰saying, “Go into the village ahead of you, and as you enter it you will find tied there a colt that has never been ridden. Untie it and bring it here. ³¹If anyone asks you, ‘Why are you untying it?’ just say this, ‘The Lord needs it.’ ” ³²So those who were sent departed and found it as he had told them.^{*} ³³As they were untying the colt, its owners asked them, “Why are you untying the colt?” ³⁴They said, “The Lord needs it.” ³⁵Then they brought it to Jesus, and after throwing their cloaks on the colt, they set Jesus on it. ³⁶As he rode along, people kept spreading their cloaks on the road.^{*} ³⁷Now as he was approaching the path down from the Mount of Olives, the whole multitude of the disciples began to praise God joyfully with a loud voice for all the deeds of power that they had seen, ³⁸saying,

“Blessed is the king
who comes in the name of the Lord!
Peace in heaven,
and glory in the highest heaven!”^{*}

³⁹Some of the Pharisees in the crowd said to him, “Teacher, order your disciples to stop.”^{*} ⁴⁰He answered, “I tell you, if these were silent, the stones would shout out.”^{*}

JESUS WEEPS OVER JERUSALEM

41 As he came near and saw the city, he wept over it, ^{*} ⁴²saying, “If you, even you, had only recognized on this day the things that make for peace! But now they are hidden from your eyes. ⁴³Indeed, the days will come upon you when your enemies will set up ramparts around you and surround you and hem you in on every side. ^{*} ⁴⁴They will crush you to the ground, you and your children within you, and they will not leave within you one stone upon another, because you did not recognize the time of your visitation from God.”^{u,*}

JESUS CLEANSSES THE TEMPLE

45 Then he entered the temple and began to drive out those who were selling things^v there, ⁴⁶and he said, “It is written,

‘My house shall be a house of prayer,’

but you have made it a den of robbers.”^{*}

47 Every day he was teaching in the temple. The chief priests, the scribes, and the leaders of the people kept looking for a way to kill him,^{*} ⁴⁸but they did not find anything they could do, for all the people were spellbound by what they heard.

Luke 20

THE AUTHORITY OF JESUS QUESTIONED

1 One day as he was teaching the people in the temple and proclaiming the good news, the chief priests and the scribes came with the elders^{*} **2** and said to him, “Tell us, by what authority are you doing these things? Who is it who gave you this authority?”^{*} **3** He answered them, “I will also ask you a question, and you tell me: **4** Did the baptism of John come from heaven, or was it of human origin?” **5** They discussed it with one another, saying, “If we say, ‘From heaven,’ he will say, ‘Why did you not believe him?’ **6** But if we say, ‘Of human origin,’ all the people will stone us, for they are convinced that John was a prophet.”^{*} **7** So they answered that they did not know where it came from. **8** Then Jesus said to them, “Neither will I tell you by what authority I am doing these things.”

THE PARABLE OF THE WICKED TENANTS

9 He began to tell the people this parable: “A man planted a vineyard and leased it to tenants and went away for a long time.^{*} **10** When the season came, he sent a slave to the tenants in order that they might give him his share of the produce of the vineyard, but the tenants beat him and sent him away empty-handed. **11** Next he sent another slave; that one also they beat and insulted and sent away empty-handed. **12** And he sent still a third; this one also they wounded and threw out. **13** Then the owner of the vineyard said, ‘What shall I do? I will send my beloved son; perhaps they will respect him.’ **14** But when the tenants saw him, they discussed it among themselves and said, ‘This is the heir; let us kill him so that the inheritance may be ours.’ **15** So they threw him out of the vineyard and killed him. What then will the owner of the vineyard do to them? **16** He will come and destroy those tenants and give the vineyard to others.” When they heard this, they said, “Heaven forbid!”^{*} **17** But he looked at them and said, “What then does this text mean:

‘The stone that the builders rejected

has become the cornerstone'?^{w,*}

¹⁸“Everyone who falls on that stone will be broken to pieces, and it will crush anyone on whom it falls.”^{*} ¹⁹When the scribes and chief priests realized that he had told this parable against them, they wanted to lay hands on him at that very hour, but they feared the people.^{*}

THE QUESTION ABOUT PAYING TRIBUTE

20 So they watched him and sent spies who pretended to be honest, in order to trap him by what he said and then to hand him over to the jurisdiction and authority of the governor. ²¹So they asked him, “Teacher, we know that you are right in what you say and teach, and you show deference to no one but teach the way of God in accordance with truth.”^{*} ²²Is it lawful for us to pay tribute to Caesar or not?” ²³But he perceived their craftiness and said to them, ²⁴“Show me a denarius. Whose head and whose title does it bear?” They said, “Caesar’s.” ²⁵He said to them, “Then give to Caesar the things that are Caesar’s and to God the things that are God’s.”^{*} ²⁶And they were not able in the presence of the people to trap him by what he said, and being amazed by his answer they became silent.

THE QUESTION ABOUT THE RESURRECTION

27 Some Sadducees, those who say there is no resurrection, came to him^{*} ²⁸and asked him a question: “Teacher, Moses wrote for us that if a man’s brother dies leaving a wife but no children, the man^x shall marry the widow and raise up children for his brother.”^{*} ²⁹Now there were seven brothers; the first married a woman and died childless; ³⁰then the second^y ³¹and the third married her, and so in the same way all seven died childless. ³²Finally the woman also died. ³³In the resurrection, therefore, whose wife will the woman be? For the seven had married her.”

34 Jesus said to them, “Those who belong to this age marry and are given in marriage, ³⁵but those who are considered worthy of a place in that age and in the resurrection from the dead neither marry nor are given in marriage. ³⁶Indeed, they cannot die anymore, because they are like angels and are children of God, being children of the resurrection.”^{*} ³⁷And the fact

that the dead are raised Moses himself showed, in the story about the bush, where he speaks of the Lord as the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob. * ³⁸Now he is God not of the dead but of the living, for to him all of them are alive.”* ³⁹Then some of the scribes answered, “Teacher, you have spoken well.” ⁴⁰For they no longer dared to ask him another question.*

THE QUESTION ABOUT DAVID’S SON

41 Then he said to them, “How can they say that the Messiah^z is David’s son? ⁴²For David himself says in the book of Psalms,

‘The Lord said to my Lord,

“Sit at my right hand”*

⁴³until I make your enemies a footstool for your feet.” ’

⁴⁴“David thus calls him Lord, so how can he be his son?”

JESUS DENOUNCES THE SCRIBES

45 In the hearing of all the people he said to the disciples, ⁴⁶“Beware of the scribes who like to walk around in long robes and who love respectful greetings in the marketplaces and the best seats in the synagogues and places of honor at banquets.* ⁴⁷They devour widows’ houses and for the sake of appearance say long prayers. They will receive the greater condemnation.”

Luke 21

THE WIDOW'S OFFERING

1 He looked up and saw rich people putting their gifts into the treasury; ^{*} **2**he also saw a poor widow put in two small copper coins. ^{*} **3**He said, “Truly I tell you, this poor widow has put in more than all of them, ⁴for all of them have contributed out of their abundance, but she out of her poverty has put in all she had to live on.”

THE DESTRUCTION OF THE TEMPLE FORETOLD

5 When some were speaking about the temple, how it was adorned with beautiful stones and gifts dedicated to God, he said, ^{*} **6**“As for these things that you see, the days will come when not one stone will be left upon another; all will be thrown down.”^{*}

SIGNS AND PERSECUTIONS

7 They asked him, “Teacher, when will this be, and what will be the sign that this is about to take place?” **8**And he said, “Beware that you are not led astray, for many will come in my name and say, ‘I am he!’^a and, ‘The time is near!’^b Do not go after them.”^{*}

9 “When you hear of wars and insurrections, do not be terrified, for these things must take place first, but the end will not follow immediately.” **10**Then he said to them, “Nation will rise against nation and kingdom against kingdom; ^{*} **11**there will be great earthquakes and in various places famines and plagues, and there will be dreadful portents and great signs from heaven.

12 “But before all this occurs, they will arrest you and persecute you; they will hand you over to synagogues and prisons, and you will be brought before kings and governors because of my name. ^{*} **13**This will give you an opportunity to testify. ^{*} **14**So make up your minds not to prepare your defense in advance, ^{*} **15**for I will give you words^c and a wisdom that none of your opponents will be able to withstand or contradict. ^{*} **16**You will be

betrayed even by parents and siblings, by relatives and friends, and they will put some of you to death.* ¹⁷You will be hated by all because of my name.* ¹⁸But not a hair of your head will perish.* ¹⁹By your endurance you will gain your souls.*

THE DESTRUCTION OF JERUSALEM FORETOLD

20 “When you see Jerusalem surrounded by armies, then know that its desolation has come near.^{d,*} ²¹Then those in Judea must flee to the mountains, and those inside the city must leave it, and those out in the country must not enter it,* ²²for these are days of vengeance, as a fulfillment of all that is written.* ²³Woe to those who are pregnant and to those who are nursing infants in those days! For there will be great distress on the earth and wrath against this people; ²⁴they will fall by the edge of the sword and be taken away as captives among all nations, and Jerusalem will be trampled on by the nations, until the times of the nations are fulfilled.*

THE COMING OF THE SON OF MAN

25 “There will be signs in the sun, the moon, and the stars and on the earth distress among nations confused by the roaring of the sea and the waves.* ²⁶People will faint from fear and foreboding of what is coming upon the world, for the powers of the heavens will be shaken. ²⁷Then they will see ‘the Son of Man coming in a cloud’ with power and great glory.* ²⁸Now when these things begin to take place, stand up and raise your heads, because your redemption is drawing near.”^{e,*}

THE LESSON OF THE FIG TREE

29 Then he told them a parable: “Look at the fig tree and all the trees; ³⁰as soon as they sprout leaves you can see for yourselves and know that summer is already near. ³¹So also, when you see these things taking place, you know that the kingdom of God is near.* ³²Truly I tell you, this generation will not pass away until all things have taken place. ³³Heaven and earth will pass away, but my words will not pass away.*

EXHORTATION TO WATCH

34 “Be on guard so that your hearts are not weighed down with dissipation and drunkenness and the worries of this life and that day does not catch you unexpectedly,* ³⁵like a trap. For it will come upon all who live on the face of the whole earth. ³⁶Be alert at all times, praying that you may have the strength to escape all these things that will take place and to stand before the Son of Man.”*

37 Every day he was teaching in the temple, and at night he would go out and spend the night on the Mount of Olives, as it was called.* ³⁸And all the people would get up early in the morning to listen to him in the temple.

Luke 22

THE PLOT TO KILL JESUS

1 Now the Festival of Unleavened Bread, which is called the Passover, was near.* **2**The chief priests and the scribes were looking for a way to put Jesus^f to death, for they were afraid of the people.*

3 Then Satan entered into Judas called Iscariot, who was one of the twelve;* **4**he went away and conferred with the chief priests and officers of the temple police about how he might betray him to them. **5**They were greatly pleased and agreed to give him money.* **6**So he consented and began to look for an opportunity to betray him to them when no crowd was present.

THE PREPARATION OF THE PASSOVER

7 Then came the day of Unleavened Bread, on which the Passover lamb had to be sacrificed.* **8**So Jesus^g sent Peter and John, saying, “Go and prepare the Passover meal for us that we may eat it.”* **9**They asked him, “Where do you want us to make preparations for it?” **10**“Listen,” he said to them, “when you have entered the city, a man carrying a jar of water will meet you; follow him into the house he enters ¹¹and say to the owner of the house, ‘The teacher asks you, “Where is the guest room, where I may eat the Passover with my disciples?”’ ¹²He will show you a large room upstairs, already furnished. Make preparations for us there.” **13**So they went and found everything as he had told them, and they prepared the Passover meal.

THE INSTITUTION OF THE LORD’S SUPPER

14 When the hour came, he took his place at the table, and the apostles with him. **15**He said to them, “I have eagerly desired to eat this Passover with you before I suffer, ¹⁶for I tell you, I will not eat it^h until it is fulfilled in the kingdom of God.”* **17**Then he took a cup, and after giving thanks he said, “Take this and divide it among yourselves, ¹⁸for I tell you that from

now on I will not drink of the fruit of the vine until the kingdom of God comes.”¹⁹ Then he took a loaf of bread, and when he had given thanks he broke it and gave it to them, saying, “This is my body, which is given for you. Do this in remembrance of me.”²⁰ And he did the same with the cup after supper, saying, “This cup that is poured out for you is the new covenant in my blood.”^{i 21} But see, the one who betrays me is with me, and his hand is on the table.*²² For the Son of Man is going as it has been determined, but woe to that one by whom he is betrayed!”*²³ Then they began to ask one another which one of them it could be who would do this.

THE DISPUTE ABOUT GREATNESS

24 A dispute also arose among them as to which one of them was to be regarded as the greatest.*²⁵ But he said to them, “The kings of the gentiles lord it over them, and those in authority over them are called benefactors.*²⁶ But not so with you; rather, the greatest among you must become like the youngest and the leader like one who serves.*²⁷ For who is greater, the one who is at the table or the one who serves? Is it not the one at the table? But I am among you as one who serves.*

28 “You are those who have stood by me in my trials,*²⁹ and I confer on you, just as my Father has conferred on me, a kingdom,*³⁰ so that you may eat and drink at my table in my kingdom, and you will sit on thrones judging the twelve tribes of Israel.*

JESUS PREDICTS PETER’S DENIAL

31 “Simon, Simon, listen! Satan has demanded^j to sift all of you like wheat,*³² but I have prayed for you that your own faith may not fail, and you, when once you have turned back, strengthen your brothers.”*³³ And he said to him, “Lord, I am ready to go with you to prison and to death!”³⁴ Jesus^k said, “I tell you, Peter, the cock will not crow this day until you have denied three times that you know me.”

PURSE, BAG, AND SWORD

35 He said to them, “When I sent you out without a purse, bag, or sandals, did you lack anything?” They said, “No, not a thing.”^{* 36} He said to them, “But now, the one who has a purse must take it, and likewise a bag. And the one who has no sword must sell his cloak and buy one.³⁷ For I tell you, this scripture must be fulfilled in me, ‘And he was counted among the lawless,’ and indeed what is written about me is being fulfilled.”^{* 38} They said, “Lord, look, here are two swords.” He replied, “It is enough.”

JESUS PRAYS ON THE MOUNT OF OLIVES

39 He came out and went, as was his custom, to the Mount of Olives, and the disciples followed him.^{* 40} When he reached the place, he said to them, “Pray that you may not come into the time of trial.”^{l,* 41} Then he withdrew from them about a stone’s throw, knelt down, and prayed,⁴² “Father, if you are willing, remove this cup from me, yet not my will but yours be done.”^{*} [[⁴³ Then an angel from heaven appeared to him and gave him strength.^{*} ⁴⁴ In his anguish he prayed more earnestly, and his sweat became like great drops of blood falling down on the ground.]]^{m,* 45} When he got up from prayer, he came to the disciples and found them sleeping because of grief,⁴⁶ and he said to them, “Why are you sleeping? Get up and pray that you may not come into the time of trial.”^{n,*}

THE BETRAYAL AND ARREST OF JESUS

47 While he was still speaking, suddenly a crowd came, and the one called Judas, one of the twelve, was leading them. He approached Jesus to kiss him,⁴⁸ but Jesus said to him, “Judas, is it with a kiss that you are betraying the Son of Man?”⁴⁹ When those who were around him saw what was coming, they asked, “Lord, should we strike with the sword?”^{* 50} Then one of them struck the slave of the high priest and cut off his right ear.⁵¹ But Jesus said, “No more of this!” And he touched his ear and healed him.⁵² Then Jesus said to the chief priests, the officers of the temple police, and the elders who had come for him, “Have you come out with swords and clubs as though I were a rebel?”^{* 53} When I was with you day after day in the temple, you did not lay hands on me. But this is your hour and the power of darkness!”^{* 54}

PETER DENIES JESUS

54 Then they seized him and led him away, bringing him into the high priest's house. But Peter was following at a distance.* **55** When they had kindled a fire in the middle of the courtyard and sat down together, Peter sat among them. **56** Then a female servant, seeing him in the firelight, stared at him and said, "This man also was with him." **57** But he denied it, saying, "Woman, I do not know him." **58** A little later someone else, on seeing him, said, "You also are one of them." But Peter said, "Man, I am not!" **59** Then about an hour later still another kept insisting, "Surely this man also was with him, for he is a Galilean." **60** But Peter said, "Man, I do not know what you are talking about!" At that moment, while he was still speaking, the cock crowed. **61** The Lord turned and looked at Peter. Then Peter remembered the word of the Lord, how he had said to him, "Before the cock crows today, you will deny me three times."* **62** And he went out and wept bitterly.

THE MOCKING AND BEATING OF JESUS

63 Now the men who were holding Jesus^o began to mock him and beat him;* **64** they also blindfolded him and kept asking him, "Prophecy! Who is it who struck you?" **65** They kept heaping many other insults on him.

JESUS BEFORE THE COUNCIL

66 When day came, the assembly of the elders of the people, both chief priests and scribes, gathered together, and they brought him to their council.* **67** They said, "If you are the Messiah,^p tell us." He replied, "If I tell you, you will not believe,* **68** and if I question you, you will not answer.^q **69** But from now on the Son of Man will be seated at the right hand of the power of God." **70** All of them asked, "Are you, then, the Son of God?" He said to them, "You say that I am."* **71** Then they said, "What further testimony do we need? We have heard it ourselves from his own lips!"

Luke 23

JESUS BEFORE PILATE

1 Then the assembly rose as a body and brought Jesus^r before Pilate.* **2**They began to accuse him, saying, “We found this man inciting our nation, forbidding us to pay taxes to Caesar and saying that he himself is the Messiah, a king.”^{s,*} **3**Then Pilate asked him, “Are you the king of the Jews?” He answered, “You say so.”* **4**Then Pilate said to the chief priests and the crowds, “I find no basis for an accusation against this man.”* **5**But they were insistent and said, “He stirs up the people by teaching throughout all Judea, from Galilee where he began even to this place.”

JESUS BEFORE HEROD

6 When Pilate heard this, he asked whether the man was a Galilean.* **7**And when he learned that he was under Herod’s jurisdiction, he sent him off to Herod, who was himself in Jerusalem at that time.* **8**When Herod saw Jesus, he was very glad, for he had been wanting to see him for a long time because he had heard about him and was hoping to see him perform some sign.* **9**He questioned him at some length, but Jesus^t gave him no answer.* **10**The chief priests and the scribes stood by vehemently accusing him.* **11**Even Herod with his soldiers treated him with contempt and mocked him; then he put an elegant robe on him and sent him back to Pilate.* **12**That same day Herod and Pilate became friends with each other; before this they had been enemies.*

JESUS SENTENCED TO DEATH

13 Pilate then called together the chief priests, the leaders, and the people **14**and said to them, “You brought me this man as one who was inciting the people, and here I have examined him in your presence and have not found this man guilty of any of your charges against him.* **15**Neither has Herod, for he sent him back to us. Indeed, he has done nothing to deserve death. **16**I will therefore have him flogged and release him.”^{u,*}

18 Then they all shouted out together, “Away with this fellow! Release Barabbas for us!”^{*} ¹⁹(This was a man who had been put in prison for an insurrection that had taken place in the city and for murder.) ²⁰Pilate, wanting to release Jesus, addressed them again, ²¹but they kept shouting, “Crucify, crucify him!” ²²A third time he said to them, “Why, what evil has he done? I have found in him no ground for the sentence of death; I will therefore have him flogged and then release him.”^{*} ²³But they kept urgently demanding with loud shouts that he should be crucified, and their voices prevailed. ²⁴So Pilate gave his verdict that their demand should be granted. ²⁵He released the man they asked for, the one who had been put in prison for insurrection and murder, and he handed Jesus over as they wished.

THE CRUCIFIXION OF JESUS

26 As they led him away, they seized a man, Simon of Cyrene, who was coming from the country, and they laid the cross on him and made him carry it behind Jesus.^{*} ²⁷A great number of the people followed him, and among them were women who were beating their breasts and wailing for him.^{*} ²⁸But Jesus turned to them and said, “Daughters of Jerusalem, do not weep for me, but weep for yourselves and for your children.”^{*} ²⁹For the days are surely coming when they will say, ‘Blessed are the barren, and the wombs that never bore, and the breasts that never nursed.’ ³⁰Then they will begin to say to the mountains, ‘Fall on us,’ and to the hills, ‘Cover us.’^{*} ³¹For if they do this when the wood is green, what will happen when it is dry?”^{*}

32 Two others also, who were criminals, were led away to be put to death with him.^{*} ³³When they came to the place that is called The Skull, they crucified Jesus^v there with the criminals, one on his right and one on his left. [[³⁴Then Jesus said, “Father, forgive them, for they do not know what they are doing.”]]^w And they cast lots to divide his clothing.^{*} ³⁵And the people stood by watching, but the leaders scoffed at him, saying, “He saved others; let him save himself if he is the Messiah^x of God, his chosen one!”^{*} ³⁶The soldiers also mocked him, coming up and offering him sour wine^{*} ³⁷and saying, “If you are the King of the Jews, save yourself!” ³⁸There was also an inscription over him,^y “This is the King of the Jews.”

39 One of the criminals who were hanged there kept deriding^z him and saying, “Are you not the Messiah?^a Save yourself and us!”^{*} **40** But the other rebuked him, saying, “Do you not fear God, since you are under the same sentence of condemnation? ⁴¹And we indeed have been condemned justly, for we are getting what we deserve for our deeds, but this man has done nothing wrong.”^{*} ⁴²Then he said, “Jesus, remember me when you come in^b your kingdom.” ⁴³He replied, “Truly I tell you, today you will be with me in paradise.”^{*}

THE DEATH OF JESUS

44 It was now about noon, and darkness came over the whole land^c until three in the afternoon, ⁴⁵while the sun’s light failed,^d and the curtain of the temple was torn in two.^{*} ⁴⁶Then Jesus, crying out with a loud voice, said, “Father, into your hands I commend my spirit.” Having said this, he breathed his last.^{*} ⁴⁷When the centurion saw what had taken place, he praised God and said, “Certainly this man was innocent.”^{e,*} ⁴⁸And when all the crowds who had gathered there for this spectacle saw what had taken place, they returned home, beating their breasts. ⁴⁹But all his acquaintances, including the women who had followed him from Galilee, stood at a distance watching these things.^{*}

THE BURIAL OF JESUS

50 Now there was a good and righteous man named Joseph who, though a member of the council, ⁵¹had not agreed to their plan and action. He came from the Jewish town of Arimathea, and he was waiting expectantly for the kingdom of God.^{*} ⁵²This man went to Pilate and asked for the body of Jesus. ⁵³Then he took it down, wrapped it in a linen cloth, and laid it in a rock-hewn tomb where no one had ever been laid. ⁵⁴It was the day of Preparation, and the Sabbath was beginning.^{f,*} ⁵⁵The women who had come with him from Galilee followed, and they saw the tomb and how his body was laid.^{*} ⁵⁶Then they returned and prepared spices and ointments.

On the Sabbath they rested according to the commandment.^{*}

Luke 24

THE RESURRECTION OF JESUS

1 But on the first day of the week, at early dawn, they went to the tomb, taking the spices that they had prepared.* **2** They found the stone rolled away from the tomb,³ but when they went in they did not find the body.^g **4** While they were perplexed about this, suddenly two men in dazzling clothes stood beside them.* **5** The women^h were terrified and bowed their faces to the ground, but the menⁱ said to them, “Why do you look for the living among the dead? He is not here but has risen.^j” **6** Remember how he told you, while he was still in Galilee,* **7** that the Son of Man must be handed over to the hands of sinners and be crucified and on the third day rise again.” **8** Then they remembered his words,* **9** and returning from the tomb they told all this to the eleven and to all the rest.* **10** Now it was Mary Magdalene, Joanna, Mary the mother of James, and the other women with them who told this to the apostles.* **11** But these words seemed to them an idle tale, and they did not believe them.* **12** But Peter got up and ran to the tomb; stooping and looking in, he saw the linen cloths by themselves; then he went home, amazed at what had happened.^k

THE WALK TO EMMAUS

13 Now on that same day two of them were going to a village called Emmaus, about seven miles^l from Jerusalem,¹⁴ and talking with each other about all these things that had happened. **15** While they were talking and discussing, Jesus himself came near and went with them,* **16** but their eyes were kept from recognizing him. **17** And he said to them, “What are you discussing with each other while you walk along?” They stood still, looking sad.^m **18** Then one of them, whose name was Cleopas, answered him, “Are you the only stranger in Jerusalem who does not know the things that have taken place there in these days?”* **19** He asked them, “What things?” They replied, “The things about Jesus of Nazareth,ⁿ who was a prophet mighty in deed and word before God and all the people,* **20** and how our chief priests

and leaders handed him over to be condemned to death and crucified him.
²¹But we had hoped that he was the one to redeem Israel.^o Yes, and besides all this, it is now the third day since these things took place.* ²²Moreover, some women of our group astounded us. They were at the tomb early this morning,* ²³and when they did not find his body there they came back and told us that they had indeed seen a vision of angels who said that he was alive.²⁴ Some of those who were with us went to the tomb and found it just as the women had said, but they did not see him.”* ²⁵Then he said to them, “Oh, how foolish you are and how slow of heart to believe all that the prophets have declared! ²⁶Was it not necessary that the Messiah^p should suffer these things and then enter into his glory?”* ²⁷Then beginning with Moses and all the prophets, he interpreted to them the things about himself in all the scriptures.*

28 As they came near the village to which they were going, he walked ahead as if he were going on.* ²⁹But they urged him strongly, saying, “Stay with us, because it is almost evening and the day is now nearly over.” So he went in to stay with them. ³⁰When he was at the table with them, he took bread, blessed and broke it, and gave it to them.* ³¹Then their eyes were opened, and they recognized him, and he vanished from their sight. ³²They said to each other, “Were not our hearts burning within us^q while he was talking to us on the road, while he was opening the scriptures to us?” ³³That same hour they got up and returned to Jerusalem, and they found the eleven and their companions gathered together.* ³⁴They were saying, “The Lord has risen indeed, and he has appeared to Simon!”* ³⁵Then they told what had happened on the road and how he had been made known to them in the breaking of the bread.

JESUS APPEARS TO HIS DISCIPLES

36 While they were talking about this, Jesus^r himself stood among them and said to them, “Peace be with you.”^s ³⁷They were startled and terrified and thought that they were seeing a ghost.* ³⁸He said to them, “Why are you frightened, and why do doubts arise in your hearts? ³⁹Look at my hands and my feet; see that it is I myself. Touch me and see, for a ghost does not have flesh and bones as you see that I have.”* ⁴⁰And when he had said this,

he showed them his hands and his feet.^{t 41} Yet for all their joy they were still disbelieving and wondering, and he said to them, “Have you anything here to eat?”^{* 42} They gave him a piece of broiled fish,^{u 43} and he took it and ate in their presence.^{*}

44 Then he said to them, “These are my words that I spoke to you while I was still with you—that everything written about me in the law of Moses, the prophets, and the psalms must be fulfilled.”^{* 45} Then he opened their minds to understand the scriptures,⁴⁶ and he said to them, “Thus it is written, that the Messiah^v is^w to suffer and to rise from the dead on the third day^{* 47} and that repentance and forgiveness of sins is to be proclaimed in his name to all nations, beginning from Jerusalem.^{* 48} You are witnesses^x of these things.^{* 49} And see, I am sending upon you what my Father promised, so stay here in the city until you have been clothed with power from on high.”^{*}

THE ASCENSION OF JESUS

50 Then he led them out as far as Bethany, and, lifting up his hands, he blessed them.^{* 51} While he was blessing them, he withdrew from them and was carried up into heaven.^{y,* 52} And they worshiped him and^z returned to Jerusalem with great joy,⁵³ and they were continually in the temple^a blessing God.^{b,*}

The Gospel according to John

John 1

THE WORD BECAME FLESH

1 In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God. ^{*} **2** He was in the beginning with God. **3** All things came into being through him, and without him not one thing came into being. What has come into being ^{*} **4** in him was life,^a and the life was the light of all people. ^{*} **5** The light shines in the darkness, and the darkness did not overtake it.

6 There was a man sent from God whose name was John. **7** He came as a witness to testify to the light, so that all might believe through him. **8** He himself was not the light, but he came to testify to the light. **9** The true light, which enlightens everyone, was coming into the world.^{b,*}

10 He was in the world, and the world came into being through him, yet the world did not know him. ^{*} **11** He came to what was his own,^c and his own people did not accept him. **12** But to all who received him, who believed in his name, he gave power to become children of God, ^{*} **13** who were born, not of blood or of the will of the flesh or of the will of man, but of God. ^{*}

14 And the Word became flesh and lived among us, and we have seen his glory, the glory as of a father's only son,^d full of grace and truth. ^{*} **15** (John testified to him and cried out, "This was he of whom I said, 'He who comes after me ranks ahead of me because he was before me.' ") **16** From his fullness we have all received, grace upon grace.^{e,*} **17** The law indeed was given through Moses; grace and truth came through Jesus Christ. ^{*} **18** No one has ever seen God. It is the only Son, himself God, who^f is close to the Father's heart,^g who has made him known. ^{*}

THE TESTIMONY OF JOHN THE BAPTIST

19 This is the testimony given by John when the Jews sent priests and Levites from Jerusalem to ask him, “Who are you?” ²⁰He confessed and did not deny it, but he confessed, “I am not the Messiah.”^{h,*} ²¹And they asked him, “What then? Are you Elijah?” He said, “I am not.” “Are you the prophet?” He answered, “No.”^{*} ²²Then they said to him, “Who are you? Let us have an answer for those who sent us. What do you say about yourself?” ²³He said,

“I am the voice of one crying out in the wilderness,

‘Make straight the way of the Lord,’ ”

as the prophet Isaiah said.^{*}

24 Now they had been sent from the Pharisees. ²⁵They asked him, “Why, then, are you baptizing if you are neither the Messiah,ⁱ nor Elijah, nor the prophet?” ²⁶John answered them, “I baptize with water. Among you stands one whom you do not know, ²⁷the one who is coming after me; I am not worthy to untie the strap of his sandal.” ²⁸This took place in Bethany across the Jordan where John was baptizing.

THE LAMB OF GOD

29 The next day he saw Jesus coming toward him and declared, “Here is the Lamb of God who takes away the sin of the world!”^{*} ³⁰This is he of whom I said, ‘After me comes a man who ranks ahead of me because he was before me.’ ³¹I myself did not know him, but I came baptizing with water for this reason, that he might be revealed to Israel.” ³²And John testified, “I saw the Spirit descending from heaven like a dove, and it remained on him.”^{*} ³³I myself did not know him, but the one who sent me to baptize with water said to me, ‘He on whom you see the Spirit descend and remain is the one who baptizes with the Holy Spirit.’^{*} ³⁴And I myself have seen and have testified that this is the Chosen One.”^j

THE FIRST DISCIPLES OF JESUS

35 The next day John again was standing with two of his disciples, ³⁶and as he watched Jesus walk by he exclaimed, “Look, here is the Lamb of God!”^{*} ³⁷The two disciples heard him say this, and they followed Jesus.

³⁸When Jesus turned and saw them following, he said to them, “What are you looking for?” They said to him, “Rabbi” (which translated means Teacher), “where are you staying?”* ³⁹He said to them, “Come and see.” They came and saw where he was staying, and they remained with him that day. It was about four o’clock in the afternoon. ⁴⁰One of the two who heard John speak and followed him was Andrew, Simon Peter’s brother.* ⁴¹He first found his brother Simon and said to him, “We have found the Messiah” (which is translated Anointed^k).* ⁴²He brought Simon^l to Jesus, who looked at him and said, “You are Simon son of John. You are to be called Cephas”^m (which is translated Peterⁿ).*

JESUS CALLS PHILIP AND NATHANAEL

43 The next day Jesus decided to go to Galilee. He found Philip and said to him, “Follow me.”* ⁴⁴Now Philip was from Bethsaida, the city of Andrew and Peter.* ⁴⁵Philip found Nathanael and said to him, “We have found him about whom Moses in the Law and also the Prophets wrote, Jesus son of Joseph from Nazareth.”* ⁴⁶Nathanael said to him, “Can anything good come out of Nazareth?” Philip said to him, “Come and see.”* ⁴⁷When Jesus saw Nathanael coming toward him, he said of him, “Here is truly an Israelite in whom there is no deceit!”* ⁴⁸Nathanael asked him, “Where did you get to know me?” Jesus answered, “I saw you under the fig tree before Philip called you.” ⁴⁹Nathanael replied, “Rabbi, you are the Son of God! You are the King of Israel!”* ⁵⁰Jesus answered, “Do you believe because I told you that I saw you under the fig tree? You will see greater things than these.” ⁵¹And he said to him, “Very truly, I tell you,^o you will see heaven opened and the angels of God ascending and descending upon the Son of Man.”*

John 2

THE WEDDING AT CANA

1 On the third day there was a wedding in Cana of Galilee, and the mother of Jesus was there.* **2** Jesus and his disciples had also been invited to the wedding. **3** When the wine gave out, the mother of Jesus said to him, “They have no wine.” **4** And Jesus said to her, “Woman, what concern is that to me and to you?^P My hour has not yet come.”* **5** His mother said to the servants, “Do whatever he tells you.” **6** Now standing there were six stone water jars for the Jewish rites of purification, each holding twenty or thirty gallons.* **7** Jesus said to them, “Fill the jars with water.” And they filled them up to the brim. **8** He said to them, “Now draw some out, and take it to the person in charge of the banquet.” So they took it. **9** When the person in charge tasted the water that had become wine and did not know where it came from (though the servants who had drawn the water knew), that person called the bridegroom ¹⁰and said to him, “Everyone serves the good wine first and then the inferior wine after the guests have become drunk. But you have kept the good wine until now.” **11** Jesus did this, the first of his signs, in Cana of Galilee and revealed his glory, and his disciples believed in him.*

12 After this he went down to Capernaum with his mother, his brothers, and his disciples, and they remained there a few days.*

JESUS CLEANSSES THE TEMPLE

13 The Passover of the Jews was near, and Jesus went up to Jerusalem.* ¹⁴In the temple he found people selling cattle, sheep, and doves and the money changers seated at their tables. ¹⁵Making a whip of cords, he drove all of them out of the temple, with the sheep and the cattle. He also poured out the coins of the money changers and overturned their tables. ¹⁶He told those who were selling the doves, “Take these things out of here! Stop making my Father’s house a marketplace!”* ¹⁷His disciples remembered that it was written, “Zeal for your house will consume me.”* ¹⁸The Jews then said to him, “What sign can you show us for doing this?”* ¹⁹Jesus

answered them, “Destroy this temple, and in three days I will raise it up.”*
²⁰The Jews then said, “This temple has been under construction for forty-six years, and will you raise it up in three days?” ²¹But he was speaking of the temple of his body. * ²²After he was raised from the dead, his disciples remembered that he had said this, and they believed the scripture and the word that Jesus had spoken.

23 When he was in Jerusalem during the Passover festival, many believed in his name because they saw the signs that he was doing. ²⁴But Jesus on his part would not entrust himself to them, because he knew all people ²⁵and needed no one to testify about anyone, for he himself knew what was in everyone.*

John 3

NICODEMUS VISITS JESUS

1 Now there was a Pharisee named Nicodemus, a leader of the Jews. **2** He came to Jesus^q by night and said to him, “Rabbi, we know that you are a teacher who has come from God, for no one can do these signs that you do unless God is with that person.”^{*} **3** Jesus answered him, “Very truly, I tell you, no one can see the kingdom of God without being born from above.”^{r,*} **4** Nicodemus said to him, “How can anyone be born after having grown old? Can one enter a second time into the mother’s womb and be born?” **5** Jesus answered, “Very truly, I tell you, no one can enter the kingdom of God without being born of water and Spirit.^{*} **6** What is born of the flesh is flesh, and what is born of the Spirit is spirit. **7** Do not be astonished that I said to you, ‘You^s must be born from above.’^t **8** The wind^u blows where it chooses, and you hear the sound of it, but you do not know where it comes from or where it goes. So it is with everyone who is born of the Spirit.”^{*} **9** Nicodemus said to him, “How can these things be?”^{*} **10** Jesus answered him, “Are you the teacher of Israel, and yet you do not understand these things?

11 “Very truly, I tell you, we speak of what we know and testify to what we have seen, yet you^v do not receive our testimony.”^{*} **12** If I have told you about earthly things and you do not believe, how can you believe if I tell you about heavenly things? **13** No one has ascended into heaven except the one who descended from heaven, the Son of Man.^{w,*} **14** And just as Moses lifted up the serpent in the wilderness, so must the Son of Man be lifted up,^{*} **15** that whoever believes in him may have eternal life.^{x,*}

16 “For God so loved the world that he gave his only Son, so that everyone who believes in him may not perish but may have eternal life.”^{*}

17 “Indeed, God did not send the Son into the world to condemn the world but in order that the world might be saved through him.”^{*} **18** Those who believe in him are not condemned, but those who do not believe are condemned already because they have not believed in the name of the only

Son of God.* ¹⁹And this is the judgment, that the light has come into the world, and people loved darkness rather than light because their deeds were evil.* ²⁰For all who do evil hate the light and do not come to the light, so that their deeds may not be exposed.* ²¹But those who do what is true come to the light, so that it may be clearly seen that their deeds have been done in God.”^{y,*}

JESUS AND JOHN THE BAPTIST

22 After this Jesus and his disciples went into the region of Judea, and he spent some time there with them and baptized. ²³John also was baptizing at Aenon near Salim because water was abundant there, and people kept coming and were being baptized. ²⁴(John, of course, had not yet been thrown into prison.)*

25 Now a discussion about purification arose between John’s disciples and a Jew.^z ²⁶They came to John and said to him, “Rabbi, the one who was with you across the Jordan, to whom you testified, here he is baptizing, and all are going to him.”* ²⁷John answered, “No one can receive anything except what has been given from heaven.* ²⁸You yourselves are my witnesses that I said, ‘I am not the Messiah,^a but I have been sent ahead of him.’* ²⁹He who has the bride is the bridegroom. The friend of the bridegroom who stands and hears him rejoices greatly at the bridegroom’s voice. For this reason my joy has been fulfilled.* ³⁰He must increase, but I must decrease.”^b

THE ONE WHO COMES FROM HEAVEN

31 The one who comes from above is above all; the one who is of the earth belongs to the earth and speaks about earthly things. The one who comes from heaven is above all.* ³²He testifies to what he has seen and heard, yet no one accepts his testimony.* ³³Whoever has accepted his testimony has certified^c this, that God is true.* ³⁴He whom God has sent speaks the words of God, for he gives the Spirit without measure.* ³⁵The Father loves the Son and has placed all things in his hands.* ³⁶Whoever believes in the Son has eternal life; whoever disobeys the Son will not see life but must endure God’s wrath.*

John 4

JESUS AND THE WOMAN OF SAMARIA

1 Now when Jesus^d learned that the Pharisees had heard, “Jesus is making and baptizing more disciples than John”^{*} ²(although it was not Jesus himself but his disciples who baptized), ³he left Judea and started back to Galilee. ⁴But he had to go through Samaria. ⁵So he came to a Samaritan city called Sychar, near the plot of ground that Jacob had given to his son Joseph.^{*} ⁶Jacob’s well was there, and Jesus, tired out by his journey, was sitting by the well. It was about noon.

7 A Samaritan woman came to draw water, and Jesus said to her, “Give me a drink.” ⁸(His disciples had gone to the city to buy food.) ⁹The Samaritan woman said to him, “How is it that you, a Jew, ask a drink of me, a woman of Samaria?” (Jews do not share things in common with Samaritans.)^{e,*} ¹⁰Jesus answered her, “If you knew the gift of God and who it is that is saying to you, ‘Give me a drink,’ you would have asked him, and he would have given you living water.”^{*} ¹¹The woman said to him, “Sir,^f you have no bucket, and the well is deep. Where do you get that living water? ¹²Are you greater than our ancestor Jacob, who gave us the well and with his sons and his flocks drank from it?” ¹³Jesus said to her, “Everyone who drinks of this water will be thirsty again, ¹⁴but those who drink of the water that I will give them will never be thirsty. The water that I will give will become in them a spring of water gushing up to eternal life.”^{*} ¹⁵The woman said to him, “Sir,^g give me this water, so that I may never be thirsty or have to keep coming here to draw water.”^{*}

16 Jesus said to her, “Go, call your husband, and come back.” ¹⁷The woman answered him, “I have no husband.” Jesus said to her, “You are right in saying, ‘I have no husband,’ ¹⁸for you have had five husbands, and the one you have now is not your husband. What you have said is true!” ¹⁹The woman said to him, “Sir,^h I see that you are a prophet. ²⁰Our ancestors worshiped on this mountain, but youⁱ say that the place where people must worship is in Jerusalem.”^{*} ²¹Jesus said to her, “Woman, believe me, the hour is coming when you^j will worship the Father neither on this

mountain nor in Jerusalem.* ²²You^k worship what you^l do not know; we worship what we know, for salvation is from the Jews.* ²³But the hour is coming and is now here when the true worshipers will worship the Father in spirit and truth, for the Father seeks such as these to worship him.* ²⁴God is spirit, and those who worship him must worship in spirit and truth.”* ²⁵The woman said to him, “I know that Messiah is coming” (who is called Christ). “When he comes, he will proclaim all things to us.”* ²⁶Jesus said to her, “I am he,^m the one who is speaking to you.”*

27 Just then his disciples came. They were astonished that he was speaking with a woman, but no one said, “What do you want?” or, “Why are you speaking with her?” ²⁸Then the woman left her water jar and went back to the city. She said to the people, ²⁹“Come and see a man who told me everything I have ever done! He cannot be the Messiah,ⁿ can he?”* ³⁰They left the city and were on their way to him.

31 Meanwhile the disciples were urging him, “Rabbi, eat something.” ³²But he said to them, “I have food to eat that you do not know about.” ³³So the disciples said to one another, “Surely no one has brought him something to eat?” ³⁴Jesus said to them, “My food is to do the will of him who sent me and to complete his work.* ³⁵Do you not say, ‘Four months more, then comes the harvest’? But I tell you, look around you, and see how the fields are ripe for harvesting.* ³⁶The reaper is already receiving^o wages and is gathering fruit for eternal life, so that sower and reaper may rejoice together.* ³⁷For here the saying holds true, ‘One sows and another reaps.’* ³⁸I sent you to reap that for which you did not labor. Others have labored, and you have entered into their labor.”

39 Many Samaritans from that city believed in him because of the woman’s testimony, “He told me everything I have ever done.”* ⁴⁰So when the Samaritans came to him, they asked him to stay with them, and he stayed there two days. ⁴¹And many more believed because of his word. ⁴²They said to the woman, “It is no longer because of what you said that we believe, for we have heard for ourselves, and we know that this is truly the Savior of the world.”*

JESUS RETURNS TO GALILEE

43 When the two days were over, he went from that place to Galilee*
⁴⁴(for Jesus himself had testified that a prophet has no honor in the prophet's own country).* ⁴⁵When he came to Galilee, the Galileans welcomed him, since they had seen all that he had done in Jerusalem at the festival, for they, too, had gone to the festival.*

JESUS HEALS AN OFFICIAL'S SON

46 Then he came again to Cana in Galilee, where he had changed the water into wine. Now there was a royal official whose son lay ill in Capernaum.* ⁴⁷When he heard that Jesus had come from Judea to Galilee, he went and begged him to come down and heal his son, for he was at the point of death.* ⁴⁸Then Jesus said to him, "Unless you^P see signs and wonders you will not believe."* ⁴⁹The official said to him, "Sir,^q come down before my little boy dies." ⁵⁰Jesus said to him, "Go; your son will live."r The man believed the word that Jesus spoke to him and started on his way. ⁵¹As he was going down, his slaves met him and told him that his child was alive. ⁵²So he asked them the hour when he began to recover, and they said to him, "Yesterday at one in the afternoon the fever left him." ⁵³The father realized that this was the hour when Jesus had said to him, "Your son will live."s So he himself believed, along with his whole household.* ⁵⁴Now this was the second sign that Jesus did after coming from Judea to Galilee.*

John 5

JESUS HEALS ON THE SABBATH

1 After this there was a festival of the Jews, and Jesus went up to Jerusalem.

2 Now in Jerusalem by the Sheep Gate there is a pool, called in Hebrew^t Beth-zatha,^u which has five porticoes.^{*} **3** In these lay many ill, blind, lame, and paralyzed people.^v **5** One man was there who had been ill for thirty-eight years. **6** When Jesus saw him lying there and knew that he had been there a long time, he said to him, “Do you want to be made well?” **7** The ill man answered him, “Sir,^w I have no one to put me into the pool when the water is stirred up, and while I am making my way someone else steps down ahead of me.” **8** Jesus said to him, “Stand up, take your mat and walk.”^{*} **9** At once the man was made well, and he took up his mat and began to walk.

Now that day was a Sabbath.^{*} **10** So the Jews said to the man who had been cured, “It is the Sabbath; it is not lawful for you to carry your mat.”^{*} **11** But he answered them, “The man who made me well said to me, ‘Take up your mat and walk.’” **12** They asked him, “Who is the man who said to you, ‘Take it up and walk’?” **13** Now the man who had been healed did not know who it was, for Jesus had disappeared in^x the crowd that was there. **14** Later Jesus found him in the temple and said to him, “See, you have been made well! Do not sin any more, so that nothing worse happens to you.”^{*} **15** The man went away and told the Jews that it was Jesus who had made him well. **16** Therefore the Jews started persecuting Jesus, because he was doing such things on the Sabbath. **17** But Jesus answered them, “My Father is still working, and I also am working.”^{*} **18** For this reason the Jews were seeking all the more to kill him, because he was not only breaking the Sabbath but was also calling God his own Father, thereby making himself equal to God.^{*}

THE AUTHORITY OF THE SON

19 Jesus said to them, “Very truly, I tell you, the Son can do nothing on his own but only what he sees the Father doing, for whatever the Father^y

does, the Son does likewise.* ²⁰The Father loves the Son and shows him all that he himself is doing, and he will show him greater works than these, so that you will be astonished.* ²¹Indeed, just as the Father raises the dead and gives them life, so also the Son gives life to whomever he wishes.* ²²The Father judges no one but has given all judgment to the Son,* ²³so that all may honor the Son just as they honor the Father. Anyone who does not honor the Son does not honor the Father who sent him.* ²⁴Very truly, I tell you, anyone who hears my word and believes him who sent me has eternal life and does not come under judgment but has passed from death to life.*

25 “Very truly, I tell you, the hour is coming and is now here when the dead will hear the voice of the Son of God, and those who hear will live.* ²⁶For just as the Father has life in himself, so he has granted the Son also to have life in himself, ²⁷and he has given him authority to execute judgment because he is the Son of Man.* ²⁸Do not be astonished at this, for the hour is coming when all who are in their graves will hear his voice ²⁹and will come out: those who have done good to the resurrection of life, and those who have done evil to the resurrection of condemnation.*

WITNESSES TO JESUS

30 “I can do nothing on my own. As I hear, I judge, and my judgment is just because I seek to do not my own will but the will of him who sent me.*

31 “If I testify about myself, my testimony is not true.* ³²There is another who testifies on my behalf, and I know that his testimony to me is true.* ³³You sent messengers to John, and he testified to the truth.* ³⁴Not that I accept such human testimony, but I say these things so that you may be saved. ³⁵He was a burning and shining lamp, and you were willing to rejoice for a while in his light.* ³⁶But I have a testimony greater than John’s. The works that the Father has given me to complete, the very works that I am doing, testify on my behalf that the Father has sent me.* ³⁷And the Father who sent me has himself testified on my behalf. You have never heard his voice or seen his form,* ³⁸and you do not have his word abiding in you, because you do not believe him whom he has sent.*

39 “You search the scriptures because you think that in them you have eternal life, and it is they that testify on my behalf.* ⁴⁰Yet you refuse to

come to me to have life. ⁴¹I do not accept glory from humans. ⁴²But I know that you do not have the love of God in^z you. ⁴³I have come in my Father's name, and you do not accept me; if another comes in his own name, you will accept him. ⁴⁴How can you believe when you accept glory from one another and do not seek the glory that comes from the one who alone is God?^{a,*} ⁴⁵Do not think that I will accuse you before the Father; your accuser is Moses, on whom you have set your hope.^{*} ⁴⁶If you believed Moses, you would believe me, for he wrote about me.^{*} ⁴⁷But if you do not believe what he wrote, how will you believe what I say?"

John 6

FEEDING THE FIVE THOUSAND

1 After this Jesus went to the other side of the Sea of Galilee, also called the Sea of Tiberias.^b **2**A large crowd kept following him because they saw the signs that he was doing for the sick. **3**Jesus went up the mountain and sat down there with his disciples. **4**Now the Passover, the festival of the Jews, was near. **5**When he looked up and saw a large crowd coming toward him, Jesus said to Philip, “Where are we to buy bread for these people to eat?”^{*} **6**He said this to test him, for he himself knew what he was going to do. **7**Philip answered him, “Two hundred denarii would not buy enough bread for each of them to get a little.” **8**One of his disciples, Andrew, Simon Peter’s brother, said to him, **9**“There is a boy here who has five barley loaves and two fish. But what are they among so many people?” **10**Jesus said, “Make the people sit down.” Now there was a great deal of grass in the place, so they^c sat down, about five thousand in all. **11**Then Jesus took the loaves, and when he had given thanks he distributed them to those who were seated; so also the fish, as much as they wanted.^{*} **12**When they were satisfied, he told his disciples, “Gather up the fragments left over, so that nothing may be lost.” **13**So they gathered them up, and from the fragments of the five barley loaves, left by those who had eaten, they filled twelve baskets. **14**When the people saw the sign that he had done, they began to say, “This is indeed the prophet who is to come into the world.”^{*}

15 When Jesus realized that they were about to come and take him by force to make him king, he withdrew again to the mountain by himself.^{*}

JESUS WALKS ON THE WATER

16 When evening came, his disciples went down to the sea, **17**got into a boat, and started across the sea to Capernaum. It was now dark, and Jesus had not yet come to them. **18**The sea became rough because a strong wind was blowing. **19**When they had rowed about three or four miles, they saw Jesus walking on the sea and coming near the boat, and they were terrified.

²⁰But he said to them, “It is I;^d do not be afraid.” ²¹Then they wanted to take him into the boat, and immediately the boat reached the land toward which they were going.

THE BREAD FROM HEAVEN

22 The next day the crowd that had stayed on the other side of the sea saw that there had been only one boat there. They also saw that Jesus had not gotten into the boat with his disciples but that his disciples had gone away alone.* ²³But some boats from Tiberias came near the place where they had eaten the bread after the Lord had given thanks.* ²⁴So when the crowd saw that neither Jesus nor his disciples were there, they themselves got into the boats and went to Capernaum looking for Jesus.*

25 When they found him on the other side of the sea, they said to him, “Rabbi, when did you come here?” ²⁶Jesus answered them, “Very truly, I tell you, you are looking for me not because you saw signs but because you ate your fill of the loaves.* ²⁷Do not work for the food that perishes but for the food that endures for eternal life, which the Son of Man will give you. For it is on him that God the Father has set his seal.”* ²⁸Then they said to him, “What must we do to perform the works of God?” ²⁹Jesus answered them, “This is the work of God, that you believe in him whom he has sent.”* ³⁰So they said to him, “What sign are you going to give us, then, so that we may see it and believe you? What work are you performing?”* ³¹Our ancestors ate the manna in the wilderness, as it is written, ‘He gave them bread from heaven to eat.’ ”* ³²Then Jesus said to them, “Very truly, I tell you, it was not Moses who gave you the bread from heaven, but it is my Father who gives you the true bread from heaven. ³³For the bread of God is that which^e comes down from heaven and gives life to the world.”* ³⁴They said to him, “Sir,^f give us this bread always.”*

35 Jesus said to them, “I am the bread of life. Whoever comes to me will never be hungry, and whoever believes in me will never be thirsty.* ³⁶But I said to you that you have seen me and yet do not believe.* ³⁷Everything that the Father gives me will come to me, and anyone who comes to me I will never drive away,* ³⁸for I have come down from heaven not to do my own will but the will of him who sent me.* ³⁹And this is the will of him who sent

me, that I should lose nothing of all that he has given me but raise it up on the last day.* ⁴⁰This is indeed the will of my Father, that all who see the Son and believe in him may have eternal life, and I will raise them up on the last day.”*

41 Then the Jews began to complain about him because he said, “I am the bread that came down from heaven.” ⁴²They were saying, “Is not this Jesus, the son of Joseph, whose father and mother we know? How can he now say, ‘I have come down from heaven?’”* ⁴³Jesus answered them, “Do not complain among yourselves. ⁴⁴No one can come to me unless drawn by the Father who sent me, and I will raise that person up on the last day.* ⁴⁵It is written in the prophets, ‘And they shall all be taught by God.’ Everyone who has heard and learned from the Father comes to me.* ⁴⁶Not that anyone has seen the Father except the one who is from God; he has seen the Father.* ⁴⁷Very truly, I tell you, whoever believes has eternal life.* ⁴⁸I am the bread of life. ⁴⁹Your ancestors ate the manna in the wilderness, and they died. ⁵⁰This is the bread that comes down from heaven, so that one may eat of it and not die. ⁵¹I am the living bread that came down from heaven. Whoever eats of this bread will live forever, and the bread that I will give for the life of the world is my flesh.”*

52 The Jews then disputed among themselves, saying, “How can this man give us his flesh to eat?”* ⁵³So Jesus said to them, “Very truly, I tell you, unless you eat the flesh of the Son of Man and drink his blood, you have no life in you.* ⁵⁴Those who eat my flesh and drink my blood have eternal life, and I will raise them up on the last day,* ⁵⁵for my flesh is true food, and my blood is true drink. ⁵⁶Those who eat my flesh and drink my blood abide in me and I in them.* ⁵⁷Just as the living Father sent me and I live because of the Father, so whoever eats me will live because of me. ⁵⁸This is the bread that came down from heaven, not like that which the ancestors ate, and they died. But the one who eats this bread will live forever.” ⁵⁹He said these things while he was teaching in a synagogue at Capernaum.

THE WORDS OF ETERNAL LIFE

60 When many of his disciples heard it, they said, “This teaching is difficult; who can accept it?” ⁶¹But Jesus, being aware that his disciples were complaining about it, said to them, “Does this offend you?” ⁶²Then what if you were to see the Son of Man ascending to where he was before? ⁶³It is the spirit that gives life; the flesh is useless. The words that I have spoken to you are spirit and life. ⁶⁴But among you there are some who do not believe.” For Jesus knew from the beginning who were the ones who did not believe and who was the one who would betray him. ⁶⁵And he said, “For this reason I have told you that no one can come to me unless it is granted by the Father.”*

66 Because of this many of his disciples turned back and no longer went about with him. ⁶⁷So Jesus asked the twelve, “Do you also wish to go away?” ⁶⁸Simon Peter answered him, “Lord, to whom can we go? You have the words of eternal life. ⁶⁹We have come to believe and know that you are the Holy One of God.”^{g,*} ⁷⁰Jesus answered them, “Did I not choose you, the twelve? Yet one of you is a devil.”* ⁷¹He was speaking of Judas son of Simon Iscariot,^h for he, though one of the twelve, was going to betray him.

John 7

THE UNBELIEF OF JESUS'S BROTHERS

1 After this Jesus went about in Galilee. He did not wish to go about in Judea because the Jews were looking for an opportunity to kill him.* **2** Now the Jewish Festival of Boothsⁱ was near.* **3** So his brothers said to him, "Leave here and go to Judea so that your disciples also may see the works you are doing,* **4** for no one who wants^j to be widely known acts in secret. If you do these things, show yourself to the world." **5** (For not even his brothers believed in him.)* **6** Jesus said to them, "My time has not yet come, but your time is always here.* **7** The world cannot hate you, but it hates me because I testify against it that its works are evil.* **8** Go to the festival yourselves. I am not^k going to this festival, for my time has not yet fully come." **9** After saying this, he remained in Galilee.

JESUS AT THE FESTIVAL OF BOOTHS

10 But after his brothers had gone to the festival, then he also went, not publicly but, as it were,^l in secret. **11** The Jews were looking for him at the festival and saying, "Where is he?" **12** And there was considerable complaining about him among the crowds. While some were saying, "He is a good man," others were saying, "No, he is deceiving the crowd."* **13** Yet no one would speak openly about him for fear of the Jews.*

14 About the middle of the festival Jesus went up into the temple and began to teach. **15** The Jews were astonished at it, saying, "How does this man have such learning, when he has never been taught?"* **16** Then Jesus answered them, "My teaching is not mine but his who sent me.* **17** Anyone who resolves to do the will of God will know whether the teaching is from God or whether I am speaking on my own.* **18** Those who speak on their own seek their own glory, but the one who seeks the glory of him who sent him is true, and there is nothing unjust in him.*

19 "Did not Moses give you the law? Yet none of you keeps the law. Why are you looking for an opportunity to kill me?"* **20** The crowd

answered, “You have a demon! Who is trying to kill you?”^{* 21} Jesus answered them, “I performed one work, and all of you are astonished.²² Because of this Moses gave you circumcision (it is, of course, not from Moses but from the patriarchs), and you circumcise a man on the Sabbath.^{*} ²³ If a man receives circumcision on the Sabbath in order that the law of Moses may not be broken, are you angry with me because I healed a man’s whole body on the Sabbath?”^{*} ²⁴ Do not judge by appearances, but judge with right judgment.”^{*}

IS THIS THE CHRIST?

25 Now some of the people of Jerusalem were saying, “Is not this the man whom they are trying to kill? ²⁶ And here he is, speaking openly, but they say nothing to him! Can it be that the authorities really know that this is the Messiah?^m ²⁷ Yet we know where this man is from, but when the Messiahⁿ comes no one will know where he is from.”^{*} ²⁸ Then Jesus cried out as he was teaching in the temple, “You know me, and you know where I am from. I have not come on my own. But the one who sent me is true, and you do not know him.^{*} ²⁹ I know him because I am from him, and he sent me.”^{*} ³⁰ Then they tried to arrest him, but no one laid hands on him because his hour had not yet come.^{*} ³¹ Yet many in the crowd believed in him and were saying, “When the Messiah^o comes, will he do more signs than this man has done?”^{p,*}

OFFICERS ARE SENT TO ARREST JESUS

32 The Pharisees heard the crowd muttering such things about him, and the chief priests and Pharisees sent temple police to arrest him. ³³ Jesus then said, “I will be with you a little while longer, and then I am going to him who sent me.^{*} ³⁴ You will search for me, but you will not find me, and where I am, you cannot come.”^{*} ³⁵ The Jews said to one another, “Where does this man intend to go that we will not find him? Does he intend to go to the dispersion among the Greeks and teach the Greeks?”^{*} ³⁶ What does he mean by saying, ‘You will search for me, but you will not find me’ and ‘Where I am, you cannot come’?”

RIVERS OF LIVING WATER

37 On the last day of the festival, the great day, while Jesus was standing there, he cried out, “Let anyone who is thirsty come to me,”³⁸ and let the one who believes in me drink. As^q the scripture has said, ‘Out of the believer’s heart^r shall flow rivers of living water.’ ”³⁹ Now he said this about the Spirit, which believers in him were to receive, for as yet there was no Spirit^s because Jesus was not yet glorified.*

DIVISION AMONG THE PEOPLE

40 When they heard these words, some in the crowd said, “This is really the prophet.”⁴¹ Others said, “This is the Messiah.”^t But some asked, “Surely the Messiah^u does not come from Galilee, does he?”⁴² Has not the scripture said that the Messiah^v is descended from David and comes from Bethlehem, the village where David lived?”⁴³ So there was a division in the crowd because of him.⁴⁴ Some of them wanted to arrest him, but no one laid hands on him.

THE UNBELIEF OF THOSE IN AUTHORITY

45 Then the temple police went back to the chief priests and Pharisees, who asked them, “Why did you not arrest him?”⁴⁶ The police answered, “Never has anyone spoken like this!”⁴⁷ Then the Pharisees replied, “Surely you have not been deceived, too, have you?”⁴⁸ Has any one of the authorities or of the Pharisees believed in him?”⁴⁹ But this crowd, which does not know the law, they are accursed.”⁵⁰ Nicodemus, who had gone to Jesus^w before and who was one of them, asked,⁵¹ “Our law does not judge people without first giving them a hearing to find out what they are doing, does it?”⁵² They replied, “Surely you are not also from Galilee, are you? Search and you will see that no prophet is to arise from Galilee.”

THE WOMAN CAUGHT IN ADULTERY

[[**53** Then each of them went home,

John 8

1 while Jesus went to the Mount of Olives. **2**Early in the morning he came again to the temple. All the people came to him, and he sat down and began to teach them. **3**The scribes and the Pharisees brought a woman who had been caught in adultery, and, making her stand before all of them, **4**they said to him, “Teacher, this woman was caught in the very act of committing adultery. **5**Now in the law Moses commanded us to stone such women. Now what do you say?”* **6**They said this to test him, so that they might have some charge to bring against him. Jesus bent down and wrote with his finger on the ground. **7**When they kept on questioning him, he straightened up and said to them, “Let anyone among you who is without sin be the first to throw a stone at her.”* **8**And once again he bent down and wrote on the ground. **9**When they heard it, they went away, one by one, beginning with the elders, and Jesus was left alone with the woman standing before him.* **10**Jesus straightened up and said to her, “Woman, where are they? Has no one condemned you?” **11**She said, “No one, sir.”^x And Jesus said, “Neither do I condemn you. Go your way, and from now on do not sin again.”^{y,*}

JESUS THE LIGHT OF THE WORLD

12 Again Jesus spoke to them, saying, “I am the light of the world. Whoever follows me will never walk in darkness but will have the light of life.”* **13**Then the Pharisees said to him, “You are testifying on your own behalf; your testimony is not valid.” **14**Jesus answered, “Even if I testify on my own behalf, my testimony is valid because I know where I have come from and where I am going, but you do not know where I come from or where I am going. **15**You judge by human standards;^z I judge no one. **16**Yet even if I do judge, my judgment is valid, for it is not I alone who judge but I and the Father^a who sent me. **17**In your law it is written that the testimony of two witnesses is valid.* **18**I testify on my own behalf, and the Father who sent me testifies on my behalf.”* **19**Then they said to him, “Where is your Father?” Jesus answered, “You know neither me nor my Father. If you knew me, you would know my Father also.”* **20**He spoke these words while

he was teaching in the treasury of the temple, but no one arrested him, because his hour had not yet come.*

JESUS FORETELLS HIS DEATH

21 Again he said to them, “I am going away, and you will search for me, but you will die in your sin. Where I am going, you cannot come.”* ²²Then the Jews said, “Is he going to kill himself? Is that what he means by saying, ‘Where I am going, you cannot come’?” ²³He said to them, “You are from below, I am from above; you are from this world, I am not from this world.* ²⁴I told you that you would die in your sins, for you will die in your sins unless you believe that I am he.”* ²⁵They said to him, “Who are you?” Jesus said to them, “Why do I speak to you at all?”* ²⁶I have much to say about you and much to condemn, but the one who sent me is true, and I declare to the world what I have heard from him.”* ²⁷They did not understand that he was speaking to them about the Father. ²⁸So Jesus said, “When you have lifted up the Son of Man, then you will realize that I am he^d and that I do nothing on my own, but I speak these things as the Father instructed me.* ²⁹And the one who sent me is with me; he has not left me alone, for I always do what is pleasing to him.”* ³⁰As he was saying these things, many believed in him.

TRUE DISCIPLES

31 Then Jesus said to the Jews who had believed in him, “If you continue in my word, you are truly my disciples, ³²and you will know the truth, and the truth will make you free.”* ³³They answered him, “We are descendants of Abraham and have never been slaves to anyone. What do you mean by saying, ‘You will be made free’?”*

34 Jesus answered them, “Very truly, I tell you, everyone who commits sin is a slave to sin.* ³⁵The slave does not have a permanent place in the household; the son has a place there forever.* ³⁶So if the Son makes you free, you will be free indeed. ³⁷I know that you are descendants of Abraham, yet you look for an opportunity to kill me because there is no place in you for my word. ³⁸I declare what I have seen in the Father’s

presence; as for you, you should do what you have heard from the Father.”^{e,*}

JESUS AND ABRAHAM

39 They answered him, “Abraham is our father.” Jesus said to them, “If you are Abraham’s children, you would do^f what Abraham did,^{*} ⁴⁰but now you are trying to kill me, a man who has told you the truth that I heard from God. This is not what Abraham did. ⁴¹You are indeed doing what your father does.” They said to him, “We are not illegitimate children; we have one Father, God himself.”^{*} ⁴²Jesus said to them, “If God were your Father, you would love me, for I came from God, and now I am here. I did not come on my own, but he sent me.”^{*} ⁴³Why do you not understand what I say? It is because you cannot accept my word. ⁴⁴You are from your father the devil, and you choose to do your father’s desires. He was a murderer from the beginning and does not stand in the truth because there is no truth in him. When he lies, he speaks according to his own nature, for he is a liar and the father of lies.^{*} ⁴⁵But because I tell the truth, you do not believe me.^g ⁴⁶Which of you convicts me of sin? If I tell the truth, why do you not believe me? ⁴⁷Whoever is from God hears the words of God. The reason you do not hear them is that you are not from God.”^{*}

48 The Jews answered him, “Are we not right in saying that you are a Samaritan and have a demon?”^{*} ⁴⁹Jesus answered, “I do not have a demon, but I honor my Father, and you dishonor me. ⁵⁰Yet I do not seek my own glory; there is one who seeks it, and he is the judge.”^{*} ⁵¹Very truly, I tell you, whoever keeps my word will never see death.”^{*} ⁵²The Jews said to him, “Now we know that you have a demon. Abraham died, and so did the prophets, yet you say, ‘Whoever keeps my word will never taste death.’”^{*} ⁵³Are you greater than our father Abraham, who died? The prophets also died. Who do you claim to be?”^{*} ⁵⁴Jesus answered, “If I glorify myself, my glory is nothing. It is my Father who glorifies me, he of whom you say, ‘He is our God,’”^{*} ⁵⁵though you do not know him. But I know him; if I would say that I do not know him, I would be a liar like you. But I do know him, and I keep his word.”^{*} ⁵⁶Your ancestor Abraham rejoiced that he would see my day; he saw it and was glad.”^{*} ⁵⁷Then the Jews said to him, “You are

not yet fifty years old, and have you seen Abraham?”^h 58 Jesus said to them,
“Very truly, I tell you, before Abraham was, I am.”^{*} 59 So they picked up
stones to throw at him, but Jesus hid himself and went out of the temple.^{*}

John 9

A MAN BORN BLIND RECEIVES SIGHT

1 As he walked along, he saw a man blind from birth. **2** His disciples asked him, “Rabbi, who sinned, this man or his parents, that he was born blind?” **3** Jesus answered, “Neither this man nor his parents sinned; he was born blind so that God’s works might be revealed in him.” **4** Weⁱ must work the works of him who sent me^j while it is day; night is coming, when no one can work.* **5** As long as I am in the world, I am the light of the world.”* **6** When he had said this, he spat on the ground and made mud with the saliva and spread the mud on the man’s eyes,* **7** saying to him, “Go, wash in the pool of Siloam” (which means Sent). Then he went and washed and came back able to see.* **8** The neighbors and those who had seen him before as a beggar began to ask, “Is this not the man who used to sit and beg?” **9** Some were saying, “It is he.” Others were saying, “No, but it is someone like him.” He kept saying, “I am he.” **10** But they kept asking him, “Then how were your eyes opened?” **11** He answered, “The man called Jesus made mud, spread it on my eyes, and said to me, ‘Go to Siloam and wash.’ Then I went and washed and received my sight.” **12** They said to him, “Where is he?” He said, “I do not know.”

THE PHARISEES INVESTIGATE THE HEALING

13 They brought to the Pharisees the man who had formerly been blind. **14** Now it was a Sabbath day when Jesus made the mud and opened his eyes.* **15** Then the Pharisees also began to ask him how he had received his sight. He said to them, “He put mud on my eyes. Then I washed, and now I see.” **16** Some of the Pharisees said, “This man is not from God, for he does not observe the Sabbath.” Others said, “How can a man who is a sinner perform such signs?” And they were divided.* **17** So they said again to the blind man, “What do you say about him? It was your eyes he opened.” He said, “He is a prophet.”*

18 The Jews did not believe that he had been blind and had received his sight until they called the parents of the man who had received his sight¹⁹ and asked them, “Is this your son, who you say was born blind? How then does he now see?”²⁰ His parents answered, “We know that this is our son and that he was born blind,²¹ but we do not know how it is that now he sees, nor do we know who opened his eyes. Ask him; he is of age. He will speak for himself.”²² His parents said this because they were afraid of the Jews, for the Jews had already agreed that anyone who confessed Jesus^k to be the Messiah^l would be put out of the synagogue.*²³ Therefore his parents said, “He is of age; ask him.”

24 So for the second time they called the man who had been blind, and they said to him, “Give glory to God! We know that this man is a sinner.”*²⁵ He answered, “I do not know whether he is a sinner. One thing I do know, that though I was blind, now I see.”²⁶ They said to him, “What did he do to you? How did he open your eyes?”²⁷ He answered them, “I have told you already, and you would not listen. Why do you want to hear it again? Do you also want to become his disciples?”²⁸ Then they reviled him, saying, “You are his disciple, but we are disciples of Moses.*²⁹ We know that God has spoken to Moses, but as for this man, we do not know where he comes from.”*³⁰ The man answered, “Here is an astonishing thing! You do not know where he comes from, yet he opened my eyes.³¹ We know that God does not listen to sinners, but he does listen to one who worships him and obeys his will.*³² Never since the world began has it been heard that anyone opened the eyes of a person born blind.³³ If this man were not from God, he could do nothing.”³⁴ They answered him, “You were born entirely in sins, and are you trying to teach us?” And they drove him out.

SPIRITUAL BLINDNESS

35 Jesus heard that they had driven him out, and when he found him he said, “Do you believe in the Son of Man?”^{m,*}³⁶ He answered, “And who is he, sir?ⁿ Tell me, so that I may believe in him.”*³⁷ Jesus said to him, “You have seen him, and the one speaking with you is he.”*³⁸ He said, “Lord,^o I believe.” And he worshiped him.³⁹ Jesus said, “I came into this world for judgment, so that those who do not see may see and those who do see may

become blind.”* ⁴⁰Some of the Pharisees who were with him heard this and said to him, “Surely we are not blind, are we?”* ⁴¹Jesus said to them, “If you were blind, you would not have sin. But now that you say, ‘We see,’ your sin remains.*

John 10

JESUS THE GOOD SHEPHERD

1 “Very truly, I tell you, anyone who does not enter the sheepfold by the gate but climbs in by another way is a thief and a bandit. **2**The one who enters by the gate is the shepherd of the sheep.* **3**The gatekeeper opens the gate for him, and the sheep hear his voice. He calls his own sheep by name and leads them out. **4**When he has brought out all his own, he goes ahead of them, and the sheep follow him because they know his voice. **5**They will not follow a stranger, but they will run from him because they do not know the voice of strangers.” **6**Jesus used this figure of speech with them, but they did not understand what he was saying to them.

7 So again Jesus said to them, “Very truly, I tell you, I am the gate for the sheep. **8**All who came before me^p are thieves and bandits, but the sheep did not listen to them. **9**I am the gate. Whoever enters by me will be saved and will come in and go out and find pasture. **10**The thief comes only to steal and kill and destroy. I came that they may have life and have it abundantly.*

11 “I am the good shepherd. The good shepherd lays down his life for the sheep.* **12**The hired hand, who is not the shepherd and does not own the sheep, sees the wolf coming and leaves the sheep and runs away, and the wolf snatches them and scatters them.* **13**The hired hand runs away because a hired hand does not care for the sheep. **14**I am the good shepherd. I know my own, and my own know me, **15**just as the Father knows me, and I know the Father. And I lay down my life for the sheep. **16**I have other sheep that do not belong to this fold. I must bring them also, and they will listen to my voice. So there will be one flock, one shepherd.* **17**For this reason the Father loves me, because I lay down my life in order to take it up again. **18**No one takes^q it from me, but I lay it down of my own accord. I have power to lay it down, and I have power to take it up again. I have received this command from my Father.”

19 Again the Jews were divided because of these words.* **20**Many of them were saying, “He has a demon and is out of his mind. Why listen to

him?”* ²¹Others were saying, “These are not the words of one who has a demon. Can a demon open the eyes of the blind?”*

JESUS IS REJECTED BY THE JEWS

22 At that time the Festival of the Dedication took place in Jerusalem. It was winter, ²³and Jesus was walking in the temple, in the portico of Solomon.* ²⁴So the Jews gathered around him and said to him, “How long will you keep us in suspense? If you are the Messiah,^r tell us plainly.” ²⁵Jesus answered, “I have told you, and you do not believe. The works that I do in my Father’s name testify to me,* ²⁶but you do not believe because you do not belong to my sheep.* ²⁷My sheep hear my voice. I know them, and they follow me.* ²⁸I give them eternal life, and they will never perish. No one will snatch them out of my hand.* ²⁹My Father, in regard to what he has given me, is greater than all,^s and no one can snatch them out of the Father’s hand.* ³⁰The Father and I are one.”

31 The Jews took up stones again to stone him. ³²Jesus replied, “I have shown you many good works from the Father. For which of these are you going to stone me?” ³³The Jews answered, “It is not for a good work that we are going to stone you but for blasphemy, because you, though only a human, are making yourself God.”* ³⁴Jesus answered, “Is it not written in your law,^t ‘I said, you are gods’?”* ³⁵If those to whom the word of God came were called ‘gods’—and the scripture cannot be annulled—³⁶can you say that the one whom the Father has sanctified and sent into the world is blaspheming because I said, ‘I am God’s Son’?”* ³⁷If I am not doing the works of my Father, then do not believe me.* ³⁸But if I do them, even though you do not believe me, believe the works, so that you may know and understand^u that the Father is in me and I am in the Father.”* ³⁹Then they tried to arrest him again, but he escaped from their hands.*

40 He went away again across the Jordan to the place where John had been baptizing earlier, and he remained there. ⁴¹Many came to him, and they were saying, “John performed no sign, but everything that John said about this man was true.”* ⁴²And many believed in him there.*

John 11

THE DEATH OF LAZARUS

1 Now a certain man was ill, Lazarus of Bethany, the village of Mary and her sister Martha. ^{*} **2** Mary was the one who anointed the Lord with perfume and wiped his feet with her hair; her brother Lazarus was ill. ^{*} **3** So the sisters sent a message to Jesus, ^v “Lord, he whom you love is ill.” **4** But when Jesus heard it, he said, “This illness does not lead to death; rather, it is for God’s glory, so that the Son of God may be glorified through it.” ^{*} **5** Accordingly, though Jesus loved Martha and her sister and Lazarus, ⁶ after having heard that Lazarus ^w was ill, he stayed two days longer in the place where he was.

7 Then after this he said to the disciples, “Let us go to Judea again.” ^{*} **8** The disciples said to him, “Rabbi, the Jews were just now trying to stone you, and are you going there again?” ^{*} **9** Jesus answered, “Are there not twelve hours of daylight? Those who walk during the day do not stumble because they see the light of this world. ¹⁰ But those who walk at night stumble because the light is not in them.” **11** After saying this, he told them, “Our friend Lazarus has fallen asleep, but I am going there to awaken him.” **12** The disciples said to him, “Lord, if he has fallen asleep, he will be all right.” ^x **13** Jesus, however, had been speaking about his death, but they thought that he was referring merely to sleep. **14** Then Jesus told them plainly, “Lazarus is dead. ¹⁵ For your sake I am glad I was not there, so that you may believe. But let us go to him.” **16** Thomas, who was called the Twin, ^y said to his fellow disciples, “Let us also go, that we may die with him.”

JESUS THE RESURRECTION AND THE LIFE

17 When Jesus arrived, he found that Lazarus ^z had already been in the tomb four days. **18** Now Bethany was near Jerusalem, some two miles away, **19** and many of the Jews had come to Martha and Mary to console them about their brother. ^{*} **20** When Martha heard that Jesus was coming, she went and met him, while Mary stayed at home. **21** Martha said to Jesus, “Lord, if

you had been here, my brother would not have died.²² But even now I know that God will give you whatever you ask of him.”^{*} ²³Jesus said to her, “Your brother will rise again.” ²⁴Martha said to him, “I know that he will rise again in the resurrection on the last day.”^{*} ²⁵Jesus said to her, “I am the resurrection and the life.^a Those who believe in me, even though they die, will live,^{*} ²⁶and everyone who lives and believes in me will never die. Do you believe this?” ²⁷She said to him, “Yes, Lord, I believe that you are the Messiah,^b the Son of God, the one coming into the world.”^{*}

JESUS WEEPS

28 When she had said this, she went back and called her sister Mary and told her privately, “The Teacher is here and is calling for you.” ²⁹And when she heard it, she got up quickly and went to him. ³⁰Now Jesus had not yet come to the village but was still at the place where Martha had met him. ³¹The Jews who were with her in the house consoling her saw Mary get up quickly and go out. They followed her because they thought that she was going to the tomb to weep there. ³²When Mary came where Jesus was and saw him, she knelt at his feet and said to him, “Lord, if you had been here, my brother would not have died.”^{*} ³³When Jesus saw her weeping and the Jews who came with her also weeping, he was greatly disturbed in spirit and deeply moved. ³⁴He said, “Where have you laid him?” They said to him, “Lord, come and see.” ³⁵Jesus began to weep.^{*} ³⁶So the Jews said, “See how he loved him!” ³⁷But some of them said, “Could not he who opened the eyes of the blind man have kept this man from dying?”^{*}

JESUS RAISES LAZARUS TO LIFE

38 Then Jesus, again greatly disturbed, came to the tomb. It was a cave, and a stone was lying against it.^{*} ³⁹Jesus said, “Take away the stone.” Martha, the sister of the dead man, said to him, “Lord, already there is a stench because he has been dead four days.”^{*} ⁴⁰Jesus said to her, “Did I not tell you that if you believed you would see the glory of God?”^{*} ⁴¹So they took away the stone. And Jesus looked upward and said, “Father, I thank you for having heard me.”^{*} ⁴²I knew that you always hear me, but I have said this for the sake of the crowd standing here, so that they may believe that

you sent me.”* ⁴³When he had said this, he cried with a loud voice, “Lazarus, come out!” ⁴⁴The dead man came out, his hands and feet bound with strips of cloth and his face wrapped in a cloth. Jesus said to them, “Unbind him, and let him go.”*

THE PLOT TO KILL JESUS

45 Many of the Jews, therefore, who had come with Mary and had seen what Jesus did believed in him.* ⁴⁶But some of them went to the Pharisees and told them what Jesus had done. ⁴⁷So the chief priests and the Pharisees called a meeting of the council and said, “What are we to do? This man is performing many signs.* ⁴⁸If we let him go on like this, everyone will believe in him, and the Romans will come and destroy both our holy place^c and our nation.” ⁴⁹But one of them, Caiaphas, who was high priest that year, said to them, “You know nothing at all!* ⁵⁰You do not understand that it is better for you to have one man die for the people than to have the whole nation destroyed.”* ⁵¹He did not say this on his own, but being high priest that year he prophesied that Jesus was about to die for the nation, ⁵²and not for the nation only, but to gather into one the dispersed children of God. ⁵³So from that day on they planned to put him to death.*

54 Jesus therefore no longer walked about openly among the Jews but went from there to a town called Ephraim in the region near the wilderness, and he remained there with the disciples.*

55 Now the Passover of the Jews was near, and many went up from the country to Jerusalem before the Passover to purify themselves.* ⁵⁶They were looking for Jesus and were asking one another as they stood in the temple, “What do you think? Surely he will not come to the festival, will he?” ⁵⁷Now the chief priests and the Pharisees had given orders that anyone who knew where Jesus^d was should let them know, so that they might arrest him.

John 12

MARY ANOINTS JESUS

1 Six days before the Passover Jesus came to Bethany, the home of Lazarus, whom he had raised from the dead.* **2**There they gave a dinner for him. Martha served, and Lazarus was one of those reclining with him.* **3**Mary took a pound of costly perfume made of pure nard, anointed Jesus's feet, and wiped them^e with her hair. The house was filled with the fragrance of the perfume.* **4**But Judas Iscariot, one of his disciples (the one who was about to betray him), said, **5**"Why was this perfume not sold for three hundred denarii and the money given to the poor?" **6**(He said this not because he cared about the poor but because he was a thief; he kept the common purse and used to steal what was put into it.) **7**Jesus said, "Leave her alone. She bought it^f so that she might keep it for the day of my burial.* **8**You always have the poor with you, but you do not always have me."*

THE PLOT TO KILL LAZARUS

9 When the great crowd of the Jews learned that he was there, they came not only because of Jesus but also to see Lazarus, whom he had raised from the dead. **10**So the chief priests planned to put Lazarus to death as well, **11**since it was on account of him that many of the Jews were deserting and were believing in Jesus.*

JESUS'S TRIUMPHAL ENTRY INTO JERUSALEM

12 The next day the great crowd that had come to the festival heard that Jesus was coming to Jerusalem. **13**So they took branches of palm trees and went out to meet him, shouting,

"Hosanna!

Blessed is the one who comes in the name of the Lord—
the King of Israel!"*

14Jesus found a young donkey and sat on it, as it is written:

¹⁵“Do not be afraid, daughter of Zion.

Look, your king is coming,

sitting on a donkey’s colt!”*

¹⁶His disciples did not understand these things at first, but when Jesus was glorified, then they remembered that these things had been written of him and had been done to him.* ¹⁷So the crowd that had been with him when he called Lazarus out of the tomb and raised him from the dead continued to testify.^g ¹⁸It was also because they heard that he had performed this sign that the crowd went to meet him. ¹⁹The Pharisees then said to one another, “You see, you can do nothing. Look, the world has gone after him!”*

SOME GREEKS WISH TO SEE JESUS

20 Now among those who went up to worship at the festival were some Greeks.* ²¹They came to Philip, who was from Bethsaida in Galilee, and said to him, “Sir, we wish to see Jesus.” ²²Philip went and told Andrew, then Andrew and Philip went and told Jesus. ²³Jesus answered them, “The hour has come for the Son of Man to be glorified.* ²⁴Very truly, I tell you, unless a grain of wheat falls into the earth and dies, it remains just a single grain, but if it dies it bears much fruit. ²⁵Those who love their life lose it, and those who hate their life in this world will keep it for eternal life.* ²⁶Whoever serves me must follow me, and where I am, there will my servant be also. Whoever serves me, the Father will honor.*

JESUS SPEAKS ABOUT HIS DEATH

27 “Now my soul is troubled. And what should I say: ‘Father, save me from this hour’? No, it is for this reason that I have come to this hour.* ²⁸Father, glorify your name.” Then a voice came from heaven, “I have glorified it, and I will glorify it again.”* ²⁹The crowd standing there heard it and said that it was thunder. Others said, “An angel has spoken to him.” ³⁰Jesus answered, “This voice has come for your sake, not for mine. ³¹Now is the judgment of this world; now the ruler of this world will be driven out.* ³²And I, when I am lifted up from the earth, will draw all people^h to myself.”* ³³He said this to indicate the kind of death he was to die. ³⁴The

crowd answered him, “We have heard from the law that the Messiahⁱ remains forever. How can you say that the Son of Man must be lifted up? Who is this Son of Man?”^{*} ³⁵Jesus said to them, “The light is in you^j for a little longer. Walk while you have the light, so that the darkness may not overtake you. If you walk in the darkness, you do not know where you are going. ³⁶While you have the light, believe in the light, so that you may become children of light.”

THE UNBELIEF OF THE PEOPLE

After Jesus had said this, he departed and hid from them.^{*} ³⁷Although he had performed so many signs in their presence, they did not believe in him. ³⁸This was to fulfill the word spoken by the prophet Isaiah:

“Lord, who has believed our message,
and to whom has the arm of the Lord been revealed?”^{*}

³⁹And so they could not believe, because Isaiah also said,

⁴⁰“He has blinded their eyes
and hardened their heart,
so that they might not look with their eyes
and understand with their heart and turn —
and I would heal them.”^{*}

⁴¹Isaiah said this because^k he saw his glory and spoke about him.^{*}

⁴²Nevertheless many, even of the authorities, believed in him. But because of the Pharisees they did not confess it, for fear that they would be put out of the synagogue,^{*} ⁴³for they loved human glory more than the glory that comes from God.

SUMMARY OF JESUS’S TEACHING

44 Then Jesus cried aloud: “Whoever believes in me believes not in me but in him who sent me.^{*} ⁴⁵And whoever sees me sees him who sent me.^{*} ⁴⁶I have come as light into the world, so that everyone who believes in me should not remain in the darkness.^{*} ⁴⁷I do not judge anyone who hears my words and does not keep them, for I came not to judge the world but to save

the world.* ⁴⁸The one who rejects me and does not receive my words has a judge; on the last day the word that I have spoken will serve as judge,* ⁴⁹for I have not spoken on my own, but the Father who sent me has himself given me a commandment about what to say and what to speak. ⁵⁰And I know that his commandment is eternal life. What I speak, therefore, I speak just as the Father has told me.”

John 13

JESUS WASHES THE DISCIPLES' FEET

1 Now before the festival of the Passover, Jesus knew that his hour had come to depart from this world and go to the Father. Having loved his own who were in the world, he loved them to the end.* **2** The devil had already decided¹ that Judas son of Simon Iscariot would betray Jesus. And during supper* **3** Jesus, knowing that the Father had given all things into his hands and that he had come from God and was going to God,* **4** got up from supper, took off his outer robe, and tied a towel around himself.* **5** Then he poured water into a basin and began to wash the disciples' feet and to wipe them with the towel that was tied around him. **6** He came to Simon Peter, who said to him, "Lord, are you going to wash my feet?" **7** Jesus answered, "You do not know now what I am doing, but later you will understand." **8** Peter said to him, "You will never wash my feet." Jesus answered, "Unless I wash you, you have no share with me."* **9** Simon Peter said to him, "Lord, not my feet only but also my hands and my head!" **10** Jesus said to him, "One who has bathed does not need to wash, except for the feet,^m but is entirely clean. And youⁿ are clean, though not all of you." **11** For he knew who was to betray him; for this reason he said, "Not all of you are clean."*

12 After he had washed their feet, had put on his robe, and had reclined again, he said to them, "Do you know what I have done to you? **13** You call me Teacher and Lord, and you are right, for that is what I am.* **14** So if I, your Lord and Teacher, have washed your feet, you also ought to wash one another's feet.* **15** For I have set you an example, that you also should do as I have done to you.* **16** Very truly, I tell you, slaves are not greater than their master, nor are messengers^o greater than the one who sent them.* **17** If you know these things, you are blessed if you do them. **18** I am not speaking of all of you; I know whom I have chosen. But it is to fulfill the scripture, 'The one who ate my bread^p has lifted his heel against me.'* **19** I tell you this now, before it occurs, so that when it does occur you may believe that I am he.^{q,*} **20** Very truly, I tell you, whoever receives one whom I send receives me, and whoever receives me receives him who sent me."*

JESUS FORETELLS HIS BETRAYAL

21 After saying this Jesus was troubled in spirit and declared, “Very truly, I tell you, one of you will betray me.”* ²²The disciples looked at one another, uncertain of whom he was speaking. ²³One of his disciples—the one whom Jesus loved—was reclining close to his heart,^{r,*} ²⁴Simon Peter therefore motioned to him to ask Jesus of whom he was speaking. ²⁵So while reclining next to Jesus, he asked him, “Lord, who is it?”* ²⁶Jesus answered, “It is the one to whom I give this piece of bread when I have dipped it in the dish.”^s So when he had dipped the piece of bread, he gave it to Judas son of Simon Iscariot.^{t,*} ²⁷After he received the piece of bread, Satan entered into him. Jesus said to him, “Do quickly what you are going to do.”* ²⁸Now no one knew why he said this to him. ²⁹Some thought that, because Judas had the common purse, Jesus was telling him, “Buy what we need for the festival,” or that he should give something to the poor. ³⁰So, after receiving the piece of bread, he immediately went out. And it was night.

THE NEW COMMANDMENT

31 When he had gone out, Jesus said, “Now the Son of Man has been glorified, and God has been glorified in him.”* ³²If God has been glorified in him,^u God will also glorify him in himself and will glorify him at once. ³³Little children, I am with you only a little longer. You will look for me, and as I said to the Jews so now I say to you, ‘Where I am going, you cannot come.’* ³⁴I give you a new commandment, that you love one another. Just as I have loved you, you also should love one another.* ³⁵By this everyone will know that you are my disciples, if you have love for one another.”*

JESUS FORETELLS PETER’S DENIAL

36 Simon Peter said to him, “Lord, where are you going?” Jesus answered, “Where I am going, you cannot follow me now, but you will follow afterward.”* ³⁷Peter said to him, “Lord, why can I not follow you now? I will lay down my life for you.”* ³⁸Jesus answered, “Will you lay

down your life for me? Very truly, I tell you, before the cock crows, you will have denied me three times.

John 14

JESUS THE WAY TO THE FATHER

1 “Do not let your hearts be troubled. Believe^v in God; believe also in me.*
²In my Father’s house there are many dwelling places. If it were not so, would I have told you that I go to prepare a place for you?^w ³And if I go and prepare a place for you, I will come again and will take you to myself, so that where I am, there you may be also.* ⁴And you know the way to the place where I am going.”^x ⁵Thomas said to him, “Lord, we do not know where you are going. How can we know the way?” ⁶Jesus said to him, “I am the way and the truth and the life. No one comes to the Father except through me.* ⁷If you know me, you will know^y my Father also. From now on you do know him and have seen him.”

8 Philip said to him, “Lord, show us the Father, and we will be satisfied.”
⁹Jesus said to him, “Have I been with you all this time, Philip, and you still do not know me? Whoever has seen me has seen the Father. How can you say, ‘Show us the Father’?*” ¹⁰Do you not believe that I am in the Father and the Father is in me? The words that I say to you I do not speak on my own, but the Father who dwells in me does his works.* ¹¹Believe me that I am in the Father and the Father is in me, but if you do not, then believe^z because of the works themselves.* ¹²Very truly, I tell you, the one who believes in me will also do the works that I do and, in fact, will do greater works than these, because I am going to the Father. ¹³I will do whatever you ask in my name, so that the Father may be glorified in the Son. ¹⁴If in my name you ask me^a for anything, I will do it.

THE PROMISE OF THE HOLY SPIRIT

15 “If you love me, you will keep^b my commandments.* ¹⁶And I will ask the Father, and he will give you another Advocate,^c to be with you forever.*
¹⁷This is the Spirit of truth, whom the world cannot receive because it neither sees him nor knows him. You know him because he abides with you, and he will be^d in^e you.*

18 “I will not leave you orphaned; I am coming to you. ¹⁹In a little while the world will no longer see me, but you will see me; because I live, you also will live. ²⁰On that day you will know that I am in my Father, and you in me, and I in you.* ²¹They who have my commandments and keep them are those who love me, and those who love me will be loved by my Father, and I will love them and reveal myself to them.”* ²²Judas (not Iscariot) said to him, “Lord, how is it that you will reveal yourself to us and not to the world?” ²³Jesus answered him, “Those who love me will keep my word, and my Father will love them, and we will come to them and make our home with them.* ²⁴Whoever does not love me does not keep my words, and the word that you hear is not mine but is from the Father who sent me.*

25 “I have said these things to you while I am still with you. ²⁶But the Advocate,^f the Holy Spirit, whom the Father will send in my name, will teach you everything and remind you of all that I have said to you.* ²⁷Peace I leave with you; my peace I give to you. I do not give to you as the world gives. Do not let your hearts be troubled, and do not let them be afraid.* ²⁸You heard me say to you, ‘I am going away, and I am coming to you.’ If you loved me, you would rejoice that I am going to the Father, because the Father is greater than I.* ²⁹And now I have told you this before it occurs, so that when it does occur you may believe. ³⁰I will no longer talk much with you, for the ruler of this world is coming. He has no power over me,* ³¹but I do as the Father has commanded me, so that the world may know that I love the Father. Rise, let us be on our way.*

John 15

JESUS THE TRUE VINE

1 “I am the true vine, and my Father is the vinegrower. **2**He removes every branch in me that bears no fruit. Every branch that bears fruit he prunes^g to make it bear more fruit. **3**You have already been cleansed^h by the word that I have spoken to you.* **4**Abide in me as I abide in you. Just as the branch cannot bear fruit by itself unless it abides in the vine, neither can you unless you abide in me.* **5**I am the vine; you are the branches. Those who abide in me and I in them bear much fruit, because apart from me you can do nothing. **6**Whoever does not abide in me is thrown away like a branch and withers; such branches are gathered, thrown into the fire, and burned. **7**If you abide in me and my words abide in you, ask for whatever you wish, and it will be done for you.* **8**My Father is glorified by this, that you bear much fruit and becomeⁱ my disciples.* **9**As the Father has loved me, so I have loved you; abide in my love. **10**If you keep my commandments, you will abide in my love, just as I have kept my Father’s commandments and abide in his love.* **11**I have said these things to you so that my joy may be in you and that your joy may be complete.*

12 “This is my commandment, that you love one another as I have loved you.* **13**No one has greater love than this, to lay down one’s life for one’s friends.* **14**You are my friends if you do what I command you.* **15**I do not call you servants^j any longer, because the servant^k does not know what the master is doing, but I have called you friends, because I have made known to you everything that I have heard from my Father. **16**You did not choose me, but I chose you. And I appointed you to go and bear fruit, fruit that will last, so that the Father will give you whatever you ask him in my name.* **17**I am giving you these commands so that you may love one another.

THE WORLD’S HATRED

18 “If the world hates you, be aware that it hated me before it hated you.* **19**If you belonged to the world, the world would love you as its own.

Because you do not belong to the world, but I have chosen you out of the world, therefore the world hates you. ²⁰Remember the word that I said to you, ‘Slaves are not greater than their master.’ If they persecuted me, they will persecute you; if they kept my word, they will keep yours also. ²¹But they will do all these things to you on account of my name, because they do not know him who sent me. ²²If I had not come and spoken to them, they would not have sin, but now they have no excuse for their sin. ²³Whoever hates me hates my Father also. ²⁴If I had not done among them the works that no one else did, they would not have sin. But now they have seen and hated both me and my Father. ²⁵It was to fulfill the word that is written in their law, ‘They hated me without a cause.’^{*}

26 “When the Advocate¹ comes, whom I will send to you from the Father, the Spirit of truth who comes from the Father, he will testify on my behalf. ²⁷You also are to testify, because you have been with me from the beginning.^{*}

John 16

1 “I have said these things to you to keep you from falling away.^{m,*} 2 They will put you out of the synagogues. Indeed, an hour is coming when those who kill you will think that by doing so they are offering worship to God.* 3 And they will do this because they have not known the Father or me.* 4 But I have said these things to you so that when their hour comes you may remember that I told you about them.

THE WORK OF THE SPIRIT

“I did not say these things to you from the beginning, because I was with you. 5 But now I am going to him who sent me, yet none of you asks me, ‘Where are you going?’* 6 But because I have said these things to you, sorrow has filled your hearts. 7 Nevertheless, I tell you the truth: it is to your advantage that I go away, for if I do not go away, the Advocateⁿ will not come to you, but if I go, I will send him to you. 8 And when he comes, he will prove the world wrong about^o sin and righteousness and judgment: 9 about sin, because they do not believe in me; 10 about righteousness, because I am going to the Father, and you will see me no longer; 11 about judgment, because the ruler of this world has been condemned.*

12 “I still have many things to say to you, but you cannot bear them now.* 13 When the Spirit of truth comes, he will guide you into all the truth, for he will not speak on his own but will speak whatever he hears, and he will declare to you the things that are to come.* 14 He will glorify me because he will take what is mine and declare it to you. 15 All that the Father has is mine. For this reason I said that he will take what is mine and declare it to you.*

SORROW WILL TURN INTO JOY

16 “A little while, and you will no longer see me, and again a little while, and you will see me.”* 17 Then some of his disciples said to one another, “What does he mean by saying to us, ‘A little while, and you will no longer

see me, and again a little while, and you will see me,' and 'because I am going to the Father'?" ¹⁸They said, "What does he mean by this 'a little while'? We do not know what he is talking about." ¹⁹Jesus knew that they wanted to ask him, so he said to them, "Are you discussing among yourselves what I meant when I said, 'A little while, and you will no longer see me, and again a little while, and you will see me'? ²⁰Very truly, I tell you, you will weep and mourn, but the world will rejoice; you will have pain, but your pain will turn into joy. ²¹When a woman is in labor, she has pain because her hour has come. But when her child is born, she no longer remembers the anguish because of the joy of having brought a human being into the world.* ²²So you have pain now, but I will see you again, and your hearts will rejoice, and no one will take your joy from you.* ²³On that day you will ask nothing of me.^p Very truly, I tell you, if you ask anything of the Father in my name, he will give it to you.^q ²⁴Until now you have not asked for anything in my name. Ask and you will receive, so that your joy may be complete.*

PEACE FOR THE DISCIPLES

25 "I have said these things to you in figures of speech. The hour is coming when I will no longer speak to you in figures but will tell you plainly of the Father. ²⁶On that day you will ask in my name. I do not say to you that I will ask the Father on your behalf, ²⁷for the Father himself loves you because you have loved me and have believed that I came from God.^{r,*} ²⁸I came from the Father and have come into the world; again, I am leaving the world and am going to the Father."^{*}

29 His disciples said, "Yes, now you are speaking plainly, not in any figure of speech! ³⁰Now we know that you know all things and do not need to have anyone question you; by this we believe that you came from God."^{*} ³¹Jesus answered them, "Do you now believe? ³²The hour is coming, indeed it has come, when you will be scattered, each one to his home, and you will leave me alone. Yet I am not alone because the Father is with me.* ³³I have said this to you so that in me you may have peace. In the world you face persecution, but take courage: I have conquered the world!"^{*}

John 17

JESUS PRAYS FOR HIS DISCIPLES

1 After Jesus had spoken these words, he looked up to heaven and said, “Father, the hour has come; glorify your Son so that the Son may glorify you,* ²since you have given him authority over all people,^s to give eternal life to all whom you have given him.* ³And this is eternal life, that they may know you, the only true God, and Jesus Christ, whom you have sent.* ⁴I glorified you on earth by finishing the work that you gave me to do.* ⁵So now, Father, glorify me in your own presence with the glory that I had in your presence before the world existed.*

6 “I have made your name known to those whom you gave me from the world. They were yours, and you gave them to me, and they have kept your word.* ⁷Now they know that everything you have given me is from you,⁸ for the words that you gave to me I have given to them, and they have received them and know in truth that I came from you, and they have believed that you sent me.* ⁹I am asking on their behalf; I am not asking on behalf of the world but on behalf of those whom you gave me, because they are yours.* ¹⁰All mine are yours, and yours are mine, and I have been glorified in them.* ¹¹And now I am no longer in the world, but they are in the world, and I am coming to you. Holy Father, protect them in your name that you have given me, so that they may be one, as we are one.* ¹²While I was with them, I protected them in your name that^t you have given me. I guarded them, and not one of them was lost except the one destined to be lost,^u so that the scripture might be fulfilled.* ¹³But now I am coming to you, and I speak these things in the world so that they may have my joy made complete in themselves.^v ¹⁴I have given them your word, and the world has hated them because they do not belong to the world, just as I do not belong to the world.* ¹⁵I am not asking you to take them out of the world, but I ask you to protect them from the evil one.^{w,*} ¹⁶They do not belong to the world, just as I do not belong to the world. ¹⁷Sanctify them in the truth; your word is truth. ¹⁸As you have sent me into the world, so I

have sent them into the world.* ¹⁹And for their sakes I sanctify myself, so that they also may be sanctified in truth.

20 “I ask not only on behalf of these but also on behalf of those who believe in me through their word, ²¹that they may all be one. As you, Father, are in me and I am in you, may they also be in us,* ²²so that the world may believe that you have sent me.* ²³The glory that you have given me I have given them, so that they may be one, as we are one,* ²⁴I in them and you in me, that they may become completely one, so that the world may know that you have sent me and have loved them even as you have loved me. ²⁵Father, I desire that those also, whom you have given me, may be with me where I am, to see my glory, which you have given me because you loved me before the foundation of the world.*

25 “Righteous Father, the world does not know you, but I know you, and these know that you have sent me.* ²⁶I made your name known to them, and I will make it known, so that the love with which you have loved me may be in them and I in them.”*

John 18

THE BETRAYAL AND ARREST OF JESUS

1 After Jesus had spoken these words, he went out with his disciples across the Kidron Valley to a place where there was a garden, which he and his disciples entered. **2** Now Judas, who betrayed him, also knew the place because Jesus often met there with his disciples.* **3** So Judas brought a detachment of soldiers together with police from the chief priests and the Pharisees, and they came there with lanterns and torches and weapons.* **4** Then Jesus, knowing all that was to happen to him, came forward and asked them, “Whom are you looking for?”* **5** They answered, “Jesus of Nazareth.”^y Jesus replied, “I am he.”^z Judas, who betrayed him, was standing with them. **6** When Jesus^a said to them, “I am he,”^b they stepped back and fell to the ground. **7** Again he asked them, “Whom are you looking for?” And they said, “Jesus of Nazareth.”^{c,*} **8** Jesus answered, “I told you that I am he.^d So if you are looking for me, let these people go.” **9** This was to fulfill the word that he had spoken, “I did not lose a single one of those whom you gave me.”* **10** Then Simon Peter, who had a sword, drew it, struck the high priest’s slave, and cut off his right ear. The slave’s name was Malchus. **11** Jesus said to Peter, “Put your sword back into its sheath. Am I not to drink the cup that the Father has given me?”*

JESUS BEFORE THE HIGH PRIEST

12 So the soldiers, their officer, and the Jewish police arrested Jesus and bound him. **13** First they took him to Annas, who was the father-in-law of Caiaphas, the high priest that year.* **14** Caiaphas was the one who had advised the Jews that it was better to have one person die for the people.*

PETER DENIES JESUS

15 Simon Peter and another disciple followed Jesus. Since that disciple was known to the high priest, he went with Jesus into the courtyard of the high priest,* **16** but Peter was standing outside at the gate. So the other

disciple, who was known to the high priest, went out, spoke to the woman who guarded the gate, and brought Peter in. ¹⁷The woman said to Peter, “You are not also one of this man’s disciples, are you?” He said, “I am not.”^{*} ¹⁸Now the slaves and the police had made a charcoal fire because it was cold, and they were standing around it and warming themselves. Peter also was standing with them and warming himself.^{*}

THE HIGH PRIEST QUESTIONS JESUS

19 Then the high priest questioned Jesus about his disciples and about his teaching.^{*} ²⁰Jesus answered, “I have spoken openly to the world; I have always taught in synagogues and in the temple, where all the Jews come together. I have said nothing in secret. ²¹Why do you ask me? Ask those who heard what I said to them; they know what I said.” ²²When he had said this, one of the police standing nearby struck Jesus on the face, saying, “Is that how you answer the high priest?”^{*} ²³Jesus answered, “If I have spoken wrongly, testify to the wrong. But if I have spoken rightly, why do you strike me?”^{*} ²⁴Then Annas sent him bound to Caiaphas the high priest.^{*}

PETER DENIES JESUS AGAIN

25 Now Simon Peter was standing and warming himself. They asked him, “You are not also one of his disciples, are you?” He denied it and said, “I am not.”^{*} ²⁶One of the slaves of the high priest, a relative of the man whose ear Peter had cut off, asked, “Did I not see you in the garden with him?”^{*} ²⁷Again Peter denied it, and at that moment the cock crowed.^{*}

JESUS BEFORE PILATE

28 Then they took Jesus from Caiaphas to Pilate’s headquarters. It was early in the morning. They themselves did not enter the headquarters, so as to avoid ritual defilement and to be able to eat the Passover.^{*} ²⁹So Pilate went out to them and said, “What accusation do you bring against this man?” ³⁰They answered, “If this man were not a criminal, we would not have handed him over to you.” ³¹Pilate said to them, “Take him yourselves and judge him according to your law.” The Jews replied, “We are not

permitted to put anyone to death.”³²(This was to fulfill what Jesus had said when he indicated the kind of death he was to die.)^{*}

33 Then Pilate entered the headquarters again, summoned Jesus, and asked him, “Are you the King of the Jews?”^{*}³⁴Jesus answered, “Do you ask this on your own, or did others tell you about me?”³⁵Pilate replied, “I am not a Jew, am I? Your own nation and the chief priests have handed you over to me. What have you done?”³⁶Jesus answered, “My kingdom does not belong to this world. If my kingdom belonged to this world, my followers would be fighting to keep me from being handed over to the Jews. But as it is, my kingdom is not from here.”^{*}³⁷Pilate asked him, “So you are a king?” Jesus answered, “You say that I am a king. For this I was born, and for this I came into the world, to testify to the truth. Everyone who belongs to the truth listens to my voice.”^{*}³⁸Pilate asked him, “What is truth?”

JESUS SENTENCED TO DEATH

After he had said this, he went out to the Jews again and told them, “I find no case against him.”^{*}³⁹But you have a custom that I release someone for you at the Passover. Do you want me to release for you the King of the Jews?”^{*}⁴⁰They shouted in reply, “Not this man but Barabbas!” Now Barabbas was a rebel.^{*}

John 19

1 Then Pilate took Jesus and had him flogged.* **2** And the soldiers wove a crown of thorns and put it on his head, and they dressed him in a purple robe.* **3** They kept coming up to him, saying, “Hail, King of the Jews!” and striking him on the face.* **4** Pilate went out again and said to them, “Look, I am bringing him out to you to let you know that I find no case against him.”* **5** So Jesus came out wearing the crown of thorns and the purple robe. Pilate^e said to them, “Behold the man!”* **6** When the chief priests and the police saw him, they shouted, “Crucify him! Crucify him!” Pilate said to them, “Take him yourselves and crucify him; I find no case against him.”* **7** The Jews answered him, “We have a law, and according to that law he ought to die because he has claimed to be the Son of God.”*

8 Now when Pilate heard this, he was more afraid than ever. **9** He entered his headquarters again and asked Jesus, “Where are you from?” But Jesus gave him no answer.* **10** Pilate therefore said to him, “Do you refuse to speak to me? Do you not know that I have power to release you and power to crucify you?” **11** Jesus answered him, “You would have no power over me unless it had been given you from above; therefore the one who handed me over to you is guilty of a greater sin.”* **12** From then on Pilate tried to release him, but the Jews cried out, “If you release this man, you are no friend of Caesar. Everyone who claims to be a king sets himself against Caesar.”*

13 When Pilate heard these words, he brought Jesus outside and sat^f on the judge’s bench at a place called The Stone Pavement, or in Hebrew^g Gabbatha.* **14** Now it was the day of Preparation for the Passover, and it was about noon. He said to the Jews, “Here is your King!”* **15** They cried out, “Away with him! Away with him! Crucify him!” Pilate asked them, “Shall I crucify your King?” The chief priests answered, “We have no king but Caesar.” **16** Then he handed him over to them to be crucified.

THE CRUCIFIXION OF JESUS

So they took Jesus,^{*} ¹⁷and carrying the cross by himself he went out to what is called the Place of the Skull, which in Hebrew^h is called Golgotha.^{*} ¹⁸There they crucified him and with him two others, one on either side, with Jesus between them. ¹⁹Pilate also had an inscription written and put on the cross. It read, “Jesus of Nazareth,ⁱ the King of the Jews.” ²⁰Many of the Jews read this inscription because the place where Jesus was crucified was near the city, and it was written in Hebrew,^j in Latin, and in Greek. ²¹Then the chief priests of the Jews said to Pilate, “Do not write, ‘The King of the Jews,’ but, ‘This man said, I am King of the Jews.’ ”^{*} ²²Pilate answered, “What I have written I have written.” ²³When the soldiers had crucified Jesus, they took his clothes and divided them into four parts, one for each soldier. They also took his tunic; now the tunic was seamless, woven in one piece from the top. ²⁴So they said to one another, “Let us not tear it but cast lots for it to see who will get it.” This was to fulfill what the scripture says,

“They divided my clothes among themselves,
and for my clothing they cast lots.”^{*}

²⁵And that is what the soldiers did.

Meanwhile, standing near the cross of Jesus were his mother, and his mother’s sister, Mary the wife of Clopas, and Mary Magdalene.^{*} ²⁶When Jesus saw his mother and the disciple whom he loved standing beside her, he said to his mother, “Woman, here is your son.”^{*} ²⁷Then he said to the disciple, “Here is your mother.” And from that hour the disciple took her into his own home.

28 After this, when Jesus knew that all was now finished, he said (in order to fulfill the scripture), “I am thirsty.”^{*} ²⁹A jar full of sour wine was standing there. So they put a sponge full of the wine on a branch of hyssop and held it to his mouth. ³⁰When Jesus had received the wine, he said, “It is finished.” Then he bowed his head and gave up his spirit.^{*}

JESUS’S SIDE IS PIERCED

31 Since it was the day of Preparation, the Jews did not want the bodies left on the cross during the Sabbath, especially because that Sabbath was a day of great solemnity. So they asked Pilate to have the legs of the crucified men broken and the bodies removed.^{*} ³²Then the soldiers came and broke

the legs of the first and of the other who had been crucified with him.* ³³But when they came to Jesus and saw that he was already dead, they did not break his legs. ³⁴Instead, one of the soldiers pierced his side with a spear, and at once blood and water came out.* ³⁵(He who saw this has testified so that you also may believe. His testimony is true, and he knows^k that he tells the truth, so that you also may continue^l to believe.)* ³⁶These things occurred so that the scripture might be fulfilled, “None of his bones shall be broken.”* ³⁷And again another passage of scripture says, “They will look on the one whom they have pierced.”*

THE BURIAL OF JESUS

38 After these things, Joseph of Arimathea, who was a disciple of Jesus, though a secret one because of his fear of the Jews, asked Pilate to let him take away the body of Jesus. Pilate gave him permission, so he came and removed his body. ³⁹Nicodemus, who had at first come to Jesus by night, also came, bringing a mixture of myrrh and aloes, weighing about a hundred pounds.* ⁴⁰They took the body of Jesus and wrapped it with the spices in linen cloths, according to the burial custom of the Jews.* ⁴¹Now there was a garden in the place where he was crucified, and in the garden there was a new tomb in which no one had ever been laid. ⁴²And so, because it was the Jewish day of Preparation and the tomb was nearby, they laid Jesus there.

John 20

THE RESURRECTION OF JESUS

1 Early on the first day of the week, while it was still dark, Mary Magdalene came to the tomb and saw that the stone had been removed from the tomb.*
2 So she ran and went to Simon Peter and the other disciple, the one whom Jesus loved, and said to them, “They have taken the Lord out of the tomb, and we do not know where they have laid him.”* **3** Then Peter and the other disciple set out and went toward the tomb.* **4** The two were running together, but the other disciple outran Peter and reached the tomb first. **5** He bent down to look in and saw the linen wrappings lying there, but he did not go in.* **6** Then Simon Peter came, following him, and went into the tomb. He saw the linen wrappings lying there, **7** and the cloth that had been on Jesus’s head, not lying with the linen wrappings but rolled up in a place by itself. **8** Then the other disciple, who reached the tomb first, also went in, and he saw and believed,* **9** for as yet they did not understand the scripture, that he must rise from the dead.* **10** Then the disciples returned to their homes.

JESUS APPEARS TO MARY MAGDALENE

11 But Mary stood weeping outside the tomb. As she wept, she bent over to look^m into the tomb,* **12** and she saw two angels in white sitting where the body of Jesus had been lying, one at the head and the other at the feet.* **13** They said to her, “Woman, why are you weeping?” She said to them, “They have taken away my Lord, and I do not know where they have laid him.”* **14** When she had said this, she turned around and saw Jesus standing there, but she did not know that it was Jesus. **15** Jesus said to her, “Woman, why are you weeping? Whom are you looking for?” Supposing him to be the gardener, she said to him, “Sir,ⁿ if you have carried him away, tell me where you have laid him, and I will take him away.”* **16** Jesus said to her, “Mary!” She turned and said to him in Hebrew,^o “Rabbouni!” (which means Teacher). **17** Jesus said to her, “Do not touch me, because I have not yet ascended to the Father. But go to my brothers and say to them, ‘I am

ascending to my Father and your Father, to my God and your God.’ ”*
¹⁸Mary Magdalene went and announced to the disciples, “I have seen the Lord,” and she told them that he had said these things to her.*

JESUS APPEARS TO THE DISCIPLES

19 When it was evening on that day, the first day of the week, and the doors were locked where the disciples were, for fear of the Jews, Jesus came and stood among them and said, “Peace be with you.”* ²⁰After he said this, he showed them his hands and his side. Then the disciples rejoiced when they saw the Lord.* ²¹Jesus said to them again, “Peace be with you. As the Father has sent me, so I send you.”* ²²When he had said this, he breathed on them and said to them, “Receive the Holy Spirit. ²³If you forgive the sins of any, they are forgiven them; if you retain the sins of any, they are retained.”*

JESUS AND THOMAS

24 But Thomas (who was called the Twin^P), one of the twelve, was not with them when Jesus came.* ²⁵So the other disciples told him, “We have seen the Lord.” But he said to them, “Unless I see the mark of the nails in his hands and put my finger in the mark of the nails and my hand in his side, I will not believe.”*

26 A week later his disciples were again in the house, and Thomas was with them. Although the doors were shut, Jesus came and stood among them and said, “Peace be with you.”* ²⁷Then he said to Thomas, “Put your finger here and see my hands. Reach out your hand and put it in my side. Do not doubt but believe.”* ²⁸Thomas answered him, “My Lord and my God!” ²⁹Jesus said to him, “Have you believed because you have seen me? Blessed are those who have not seen and yet have come to believe.”*

THE PURPOSE OF THIS BOOK

30 Now Jesus did many other signs in the presence of his disciples that are not written in this book. ³¹But these are written so that you may

continue^q to believe that Jesus is the Messiah,^r the Son of God, and that through believing you may have life in his name.^{*}

John 21

JESUS APPEARS TO SEVEN DISCIPLES

1 After these things Jesus showed himself again to the disciples by the Sea of Tiberias, and he showed himself in this way.* **2**Gathered there together were Simon Peter, Thomas called the Twin,^s Nathanael of Cana in Galilee, the sons of Zebedee, and two others of his disciples.* **3**Simon Peter said to them, “I am going fishing.” They said to him, “We will go with you.” They went out and got into the boat, but that night they caught nothing.*

4 Just after daybreak, Jesus stood on the beach, but the disciples did not know that it was Jesus.* **5**Jesus said to them, “Children, you have no fish, have you?” They answered him, “No.”* **6**He said to them, “Cast the net to the right side of the boat, and you will find some.” So they cast it, and now they were not able to haul it in because there were so many fish.* **7**That disciple whom Jesus loved said to Peter, “It is the Lord!” When Simon Peter heard that it was the Lord, he put on his outer garment, for he had taken it off, and jumped into the sea.* **8**But the other disciples came in the boat, dragging the net full of fish, for they were not far from the land, only about a hundred yards off.

9 When they had gone ashore, they saw a charcoal fire there, with fish on it, and bread.* **10**Jesus said to them, “Bring some of the fish that you have just caught.” **11**So Simon Peter went aboard and hauled the net ashore, full of large fish, a hundred fifty-three of them, and though there were so many, the net was not torn. **12**Jesus said to them, “Come and have breakfast.” Now none of the disciples dared to ask him, “Who are you?” because they knew it was the Lord. **13**Jesus came and took the bread and gave it to them and did the same with the fish.* **14**This was now the third time that Jesus appeared to the disciples after he was raised from the dead.*

JESUS AND PETER

15 When they had finished breakfast, Jesus said to Simon Peter, “Simon son of John, do you love me more than these?” He said to him, “Yes, Lord;

you know that I love you.” Jesus said to him, “Feed my lambs.”* ¹⁶A second time he said to him, “Simon son of John, do you love me?” He said to him, “Yes, Lord; you know that I love you.” Jesus said to him, “Tend my sheep.”* ¹⁷He said to him the third time, “Simon son of John, do you love me?” Peter felt hurt because he said to him the third time, “Do you love me?” And he said to him, “Lord, you know everything; you know that I love you.” Jesus said to him, “Feed my sheep.”* ¹⁸Very truly, I tell you, when you were younger, you used to fasten your own belt and to go wherever you wished. But when you grow old, you will stretch out your hands, and someone else will fasten a belt around you and take you where you do not wish to go.” ¹⁹(He said this to indicate the kind of death by which he would glorify God.) After this he said to him, “Follow me.”*

JESUS AND THE BELOVED DISCIPLE

20 Peter turned and saw the disciple whom Jesus loved following them; he was the one who had reclined next to Jesus at the supper and had said, “Lord, who is it that is going to betray you?”* ²¹When Peter saw him, he said to Jesus, “Lord, what about him?” ²²Jesus said to him, “If it is my will that he remain until I come, what is that to you? Follow me!”* ²³So the rumor spread among the brothers and sisters that this disciple would not die. Yet Jesus did not say to him that he would not die, but, “If it is my will that he remain until I come, what is that to you?”*^{t,*}

24 This is the disciple who is testifying to these things and has written them, and we know that his testimony is true.* ²⁵But there are also many other things that Jesus did; if every one of them were written down, I suppose that the world itself could not contain the books that would be written.*

The Acts of the Apostles

Acts 1

THE PROMISE OF THE HOLY SPIRIT

1 In the first book, Theophilus, I wrote about all that Jesus began to do and teach^{*} **2**until the day when he was taken up to heaven, after giving instructions through the Holy Spirit to the apostles whom he had chosen.^{*} **3**After his suffering^a he presented himself alive to them by many convincing proofs, appearing to them during forty days and speaking about the kingdom of God.^{*} **4**While staying^b with them, he ordered them not to leave Jerusalem but to wait there for the promise of the Father. “This,” he said, “is what you have heard from me;^{*} **5**for John baptized with water, but you will be baptized with^c the Holy Spirit not many days from now.”^{*}

THE ASCENSION OF JESUS

6 So when they had come together, they asked him, “Lord, is this the time when you will restore the kingdom to Israel?”^{*} **7**He replied, “It is not for you to know the times or periods that the Father has set by his own authority.^{*} **8**But you will receive power when the Holy Spirit has come upon you, and you will be my witnesses in Jerusalem, in all Judea and Samaria, and to the ends of the earth.”^{*} **9**When he had said this, as they were watching, he was lifted up, and a cloud took him out of their sight.^{*} **10**While he was going and they were gazing up toward heaven, suddenly two men in white robes stood by them.^{*} **11**They said, “Men of Galilee, why do you stand looking up toward heaven? This Jesus, who has been taken up from you into heaven, will come in the same way as you saw him go into heaven.”^{*}

MATTHIAS CHOSEN TO REPLACE JUDAS

12 Then they returned to Jerusalem from the mount called Olivet, which is near Jerusalem, a Sabbath day's journey away. ¹³When they had entered the city, they went to the room upstairs where they were staying: Peter, and John, and James, and Andrew, Philip and Thomas, Bartholomew and Matthew, James son of Alphaeus, and Simon the Zealot, and Judas son of James. ¹⁴All these were constantly devoting themselves to prayer, together with certain women, including Mary the mother of Jesus, as well as his brothers.*

15 In those days Peter stood up among the brothers and sisters (together the crowd numbered about one hundred twenty persons) and said, ¹⁶"Brothers and sisters,^c the scripture had to be fulfilled, which the Holy Spirit through David foretold concerning Judas, who became a guide for those who arrested Jesus,* ¹⁷for he was numbered among us and was allotted his share in this ministry."* ¹⁸(Now this man acquired a field with the reward of his wickedness, and falling headlong, he burst open in the middle, and all his bowels gushed out.* ¹⁹This became known to all the residents of Jerusalem, so that the field was called in their language Hakeldama, that is, Field of Blood.) ²⁰"For it is written in the book of Psalms,

‘Let his house become desolate,
and let there be no one to live in it’;

and

‘Let another take his position of overseer.’*

²¹"So one of the men who have accompanied us during all the time that the Lord Jesus went in and out among us, ²²beginning from the baptism of John until the day when he was taken up from us—one of these must become a witness with us to his resurrection."* ²³So they proposed two, Joseph called Barsabbas, who was also known as Justus, and Matthias. ²⁴Then they prayed and said, "Lord, you know everyone's heart. Show us which one of these two you have chosen* ²⁵to take the place^f in this ministry and apostleship from which Judas turned aside to go to his own place." ²⁶And they cast lots for them, and the lot fell on Matthias, and he was added to the eleven apostles.

Acts 2

THE COMING OF THE HOLY SPIRIT

1 When the day of Pentecost had come, they were all together in one place.*
2 And suddenly from heaven there came a sound like the rush of a violent wind, and it filled the entire house where they were sitting.* **3** Divided tongues, as of fire, appeared among them, and a tongue rested on each of them. **4** All of them were filled with the Holy Spirit and began to speak in other languages, as the Spirit gave them ability.*

5 Now there were devout Jews from every people under heaven living in Jerusalem. **6** And at this sound the crowd gathered and was bewildered, because each one heard them speaking in the native language of each. **7** Amazed and astonished, they asked, “Are not all these who are speaking Galileans? **8** And how is it that we hear, each of us, in our own native language? **9** Parthians, Medes, Elamites, and residents of Mesopotamia, Judea and Cappadocia, Pontus and Asia, **10** Phrygia and Pamphylia, Egypt and the parts of Libya belonging to Cyrene, and visitors from Rome, both Jews and proselytes, **11** Cretans and Arabs—in our own languages we hear them speaking about God’s deeds of power.” **12** All were amazed and perplexed, saying to one another, “What does this mean?” **13** But others sneered and said, “They are filled with new wine.”

PETER ADDRESSES THE CROWD

14 But Peter, standing with the eleven, raised his voice and addressed them, “Fellow Jews^g and all who live in Jerusalem, let this be known to you, and listen to what I say. **15** Indeed, these are not drunk, as you suppose, for it is only nine o’clock in the morning.* **16** No, this is what was spoken through the prophet Joel:

17 ‘In the last days it will be, God declares,
that I will pour out my Spirit upon all flesh,
and your sons and your daughters shall prophesy,

and your young men shall see visions,
and your old men shall dream dreams.*

¹⁸Even upon my slaves, both men and women,
in those days I will pour out my Spirit,
and they shall prophesy.*

¹⁹And I will show portents in the heaven above
and signs on the earth below,
blood, and fire, and smoky mist.

²⁰The sun shall be turned to darkness
and the moon to blood,
before the coming of the Lord's great and glorious day.*

²¹Then everyone who calls on the name of the Lord shall be
saved.*

22 “Fellow Israelites,^h listen to what I have to say: Jesus of Nazareth,ⁱ a man attested to you by God with deeds of power, wonders, and signs that God did through him among you, as you yourselves know*—²³this man, handed over to you according to the definite plan and foreknowledge of God, you crucified and killed by the hands of those outside the law.* ²⁴But God raised him up, having released him from the agony of death, because it was impossible for him to be held in its power.* ²⁵For David says concerning him,

‘I saw the Lord always before me,
for he is at my right hand so that I will not be shaken;*
²⁶therefore my heart was glad, and my tongue rejoiced;
moreover, my flesh will live in hope.

²⁷For you will not abandon my soul to Hades
or let your Holy One experience corruption.*

²⁸You have made known to me the ways of life;
you will make me full of gladness with your presence.’

29 “Fellow Israelites,^j I may say to you confidently of our ancestor David that he both died and was buried, and his tomb is with us to this day.*

³⁰Since he was a prophet, he knew that God had sworn with an oath to him that he would put one of his descendants on his throne.* ³¹Foreseeing this, David^k spoke of the resurrection of the Messiah,^l saying,

‘He was not abandoned to Hades,

nor did his flesh experience corruption.’*

³²“This Jesus God raised up, and of that all of us are witnesses.* ³³Being therefore exalted at^m the right hand of God and having received from the Father the promise of the Holy Spirit, he has poured out this that you see and hear.* ³⁴For David did not ascend into the heavens, but he himself says,

‘The Lord said to my Lord,

“Sit at my right hand,*

³⁵until I make your enemies your footstool.” ’

³⁶“Therefore let the entire house of Israel know with certainty that God has made him both Lord and Messiah,ⁿ this Jesus whom you crucified.”

THE FIRST CONVERTS

37 Now when they heard this, they were cut to the heart and said to Peter and to the other apostles, “Brothers,^o what should we do?”* ³⁸Peter said to them, “Repent and be baptized every one of you in the name of Jesus Christ so that your sins may be forgiven, and you will receive the gift of the Holy Spirit.* ³⁹For the promise is for you, for your children, and for all who are far away, everyone whom the Lord our God calls to him.”* ⁴⁰And he testified with many other arguments and exhorted them, saying, “Save yourselves from this corrupt generation.” ⁴¹So those who welcomed his message were baptized, and that day about three thousand persons were added. ⁴²They devoted themselves to the apostles’ teaching and fellowship, to the breaking of bread and the prayers.

LIFE AMONG THE BELIEVERS

43 Awe came upon everyone because many wonders and signs were being done through the apostles.* ⁴⁴All who believed were together and had all things in common;* ⁴⁵they would sell their possessions and goods and

distribute the proceeds^P to all, as any had need. ⁴⁶Day by day, as they spent much time together in the temple, they broke bread at home^Q and ate their food with glad and generous^R hearts,^{*} ⁴⁷praising God and having the goodwill of all the people. And day by day the Lord added to their number those who were being saved.^{*}

Acts 3

PETER HEALS A CRIPPLED BEGGAR

1 One day Peter and John were going up to the temple at the hour of prayer, at three o'clock in the afternoon. ^{*} **2** And a man lame from birth was being carried in. People would lay him daily at the gate of the temple called the Beautiful Gate so that he could ask for alms from those entering the temple. ^{*} **3** When he saw Peter and John about to go into the temple, he asked them for alms. **4** Peter looked intently at him, as did John, and said, "Look at us." **5** And he fixed his attention on them, expecting to receive something from them. **6** Peter said, "I have no silver or gold, but what I have I give you; in the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth,^s stand up and walk."^{*} **7** And he took him by the right hand and raised him up, and immediately his feet and ankles were made strong. **8** Jumping up, he stood and began to walk, and he entered the temple with them, walking and leaping and praising God. **9** All the people saw him walking and praising God,^{*} **10** and they recognized him as the one who used to sit and ask for alms at the Beautiful Gate of the temple, and they were filled with wonder and astonishment at what had happened to him.

PETER SPEAKS IN SOLOMON'S PORTICO

11 While he clung to Peter and John, all the people ran together to them in the portico called Solomon's Portico, utterly astonished. ^{*} **12** When Peter saw it, he addressed the people, "Fellow Israelites,^t why do you wonder at this, or why do you stare at us, as though by our own power or piety we had made him walk? **13** The God of Abraham and Isaac and Jacob,^u the God of our ancestors, has glorified his servant^v Jesus, whom you handed over and rejected in the presence of Pilate, though he had decided to release him."^{*} **14** But you rejected the holy and righteous^w one and asked to have a murderer given to you,^{*} **15** and you killed the author of life, whom God raised from the dead. To this we are witnesses. ^{*} **16** And by faith in his name, his name itself has made this man strong, whom you see and know, and the

faith that is through Jesus^x has given him this perfect health in the presence of all of you.

17 “And now, brothers and sisters, I know that you acted in ignorance, as did also your rulers.* ¹⁸In this way God fulfilled what he had foretold through all the prophets, that his Messiah^y would suffer.* ¹⁹Repent, therefore, and turn to God so that your sins may be wiped out, ²⁰so that times of refreshing may come from the presence of the Lord and that he may send the Messiah^z appointed for you, that is, Jesus, ²¹who must remain in heaven until the time of universal restoration that God announced long ago through his holy prophets.* ²²Moses said, ‘The Lord your God will raise up for you from your own people a prophet like me. You must listen to whatever he tells you.* ²³And it will be that everyone who does not listen to that prophet will be utterly rooted out of the people.’ ²⁴And all the prophets, as many as have spoken, from Samuel and those after him, also predicted these days. ²⁵You are the descendants of the prophets and of the covenant that God gave to your ancestors, saying to Abraham, ‘And in your descendants all the families of the earth shall be blessed.’* ²⁶When God raised up his servant,^a he sent him first to you, to bless you by turning each of you from your wicked ways.”*

Acts 4

PETER AND JOHN BEFORE THE COUNCIL

1 While Peter and John^b were speaking to the people, the priests, the captain of the temple, and the Sadducees came to them,* ²much annoyed because they were teaching the people and proclaiming that in Jesus there is the resurrection of the dead.* ³So they arrested them and put them in custody until the next day, for it was already evening.* ⁴But many of those who heard the word believed, and they numbered about five thousand.*

5 The next day their rulers, elders, and scribes assembled in Jerusalem,* ⁶with Annas the high priest, Caiaphas, John,^c and Alexander, and all who were of the high-priestly family.* ⁷When they had made the prisoners^d stand in their midst, they inquired, “By what power or by what name did you do this?” ⁸Then Peter, filled with the Holy Spirit, said to them, “Rulers of the people and elders,* ⁹if we are being questioned today because of a good deed done to someone who was sick and are being asked how this man has been healed,^e ¹⁰let it be known to all of you, and to all the people of Israel, that this man is standing before you in good health by the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth,^f whom you crucified, whom God raised from the dead.* ¹¹This Jesus^g is

‘the stone that was rejected by you, the builders;

it has become the cornerstone.’^{h,*}

¹²“There is salvation in no one else, for there is no other name under heaven given among mortals by which we must be saved.”*

13 Now when they saw the boldness of Peter and John and realized that they were uneducated and ordinary men, they were amazed and recognized them as companions of Jesus.* ¹⁴When they saw the man who had been cured standing beside them, they had nothing to say in opposition. ¹⁵So they ordered them to leave the council while they discussed the matter with one another.* ¹⁶They said, “What will we do with them? For it is obvious to all who live in Jerusalem that a notable sign has been done through them; we cannot deny it.* ¹⁷But to keep it from spreading further among the people,

let us warn them to speak no more to anyone in this name.”¹⁸ So they called them and ordered them not to speak or teach at all in the name of Jesus.*¹⁹ But Peter and John answered them, “Whether it is right in God’s sight to listen to you rather than to God, you must judge;”²⁰ for we cannot keep from speaking about what we have seen and heard.”*²¹ After threatening them again, they let them go, finding no way to punish them because of the people, for all of them praised God for what had happened.*²² For the man on whom this sign of healing had been performed was more than forty years old.

THE BELIEVERS PRAY FOR BOLDNESS

23 After they were released, they went to their own people and reported what the chief priests and the elders had said to them.²⁴ When they heard it, they raised their voices together to God and said, “Sovereign Lord, who made the heaven and the earth, the sea, and everything in them,*²⁵ it is you who said by the Holy Spirit through our ancestor David, your servant:ⁱ

‘Why did the gentiles rage

and the peoples imagine vain things?*

²⁶The kings of the earth took their stand,

and the rulers have gathered together

against the Lord and against his Messiah.’^{j,*}

²⁷“For in this city, in fact, both Herod and Pontius Pilate, with the gentiles and the peoples of Israel, gathered together against your holy servant^k Jesus, whom you anointed,*²⁸ to do whatever your hand and your plan had predestined to take place.²⁹ And now, Lord, look at their threats, and grant to your servants to speak your word with all boldness,*³⁰ while you stretch out your hand to heal, and signs and wonders are performed through the name of your holy servant^l Jesus.”*³¹ When they had prayed, the place in which they were gathered together was shaken, and they were all filled with the Holy Spirit and spoke the word of God with boldness.*

THE BELIEVERS SHARE THEIR POSSESSIONS

32 Now the whole group of those who believed were of one heart and soul, and no one claimed private ownership of any possessions, but everything they owned was held in common.* ³³With great power the apostles gave their testimony to the resurrection of the Lord Jesus, and great grace was upon them all.* ³⁴There was not a needy person among them, for as many as owned lands or houses sold them and brought the proceeds of what was sold.* ³⁵They laid it at the apostles' feet, and it was distributed to each as any had need.* ³⁶There was a Levite from Cyprus, Joseph, to whom the apostles gave the name Barnabas (which means "son of encouragement"). ³⁷He sold a field that belonged to him, then brought the money and laid it at the apostles' feet.*

Acts 5

ANANIAS AND SAPPHIRA

1 But a man named Ananias, with the consent of his wife Sapphira, sold a piece of property; ²with his wife's knowledge, he kept back some of the proceeds and brought only a part and laid it at the apostles' feet.*
³"Ananias," Peter asked, "why has Satan filled your heart to lie to the Holy Spirit and to keep back part of the proceeds of the land?*" ⁴While it remained unsold, did it not remain your own? And after it was sold, were not the proceeds at your disposal? How is it that you have contrived this deed in your heart? You did not lie to us^m but to God!" ⁵Now when Ananias heard these words, he fell down and died. And great fear seized all who heard of it. ⁶The young men came and wrapped up his body, then carried him out and buried him.*

7 After an interval of about three hours his wife came in, not knowing what had happened. ⁸Peter said to her, "Tell me whether you and your husband sold the land for such and such a price." And she said, "Yes, that was the price." ⁹Then Peter said to her, "How is it that you have agreed together to put the Spirit of the Lord to the test? Look, the feet of those who have buried your husband are at the door, and they will carry you out."*
¹⁰Immediately she fell down at his feet and died. When the young men came in they found her dead, so they carried her out and buried her beside her husband. ¹¹And great fear seized the whole church and all who heard of these things.*

THE APOSTLES HEAL MANY

12 Now many signs and wonders were done among the people through the apostles. And they were all together in Solomon's Portico.* ¹³None of the rest dared to join them, but the people held them in high esteem.* ¹⁴Yet more than ever believers were added to the Lord, great numbers of both men and women, ¹⁵so that they even carried out the sick into the streets and laid them on cots and mats, in order that Peter's shadow might fall on some

of them as he came by.* ¹⁶A great number of people would also gather from the towns around Jerusalem, bringing the sick and those tormented by unclean spirits, and they were all cured.

THE APOSTLES ARE PERSECUTED

17 Then the high priest took action; he and all who were with him (that is, the sect of the Sadducees), being filled with jealousy, ¹⁸arrested the apostles and put them in the public prison.* ¹⁹But during the night an angel of the Lord opened the prison doors, brought them out, and said,* ²⁰“Go, stand in the temple and tell the people the whole message about this life.”* ²¹When they heard this, they entered the temple at daybreak and went on with their teaching.

When the high priest and those with him arrived, they called together the council and the whole body of the elders of Israel and sent to the prison to have them brought.* ²²But when the temple police went there, they did not find them in the prison, so they returned and reported, ²³“We found the prison securely locked and the guards standing at the doors, but when we opened them we found no one inside.” ²⁴Now when the captain of the temple and the chief priests heard these words, they were perplexed about them, wondering what might be going on.* ²⁵Then someone arrived and announced, “Look, the men whom you put in prison are standing in the temple and teaching the people!” ²⁶Then the captain went with the temple police and brought them, but without violence, for they were afraid of being stoned by the people.*

27 When they had brought them, they had them stand before the council. The high priest questioned them, ²⁸saying, “We gave you strict orders not to teach in this name,ⁿ yet here you have filled Jerusalem with your teaching, and you are determined to bring this man’s blood on us.”* ²⁹But Peter and the apostles answered, “We must obey God rather than any human authority.^{o,*} ³⁰The God of our ancestors raised up Jesus, whom you had killed by hanging him on a tree.* ³¹God exalted him at his right hand as Leader and Savior that he might give repentance to Israel and forgiveness of sins.* ³²And we are witnesses to these things, and so is the Holy Spirit whom God has given to those who obey him.”*

33 When they heard this, they were enraged and wanted to kill them.*
³⁴But a Pharisee in the council named Gamaliel, a teacher of the law, respected by all the people, stood up and ordered the men to be put outside for a short time. ³⁵Then he said to them, “Fellow Israelites,^p consider carefully what you propose to do to these men. ³⁶For some time ago Theudas rose up, claiming to be somebody, and a number of men, about four hundred, joined him, but he was killed, and all who followed him were dispersed and disappeared. ³⁷After him Judas the Galilean rose up at the time of the census and got people to follow him; he also perished, and all who followed him were scattered. ³⁸So in the present case, I tell you, keep away from these men and let them alone, because if this plan or this undertaking is of human origin, it will fail; ³⁹but if it is of God, you will not be able to overthrow them—in that case you may even be found fighting against God!”

They were convinced by him,* ⁴⁰and when they had called in the apostles, they had them flogged. Then they ordered them not to speak in the name of Jesus and let them go. ⁴¹As they left the council, they rejoiced that they were considered worthy to suffer dishonor for the sake of the name.*
⁴²And every day in the temple and at home^q they did not cease to teach and proclaim Jesus as the Messiah.^{r,*}

Acts 6

SEVEN CHOSEN TO SERVE

1 Now during those days, when the disciples were increasing in number, the Hellenists complained against the Hebrews because their widows were being neglected in the daily distribution of food.* **2** And the twelve called together the whole community of the disciples and said, “It is not right that we should neglect the word of God in order to wait on tables.^s **3** Therefore, brothers and sisters, select from among yourselves seven men of good standing, full of the Spirit and of wisdom, whom we may appoint to this task,* **4** while we, for our part, will devote ourselves to prayer and to serving the word.” **5** What they said pleased the whole community, and they chose Stephen, a man full of faith and the Holy Spirit, together with Philip, Prochorus, Nicanor, Timon, Parmenas, and Nicolaus, a proselyte of Antioch.* **6** They had these men stand before the apostles, who prayed and laid their hands on them.*

7 The word of God continued to spread; the number of the disciples increased greatly in Jerusalem, and a great many of the priests became obedient to the faith.*

THE ARREST OF STEPHEN

8 Stephen, full of grace and power, did great wonders and signs among the people. **9** Then some of those who belonged to the synagogue of the Freedmen (as it was called), Cyrenians, Alexandrians, and others of those from Cilicia and Asia, stood up and argued with Stephen. **10** But they could not withstand the wisdom and the Spirit^t with which he spoke.* **11** Then they secretly instigated some men to say, “We have heard him speak blasphemous words against Moses and God.”* **12** They stirred up the people as well as the elders and the scribes; then they suddenly confronted him, seized him, and brought him before the council. **13** They set up false witnesses who said, “This man never stops saying things against this holy place and the law,* **14** for we have heard him say that this Jesus of Nazareth^u will destroy this place and will change the customs that Moses handed on to

us.”* ¹⁵And all who sat in the council looked intently at him, and they saw that his face was like the face of an angel.

Acts 7

STEPHEN'S SPEECH TO THE COUNCIL

1 Then the high priest asked him, “Are these things so?” **2** And Stephen replied:

“Brothers^v and fathers, listen to me. The God of glory appeared to our ancestor Abraham when he was in Mesopotamia, before he lived in Haran,*
3 and said to him, ‘Leave your country and your relatives and go to the land that I will show you.’* **4** Then he left the country of the Chaldeans and settled in Haran. After his father died, God had him move from there to this country in which you are now living.* **5** He did not give him any of it as a heritage, not even a foot’s length, but promised to give it to him as his possession and to his descendants after him, even though he had no child.*
6 And God spoke in these terms, that his descendants would be resident aliens in a country belonging to others, who would enslave them and mistreat them during four hundred years.* **7** ‘But I will judge the people whom they serve,’ said God, ‘and after that they shall come out and worship me in this place.’* **8** Then he gave him the covenant of circumcision. And so Abraham^w became the father of Isaac and circumcised him on the eighth day, and Isaac did likewise to Jacob and Jacob to the twelve patriarchs.*

9 “The patriarchs, jealous of Joseph, sold him into Egypt; but God was with him* **10** and rescued him from all his afflictions and enabled him to win favor and to show wisdom when he stood before Pharaoh, king of Egypt, who appointed him ruler over Egypt and over all his household.* **11** Now there came a famine throughout Egypt and Canaan and great suffering, and our ancestors could find no food.* **12** But when Jacob heard that there was grain in Egypt, he sent our ancestors there on their first visit.* **13** On the second visit Joseph made himself known to his brothers, and Joseph’s family became known to Pharaoh.* **14** Then Joseph sent and invited his father Jacob and all his relatives to come to him, seventy-five in all;* **15** so Jacob went down to Egypt. He himself died there as well as our ancestors,*
16 and their bodies^x were brought back to Shechem and laid in the tomb that

Abraham had bought for a sum of silver from the sons of Hamor in Shechem.*

17 “But as the time drew near for the fulfillment of the promise that God had made to Abraham, our people in Egypt increased and multiplied*¹⁸until another king who had not known Joseph ruled over Egypt. ¹⁹He dealt craftily with our people and forced our ancestors to abandon their infants so that they would die.* ²⁰At this time Moses was born, and he was beautiful before God. For three months he was brought up in his father’s house,²¹and when he was abandoned, Pharaoh’s daughter adopted him and brought him up as her own son. ²²So Moses was instructed in all the wisdom of the Egyptians and was powerful in his words and deeds.*

23 “When he was forty years old, it came into his heart to visit his kinfolk, the Israelites.* ²⁴When he saw one of them being wronged, he defended the oppressed man and avenged him by striking down the Egyptian. ²⁵He supposed that his kinsfolk would understand that God through him was rescuing them, but they did not understand. ²⁶The next day he came to some of them as they were quarreling and tried to reconcile them, saying, ‘Men, you are brothers; why do you wrong each other?’ ²⁷But the man who was wronging his neighbor pushed Moses^y aside, saying, ‘Who made you a ruler and a judge over us? ²⁸Do you want to kill me as you killed the Egyptian yesterday?’ ²⁹When he heard this, Moses fled and became a resident alien in the land of Midian. There he became the father of two sons.

30 “Now when forty years had passed, an angel appeared to him in the wilderness of Mount Sinai, in the flame of a burning bush. ³¹When Moses saw it, he was amazed at the sight, and as he approached to look, there came the voice of the Lord: ³²‘I am the God of your ancestors, the God of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob.’ Moses began to tremble and did not dare to look.* ³³Then the Lord said to him, ‘Take off the sandals from your feet, for the place where you are standing is holy ground.* ³⁴I have surely seen the mistreatment of my people who are in Egypt and have heard their groaning, and I have come down to rescue them. Come now, I will send you to Egypt.’*

35 “It was this Moses whom they rejected when they said, ‘Who made you a ruler and a judge?’ and whom God now sent as both ruler and

liberator through the angel who appeared to him in the bush.* ³⁶He led them out, having performed wonders and signs in Egypt, at the Red Sea, and in the wilderness for forty years.* ³⁷This is the Moses who said to the Israelites, ‘God will raise up a prophet for you from your own people as he raised me up.’* ³⁸He is the one who was in the congregation in the wilderness with the angel who spoke to him at Mount Sinai and with our ancestors, and he received living oracles to give to us.* ³⁹Our ancestors were unwilling to obey him; instead, they pushed him aside, and in their hearts they turned back to Egypt, ⁴⁰saying to Aaron, ‘Make gods for us who will lead the way for us; as for this Moses who led us out from the land of Egypt, we do not know what has happened to him.’* ⁴¹At that time they made a calf, offered a sacrifice to the idol, and reveled in the works of their hands.* ⁴²But God turned away from them and handed them over to worship the host of heaven, as it is written in the book of the prophets:

‘Did you offer to me slain victims and sacrifices

forty years in the wilderness, O house of Israel?*

⁴³No; you took along the tent of Moloch

and the star of your god Rephan,

the images that you made to worship;

so I will remove you beyond Babylon.’

44 “Our ancestors had the tent of testimony in the wilderness, as God^z directed when he spoke to Moses, ordering him to make it according to the pattern he had seen.* ⁴⁵Our ancestors in turn brought it in with Joshua when they dispossessed the peoples whom God drove out before our ancestors. And it was there until the time of David,* ⁴⁶who found favor with God and asked that he might find a dwelling place for the house of Jacob.^{a,*} ⁴⁷But it was Solomon who built a house for him. ⁴⁸Yet the Most High does not dwell in houses made with human hands;^b as the prophet says,*

⁴⁹‘Heaven is my throne,

and the earth is my footstool.

What kind of house will you build for me, says the Lord,

or what is the place of my rest?*

⁵⁰Did not my hand make all these things?’

51 “You stiff-necked people, uncircumcised in heart and ears, you are forever opposing the Holy Spirit, just as your ancestors used to do.*
⁵²Which of the prophets did your ancestors not persecute? They killed those who foretold the coming of the Righteous One, and now you have become his betrayers and murderers.* ⁵³You are the ones who received the law as ordained by angels, and yet you have not kept it.”*

THE STONING OF STEPHEN

54 When they heard these things, they became enraged and ground their teeth at Stephen.^c ⁵⁵But filled with the Holy Spirit, he gazed into heaven and saw the glory of God and Jesus standing at the right hand of God.*
⁵⁶“Look,” he said, “I see the heavens opened and the Son of Man standing at the right hand of God!”* ⁵⁷But they covered their ears, and with a loud shout all rushed together against him. ⁵⁸Then they dragged him out of the city and began to stone him, and the witnesses laid their coats at the feet of a young man named Saul.* ⁵⁹While they were stoning Stephen, he prayed, “Lord Jesus, receive my spirit.”* ⁶⁰Then he knelt down and cried out in a loud voice, “Lord, do not hold this sin against them.” When he had said this, he died.^{d,*}

Acts 8

1 And Saul approved of their killing him.

SAUL PERSECUTES THE CHURCH

That day a severe persecution began against the church in Jerusalem, and all except the apostles were scattered throughout the countryside of Judea and Samaria.* ²Devout men buried Stephen and made loud lamentation over him.* ³But Saul was ravaging the church by entering house after house; dragging off both men and women, he committed them to prison.*

PHILIP PREACHES IN SAMARIA

4 Now those who were scattered went from place to place proclaiming the word.* ⁵Philip went down to the city^e of Samaria and proclaimed the Messiah^f to them.* ⁶The crowds with one accord listened eagerly to what was said by Philip, hearing and seeing the signs that he did, ⁷for unclean spirits, crying with loud shrieks, came out of many who were possessed, and many others who were paralyzed or lame were cured.* ⁸So there was great joy in that city.

9 Now a certain man named Simon had previously practiced magic in the city and amazed the people of Samaria, saying that he was someone great.* ¹⁰All of them, from the least to the greatest, listened to him eagerly, saying, “This man is the power of God that is called Great.”* ¹¹And they listened eagerly to him because for a long time he had amazed them with his magic. ¹²But when they believed Philip, who was proclaiming the good news about the kingdom of God and the name of Jesus Christ, they were baptized, both men and women.* ¹³Even Simon himself believed. After being baptized, he stayed constantly with Philip and was amazed when he saw the signs and great miracles that took place.*

14 Now when the apostles at Jerusalem heard that Samaria had accepted the word of God, they sent Peter and John to them.* ¹⁵The two went down and prayed for them that they might receive the Holy Spirit* ¹⁶(for as yet

the Spirit had not come^g upon any of them; they had only been baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus).^{*} ¹⁷Then Peter and John^h laid their hands on them, and they received the Holy Spirit.^{*} ¹⁸Now when Simon saw that the Spirit was given through the laying on of the apostles' hands, he offered them money, ¹⁹saying, "Give me also this power so that anyone on whom I lay my hands may receive the Holy Spirit."²⁰ But Peter said to him, "May your silver perish with you, because you thought you could obtain God's gift with money!"^{*} ²¹You have no part or share in this, for your heart is not right before God.^{*} ²²Repent therefore of this wickedness of yours, and pray to the Lord that, if possible, the intent of your heart may be forgiven you.²³ For I see that you are in the gall of bitterness and the chains of wickedness."^{*} ²⁴Simon answered, "Pray for me to the Lord, that nothing of what youⁱ have said may happen to me."

25 Now after Peter and John^j had testified and spoken the word of the Lord, they returned to Jerusalem, proclaiming the good news to many villages of the Samaritans.^{*}

PHILIP AND THE ETHIOPIAN EUNUCH

26 Then an angel of the Lord said to Philip, "Get up and go toward the south^k to the road that goes down from Jerusalem to Gaza." (This is a wilderness road.)^{*} ²⁷So he got up and went. Now there was an Ethiopian eunuch, a court official of the Candace, the queen of the Ethiopians, in charge of her entire treasury. He had come to Jerusalem to worship^{*} ²⁸and was returning home; seated in his chariot, he was reading the prophet Isaiah. ²⁹Then the Spirit said to Philip, "Go over to this chariot and join it."^{*} ³⁰So Philip ran up to it and heard him reading the prophet Isaiah. He asked, "Do you understand what you are reading?" ³¹He replied, "How can I, unless someone guides me?" And he invited Philip to get in and sit beside him. ³²Now the passage of the scripture that he was reading was this:

"Like a sheep he was led to the slaughter,
and like a lamb silent before its shearer,
so he does not open his mouth."^{*}

³³In his humiliation justice was denied him.

Who can describe his generation?

For his life is taken away from the earth.”

³⁴The eunuch asked Philip, “About whom, may I ask you, does the prophet say this, about himself or about someone else?” ³⁵Then Philip began to speak, and starting with this scripture he proclaimed to him the good news about Jesus. ^{*} ³⁶As they were going along the road, they came to some water, and the eunuch said, “Look, here is water! What is to prevent me from being baptized?”^{l,*} ³⁸He commanded the chariot to stop, and both of them, Philip and the eunuch, went down into the water, and Philip^m baptized him. ³⁹When they came up out of the water, the Spirit of the Lord snatched Philip away; the eunuch saw him no more and went on his way rejoicing. ^{*} ⁴⁰But Philip found himself at Azotus, and as he was passing through the region he proclaimed the good news to all the towns until he came to Caesarea.

Acts 9

THE CONVERSION OF SAUL

1 Meanwhile Saul, still breathing threats and murder against the disciples of the Lord, went to the high priest* ²and asked him for letters to the synagogues at Damascus, so that if he found any who belonged to the Way, men or women, he might bring them bound to Jerusalem. ³Now as he was going along and approaching Damascus, suddenly a light from heaven flashed around him.* ⁴He fell to the ground and heard a voice saying to him, “Saul, Saul, why do you persecute me?”* ⁵He asked, “Who are you, Lord?” The reply came, “I am Jesus, whom you are persecuting. ⁶But get up and enter the city, and you will be told what you are to do.” ⁷The men who were traveling with him stood speechless because they heard the voice but saw no one.* ⁸Saul got up from the ground, and though his eyes were open, he could see nothing;ⁿ so they led him by the hand and brought him into Damascus. ⁹For three days he was without sight and neither ate nor drank.

10 Now there was a disciple in Damascus named Ananias. The Lord said to him in a vision, “Ananias.” He answered, “Here I am, Lord.”* ¹¹The Lord said to him, “Get up and go to the street called Straight, and at the house of Judas look for a man of Tarsus named Saul. At this moment he is praying,* ¹²and he has seen in a vision^o a man named Ananias come in and lay his hands on him so that he might regain his sight.” ¹³But Ananias answered, “Lord, I have heard from many about this man, how much evil he has done to your saints in Jerusalem, ¹⁴and here he has authority from the chief priests to bind all who invoke your name.”* ¹⁵But the Lord said to him, “Go, for he is an instrument whom I have chosen to bring my name before gentiles and kings and before the people of Israel;* ¹⁶I myself will show him how much he must suffer for the sake of my name.”* ¹⁷So Ananias went and entered the house. He laid his hands on Saul^p and said, “Brother Saul, the Lord Jesus, who appeared to you on your way here, has sent me so that you may regain your sight and be filled with the Holy Spirit.”* ¹⁸And immediately something like scales fell from his eyes, and his sight was

restored. Then he got up and was baptized, ¹⁹and after taking some food, he regained his strength.

SAUL PREACHES IN DAMASCUS

For several days he was with the disciples in Damascus, ^{*} ²⁰and immediately he began to proclaim Jesus in the synagogues, saying, “He is the Son of God.” ²¹All who heard him were amazed and said, “Is not this the man who made havoc in Jerusalem among those who invoked this name? And has he not come here for the purpose of bringing them bound before the chief priests?” ^{*} ²²Saul became increasingly more powerful and confounded the Jews who lived in Damascus by proving that Jesus^q was the Messiah.^{r,*}

SAUL ESCAPES FROM THE JEWS

23 After some time had passed, the Jews plotted to kill him, ^{*} ²⁴but their plot became known to Saul. They were watching the gates day and night so that they might kill him, ^{*} ²⁵but his disciples took him by night and let him down through an opening in the wall,^s lowering him in a basket.

SAUL IN JERUSALEM

26 When he had come to Jerusalem, he attempted to join the disciples, and they were all afraid of him, for they did not believe that he was a disciple. ^{*} ²⁷But Barnabas took him, brought him to the apostles, and described for them how on the road he had seen the Lord, who had spoken to him, and how in Damascus he had spoken boldly in the name of Jesus. ^{*} ²⁸So he went in and out among them in Jerusalem, speaking boldly in the name of the Lord. ²⁹He spoke and argued with the Hellenists, but they were attempting to kill him. ^{*} ³⁰When the brothers and sisters learned of it, they brought him down to Caesarea and sent him off to Tarsus.

31 Meanwhile the church throughout Judea, Galilee, and Samaria had peace and was built up. Living in the fear of the Lord and in the comfort of the Holy Spirit, it increased in numbers. ^{*}

THE HEALING OF AENEAS

32 Now as Peter went here and there among all the brothers and sisters,^t he came down also to the saints living in Lydda.* ³³There he found a man named Aeneas, who had been bedridden for eight years, for he was paralyzed. ³⁴Peter said to him, “Aeneas, Jesus Christ heals you; get up and make your bed!” And immediately he got up.* ³⁵And all the residents of Lydda and Sharon saw him and turned to the Lord.*

PETER IN LYDDA AND JOPPA

36 Now in Joppa there was a disciple whose name was Tabitha, which in Greek is Dorcas.^u She was devoted to good works and acts of charity.* ³⁷At that time she became ill and died. When they had washed her, they laid her in a room upstairs.* ³⁸Since Lydda was near Joppa, the disciples, who heard that Peter was there, sent two men to him with the request, “Please come to us without delay.”* ³⁹So Peter got up and went with them, and when he arrived, they took him to the room upstairs. All the widows stood beside him, weeping and showing tunics and other clothing that Dorcas had made while she was with them.* ⁴⁰Peter put all of them outside, and then he knelt down and prayed. He turned to the body and said, “Tabitha, get up.” Then she opened her eyes, and seeing Peter, she sat up.* ⁴¹He gave her his hand and helped her up. Then calling the saints and widows, he showed her to be alive.* ⁴²This became known throughout Joppa, and many believed in the Lord. ⁴³Meanwhile, he stayed in Joppa for some time with a certain Simon, a tanner.*

Acts 10

PETER AND CORNELIUS

1 In Caesarea there was a man named Cornelius, a centurion of the Italian Cohort, as it was called. **2** He was a devout man who feared God with all his household; he gave alms generously to the people and prayed constantly to God. **3** One afternoon at about three o'clock he had a vision in which he clearly saw an angel of God coming in and saying to him, "Cornelius." **4** He stared at him in terror and said, "What is it, Lord?" He answered, "Your prayers and your alms have ascended as a memorial before God." **5** Now send men to Joppa for a certain Simon who is called Peter; **6** he is lodging with Simon, a tanner, whose house is by the seaside." **7** When the angel who spoke to him had left, he called two of his slaves and a devout soldier from the ranks of those who served him, **8** and after telling them everything he sent them to Joppa.

9 About noon the next day, as they were on their journey and approaching the city, Peter went up on the roof to pray. **10** He became hungry and wanted something to eat, and while it was being prepared he fell into a trance. **11** He saw the heaven opened and something like a large sheet coming down, being lowered to the ground by its four corners. **12** In it were all kinds of four-footed creatures and reptiles and birds of the air. **13** Then he heard a voice saying, "Get up, Peter; kill and eat." **14** But Peter said, "By no means, Lord, for I have never eaten anything that is profane or unclean." **15** The voice said to him again, a second time, "What God has made clean, you must not call profane." **16** This happened three times, and the thing was suddenly taken up to heaven.

17 Now while Peter was greatly puzzled about what to make of the vision that he had seen, suddenly the men sent by Cornelius appeared. They were asking for Simon's house and were standing by the gate. **18** They called out to ask whether Simon, who was called Peter, was staying there. **19** While Peter was still thinking about the vision, the Spirit said to him, "Look, three^v men are searching for you." **20** Now get up, go down, and go with them without hesitation, for I have sent them." **21** So Peter went down to the

men and said, “I am the one you are looking for; what is the reason for your coming?” ²²They answered, “Cornelius, a centurion, a righteous^w and God-fearing man who is well spoken of by the whole Jewish people, was directed by a holy angel to send for you to come to his house and to hear what you have to say.”^{*} ²³So Peter^x invited them in and gave them lodging.

The next day he got up and went with them, and some of the brothers and sisters from Joppa accompanied him.^{*} ²⁴The following day they came to Caesarea. Cornelius was expecting them and had called together his relatives and close friends. ²⁵On Peter’s arrival, Cornelius met him and, falling at his feet, worshiped him. ²⁶But Peter made him get up, saying, “Stand up; I am only a mortal.”^{*} ²⁷And as he talked with him, he went in and found that many had assembled,²⁸ and he said to them, “You yourselves know that it is improper for a Jew to associate with or to visit an outsider, but God has shown me that I should not call anyone profane or unclean.”^{*} ²⁹So when I was sent for, I came without objection. Now may I ask why you sent for me?”

30 Cornelius replied, “Four days ago at this very hour, at three o’clock, I was praying in my house when suddenly a man in dazzling clothes stood before me. ³¹He said, ‘Cornelius, your prayer has been heard, and your alms have been remembered before God. ³²Send therefore to Joppa and ask for Simon, who is called Peter; he is staying in the home of Simon, a tanner, by the sea.’ ³³Therefore I sent for you immediately, and you have been kind enough to come. So now all of us are here in the presence of God to listen to all that the Lord has commanded you to say.”

GENTILES HEAR THE GOOD NEWS

34 Then Peter began to speak to them: “I truly understand that God shows no partiality,^{*} ³⁵but in every people anyone who fears him and practices righteousness^y is acceptable to him.”^{*} ³⁶You know the message he sent to the people of Israel, preaching peace by Jesus Christ—he is Lord of all.^{*} ³⁷That message spread throughout Judea, beginning in Galilee after the baptism that John announced: ³⁸how God anointed Jesus of Nazareth with the Holy Spirit and with power; how he went about doing good and healing all who were oppressed by the devil, for God was with him.^{*} ³⁹We are

witnesses to all that he did both in Judea and in Jerusalem. They put him to death by hanging him on a tree,* ⁴⁰but God raised him on the third day and allowed him to appear,* ⁴¹not to all the people but to us who were chosen by God as witnesses and who ate and drank with him after he rose from the dead.* ⁴²He commanded us to preach to the people and to testify that he is the one ordained by God as judge of the living and the dead.* ⁴³All the prophets testify about him that everyone who believes in him receives forgiveness of sins through his name.”*

GENTILES RECEIVE THE HOLY SPIRIT

44 While Peter was still speaking, the Holy Spirit fell upon all who heard the word.* ⁴⁵The circumcised believers who had come with Peter were astounded that the gift of the Holy Spirit had been poured out even on the gentiles,* ⁴⁶for they heard them speaking in tongues and extolling God. Then Peter said, ⁴⁷“Can anyone withhold the water for baptizing these people who have received the Holy Spirit just as we have?”* ⁴⁸So he ordered them to be baptized in the name of Jesus Christ. Then they invited him to stay for several days.*

Acts 11

PETER'S REPORT TO THE CHURCH AT JERUSALEM

1 Now the apostles and the brothers and sisters who were in Judea heard that the gentiles had also accepted the word of God. **2** So when Peter went up to Jerusalem, the circumcised believers^z criticized him,^{*} **3** saying, “Why did you go to uncircumcised men and eat with them?”^{*} **4** Then Peter began to explain it to them, step by step, saying, **5** “I was in the city of Joppa praying, and in a trance I saw a vision. There was something like a large sheet coming down from heaven, being lowered by its four corners, and it came close to me.^{*} **6** As I looked at it closely I saw four-footed animals, beasts of prey, reptiles, and birds of the air. **7** I also heard a voice saying to me, ‘Get up, Peter; kill and eat.’ **8** But I replied, ‘By no means, Lord, for nothing profane or unclean has ever entered my mouth.’ **9** But a second time the voice answered from heaven, ‘What God has made clean, you must not call profane.’ **10** This happened three times; then everything was pulled up again to heaven. **11** At that very moment three men, sent to me from Caesarea, arrived at the house where we were. **12** The Spirit told me to go with them and not to make a distinction between them and us.^a These six brothers also accompanied me, and we entered the man’s house.^{*} **13** He told us how he had seen the angel standing in his house and saying, ‘Send to Joppa and bring Simon, who is called Peter;^{*} **14** he will give you a message by which you and your entire household will be saved.’ **15** And as I began to speak, the Holy Spirit fell upon them just as it had upon us at the beginning.^{*} **16** And I remembered the word of the Lord, how he had said, ‘John baptized with water, but you will be baptized with the Holy Spirit.’^{*} **17** If then God gave them the same gift that he gave us when we believed in the Lord Jesus Christ, who was I that I could hinder God?”^{*} **18** When they heard this, they were silenced. And they praised God, saying, “Then God has given even to the gentiles the repentance that leads to life.”^{*}

THE CHURCH IN ANTIOCH

19 Now those who were scattered because of the persecution that took place over Stephen traveled as far as Phoenicia, Cyprus, and Antioch, and they spoke the word to no one except Jews.* ²⁰But among them were some men of Cyprus and Cyrene who, on coming to Antioch, spoke to the Hellenists^b also, proclaiming the Lord Jesus.* ²¹The hand of the Lord was with them, and a great number became believers and turned to the Lord.* ²²News of this came to the ears of the church in Jerusalem, and they sent Barnabas to Antioch. ²³When he came and saw the grace of God, he rejoiced, and he exhorted them all to remain faithful to the Lord with steadfast devotion,* ²⁴for he was a good man, full of the Holy Spirit and of faith. And a great many people were brought to the Lord.* ²⁵Then Barnabas went to Tarsus to look for Saul,* ²⁶and when he had found him he brought him to Antioch. So it was that for an entire year they met with the church and taught a great many people, and it was in Antioch that the disciples were first called “Christians.”*

27 At that time prophets came down from Jerusalem to Antioch.* ²⁸One of them named Agabus stood up and predicted by the Spirit that there would be a severe famine over all the world, and this took place during the reign of Claudius.* ²⁹The disciples determined that, according to their ability, each would send relief to the brothers and sisters living in Judea;* ³⁰this they did, sending it to the elders by Barnabas and Saul.*

Acts 12

JAMES KILLED AND PETER IMPRISONED

1 About that time King Herod laid violent hands upon some who belonged to the church. ²He had James, the brother of John, killed with the sword.* ³After he saw that it pleased the Jews, he proceeded to arrest Peter also. (This was during the Festival of Unleavened Bread.)* ⁴When he had seized him, he put him in prison and handed him over to four squads of soldiers to guard him, intending to bring him out to the people after the Passover. ⁵While Peter was kept in prison, the church prayed fervently to God for him.*

PETER DELIVERED FROM PRISON

6 The very night before Herod was going to bring him out, Peter, bound with two chains, was sleeping between two soldiers, while guards in front of the door were keeping watch over the prison.* ⁷Suddenly an angel of the Lord appeared, and a light shone in the cell. He tapped Peter on the side and woke him, saying, “Get up quickly.” And the chains fell off his wrists.* ⁸The angel said to him, “Fasten your belt and put on your sandals.” He did so. Then he said to him, “Wrap your cloak around you and follow me.” ⁹Peter^c went out and followed him; he did not realize that what was happening with the angel’s help was real; he thought he was seeing a vision.* ¹⁰After they had passed the first and the second guard, they came before the iron gate leading into the city. It opened for them of its own accord, and they went outside and walked along a lane, when suddenly the angel left him.* ¹¹Then Peter came to himself and said, “Now I am sure that the Lord has sent his angel and rescued me from the hands of Herod and from all that the Jewish people were expecting.”*

12 As soon as he realized this, he went to the house of Mary, the mother of John whose other name was Mark, where many had gathered and were praying.* ¹³When he knocked at the outer gate, a maid named Rhoda came to answer.* ¹⁴On recognizing Peter’s voice, she was so overjoyed that, instead of opening the gate, she ran in and announced that Peter was

standing at the gate.* ¹⁵They said to her, “You are out of your mind!” But she insisted that it was so. They said, “It is his angel.”* ¹⁶Meanwhile Peter continued knocking, and when they opened the gate they saw him and were amazed. ¹⁷He motioned to them with his hand to be silent and described for them how the Lord had brought him out of the prison. And he added, “Tell this to James and to the brothers and sisters.” Then he left and went to another place.*

18 When morning came, there was no small commotion among the soldiers over what had become of Peter. ¹⁹When Herod had searched for him and could not find him, he examined the guards and ordered them to be put to death. Then he went down from Judea to Caesarea and stayed there.*

THE DEATH OF HEROD

20 Now Herod^d was angry with the people of Tyre and Sidon. So they came to him in a body, and after winning over Blastus, the king’s personal attendant, they asked for a reconciliation, because their country depended on the king’s country for food.* ²¹On an appointed day Herod put on his royal robes, took his seat on the platform, and delivered a public address to them. ²²The people kept shouting, “The voice of a god and not of a mortal!” ²³And immediately, because he had not given the glory to God, an angel of the Lord struck him down, and he was eaten by worms and died.*

24 But the word of God continued to advance and gain adherents.* ²⁵Then after completing their mission Barnabas and Saul returned to^e Jerusalem and brought with them John, whose other name was Mark.*

Acts 13

BARNABAS AND SAUL COMMISSIONED

1 Now in the church at Antioch there were prophets and teachers: Barnabas, Simeon who was called Niger, Lucius of Cyrene, Manaen a childhood friend of Herod the ruler,^f and Saul.* **2** While they were worshiping the Lord and fasting, the Holy Spirit said, “Set apart for me Barnabas and Saul for the work to which I have called them.”* **3** Then after fasting and praying they laid their hands on them and sent them off.*

THE APOSTLES PREACH IN CYPRUS

4 So, being sent out by the Holy Spirit, they went down to Seleucia, and from there they sailed to Cyprus.* **5** When they arrived at Salamis, they proclaimed the word of God in the Jewish synagogues. And they had John also to assist them.* **6** When they had gone through the whole island as far as Paphos, they met a certain magician, a Jewish false prophet, named Bar-Jesus.* **7** He was with the proconsul, Sergius Paulus, an intelligent man who summoned Barnabas and Saul and wanted to hear the word of God.* **8** But the magician Elymas (for that is the translation of his name) opposed them and tried to turn the proconsul away from the faith.* **9** But Saul, also known as Paul, filled with the Holy Spirit, looked intently at him* **10** and said, “You son of the devil, you enemy of all righteousness, full of all deceit and villainy, will you not stop making crooked the straight paths of the Lord?”* **11** And now listen—the hand of the Lord is against you, and you will be blind for a while, unable to see the sun.” Immediately mist and darkness came over him, and he fumbled about for someone to lead him by the hand.* **12** When the proconsul saw what had happened, he believed, for he was astonished at the teaching about the Lord.

PAUL AND BARNABAS IN ANTIOCH OF PISIDIA

13 Then Paul and his companions set sail from Paphos and came to Perga in Pamphylia. John, however, left them and returned to Jerusalem,* **14** but

they went on from Perga and came to Antioch in Pisidia. And on the Sabbath day they went into the synagogue and sat down.* ¹⁵After the reading of the Law and the Prophets, the officials of the synagogue sent them a message, saying, “Brothers,^g if you have any word of exhortation for the people, give it.” ¹⁶So Paul stood up and with a gesture began to speak:

“Fellow Israelites^h and others who fear God, listen. ¹⁷The God of this people Israel chose our ancestors and made the people great during their stay in the land of Egypt, and with uplifted arm he led them out of it.* ¹⁸For about forty years he put up withⁱ them in the wilderness.* ¹⁹After he had destroyed seven peoples in the land of Canaan, he gave them their land as an inheritance* ²⁰for about four hundred fifty years. After that he gave them judges until the time of the prophet Samuel.* ²¹Then they asked for a king, and God gave them Saul son of Kish, a man of the tribe of Benjamin, who reigned for forty years.* ²²When he had removed him, he made David their king. In his testimony about him he said, ‘I have found David, son of Jesse, to be a man after my heart, who will carry out all my wishes.’* ²³Of this man’s posterity God has brought to Israel a Savior, Jesus, as he promised;* ²⁴before his coming John had already proclaimed a baptism of repentance to all the people of Israel.* ²⁵And as John was finishing his work, he said, ‘What do you suppose that I am? I am not he. No, but one is coming after me; I am not worthy to untie the strap of the sandals^j on his feet.’* ”

26 “Brothers and sisters,^k you descendants of Abraham’s family and others who fear God, to us^l the message of this salvation has been sent. ²⁷Because the residents of Jerusalem and their leaders did not recognize him or understand the words of the prophets that are read every Sabbath, they fulfilled those words by condemning him.* ²⁸Even though they found no cause for a sentence of death, they asked Pilate to have him killed.* ²⁹When they had carried out everything that was written about him, they took him down from the tree and laid him in a tomb.* ³⁰But God raised him from the dead,* ³¹and for many days he appeared to those who came up with him from Galilee to Jerusalem, and they are now his witnesses to the people.* ³²And we bring you the good news that what God promised to our ancestors* ³³he has fulfilled for us, their children,^m by raising Jesus; as also it is written in the second psalm,

‘You are my Son;
today I have begotten you.’^{*}

³⁴“As to his raising him from the dead, no more to return to corruption, he has spoken in this way,

‘I will give you the holy promises made to David.’^{*}

³⁵“Therefore he has also said in another psalm,

‘You will not let your Holy One experience corruption.’^{*}

³⁶“For David, after he had served the purpose of God in his own generation, died,ⁿ was laid beside his ancestors, and experienced corruption,^{*} ³⁷but he whom God raised up experienced no corruption. ³⁸Let it be known to you therefore, brothers and sisters,^o that through this man forgiveness of sins is proclaimed to you;^{*} ³⁹by this Jesus^p everyone who believes is set free from all those sins^q from which you could not be freed by the law of Moses.^{*}

⁴⁰Beware, therefore, that what the prophets said does not happen to you:^{*}

⁴¹‘Look, you scoffers!

Be amazed and perish,

for in your days I am doing a work,

a work that you will never believe, even if someone tells
you.’ ”

42 As Paul and Barnabas^r were going out, the people urged them to speak about these things again the next Sabbath. ⁴³When the meeting of the synagogue broke up, many Jews and devout converts to Judaism followed Paul and Barnabas, who spoke to them and urged them to continue in the grace of God.^{*}

44 The next Sabbath almost the whole city gathered to hear the word of the Lord.^s ⁴⁵But when the Jews saw the crowds, they were filled with jealousy, and blaspheming, they contradicted what was spoken by Paul.^{*}

⁴⁶Then both Paul and Barnabas spoke out boldly, saying, “It was necessary that the word of God should be spoken first to you. Since you reject it and judge yourselves to be unworthy of eternal life, we are now turning to the gentiles.^{*} ⁴⁷For so the Lord has commanded us, saying,

‘I have set you to be a light for the gentiles,

so that you may bring salvation to the ends of the earth.’ ”*

48 When the gentiles heard this, they were glad and praised the word of the Lord, and as many as had been destined for eternal life became believers. ⁴⁹Thus the word of the Lord spread throughout the region. ⁵⁰But the Jews incited the devout women of high standing and the leading men of the city and stirred up persecution against Paul and Barnabas and drove them out of their region. ⁵¹So they shook the dust off their feet in protest against them and went to Iconium. * ⁵²And the disciples were filled with joy and with the Holy Spirit. *

Acts 14

PAUL AND BARNABAS IN ICONIUM

1 The same thing occurred in Iconium, where Paul^t and Barnabas^u went into the Jewish synagogue and spoke in such a way that a great number of both Jews and Greeks became believers. ²But the unbelieving Jews stirred up the gentiles and poisoned their minds against the brothers. ³So they remained for a long time speaking boldly for the Lord, who testified to the word of his grace by granting signs and wonders to be done through them.* ⁴But the residents of the city were divided: some sided with the Jews, and some with the apostles.* ⁵And when an attempt was made by both gentiles and Jews, with their rulers, to mistreat them and to stone them,* ⁶the apostles^v learned of it and fled to Lystra and Derbe, cities of Lycaonia, and to the surrounding region,* ⁷and there they continued proclaiming the good news.

PAUL AND BARNABAS IN LYSTRA AND DERBE

8 In Lystra there was a man sitting who could not use his feet and had never walked, for he had been lame from birth.* ⁹He listened to Paul as he was speaking. And Paul, looking at him intently and seeing that he had faith to be healed,* ¹⁰said in a loud voice, “Stand upright on your feet.” And the man^w sprang up and began to walk. ¹¹When the crowds saw what Paul had done, they shouted in the Lycaonian language, “The gods have come down to us in human form!”* ¹²Barnabas they called Zeus, and Paul they called Hermes, because he was the chief speaker. ¹³The priest of Zeus, whose temple was just outside the city,^x brought oxen and garlands to the gates; he and the crowds wanted to offer sacrifice. ¹⁴When the apostles Barnabas and Paul heard of it, they tore their clothes and rushed out into the crowd, shouting, ¹⁵“People,^y why are you doing this? We are mortals just like you, and we bring you good news, that you should turn from these worthless things to the living God, who made the heaven and the earth and the sea and all that is in them.* ¹⁶In past generations he allowed all peoples to follow their own ways,* ¹⁷yet he has not left himself without a witness in doing good, giving you rains from heaven and fruitful seasons and filling you with

food and your hearts with joy.”* ¹⁸Even with these words, they scarcely restrained the crowds from offering sacrifice to them.

19 But Jews came there from Antioch and Iconium and won over the crowds. Then they stoned Paul and dragged him out of the city, supposing that he was dead.* ²⁰But when the disciples surrounded him, he got up and went into the city. The next day he went on with Barnabas to Derbe.*

THE RETURN TO ANTIOCH IN SYRIA

21 After they had proclaimed the good news to that city and had made many disciples, they returned to Lystra, then on to Iconium and Antioch. ²²There they strengthened the souls of the disciples and encouraged them to continue in the faith, saying, “It is through many persecutions that we must enter the kingdom of God.”* ²³And after they had appointed elders for them in each church, with prayer and fasting they entrusted them to the Lord in whom they had come to believe.*

24 Then they passed through Pisidia and came to Pamphylia. ²⁵When they had spoken the word in Perga, they went down to Attalia. ²⁶From there they sailed back to Antioch, where they had been commended to the grace of God for the work^z that they had completed.* ²⁷When they arrived, they called the church together and related all that God had done with them and how he had opened a door of faith for the gentiles. ²⁸And they stayed there with the disciples for some time.

Acts 15

THE COUNCIL AT JERUSALEM

1 Then certain individuals came down from Judea and were teaching the brothers, “Unless you are circumcised according to the custom of Moses, you cannot be saved.”* **2** And after Paul and Barnabas had no small dissension and debate with them, Paul and Barnabas and some of the others were appointed to go up to Jerusalem to discuss this question with the apostles and the elders.* **3** So they were sent on their way by the church, and as they passed through both Phoenicia and Samaria, they reported the conversion of the gentiles and brought great joy to all the brothers and sisters.* **4** When they came to Jerusalem, they were welcomed by the church and the apostles and the elders, and they reported all that God had done with them.* **5** But some believers who belonged to the sect of the Pharisees stood up and said, “It is necessary for them to be circumcised and ordered to keep the law of Moses.”

6 The apostles and the elders met together to consider this matter. **7** After there had been much debate, Peter stood up and said to them, “My brothers,^a you know that in the early days God made a choice among you, that I should be the one through whom the gentiles would hear the message of the good news and become believers.* **8** And God, who knows the human heart, testified to them by giving them the Holy Spirit, just as he did to us,* **9** and in cleansing their hearts by faith he has made no distinction between them and us.* **10** Now, therefore, why are you putting God to the test by placing on the neck of the disciples a yoke that neither our ancestors nor we have been able to bear?*” **11** On the contrary, we believe that we will be saved through the grace of the Lord Jesus, just as they will.”*

12 The whole assembly kept silence and listened to Barnabas and Paul as they told of all the signs and wonders that God had done through them among the gentiles.* **13** After they finished speaking, James replied, “My brothers,^b listen to me.* **14** Simeon has related how God first looked favorably on the gentiles, to take from among them a people for his name. **15** This agrees with the words of the prophets, as it is written,

¹⁶‘After this I will return,
and I will rebuild the dwelling of David, which has fallen;
from its ruins I will rebuild it,
and I will set it up,’^{*}

¹⁷so that all other peoples may seek the Lord—
even all the gentiles over whom my name has been called.

Thus says the Lord, who has been making these things
¹⁸known from long ago.’^c

¹⁹“Therefore I have reached the decision that we should not trouble those
gentiles who are turning to God, ²⁰but we should write to them to abstain
only from things polluted by idols and from sexual immorality and from
whatever has been strangled^d and from blood.’^{*} ²¹For in every city, for
generations past, Moses has had those who proclaim him, for he has been
read aloud every Sabbath in the synagogues.”^{*}

THE COUNCIL’S LETTER TO GENTILE BELIEVERS

22 Then the apostles and the elders, with the consent of the whole
church, decided to choose men from among them and to send them to
Antioch with Paul and Barnabas. They sent Judas called Barsabbas, and
Silas, leaders among the brothers, ²³with the following letter: “The brothers,
both the apostles and the elders, to the brothers and sisters of gentile origin
in Antioch and Syria and Cilicia, greetings. ²⁴Since we have heard that
certain persons who have gone out from us, though with no instructions
from us, have said things to disturb you and have unsettled your minds,^{e,*}
²⁵we have decided unanimously to choose men and send them to you, along
with our beloved Barnabas and Paul, ²⁶who have risked their lives for the
sake of our Lord Jesus Christ.’^{*} ²⁷We have therefore sent Judas and Silas,
who themselves will tell you the same things by word of mouth. ²⁸For it has
seemed good to the Holy Spirit and to us to impose on you no further
burden than these essentials: ²⁹that you abstain from what has been
sacrificed to idols and from blood and from what is strangled^f and from
sexual immorality. If you keep yourselves from these, you will do well.
Farewell.”^{*}

30 So they were sent off and went down to Antioch. When they gathered the congregation together, they delivered the letter. ³¹When they read it, they rejoiced at the exhortation. ³²Judas and Silas, who were themselves prophets, said much to encourage and strengthen the brothers and sisters. ³³After they had been there for some time, they were sent off in peace by the brothers and sisters to those who had sent them.^{g,*} ³⁵But Paul and Barnabas remained in Antioch, and there, with many others, they taught and proclaimed the word of the Lord.

PAUL AND BARNABAS SEPARATE

36 After some days Paul said to Barnabas, “Come, let us return and visit the brothers and sisters in every city where we proclaimed the word of the Lord and see how they are doing.”^{*} ³⁷Barnabas wanted to take with them John called Mark.^{*} ³⁸But Paul decided not to take with them one who had deserted them in Pamphylia and had not accompanied them in the work.^{*} ³⁹The disagreement became so sharp that they parted company; Barnabas took Mark with him and sailed away to Cyprus. ⁴⁰But Paul chose Silas and set out, the brothers and sisters commending him to the grace of the Lord. ⁴¹He went through Syria and Cilicia, strengthening the churches.^{*}

Acts 16

TIMOTHY JOINS PAUL AND SILAS

1 Paul^h went on also to Derbe and to Lystra, where there was a disciple named Timothy, the son of a Jewish woman who was a believer, but his father was a Greek.* **2**He was well spoken of by the brothers and sisters in Lystra and Iconium. **3**Paul wanted Timothy to accompany him, and he took him and had him circumcised because of the Jews who were in those places, for they all knew that his father was a Greek.* **4**As they went from town to town, they delivered to them for observance the decisions that had been reached by the apostles and elders who were in Jerusalem.* **5**So the churches were strengthened in the faith and increased in numbers daily.*

PAUL'S VISION OF THE MAN OF MACEDONIA

6 They went through the region of Phrygia and Galatia, having been forbidden by the Holy Spirit to speak the word in Asia.* **7**When they had come opposite Mysia, they attempted to go into Bithynia, but the Spirit of Jesus did not allow them;* **8**so, passing by Mysia, they went down to Troas.* **9**During the night Paul had a vision: there stood a man of Macedonia pleading with him and saying, "Come over to Macedonia and help us."* **10**When he had seen the vision, we immediately tried to cross over to Macedonia, being convinced that God had called us to proclaim the good news to them.*

THE CONVERSION OF LYDIA

11 We thereforeⁱ set sail from Troas and took a straight course to Samothrace, the following day to Neapolis,* **12**and from there to Philippi, which is a leading city of the district of Macedonia and a Roman colony. We remained in this city for some days.* **13**On the Sabbath day we went outside the gate by the river, where we supposed^j there was a place of prayer, and we sat down and spoke to the women who had gathered there. **14**A certain woman named Lydia, a worshiper of God, was listening to us;

she was from the city of Thyatira and a dealer in purple cloth. The Lord opened her heart to listen eagerly to what was said by Paul. ¹⁵When she and her household were baptized, she urged us, saying, “If you have judged me to be faithful to the Lord, come and stay at my home.” And she prevailed upon us.*

PAUL AND SILAS IN PRISON

16 One day as we were going to the place of prayer, we met a female slave who had a spirit of divination and brought her owners a great deal of money by fortune-telling.* ¹⁷While she followed Paul and us, she would cry out, “These men are slaves of the Most High God, who proclaim to you^k the way of salvation.”* ¹⁸She kept doing this for many days. But Paul, very much annoyed, turned and said to the spirit, “I order you in the name of Jesus Christ to come out of her.” And it came out that very hour.

19 But when her owners saw that their hope of making money was gone, they seized Paul and Silas and dragged them into the marketplace before the authorities.* ²⁰When they had brought them before the magistrates, they said, “These men, these Jews, are disturbing our city* ²¹and are advocating customs that are not lawful for us, being Romans, to adopt or observe.” ²²The crowd joined in attacking them, and the magistrates had them stripped of their clothing and ordered them to be beaten with rods.* ²³After they had given them a severe flogging, they threw them into prison and ordered the jailer to keep them securely.* ²⁴Following these instructions, he put them in the innermost cell and fastened their feet in the stocks.*

25 About midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the prisoners were listening to them.* ²⁶Suddenly there was an earthquake so violent that the foundations of the prison were shaken, and immediately all the doors were opened and everyone’s chains were unfastened.* ²⁷When the jailer woke up and saw the prison doors wide open, he drew his sword and was about to kill himself, since he supposed that the prisoners had escaped.* ²⁸But Paul shouted in a loud voice, “Do not harm yourself, for we are all here.” ²⁹The jailer^l called for lights, and rushing in, he fell down trembling before Paul and Silas. ³⁰Then he brought them outside and said, “Sirs, what must I do to be saved?”* ³¹They

answered, “Believe in the Lord Jesus, and you will be saved, you and your household.”* ³²They spoke the word of the Lord^m to him and to all who were in his house. ³³At the same hour of the night he took them and washed their wounds; then he and his entire family were baptized without delay. ³⁴He brought them up into the house and set food before them, and he and his entire household rejoiced that he had become a believer in God.*

35 When morning came, the magistrates sent the police, saying, “Let those men go.” ³⁶And the jailer reported the message to Paul, saying, “The magistrates sent word to let you go; therefore come out now and go in peace.”* ³⁷But Paul replied, “They have beaten us in public, uncondemned, men who are Romans, and have thrown us into prison, and now are they going to discharge us in secret? Certainly not! Let them come and take us out themselves.”* ³⁸The police reported these words to the magistrates, and they were afraid when they heard that they were Romans,* ³⁹so they came and apologized to them. And they took them out and asked them to leave the city.* ⁴⁰After leaving the prison they went to Lydia’s home, and when they had seen and encouraged the brothers and sisters there, they departed.*

Acts 17

THE UPROAR IN THESSALONICA

1 After Paul and Silasⁿ had passed through Amphipolis and Apollonia, they came to Thessalonica, where there was a Jewish synagogue.* **2**And Paul went in, as was his custom, and on three Sabbath days argued with them from the scriptures,* **3**explaining and proving that it was necessary for the Messiah^o to suffer and to rise from the dead and saying, “This is the Messiah,^p Jesus whom I am proclaiming to you.”* **4**Some of them were persuaded and joined Paul and Silas, as did a great many of the devout Greeks and not a few of the leading women.* **5**But the Jews became jealous, and with the help of some ruffians in the marketplaces they formed a mob and set the city in an uproar. While they were searching for Paul and Silas to bring them out to the assembly, they attacked Jason’s house.* **6**When they could not find them, they dragged Jason and some brothers and sisters before the city authorities, shouting, “These people who have been turning the world upside down have come here also,* **7**and Jason has entertained them as guests. They are all acting contrary to the decrees of the emperor, saying that there is another king named Jesus.”* **8**The people and the city officials were disturbed when they heard this,⁹ and after they had taken bail from Jason and the others, they let them go.

PAUL AND SILAS IN BEROEA

10 That very night the brothers and sisters sent Paul and Silas off to Beroea, and when they arrived they went to the Jewish synagogue.* **11**These Jews were more receptive than those in Thessalonica, for they welcomed the message very eagerly and examined the scriptures every day to see whether these things were so.* **12**Many of them therefore believed, including not a few Greek women and men of high standing. **13**But when the Jews of Thessalonica learned that the word of God had been proclaimed by Paul in Beroea as well, they came there, too, to stir up and incite the crowds. **14**Then the brothers and sisters immediately sent Paul away to the coast, but Silas and Timothy remained behind. **15**Those who conducted Paul

brought him as far as Athens, and, after receiving instructions to have Silas and Timothy join him as soon as possible, they left him.*

PAUL IN ATHENS

16 While Paul was waiting for them in Athens, he was deeply distressed to see that the city was full of idols.* ¹⁷So he argued in the synagogue with the Jews and the devout persons and also in the marketplace^q every day with those who happened to be there. ¹⁸Also some Epicurean and Stoic philosophers debated with him. Some said, “What does this pretentious babbler want to say?” Others said, “He seems to be a proclaimer of foreign divinities.” (This was because he was telling the good news about Jesus and the resurrection.) ¹⁹So they took him and brought him to the Areopagus and asked him, “May we know what this new teaching is that you are presenting?” ²⁰It sounds rather strange to us, so we would like to know what it means.” ²¹Now all the Athenians and the foreigners living there would spend their time in nothing but telling or hearing something new.

22 Then Paul stood in front of the Areopagus and said, “Athenians, I see how extremely spiritual you are in every way. ²³For as I went through the city and looked carefully at the objects of your worship, I found among them an altar with the inscription, ‘To an unknown god.’ What therefore you worship as unknown, this I proclaim to you. ²⁴The God who made the world and everything in it, he who is Lord of heaven and earth, does not live in shrines made by human hands,* ²⁵nor is he served by human hands, as though he needed anything, since he himself gives to all mortals life and breath and all things.* ²⁶From one ancestor^r he made all peoples to inhabit the whole earth, and he allotted the times of their existence and the boundaries of the places where they would live,* ²⁷so that they would search for God^s and perhaps fumble about for him and find him—though indeed he is not far from each one of us.* ²⁸For ‘In him we live and move and have our being’; as even some of your own poets have said,

‘For we, too, are his offspring.’*

²⁹“Since we are God’s offspring, we ought not to think that the deity is like gold or silver or stone, an image formed by the art and imagination of mortals.* ³⁰While God has overlooked the times of human ignorance, now

he commands all people everywhere to repent,^{*} ³¹because he has fixed a day on which he will have the world judged in righteousness by a man whom he has appointed, and of this he has given assurance to all by raising him from the dead.”^{*}

32 When they heard of the resurrection of the dead, some scoffed, but others said, “We will hear you again about this.” ³³At that point Paul left them. ³⁴But some of them joined him and became believers, including Dionysius the Areopagite and a woman named Damaris and others with them.

Acts 18

PAUL IN CORINTH

1 After this Paul^t left Athens and went to Corinth.* **2**There he found a Jew named Aquila from Pontus, who had recently come from Italy with his wife Priscilla, because Claudius had ordered all Jews to leave Rome. Paul^u went to see them,* **3**and, because he was of the same trade, he stayed with them, and they worked together—by trade they were tentmakers.* **4**Every Sabbath he would argue in the synagogue and would try to convince Jews and Greeks.*

5 When Silas and Timothy arrived from Macedonia, Paul was occupied with proclaiming the word,^v testifying to the Jews that the Messiah^w was Jesus.* **6**When they opposed and reviled him, in protest he shook the dust from his clothes^x and said to them, “Your blood be on your own heads! I am innocent. From now on I will go to the gentiles.”* **7**Then he left the synagogue^y and went to the house of a man named Titius^z Justus, a worshiper of God; his house was next door to the synagogue.* **8**Crispus, the official of the synagogue, became a believer in the Lord, together with all his household, and many of the Corinthians who heard Paul became believers and were baptized.* **9**One night the Lord said to Paul in a vision, “Do not be afraid, but speak and do not be silent,* **10**for I am with you, and no one will lay a hand on you to harm you, for there are many in this city who are my people.”* **11**He stayed there a year and six months, teaching the word of God among them.

12 But when Gallio was proconsul of Achaia, the Jews made a united attack on Paul and brought him before the tribunal. **13**They said, “This man is persuading people to worship God in ways that are contrary to the law.” **14**Just as Paul was about to speak, Gallio said to the Jews, “If it were a matter of crime or serious villainy, I would be justified in accepting the complaint of you Jews,* **15**but since it is a matter of questions about words and names and your own law, see to it yourselves; I do not wish to be a judge of these matters.” **16**And he dismissed them from the tribunal. **17**Then

all of them^a seized Sosthenes, the official of the synagogue, and beat him in front of the tribunal. But Gallio paid no attention to any of these things.*

PAUL'S RETURN TO ANTIOCH

18 After staying there for a considerable time, Paul said farewell to the brothers and sisters and sailed for Syria, accompanied by Priscilla and Aquila. At Cenchreae he had his hair cut, for he was under a vow.* ¹⁹When they reached Ephesus, he left them there, but first he himself went into the synagogue and had a discussion with the Jews. ²⁰When they asked him to stay longer, he declined, ²¹but on taking leave of them he said, “I^b will return to you, if God wills.” Then he set sail from Ephesus.*

22 When he had landed at Caesarea, he went up to Jerusalem^c and greeted the church and then went down to Antioch.* ²³After spending some time there he departed and went from place to place through the region of Galatia^d and Phrygia, strengthening all the disciples.*

MINISTRY OF APOLLOS

24 Now there came to Ephesus a Jew named Apollos from Alexandria. He was an eloquent man, well-versed in the scriptures.* ²⁵He had been instructed in the Way of the Lord, and he spoke with burning enthusiasm and taught accurately the things concerning Jesus, though he knew only the baptism of John.* ²⁶He began to speak boldly in the synagogue, but when Priscilla and Aquila heard him they took him aside and explained the Way of God to him more accurately. ²⁷And when he wished to cross over to Achaia, the brothers and sisters encouraged him and wrote to the disciples to welcome him. On his arrival he greatly helped those who through grace had become believers,* ²⁸for he powerfully refuted the Jews in public, showing by the scriptures that the Messiah^e is Jesus.*

Acts 19

PAUL IN EPHESUS

1 While Apollos was in Corinth, Paul passed through the interior regions and came to Ephesus, where he found some disciples.* **2**He said to them, “Did you receive the Holy Spirit when you became believers?” They replied, “No, we have not even heard that there is a Holy Spirit.” **3**Then he said, “Into what, then, were you baptized?” They answered, “Into John’s baptism.”* **4**Paul said, “John baptized with the baptism of repentance, telling the people to believe in the one who was to come after him, that is, in Jesus.”* **5**On hearing this, they were baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus. **6**When Paul had laid his hands on them, the Holy Spirit came upon them, and they spoke in tongues and prophesied,* **7**altogether there were about twelve of them.

8 He entered the synagogue and for three months spoke out boldly and argued persuasively about the kingdom of God.* **9**When some stubbornly refused to believe and spoke evil of the Way before the congregation, he left them, taking the disciples with him, and argued daily in the lecture hall of Tyrannus.^{f,*} **10**This continued for two years, so that all the residents of Asia, both Jews and Greeks, heard the word of the Lord.*

THE SONS OF SCEVA

11 God did extraordinary miracles through Paul,* **12**so that when the handkerchiefs or aprons that had touched his skin were brought to the sick, their diseases left them, and the evil spirits came out of them.* **13**Then some itinerant Jewish exorcists tried to use the name of the Lord Jesus over those who had evil spirits, saying, “I adjure you by the Jesus whom Paul proclaims.”* **14**Seven sons of a Jewish high priest named Sceva were doing this. **15**But the evil spirit said to them in reply, “Jesus I know, and Paul I know, but who are you?” **16**Then the man with the evil spirit leaped on them, mastered them all, and so overpowered them that they fled out of the house naked and wounded. **17**When this became known to all residents of

Ephesus, both Jews and Greeks, everyone was awestruck, and the name of the Lord Jesus was praised.*¹⁸ Also many of those who became believers confessed and disclosed their practices.¹⁹ A number of those who practiced magic collected their books and burned them publicly; when the value of these books^g was calculated, it was found to come to fifty thousand silver coins.²⁰ So the word of the Lord grew mightily and prevailed.*

THE RIOT IN EPHEBUS

21 Now after these things had been accomplished, Paul resolved in the Spirit to go through Macedonia and Achaia and then to go on to Jerusalem. He said, “After I have gone there, I must also see Rome.”*²² So he sent two of his helpers, Timothy and Erastus, to Macedonia, while he himself stayed for some time longer in Asia.*

23 About that time no little disturbance broke out concerning the Way.*²⁴ A man named Demetrius, a silversmith who made silver shrines of Artemis, brought no little business to the artisans.*²⁵ These he gathered together, with the workers of the same trade, and said, “Men, you know that we get our wealth from this business.²⁶ You also see and hear that not only in Ephesus but in almost the whole of Asia this Paul has persuaded and drawn away a considerable number of people by saying that gods made with hands are not gods.*²⁷ And there is danger not only that this trade of ours may come into disrepute but also that the temple of the great goddess Artemis will be scorned, and she will be deprived of her majesty that brought all Asia and the world to worship her.”

28 When they heard this, they were enraged and shouted, “Great is Artemis of the Ephesians!”*²⁹ The city was filled with the confusion, and people^h rushed together to the theater, dragging with them Gaius and Aristarchus, Macedonians who were Paul’s travel companions.*³⁰ Paul wished to go into the crowd, but the disciples would not let him; ³¹even some officials of the province of Asiaⁱ who were friendly to him sent him a message urging him not to venture into the theater.³² Meanwhile, some were shouting one thing, some another, for the assembly was in confusion, and most of them did not know why they had come together.*³³ Some of the crowd gave instructions to Alexander, whom the Jews had pushed forward.

And Alexander motioned for silence and tried to make a defense before the people.* ³⁴But when they recognized that he was a Jew, for about two hours all of them shouted in unison, “Great is Artemis of the Ephesians!” ³⁵But when the town clerk had quieted the crowd, he said, “Citizens of Ephesus, who is there who does not know that the city of the Ephesians is the temple keeper of the great Artemis and of the statue that fell from heaven?”* ³⁶Since these things cannot be denied, you ought to be quiet and do nothing rash. ³⁷You have brought these men here who are neither temple robbers nor blasphemers of our^j goddess.* ³⁸If therefore Demetrius and the artisans with him have a complaint against anyone, the courts are open, and there are proconsuls; let them bring charges there against one another.* ³⁹If there is anything further^k you want to know, it must be settled in the regular assembly. ⁴⁰For we are in danger of being charged with rioting today, since there is no cause that we can give to justify this commotion.” ⁴¹When he had said this, he dismissed the assembly.

Acts 20

PAUL GOES TO MACEDONIA AND GREECE

1 After the uproar had ceased, Paul sent for the disciples, and after encouraging them and saying farewell, he left for Macedonia.* **2** When he had gone through those regions and had given them much encouragement, he came to Greece, **3** where he stayed for three months. He was about to set sail for Syria when a plot was made against him by the Jews, so he decided to return through Macedonia.* **4** He was accompanied¹ by Sopater son of Pyrrhus from Beroea, by Aristarchus and Secundus from Thessalonica, by Gaius from Derbe, and by Timothy, as well as by Tychicus and Trophimus from Asia.* **5** They went ahead and were waiting for us in Troas, **6** but we sailed from Philippi after the days of Unleavened Bread, and in five days we joined them in Troas, where we stayed for seven days.*

PAUL'S FAREWELL VISIT TO TROAS

7 On the first day of the week, when we met to break bread, Paul was holding a discussion with them; since he intended to leave the next day, he continued speaking until midnight.* **8** There were many lamps in the room upstairs where we were meeting. **9** A young man named Eutychus, who was sitting in the window, began to sink off into a deep sleep while Paul talked still longer. Overcome by sleep, he fell to the ground three floors below and was picked up dead. **10** But Paul went down and bending over him took him in his arms and said, "Do not be alarmed, for his life is in him."* **11** Then Paul went upstairs, and after he had broken bread and eaten, he continued to converse with them until dawn; then he left. **12** Meanwhile they had taken the boy away alive and were not a little comforted.

THE VOYAGE FROM TROAS TO MILETUS

13 We went ahead to the ship and set sail for Assos, intending to take Paul on board there, for he had made this arrangement, intending to go by land himself. **14** When he met us in Assos, we took him on board and went

to Mitylene. ¹⁵We sailed from there, and on the following day we arrived opposite Chios. The next day we touched at Samos, and^m the day after that we came to Miletus. ¹⁶For Paul had decided to sail past Ephesus, so that he might not have to spend time in Asia; he was eager to be in Jerusalem, if possible, on the day of Pentecost.*

PAUL SPEAKS TO THE EPHESIAN ELDERS

17 From Miletus he sent a message to Ephesus, asking the elders of the church to meet him.* ¹⁸When they came to him, he said to them:

“You yourselves know how I lived among you the entire time from the first day that I set foot in Asia,* ¹⁹serving the Lord with all humility and with tears, enduring the trials that came to me through the plots of the Jews. ²⁰I did not shrink from doing anything helpful, proclaiming the message to you and teaching you publicly and from house to house,* ²¹as I testified to both Jews and Greeks about repentance toward God and faith toward our Lord Jesus.^{n,*} ²²And now, as a captive to the Spirit,^o I am on my way to Jerusalem, not knowing what will happen to me there,* ²³except that the Holy Spirit testifies to me in every city that imprisonment and persecutions are waiting for me.* ²⁴But I do not count my life of any value to myself, if only I may finish my course and the ministry that I received from the Lord Jesus, to testify to the good news of God’s grace.*

25 “And now I know that none of you, among whom I have gone about proclaiming the kingdom, will ever see my face again.* ²⁶Therefore I declare to you this day that I am not responsible for the blood of any of you,* ²⁷for I did not shrink from declaring to you the whole purpose of God.* ²⁸Keep watch over yourselves and over all the flock, of which the Holy Spirit has made you overseers, to shepherd the church of God^p that he obtained with the blood of his own Son.^{q,*} ²⁹I know that after I have gone, savage wolves will come in among you, not sparing the flock.* ³⁰Some even from your own group will come distorting the truth in order to entice the disciples to follow them. ³¹Therefore be alert, remembering that for three years I did not cease night or day to warn everyone with tears.* ³²And now I commend you to God and to the message of his grace, a message that is able to build you up and to give you the inheritance among all who are

sanctified.* ³³I coveted no one's silver or gold or clothing.* ³⁴You know for yourselves that I worked with my own hands to support myself and my companions.* ³⁵In all this I have given you an example that by such work we must support the weak, remembering the words of the Lord Jesus, for he himself said, 'It is more blessed to give than to receive.' ”*

36 When he had finished speaking, he knelt down with them all and prayed.* ³⁷There was much weeping among them all; they embraced Paul and kissed him,* ³⁸grieving especially because of what he had said, that they would not see him again. Then they brought him to the ship.*

Acts 21

PAUL'S JOURNEY TO JERUSALEM

1 When we had parted from them and set sail, we came by a straight course to Cos, and the next day to Rhodes, and from there to Patara.^r **2** When we found a ship bound for Phoenicia, we went on board and set sail.* **3** We came in sight of Cyprus, and leaving it on our left, we sailed to Syria and landed at Tyre, because the ship was to unload its cargo there. **4** We looked up the disciples and stayed there for seven days. Through the Spirit they told Paul not to go on to Jerusalem.* **5** When our days there were ended, we left and proceeded on our journey, and all of them, with wives and children, escorted us outside the city. There we knelt down on the beach and prayed^{*} **6** and said farewell to one another. Then we went on board the ship, and they returned home.

7 When we had finished^s the voyage from Tyre, we arrived at Ptolemais, and we greeted the brothers and sisters and stayed with them for one day.* **8** The next day we left and came to Caesarea, and we went into the house of Philip the evangelist, one of the seven, and stayed with him.* **9** He had four unmarried daughters^t who had the gift of prophecy.* **10** While we were staying there for several days, a prophet named Agabus came down from Judea. **11** He came to us and took Paul's belt, bound his own feet and hands with it, and said, "Thus says the Holy Spirit, 'This is the way the Jews in Jerusalem will bind the man who owns this belt and will hand him over to the gentiles.'"^{*} **12** When we heard this, we and the people there urged him not to go up to Jerusalem. **13** Then Paul answered, "What are you doing, weeping and breaking my heart? For I am ready not only to be bound but even to die in Jerusalem for the name of the Lord Jesus."^{*} **14** Since he would not be persuaded, we remained silent except to say, "The Lord's will be done."^{*}

15 After these days we got ready and started to go up to Jerusalem. **16** Some of the disciples from Caesarea also came along and brought us to the house of Mnason of Cyprus, an early disciple, with whom we were to stay.*

PAUL VISITS JAMES AT JERUSALEM

17 When we arrived in Jerusalem, the brothers welcomed us warmly.*
¹⁸The next day Paul went with us to visit James, and all the elders were present.* ¹⁹After greeting them, he related one by one the things that God had done among the gentiles through his ministry.* ²⁰When they heard it, they praised God. Then they said to him, “You see, brother, how many thousands of believers there are among the Jews, and they are all zealous for the law.* ²¹They have been told about you that you teach all the Jews living among the gentiles to forsake Moses and that you tell them not to circumcise their children or observe the customs. ²²What then is to be done? They will certainly hear that you have come. ²³So do what we tell you. We have four men who are under a vow.* ²⁴Join these men, go through the rite of purification with them, and pay for the shaving of their heads. Thus all will know that there is nothing in what they have been told about you but that you yourself observe and guard the law.* ²⁵But as for the gentiles who have become believers, we have sent a letter with our judgment that they should abstain from what has been sacrificed to idols and from blood and from what is strangled^u and from sexual immorality.”*
²⁶Then Paul took the men, and the next day, having purified himself, he entered the temple with them, making public the completion of the days of purification when the sacrifice would be made for each of them.*

PAUL ARRESTED IN THE TEMPLE

27 When the seven days were almost completed, the Jews from Asia, who had seen him in the temple, stirred up the whole crowd. They seized him,* ²⁸shouting, “Fellow Israelites,^v help! This is the man who is teaching everyone everywhere against our people, our law, and this place; more than that, he has actually brought Greeks into the temple and has defiled this holy place.”* ²⁹For they had previously seen Trophimus the Ephesian with him in the city, and they supposed that Paul had brought him into the temple.* ³⁰Then all the city was aroused, and the people rushed together. They seized Paul and dragged him out of the temple, and immediately the doors were shut.* ³¹While they were trying to kill him, word came to the tribune of the cohort that all Jerusalem was in an uproar. ³²Immediately he

took soldiers and centurions and ran down to them. When they saw the tribune and the soldiers, they stopped beating Paul.* ³³Then the tribune came, arrested him, and ordered him to be bound with two chains; he inquired who he was and what he had done.* ³⁴Some in the crowd shouted one thing, some another, and as he could not learn the facts because of the uproar, he ordered him to be brought into the barracks.* ³⁵When Paul^w came to the steps, the violence of the mob was so great that he had to be carried by the soldiers. ³⁶The crowd that followed kept shouting, “Away with him!”*

PAUL DEFENDS HIMSELF

37 Just as Paul was about to be brought into the barracks, he said to the tribune, “May I say something to you?” The tribune^x replied, “Do you know Greek? ³⁸Then you are not the Egyptian who recently stirred up a revolt and led the four thousand assassins out into the wilderness?”* ³⁹Paul replied, “I am a Jew from Tarsus in Cilicia, a citizen of an important city; I beg you, let me speak to the people.”* ⁴⁰When he had given him permission, Paul stood on the steps and motioned to the people for silence, and when there was a great hush, he addressed them in the Hebrew^y language, saying:*

Acts 22

1 “Brothers^z and fathers, listen to the defense that I now make before you.”*

2 When they heard him addressing them in Hebrew,^a they became even more quiet. Then he said:*

3 “I am a Jew born in Tarsus in Cilicia but brought up in this city at the feet of Gamaliel, educated strictly according to our ancestral law, being zealous for God, just as all of you are today.* **4**I persecuted this Way up to the point of death by binding both men and women and putting them in prison,* **5**as the high priest and the whole council of elders can testify about me. From them I also received letters to the brothers in Damascus, and I went there in order to bind those who were there and to bring them back to Jerusalem for punishment.*

PAUL TELLS OF HIS CONVERSION

6 “While I was on my way and approaching Damascus, about noon a great light from heaven suddenly shone about me.* **7**I fell to the ground and heard a voice saying to me, ‘Saul, Saul, why are you persecuting me?’ **8**I answered, ‘Who are you, Lord?’ Then he said to me, ‘I am Jesus of Nazareth^b whom you are persecuting.’ **9**Now those who were with me saw the light but did not hear the voice of the one who was speaking to me.* **10**I asked, ‘What am I to do, Lord?’ The Lord said to me, ‘Get up and go to Damascus; there you will be told everything that has been assigned to you to do.’* **11**Since I could not see because of the brightness of that light, those who were with me took my hand and led me to Damascus.*

12 “A certain Ananias, who was a devout man according to the law and well spoken of by all the Jews living there,* **13**came to me, and standing beside me, he said, ‘Brother Saul, regain your sight!’ In that very hour I regained my sight and saw him. **14**Then he said, ‘The God of our ancestors has chosen you to know his will, to see the Righteous One, and to hear his own voice,* **15**for you will be his witness to all the world of what you have

seen and heard.* ¹⁶And now why do you delay? Get up, be baptized, and have your sins washed away, calling on his name.’*

PAUL SENT TO THE GENTILES

17 “After I had returned to Jerusalem and while I was praying in the temple, I fell into a trance* ¹⁸and saw Jesus^c saying to me, ‘Hurry and get out of Jerusalem quickly, because they will not accept your testimony about me.’ ¹⁹And I said, ‘Lord, they themselves know that in every synagogue I imprisoned and beat those who believed in you.* ²⁰And while the blood of your witness Stephen was shed, I myself was standing by, approving and keeping the coats of those who killed him.’* ²¹Then he said to me, ‘Go, for I will send you far away to the gentiles.’ ”*

PAUL AND THE ROMAN TRIBUNE

22 Up to this point they listened to him, but then they shouted, “Away with such a fellow from the earth! For he should not be allowed to live.” ²³And while they were shouting, throwing off their cloaks, and tossing dust into the air,* ²⁴the tribune directed that he was to be brought into the barracks and ordered him to be examined by flogging, to find out the reason for this outcry against him. ²⁵But when they had tied him up with straps,^d Paul said to the centurion who was standing by, “Is it legal for you to flog a Roman person who is uncondemned?”* ²⁶When the centurion heard that, he went to the tribune and said to him, “What are you about to do? This man is a Roman.” ²⁷The tribune came and asked Paul,^e “Tell me, are you a Roman?” And he said, “Yes.” ²⁸The tribune answered, “It cost me a large sum of money to get my citizenship.” Paul said, “But I was born a Roman.” ²⁹Immediately those who were about to examine him drew back from him, and the tribune also was afraid, for he realized that Paul was a Roman and that he had bound him.

PAUL BEFORE THE COUNCIL

30 Since he wanted to find out what Paul^f was being accused of by the Jews, the next day he released him and ordered the chief priests and the

entire council to meet. He brought Paul down and had him stand before them.*

Acts 23

1 While Paul was looking intently at the council he said, “Brothers,^g up to this day I have lived my life with a clear conscience before God.”* **2**Then the high priest Ananias ordered those standing near him to strike him on the mouth.* **3**At this Paul said to him, “God will strike you, you whitewashed wall! Are you sitting there to judge me according to the law, and yet in violation of the law you order me to be struck?”* **4**Those standing nearby said, “Do you dare to insult God’s high priest?” **5**And Paul said, “I did not realize, brothers, that he was high priest, for it is written, ‘You shall not speak evil of a leader of your people.’ ”*

6 When Paul noticed that some were Sadducees and others were Pharisees, he called out in the council, “Brothers,^h I am a Pharisee, a son of Pharisees. I am on trial concerning the hope of the resurrectionⁱ of the dead.”* **7**When he said this, a dissension began between the Pharisees and the Sadducees, and the assembly was divided. **8**(The Sadducees say that there is no resurrection or angel or spirit, but the Pharisees acknowledge all three.)* **9**Then a great clamor arose, and certain scribes of the Pharisees’ group stood up and contended, “We find nothing wrong with this man. What if a spirit or an angel has spoken to him?”* **10**When the dissension became violent, the tribune, fearing that they would tear Paul to pieces, ordered the soldiers to go down, take him by force, and bring him into the barracks.*

11 That night the Lord stood near him and said, “Keep up your courage! For just as you have testified for me in Jerusalem, so you must bear witness also in Rome.”*

THE PLOT TO KILL PAUL

12 In the morning the Jews joined in a conspiracy and bound themselves by an oath neither to eat nor drink until they had killed Paul.* **13**There were more than forty who joined in this conspiracy. **14**They went to the chief priests and elders and said, “We have strictly bound ourselves by an oath to taste no food until we have killed Paul.”* **15**Now then, you and the council

must notify the tribune to bring him down to you, on the pretext that you want to make a more thorough examination of his case. And we are ready to do away with him before he arrives.”*

16 Now the son of Paul’s sister heard about the ambush, so he went and gained entrance to the barracks and told Paul.* ¹⁷Paul called one of the centurions and said, “Take this young man to the tribune, for he has something to report to him.” ¹⁸So he took him, brought him to the tribune, and said, “The prisoner Paul called me and asked me to bring this young man to you; he has something to tell you.”* ¹⁹The tribune took him by the hand, drew him aside privately, and asked, “What is it that you have to report to me?” ²⁰He answered, “The Jews have agreed to ask you to bring Paul down to the council tomorrow, as though they were going to inquire more thoroughly into his case.* ²¹But do not be persuaded by them, for more than forty of their men are lying in ambush for him. They have bound themselves by an oath neither to eat nor drink until they kill him. They are ready now and are waiting for your consent.”* ²²So the tribune dismissed the young man, ordering him, “Tell no one that you have informed me of this.”

PAUL SENT TO FELIX THE GOVERNOR

23 Then he summoned two of the centurions and said, “Get ready to leave by nine o’clock tonight for Caesarea with two hundred soldiers, seventy horsemen, and two hundred spearmen.* ²⁴Also provide mounts for Paul to ride and take him safely to Felix the governor.”* ²⁵He wrote a letter to this effect:

26 “Claudius Lysias to his Excellency the governor Felix, greetings.* ²⁷This man was seized by the Jews and was about to be killed by them, but when I had learned that he was a Roman, I came with the guard and rescued him.* ²⁸Since I wanted to know the charge for which they accused him, I had him brought to their council.* ²⁹I found that he was accused concerning questions of their law but was charged with nothing deserving death or imprisonment.* ³⁰When I was informed that there would be a plot against the man, I sent him to you at once, ordering his accusers also to state before you what they have against him.”j,*

31 So the soldiers, according to their instructions, took Paul and brought him during the night to Antipatris. ³²The next day they let the horsemen go on with him, while they returned to the barracks.* ³³When they came to Caesarea and delivered the letter to the governor, they presented Paul also before him.* ³⁴On reading the letter, he asked what province he belonged to, and when he learned that he was from Cilicia,* ³⁵he said, “I will give you a hearing when your accusers arrive.” Then he ordered that he be kept under guard in Herod’s headquarters.^{k,*}

Acts 24

PAUL BEFORE FELIX AT CAESAREA

1 Five days later the high priest Ananias came down with some elders and an attorney, a certain Tertullus, and they reported their case against Paul to the governor.* **2**When Paul^l had been summoned, Tertullus began to accuse him, saying:

“Because of you, most excellent Felix, we have long enjoyed peace, and reforms have been made for this people because of your foresight.³In every way and everywhere we welcome this with utmost gratitude.* **4**But, to detain you no further, I beg you to hear us briefly with your customary graciousness.⁵We have, in fact, found this man a pestilent fellow, an agitator among all the Jews throughout the world, and a ringleader of the sect of the Nazarenes.^{m,*} **6**He even tried to profane the temple, so we seized him.^{n,*} **8**By examining him yourself you will be able to learn from him concerning everything of which we accuse him.”

9 The Jews also joined in the charge by asserting that all this was true.*

PAUL’S DEFENSE BEFORE FELIX

10 When the governor motioned to him to speak, Paul replied:

“I cheerfully make my defense, knowing that for many years you have been a judge over this people.* **11**As you can find out, it is not more than twelve days since I went up to worship in Jerusalem.* **12**They did not find me disputing with anyone in the temple or stirring up a crowd either in the synagogues or throughout the city.* **13**Neither can they prove to you the charge that they now bring against me.* **14**But this I admit to you, that according to the Way, which they call a sect, I worship the God of our ancestors, believing everything laid down according to the law or written in the prophets.* **15**I have a hope in God—a hope that they themselves also accept—that there will be a resurrection of both^o the righteous and the unrighteous.* **16**Therefore I do my best always to have a clear conscience toward God and all people.* **17**Now after some years I came to bring alms to

my people and to offer sacrifices.* ¹⁸While I was doing this, they found me in the temple completing the rite of purification, without any crowd or disturbance.* ¹⁹But there were some Jews from Asia—they ought to be here before you to make an accusation, if they have anything against me.* ²⁰Or let these men here tell what crime they had found when I stood before the council, ²¹unless it was this one sentence that I called out while standing before them, ‘It is about the resurrection of the dead that I am on trial before you today.’ ”*

22 But Felix, who was rather well informed about the Way, adjourned the hearing with the comment, “When Lysias the tribune comes down, I will decide your case.” ²³Then he ordered the centurion to keep him in custody but to let him have some liberty and not to prevent any of his friends from taking care of his needs.*

PAUL HELD IN CUSTODY

24 Some days later when Felix came with his wife Drusilla, who was Jewish, he sent for Paul and heard him speak concerning faith in Christ Jesus. ²⁵And as he discussed justice, self-control, and the coming judgment, Felix became frightened and said, “Go away for the present; when I have an opportunity, I will send for you.”* ²⁶At the same time he hoped that money would be given him by Paul, and for that reason he used to send for him very often and converse with him.

27 After two years had passed, Felix was succeeded by Porcius Festus, and since he wanted to grant the Jews a favor, Felix left Paul in prison.*

Acts 25

PAUL APPEALS TO THE EMPEROR

1 Three days after Festus had arrived in the province, he went up from Caesarea to Jerusalem, ²where the chief priests and the leaders of the Jews gave him a report against Paul. They appealed to him ^{*} ³and requested, as a favor to them against Paul,^P to have him transferred to Jerusalem. They were, in fact, planning an ambush to kill him along the way. ^{*} ⁴Festus replied that Paul was being kept at Caesarea and that he himself intended to go there shortly. ^{*} ⁵“So,” he said, “let those of you who have the authority come down with me, and if there is anything wrong about the man, let them accuse him.”

6 After he had stayed among them not more than eight or ten days, he went down to Caesarea; the next day he took his seat on the tribunal and ordered Paul to be brought. ⁷When he arrived, the Jews who had gone down from Jerusalem surrounded him, bringing many serious charges against him, which they could not prove. ^{*} ⁸Paul said in his defense, “I have in no way committed an offense against the law of the Jews or against the temple or against the emperor.” ^{*} ⁹But Festus, wishing to do the Jews a favor, asked Paul, “Do you wish to go up to Jerusalem and be tried there before me on these charges?” ^{*} ¹⁰Paul said, “I am standing before the emperor’s tribunal; this is where I should be tried. I have done no wrong to the Jews, as you very well know. ¹¹Now if I am in the wrong and have committed something for which I deserve to die, I am not trying to escape death, but if there is nothing to their charges against me, no one can turn me over to them. I appeal to the emperor.” ^{*} ¹²Then Festus, after he had conferred with his council, replied, “You have appealed to the emperor; to the emperor you will go.”

FESTUS CONSULTS KING AGRIPPA

13 After several days had passed, King Agrippa and Bernice arrived at Caesarea to welcome Festus. ¹⁴Since they were staying there several days, Festus laid Paul’s case before the king, saying, “There is a man here who

was left in prison by Felix.* ¹⁵When I was in Jerusalem, the chief priests and the elders of the Jews informed me about him and asked for a sentence against him.* ¹⁶I told them that it was not the custom of the Romans to hand over anyone before the accused had met the accusers face to face and had been given an opportunity to make a defense against the charge.* ¹⁷So when they met here, I lost no time but on the next day took my seat on the tribunal and ordered the man to be brought.* ¹⁸When the accusers stood up, they did not charge him with any of the crimes^q that I was expecting.¹⁹ Instead, they had certain points of disagreement with him about their own religion and about a certain Jesus, who had died but whom Paul asserted to be alive.* ²⁰Since I was at a loss how to investigate these questions, I asked whether he wished to go to Jerusalem and be tried there on these charges.^{r,*} ²¹But when Paul had appealed to be kept in custody for the decision of his Imperial Majesty, I ordered him to be held until I could send him to the emperor.”* ²²Agrippa said to Festus, “I would like to hear the man myself.” “Tomorrow,” he said, “you will hear him.”*

PAUL BROUGHT BEFORE AGRIPPA

23 So on the next day Agrippa and Bernice came with great pomp, and they entered the audience hall with the military tribunes and the prominent men of the city. Then Festus gave the order and Paul was brought in.* ²⁴And Festus said, “King Agrippa and all here present with us, you see this man about whom the whole Jewish community petitioned me, both in Jerusalem and here, shouting that he ought not to live any longer.* ²⁵But I found that he had done nothing deserving death, and when he appealed to his Imperial Majesty, I decided to send him.* ²⁶But I have nothing definite to write to our sovereign about him. Therefore I have brought him before all of you, and especially before you, King Agrippa, so that, after we have examined him, I may have something to write, ²⁷for it seems to me unreasonable to send a prisoner without indicating the charges against him.”

Acts 26

PAUL DEFENDS HIMSELF BEFORE AGRIPPA

1 Agrippa said to Paul, “You have permission to speak for yourself.” Then Paul stretched out his hand and began to defend himself.*

2 “I consider myself fortunate that it is before you, King Agrippa, I am to make my defense today against all the accusations of the Jews, ³because you are especially familiar with all the customs and controversies of the Jews; therefore I beg of you to listen to me patiently.*

4 “All the Jews know my way of life from my youth, a life spent from the beginning among my own people and in Jerusalem.* ⁵They have known for a long time, if they are willing to testify, that I have belonged to the strictest sect of our religion and lived as a Pharisee.* ⁶And now I stand here on trial on account of my hope in the promise made by God to our ancestors,* ⁷a promise that our twelve tribes hope to attain, as they earnestly worship day and night. It is for this hope, Your Excellency,^s that I am accused by Jews!* ⁸Why is it thought incredible by any of you that God raises the dead?*

9 “Indeed, I myself was convinced that I ought to do many things against the name of Jesus of Nazareth.^{t,*} ¹⁰And that is what I did in Jerusalem; with authority received from the chief priests, I not only locked up many of the saints in prison, but I also cast my vote against them when they were being condemned to death.* ¹¹By punishing them often in all the synagogues I tried to force them to blaspheme, and since I was so furiously enraged at them, I pursued them even to foreign cities.*

PAUL TELLS OF HIS CONVERSION

12 “With this in mind, I was traveling to Damascus with the authority and commission of the chief priests,* ¹³when at midday along the road, Your Excellency,^u I saw a light from heaven, brighter than the sun, shining around me and my companions. ¹⁴When we had all fallen to the ground, I heard a voice saying to me in the Hebrew^v language, ‘Saul, Saul, why are you persecuting me? It hurts you to kick against the goads.’* ¹⁵I asked,

‘Who are you, Lord?’ The Lord answered, ‘I am Jesus whom you are persecuting. ¹⁶But get up and stand on your feet, for I have appeared to you for this purpose, to appoint you to serve and testify to the things in which you have seen me^w and to those in which I will appear to you.’ ¹⁷I will rescue you from your people and from the gentiles—to whom I am sending you^{*} ¹⁸to open their eyes so that they may turn from darkness to light and from the power of Satan to God, so that they may receive forgiveness of sins and a place among those who are sanctified by faith in me.’^{*}

PAUL TELLS OF HIS PREACHING

19 “After that, King Agrippa, I was not disobedient to the heavenly vision ²⁰but declared first to those in Damascus, then in Jerusalem and throughout the countryside of Judea, and also to the gentiles, that they should repent and turn to God and do deeds consistent with repentance.^{*} ²¹For this reason the Jews seized me in the temple and tried to kill me.^{*} ²²To this day I have had help from God, and so I stand here, testifying to both small and great, saying nothing but what the prophets and Moses said would take place:^{*} ²³that the Messiah^x must suffer and that, by being the first to rise from the dead, he would proclaim light both to our people and to the gentiles.”^{*}

PAUL APPEALS TO AGRIPPA TO BELIEVE

24 While he was making this defense, Festus exclaimed, “You are out of your mind, Paul! Too much learning is driving you insane!”^{*} ²⁵But Paul said, “I am not out of my mind, most excellent Festus, but I am speaking the sober truth.”^{*} ²⁶Indeed, the king knows about these things, and to him I speak freely, for I am certain that none of these things has escaped his notice, for this was not done in a corner. ²⁷King Agrippa, do you believe the prophets? I know that you believe.” ²⁸Agrippa said to Paul, “Are you so quickly persuading me to become a Christian?”^{*} ²⁹Paul replied, “Whether quickly or not, I pray to God that not only you but also all who are listening to me today might become such as I am—except for these chains.”^{*}

30 Then the king got up and with him the governor and Bernice and those who had been seated with them, ³¹and as they were leaving they said

to one another, “This man is doing nothing to deserve death or imprisonment.”* ³²Agrippa said to Festus, “This man could have been set free if he had not appealed to the emperor.”*

Acts 27

PAUL SAILS FOR ROME

1 When it was decided that we were to sail for Italy, they transferred Paul and some other prisoners to a centurion of the Augustan Cohort, named Julius.* **2** Embarking on a ship of Adramyttium that was about to set sail to the ports along the coast of Asia, we put to sea, accompanied by Aristarchus, a Macedonian from Thessalonica.* **3** The next day we put in at Sidon, and Julius treated Paul kindly and allowed him to go to his friends to be cared for.* **4** Putting out to sea from there, we sailed under the lee of Cyprus, because the winds were against us. **5** After we had sailed across the sea that is off Cilicia and Pamphylia, we came to Myra in Lycia.* **6** There the centurion found an Alexandrian ship bound for Italy and put us on board.* **7** We sailed slowly for a number of days and arrived with difficulty off Cnidus, and as the wind was against us, we sailed under the lee of Crete off Salmone. **8** Sailing past it with difficulty, we came to a place called Fair Havens, near the city of Lasea.

9 Since much time had been lost and sailing was now dangerous, because even the Fast had already gone by, Paul advised them,* **10** saying, “Men, I can see that the voyage will be with danger and much heavy loss, not only of the cargo and the ship, but also of our lives.” **11** But the centurion paid more attention to the pilot and to the owner of the ship than to what Paul said. **12** Since the harbor was not suitable for spending the winter, the majority was in favor of putting to sea from there on the chance that somehow they could reach Phoenix, where they could spend the winter. It was a harbor of Crete, facing southwest and northwest.

THE STORM AT SEA

13 When a moderate south wind began to blow, they thought they could achieve their purpose; so they weighed anchor and began to sail past Crete, close to the shore. **14** But soon a violent wind, called the northeaster, rushed down from Crete.^{y,*} **15** Since the ship was caught and could not be turned head-on into the wind, we gave way to it and were driven. **16** By running

under the lee of a small island called Cauda^z we were scarcely able to get the ship's boat under control. ¹⁷After hoisting it up they took measures to undergird the ship; then, fearing that they would run on the Syrtis, they lowered the sea anchor and so were driven.* ¹⁸We were being pounded by the storm so violently that on the next day they began to throw the cargo overboard,* ¹⁹and on the third day with their own hands they threw the ship's tackle overboard. ²⁰When neither sun nor stars appeared for many days and no small tempest raged, all hope of our being saved was at last abandoned.

21 Since they had been without food for a long time, Paul then stood up among them and said, "Men, you should have listened to me and not have set sail from Crete and thereby avoided this damage and loss.* ²²I urge you now to keep up your courage, for there will be no loss of life among you, but only of the ship.* ²³For last night there stood by me an angel of the God to whom I belong and whom I worship,* ²⁴and he said, 'Do not be afraid, Paul; you must stand before the emperor, and, indeed, God has granted safety to all those who are sailing with you.'* ²⁵So keep up your courage, men, for I have faith in God that it will be exactly as I have been told.* ²⁶But we will have to run aground on some island."*

27 When the fourteenth night had come, as we were drifting across the Adriatic Sea, about midnight the sailors suspected that they were nearing land. ²⁸So they took soundings and found twenty fathoms; a little farther on they took soundings again and found fifteen fathoms. ²⁹Fearing that we might run on the rocks, they let down four anchors from the stern and prayed for day to come. ³⁰But when the sailors tried to escape from the ship and had lowered the boat into the sea on the pretext of putting out anchors from the bow,* ³¹Paul said to the centurion and the soldiers, "Unless these men stay in the ship, you cannot be saved." ³²Then the soldiers cut away the ropes of the boat and set it adrift.

33 Just before daybreak, Paul urged all of them to take some food, saying, "Today is the fourteenth day that you have been in suspense and remaining without food, having eaten nothing. ³⁴Therefore I urge you to take some food, for it will help you survive, for none of you will lose a hair from your heads."* ³⁵After he had said this, he took bread, and giving thanks to God in the presence of all, he broke it and began to eat.* ³⁶Then

all of them were encouraged and took food for themselves.* ³⁷(We were in all two hundred seventy-six^a persons in the ship.) ³⁸After they had satisfied their hunger, they lightened the ship by throwing the wheat into the sea.*

THE SHIPWRECK

39 In the morning they did not recognize the land, but they noticed a bay with a beach on which they planned to run the ship ashore, if they could.* ⁴⁰So they cast off the anchors and left them in the sea. At the same time they loosened the ropes that tied the steering-oars; then hoisting the foresail to the wind, they made for the beach.* ⁴¹But striking a reef,^b they ran the ship aground; the bow stuck and remained immovable, but the stern was being broken up by the force of the waves.* ⁴²The soldiers' plan was to kill the prisoners, so that none might swim away and escape;* ⁴³but the centurion, wishing to save Paul, kept them from carrying out their plan. He ordered those who could swim to jump overboard first and make for the land* ⁴⁴and the rest to follow, some on planks and others on pieces of the ship. And so it was that all were brought safely to land.*

Acts 28

PAUL ON THE ISLAND OF MALTA

1 After we had reached safety, we then learned that the island was called Malta.* **2**The local people showed us unusual kindness. Since it had begun to rain and was cold, they kindled a fire and welcomed all of us around it.* **3**Paul had gathered a bundle of brushwood and was putting it on the fire when a viper, driven out by the heat, fastened itself on his hand. **4**When the local people saw the creature hanging from his hand, they said to one another, “This man must be a murderer; though he has escaped from the sea, Justice has not allowed him to live.”* **5**He, however, shook off the creature into the fire and suffered no harm.* **6**They were expecting him to swell up or drop dead, but after they had waited a long time and saw that nothing unusual had happened to him, they changed their minds and began to say that he was a god.*

7 Now in the vicinity of that place were lands belonging to the leading man of the island, named Publius, who received us and entertained us hospitably for three days. **8**It so happened that the father of Publius lay sick in bed with fever and dysentery. Paul visited him and cured him by praying and putting his hands on him.* **9**After this happened, the rest of the people on the island who had diseases also came and were cured. **10**They bestowed many honors on us, and when we were about to sail, they put on board all the provisions we needed.

PAUL ARRIVES AT ROME

11 Three months later we set sail on a ship that had wintered at the island, an Alexandrian ship with the Twin Brothers as its figurehead.* **12**We put in at Syracuse and stayed there for three days; **13**then we weighed anchor and came to Rhegium. After one day there a south wind sprang up, and on the second day we came to Puteoli. **14**There we found brothers and sisters and were invited to stay with them for seven days. And so we came to Rome.* **15**The brothers and sisters from there, when they heard of us,

came as far as the Forum of Appius and Three Taverns to meet us. On seeing them, Paul thanked God and took courage.

16 When we came into Rome, Paul was allowed to live by himself, with the soldier who was guarding him.*

PAUL AND JEWISH LEADERS IN ROME

17 Three days later he called together the local leaders of the Jews. When they had assembled, he said to them, “Brothers,^c though I had done nothing against our people or the customs of our ancestors, yet I was arrested in Jerusalem and handed over to the Romans.*¹⁸ When they had examined me, the Romans^d wanted to release me because there was no reason for the death penalty in my case.*¹⁹ But when the Jews objected, I was compelled to appeal to the emperor—even though I had no charge to bring against my people.*²⁰ For this reason therefore I asked to see you and speak with you, since it is for the sake of the hope of Israel that I am bound with this chain.”*²¹ They replied, “We have received no letters from Judea about you, and none of the brothers coming here has reported or spoken anything evil about you.*²² But we would like to hear from you what you think, for with regard to this sect we know that everywhere it is spoken against.”*

PAUL PREACHES IN ROME

23 After they had set a day to meet with him, they came to him at his lodgings in great numbers. From morning until evening he explained the matter to them, testifying to the kingdom of God and trying to convince them about Jesus both from the law of Moses and from the prophets.²⁴ Some were convinced by what he had said, while others refused to believe.²⁵ So they disagreed with each other, and as they were leaving Paul made one further statement: “The Holy Spirit was right in saying to your ancestors through the prophet Isaiah,

²⁶‘Go to this people and say,

You will indeed listen but never understand,

and you will indeed look but never perceive.

²⁷For this people’s heart has grown dull,

and their ears are hard of hearing,
and they have shut their eyes;
otherwise they might look with their eyes
and listen with their ears
and understand with their heart and turn —
and I would heal them.’

²⁸“Let it be known to you, then, that this salvation of God has been sent to the gentiles; they will listen.”^e

30 He lived there two whole years at his own expense^f and welcomed all who came to him, ³¹proclaiming the kingdom of God and teaching about the Lord Jesus Christ with all boldness and without hindrance.

The Revelation

to John

Revelation 1

INTRODUCTION AND SALUTATION

1 The revelation of Jesus Christ, which God gave him to show his servants what must soon take place, and he made it known by sending his angel to his servant John,^{*} **2** who testified to the word of God and to the testimony of Jesus Christ, even to all that he saw.^{*}

3 Blessed is the one who reads the words of the prophecy, and blessed are those who hear and who keep what is written in it, for the time is near.

4 John to the seven churches that are in Asia:

Grace to you and peace from him who is and who was and who is to come and from the seven spirits who are before his throne,^{*} **5** and from Jesus Christ, the faithful witness, the firstborn of the dead, and the ruler of the kings of the earth.

To him who loves us and freed^a us from our sins by his blood **6** and made us a kingdom, priests serving^b his God and Father, to him be glory and dominion forever and ever. Amen.^{*}

7 Look! He is coming with the clouds;

every eye will see him,

even those who pierced him,

and all the tribes of the earth will wail on account of him.

So it is to be. Amen.^{*}

8 “I am the Alpha and the Omega,” says the Lord God, who is and who was and who is to come, the Almighty.^{*}

A VISION OF CHRIST

9 I, John, your brother who share with you the persecution and the kingdom and the endurance in Jesus, was on the island called Patmos because of the word of God and the testimony of Jesus.^{c,*} **10** I was in the spirit^d on the Lord's day, and I heard behind me a loud voice like a trumpet^{*} **11** saying, "Write in a book what you see, and send it to the seven churches, to Ephesus, to Smyrna, to Pergamum, to Thyatira, to Sardis, to Philadelphia, and to Laodicea."

12 Then I turned to see whose voice it was that spoke to me, and on turning I saw seven golden lampstands,^{*} **13** and in the midst of the lampstands I saw one like the Son of Man, clothed with a long robe and with a golden sash across his chest.^{*} **14** His head and his hair were white as white wool, white as snow; his eyes were like a flame of fire;^{*} **15** his feet were like burnished bronze, refined as in a furnace, and his voice was like the sound of many waters.^{*} **16** In his right hand he held seven stars, and from his mouth came a sharp, two-edged sword, and his face was like the sun shining with full force.^{*}

17 When I saw him, I fell at his feet as though dead. But he placed his right hand on me, saying, "Do not be afraid; I am the First and the Last^{*} **18** and the Living One. I was dead, and see, I am alive forever and ever, and I have the keys of Death and of Hades.^{*} **19** Now write what you have seen, what is, and what is to take place after this. **20** As for the mystery of the seven stars that you saw in my right hand and the seven golden lampstands: the seven stars are the angels of the seven churches, and the seven lampstands are the seven churches.^{*}

Revelation 2

THE MESSAGE TO EPHESUS

1 “To the angel of the church in Ephesus write: These are the words of him who holds the seven stars in his right hand, who walks among the seven golden lampstands:

2 “I know your works, your toil and your endurance. I know that you cannot tolerate evildoers; you have tested those who claim to be apostles but are not and have found them to be false.* **3**I also know that you are enduring and bearing up for the sake of my name and that you have not grown weary.* **4**But I have this against you, that you have abandoned the love you had at first. **5**Remember, then, from where you have fallen; repent and do the works you did at first. If not, I will come to you and remove your lampstand from its place, unless you repent. **6**Yet this is to your credit: you hate the works of the Nicolaitans, which I also hate. **7**Let anyone who has an ear listen to what the Spirit is saying to the churches. To everyone who conquers, I will give permission to eat from the tree of life that is in the paradise of God.*

THE MESSAGE TO SMYRNA

8 “And to the angel of the church in Smyrna write: These are the words of the First and the Last, who was dead and came to life:*

9 “I know your affliction and your poverty, even though you are rich. I know the slander on the part of those who say that they are Jews and are not but are a synagogue of Satan.* **10**Do not fear what you are about to suffer. Beware, the devil is about to throw some of you into prison so that you may be tested, and for ten days you will have affliction. Be faithful until death, and I will give you the crown of life.* **11**Let anyone who has an ear listen to what the Spirit is saying to the churches. Whoever conquers will not be harmed by the second death.*

THE MESSAGE TO PERGAMUM

12 “And to the angel of the church in Pergamum write: These are the words of him who has the sharp two-edged sword:*

13 “I know where you are living, where Satan’s throne is. Yet you are holding fast to my name, and you did not deny your faith in me^e even in the days of Antipas my witness, my faithful one, who was killed among you, where Satan lives. ¹⁴But I have a few things against you: you have some there who hold to the teaching of Balaam, who taught Balak to put a stumbling block before the people of Israel, so that they would eat food sacrificed to idols and engage in sexual immorality.^{f,*} ¹⁵So you also have some who hold to the teaching of the Nicolaitans. ¹⁶Repent, then. If not, I will come to you soon and wage war against them with the sword of my mouth.* ¹⁷Let anyone who has an ear listen to what the Spirit is saying to the churches. To everyone who conquers I will give some of the hidden manna, and I will give a white stone, and on the white stone is written a new name that no one knows except the one who receives it.*

THE MESSAGE TO THYATIRA

18 “And to the angel of the church in Thyatira write: These are the words of the Son of God, who has eyes like a flame of fire and whose feet are like burnished bronze:*

19 “I know your works: your love, faith, service, and endurance. I know that your latest works are greater than the first. ²⁰But I have this against you: you tolerate that woman Jezebel, who calls herself a prophet and is teaching and beguiling my servants to engage in sexual immorality^g and to eat food sacrificed to idols.* ²¹I gave her time to repent, but she refuses to repent of her sexual immorality.^{h,*} ²²Beware, I am throwing her on a bed, and those who commit adultery with her I am throwing into great distress, unless they repent of her doings, ²³and I will strike her children dead. And all the churches will know that I am the one who searches minds and hearts, and I will give to each of you as your works deserve.* ²⁴But to the rest of you in Thyatira, who do not hold this teaching, who have not learned what some call ‘the deep things of Satan,’ to you I say, I do not lay on you any other burden;* ²⁵only hold fast to what you have until I come. ²⁶To everyone who conquers and continues to do my works to the end,

I will give authority over the nations,*

²⁷to ruleⁱ them with an iron scepter,

as when clay pots are shattered—*

²⁸“even as I also received authority from my Father. To the one who conquers I will also give the morning star.* ²⁹Let anyone who has an ear listen to what the Spirit is saying to the churches.

Revelation 3

THE MESSAGE TO SARDIS

1 “And to the angel of the church in Sardis write: These are the words of him who has the seven spirits of God and the seven stars:

“I know your works; you have a name of being alive, but you are dead.*
2Wake up and strengthen what remains and is on the point of death, for I have not found your works perfect in the sight of my God. **3**Remember, then, what you received and heard; obey it and repent. If you do not wake up, I will come like a thief, and you will not know at what hour I will come to you.* **4**Yet you have still a few persons in Sardis who have not soiled their clothes; they will walk with me, dressed in white, for they are worthy.*
5If you conquer, you will be clothed like them in white robes, and I will not erase your name from the book of life; I will confess your name before my Father and before his angels.* **6**Let anyone who has an ear listen to what the Spirit is saying to the churches.

THE MESSAGE TO PHILADELPHIA

7 “And to the angel of the church in Philadelphia write:

These are the words of the Holy One, the True One,
who has the key of David,
who opens and no one will shut,
who shuts and no one opens:*

8 “I know your works. Look, I have set before you an open door that no one is able to shut. I know that you have but little power, yet you have kept my word and have not denied my name.* **9**I will make those of the synagogue of Satan who say that they are Jews and are not but are lying—I will make them come and bow down before your feet, and they will learn that I have loved you.* **10**Because you have kept my word of endurance, I will keep you from the hour of trial that is coming on the whole world to test the inhabitants of the earth.* **11**I am coming soon; hold fast to what you have, so that no one takes away your crown. **12**If you conquer, I will make

you a pillar in the temple of my God; you will never go out of it. I will write on you the name of my God and the name of the city of my God, the new Jerusalem that comes down from my God out of heaven, and my own new name.* ¹³Let anyone who has an ear listen to what the Spirit is saying to the churches.

THE MESSAGE TO LAODICEA

14 “And to the angel of the church in Laodicea write: The words of the Amen, the faithful and true witness, the origin^j of God’s creation:*

15 “I know your works; you are neither cold nor hot. I wish that you were either cold or hot. ¹⁶So, because you are lukewarm and neither cold nor hot, I am about to spit you out of my mouth. ¹⁷For you say, ‘I am rich, I have prospered, and I need nothing.’ You do not realize that you are wretched, pitiable, poor, blind, and naked.* ¹⁸Therefore I advise you to buy from me gold refined by fire so that you may be rich, and white robes to clothe yourself and to keep the shame of your nakedness from being seen, and salve to anoint your eyes so that you may see.* ¹⁹I reprove and discipline those whom I love. Be earnest, therefore, and repent.* ²⁰Listen! I am standing at the door, knocking; if you hear my voice and open the door, I will come in and eat with you, and you with me.* ²¹To the one who conquers I will give a place with me on my throne, just as I myself conquered and sat down with my Father on his throne.* ²²Let anyone who has an ear listen to what the Spirit is saying to the churches.”

Revelation 4

THE HEAVENLY WORSHIP

1 After this I looked, and there in heaven a door stood open! And the first voice, which I had heard speaking to me like a trumpet, said, “Come up here, and I will show you what must take place after this.”^{*} **2** At once I was in the spirit,^k and there in heaven stood a throne, with one seated on the throne!^{*} **3** And the one seated there looks like jasper and carnelian, and around the throne is a rainbow that looks like an emerald. **4** Around the throne are twenty-four thrones, and seated on the thrones are twenty-four elders, dressed in white robes, with golden crowns on their heads.^{*} **5** Coming from the throne are flashes of lightning and rumblings and peals of thunder, and in front of the throne burn seven flaming torches, which are the seven spirits of God,^{*} **6** and in front of the throne there is something like a sea of glass, like crystal.

Around the throne, and on each side of the throne, are four living creatures, full of eyes in front and back:^{*} **7** the first living creature like a lion, the second living creature like an ox, the third living creature with a face like a human, and the fourth living creature like a flying eagle.^{*} **8** And the four living creatures, each of them with six wings, are full of eyes all around and inside. Day and night without ceasing they sing,

“Holy, holy, holy,
the Lord God the Almighty,
who was and is and is to come.”^{*}

9 And whenever the living creatures give glory and honor and thanks to the one who is seated on the throne, who lives forever and ever,^{*} **10** the twenty-four elders fall before the one who is seated on the throne and worship the one who lives forever and ever; they cast their crowns before the throne, singing,^{*}

11 “You are worthy, our Lord and God,
to receive glory and honor and power,
for you created all things,

and by your will they existed and were created.”*

Revelation 5

THE SCROLL AND THE LAMB

1 Then I saw in the right hand of the one seated on the throne a scroll written on the inside and on the back, sealed^l with seven seals,* **2**and I saw a mighty angel proclaiming with a loud voice, “Who is worthy to open the scroll and break its seals?” **3**And no one in heaven or on earth or under the earth was able to open the scroll or to look into it. **4**And I began to weep bitterly because no one was found worthy to open the scroll or to look into it. **5**Then one of the elders said to me, “Do not weep. See, the Lion of the tribe of Judah, the Root of David, has conquered, so that he can open the scroll and its seven seals.”*

6 Then I saw between the throne and the four living creatures and among the elders a Lamb standing as if it had been slaughtered, with seven horns and seven eyes, which are the seven spirits of God sent out into all the earth.* **7**He went and took the scroll from the right hand of the one who was seated on the throne. **8**When he had taken the scroll, the four living creatures and the twenty-four elders fell before the Lamb, each holding a harp and golden bowls full of incense, which are the prayers of the saints.* **9**They sing a new song:

“You are worthy to take the scroll
and to break its seals,
for you were slaughtered and by your blood you ransomed for
God
saints from^m every tribe and language and people and nation;*
10you have made them a kingdom and priests servingⁿ our God,
and they will reign^o on earth.”*

11 Then I looked, and I heard the voice of many angels surrounding the throne and the living creatures and the elders; they numbered myriads of myriads and thousands of thousands,* **12**singing with full voice,

“Worthy is the Lamb that was slaughtered

to receive power and wealth and wisdom and might
and honor and glory and blessing!”

¹³Then I heard every creature in heaven and on earth and under the earth
and in the sea and all that is in them, singing,

“To the one seated on the throne and to the Lamb
be blessing and honor and glory and might
forever and ever!”*

¹⁴And the four living creatures said, “Amen!” And the elders fell down and
worshiped.

Revelation 6

THE SEVEN SEALS

1 Then I saw the Lamb break one of the seven seals, and I heard one of the four living creatures call out, as with a voice of thunder, “Come!”^{p,*} **2**I looked, and there was a white horse! Its rider had a bow; a crown was given to him, and he came out conquering and to conquer.*

3 When he broke the second seal, I heard the second living creature call out, “Come!”^q **4**And out came^r another horse, bright red; its rider was permitted to take peace from the earth, so that people would slaughter one another, and he was given a great sword.*

5 When he broke the third seal, I heard the third living creature call out, “Come!”^s I looked, and there was a black horse! Its rider held a pair of scales in his hand,* **6**and I heard what seemed to be a voice in the midst of the four living creatures saying, “A quart of wheat for a day’s pay^t and three quarts of barley for a day’s pay,^u but do not damage the olive oil and the wine!”

7 When he broke the fourth seal, I heard the voice of the fourth living creature call out, “Come!”^v **8**I looked, and there was a pale green horse! Its rider’s name was Death, and Hades followed with him; they were given authority over a fourth of the earth, to kill with sword, famine, and pestilence and by the wild animals of the earth.*

9 When he broke the fifth seal, I saw under the altar the souls of those who had been slaughtered for the word of God and for the testimony they had given;* **10**they cried out with a loud voice, “Sovereign Lord, holy and true, how long will it be before you judge and avenge our blood on the inhabitants of the earth?”* **11**They were each given a white robe and told to rest a little longer, until the number would be complete both of their fellow servants and of their brothers and sisters who were soon to be killed as they themselves had been killed.*

12 When he broke the sixth seal, I looked, and there was a great earthquake; the sun became black as sackcloth, the full moon became like

blood,* ¹³and the stars of the sky fell to the earth as the fig tree drops its winter fruit when shaken by a gale.* ¹⁴The sky vanished like a scroll rolling itself up, and every mountain and island was removed from its place.* ¹⁵Then the kings of the earth and the magnates and the generals and the rich and the powerful and everyone, slave and free, hid in the caves and among the rocks of the mountains,* ¹⁶calling to the mountains and rocks, “Fall on us and hide us from the face of the one seated on the throne and from the wrath of the Lamb,* ¹⁷for the great day of their^w wrath has come, and who is able to stand?”*

Revelation 7

THE 144,000 OF ISRAEL SEALED

1 After this I saw four angels standing at the four corners of the earth, holding back the four winds of the earth so that no wind could blow on earth or sea or against any tree.* **2**I saw another angel ascending from the rising of the sun, with the seal of the living God, and he called with a loud voice to the four angels who had been given power to damage earth and sea, **3**saying, “Do not damage the earth or the sea or the trees, until we have marked the servants of our God with a seal on their foreheads.”*

4 And I heard the number of those who were sealed, one hundred forty-four thousand, sealed out of every tribe of the people of Israel:*

5From the tribe of Judah twelve thousand sealed,
from the tribe of Reuben twelve thousand,
from the tribe of Gad twelve thousand,
6from the tribe of Asher twelve thousand,
from the tribe of Naphtali twelve thousand,
from the tribe of Manasseh twelve thousand,
7from the tribe of Simeon twelve thousand,
from the tribe of Levi twelve thousand,
from the tribe of Issachar twelve thousand,
8from the tribe of Zebulun twelve thousand,
from the tribe of Joseph twelve thousand,
from the tribe of Benjamin twelve thousand sealed.

THE MULTITUDE FROM EVERY NATION

9 After this I looked, and there was a great multitude that no one could count, from every nation, from all tribes and peoples and languages, standing before the throne and before the Lamb, robed in white, with palm branches in their hands.* **10**They cried out in a loud voice, saying,

“Salvation belongs to our God who is seated on the throne and to the Lamb!”*

¹¹And all the angels stood around the throne and around the elders and the four living creatures, and they fell on their faces before the throne and worshiped God, ¹²singing,

“Amen! Blessing and glory and wisdom

and thanksgiving and honor

and power and might

be to our God forever and ever! Amen.”*

13 Then one of the elders addressed me, saying, “Who are these, robed in white, and where have they come from?” ¹⁴I said to him, “Sir, you are the one who knows.” Then he said to me, “These are they who have come out of the great ordeal; they have washed their robes and made them white in the blood of the Lamb.*

¹⁵For this reason they are before the throne of God
and worship him day and night within his temple,
and the one who is seated on the throne will shelter them.*

¹⁶They will hunger no more and thirst no more;
the sun will not strike them,
nor any scorching heat,*

¹⁷for the Lamb at the center of the throne will be their shepherd,
and he will guide them to springs of the water of life,
and God will wipe away every tear from their eyes.”*

Revelation 8

THE SEVENTH SEAL AND THE GOLDEN CENSER

1 When the Lamb broke the seventh seal, there was silence in heaven for about half an hour.* **2** And I saw the seven angels who stand before God, and seven trumpets were given to them.*

3 Another angel with a golden censer came and stood at the altar; he was given a great quantity of incense to offer with the prayers of all the saints on the golden altar that is before the throne.* **4** And the smoke of the incense, with the prayers of the saints, rose before God from the hand of the angel.* **5** Then the angel took the censer and filled it with fire from the altar and threw it on the earth, and there were peals of thunder, rumblings, flashes of lightning, and an earthquake.*

THE SEVEN TRUMPETS

6 Now the seven angels who had the seven trumpets made ready to blow them.*

7 The first angel blew his trumpet, and there came hail and fire, mixed with blood, and they were hurled to the earth, and a third of the earth was burned up, and a third of the trees were burned up, and all green grass was burned up.*

8 The second angel blew his trumpet, and something like a great mountain, burning with fire, was thrown into the sea.* **9** A third of the sea became blood, a third of the living creatures in the sea died, and a third of the ships were destroyed.

10 The third angel blew his trumpet, and a great star fell from heaven, blazing like a torch, and it fell on a third of the rivers and on the springs of water.* **11** The name of the star is Wormwood. A third of the waters became wormwood, and many died from the water because it was made bitter.*

12 The fourth angel blew his trumpet, and a third of the sun was struck, and a third of the moon, and a third of the stars, so that a third of their light

was darkened; a third of the day was kept from shining and likewise the night.*

13 Then I looked, and I heard an eagle crying with a loud voice as it flew in midheaven, “Woe, woe, woe to the inhabitants of the earth, at the blasts of the other trumpets that the three angels are about to blow!”*

Revelation 9

1 And the fifth angel blew his trumpet, and I saw a star that had fallen from heaven to earth, and he was given the key to the shaft of the bottomless pit; ^{*}
²he opened the shaft of the bottomless pit, and from the shaft rose smoke like the smoke of a great furnace, and the sun and the air were darkened with the smoke from the shaft. ^{*} ³Then from the smoke came locusts on the earth, and they were given authority like the authority of scorpions of the earth. ^{*} ⁴They were told not to damage the grass of the earth or any green growth or any tree, but only those people who do not have the seal of God on their foreheads. ^{*} ⁵They were allowed to torment them for five months but not to kill them, and the agony suffered was like that caused by a scorpion when it stings someone. ^{*} ⁶And in those days people will seek death but will not find it; they will long to die, but death will flee from them. ^{*}

7 In appearance the locusts were like horses equipped for battle. On their heads were what looked like crowns of gold; their faces were like human faces, ^{*} ⁸their hair like women's hair, and their teeth like lions' teeth; ^{*} ⁹they had scales like iron breastplates, and the noise of their wings was like the noise of many chariots with horses rushing into battle. ^{*} ¹⁰They have tails like scorpions, with stingers, and in their tails is their power to harm people for five months. ¹¹They have as king over them the angel of the bottomless pit; his name in Hebrew is Abaddon,^y and in Greek he is called Apollyon.^{z,*}

12 The first woe has passed. There are still two woes to come. ^{*}

13 Then the sixth angel blew his trumpet, and I heard a voice from the horns^a of the golden altar before God, ^{*} ¹⁴saying to the sixth angel who had the trumpet, "Release the four angels who are bound at the great River Euphrates."^{*} ¹⁵So the four angels were released, who had been held ready for the hour, the day, the month, and the year, to kill a third of humankind. ¹⁶The number of the troops of cavalry was two hundred million; I heard their number. ^{*} ¹⁷And this was how I saw the horses in my vision: the riders wore breastplates the color of fire and of sapphire^b and of sulfur; the heads of the horses were like lions' heads, and fire and smoke and sulfur came out

of their mouths.* ¹⁸By these three plagues a third of humankind was killed, by the fire and smoke and sulfur coming out of the horses' ^c mouths. ¹⁹For the power of the horses is in their mouths and in their tails; their tails are like serpents, with heads, and with them they inflict harm.

20 The rest of humankind, who were not killed by these plagues, did not repent of the works of their hands or give up worshiping demons and idols of gold and silver and bronze and stone and wood, which cannot see or hear or walk.* ²¹And they did not repent of their murders or their sorceries or their prostitution or their thefts.

Revelation 10

THE ANGEL WITH THE LITTLE SCROLL

1 And I saw another mighty angel coming down from heaven, wrapped in a cloud, with a rainbow over his head; his face was like the sun and his legs like pillars of fire.* **2**He held a little scroll open in his hand. Setting his right foot on the sea and his left foot on the land, **3**he gave a great shout, like a lion roaring. And when he shouted, the seven thunders sounded.* **4**And when the seven thunders had sounded, I was about to write, but I heard a voice from heaven saying, “Seal up what the seven thunders have said, and do not write it down.”* **5**Then the angel whom I saw standing on the sea and the land

raised his right hand to heaven*

6and swore by him who lives forever and ever, who created heaven and what is in it, the earth and what is in it, and the sea and what is in it: “There will be no more delay,* **7**but in the days when the seventh angel is to blow his trumpet, the mystery of God will be fulfilled, as he announced to his servants the prophets.”*

8 Then the voice that I had heard from heaven spoke to me again, saying, “Go, take the scroll that is open in the hand of the angel who is standing on the sea and on the land.” **9**So I went to the angel and told him to give me the little scroll, and he said to me, “Take it and eat; it will be bitter to your stomach but sweet as honey in your mouth.”* **10**So I took the little scroll from the hand of the angel and ate it; it was sweet as honey in my mouth, but when I had eaten it my stomach was made bitter.*

11 Then they said to me, “You must prophesy again about many peoples and nations and languages and kings.”

Revelation 11

THE TWO WITNESSES

1 Then I was given a measuring rod like a staff, and I was told, “Come and measure the temple of God and the altar and those who worship there,^{*} **2**but do not measure the court outside the temple; leave that out, for it is given over to the nations, and they will trample over the holy city for forty-two months.^{*} **3**And I will grant my two witnesses authority to prophesy for one thousand two hundred sixty days, wearing sackcloth.”^{*}

4 These are the two olive trees and the two lampstands that stand before the Lord of the earth.^{*} **5**And if anyone wants to harm them, fire pours from their mouth and consumes their foes; anyone who wants to harm them must be killed in this manner.^{*} **6**They have authority to shut the sky, so that no rain may fall during the days of their prophesying, and they have authority over the waters to turn them into blood and to strike the earth with every kind of plague, as often as they desire.^{*}

7 When they have finished their testimony, the beast that comes up from the bottomless pit will wage war on them and conquer them and kill them,^{*} **8**and their dead bodies will lie in the street of the great city that is prophetically^d called Sodom and Egypt, where also their Lord was crucified.^{*} **9**For three and a half days members of the peoples and tribes and languages and nations will gaze at their dead bodies and refuse to let them be placed in a tomb,¹⁰and the inhabitants of the earth will gloat over them and celebrate and exchange presents, because these two prophets tormented the inhabitants of the earth.^{*}

11 But after the three and a half days, the breath^e of life from God entered the two witnesses,^f and they stood on their feet, and those who saw them were terrified.^{*} **12**Then they^g heard a loud voice from heaven saying to them, “Come up here!” And they went up to heaven in a cloud while their enemies watched them.^{*} **13**At that moment there was a great earthquake, and a tenth of the city fell; seven thousand people were killed in the earthquake, and the rest were terrified and gave glory to the God of heaven.^{*}

14 The second woe has passed. The third woe is coming very soon.*

THE SEVENTH TRUMPET

15 Then the seventh angel blew his trumpet, and there were loud voices in heaven, saying,

“The kingdom of the world has become the kingdom of our Lord
and of his Messiah,^h
and he will reign forever and ever.”*

16 Then the twenty-four elders who sit on their thrones before God fell on their faces and worshiped God,* ¹⁷singing,

“We give you thanks, Lord God Almighty,
who are and who were,
for you have taken your great power
and begun to reign.*

¹⁸The nations raged,
but your wrath has come,
and the time for judging the dead,
for rewarding your servants, the prophets
and saints and all who fear your name,
both small and great,
and for destroying those who destroy the earth.”*

19 Then God’s temple in heaven was opened, and the ark of his covenant was seen within his temple, and there were flashes of lightning, rumblings, peals of thunder, an earthquake, and heavy hail.*

Revelation 12

THE WOMAN AND THE DRAGON

1 A great portent appeared in heaven: a woman clothed with the sun, with the moon under her feet, and on her head a crown of twelve stars. ²She was pregnant and was crying out in birth pangs, in the agony of giving birth.*
³Then another portent appeared in heaven: a great red dragon, with seven heads and ten horns and seven diadems on his heads.* ⁴His tail swept down a third of the stars of heaven and threw them to the earth. Then the dragon stood before the woman who was about to deliver a child, so that he might devour her child as soon as it was born.* ⁵And she gave birth to a son, a male child, who is to ruleⁱ all the nations with a scepter of iron. But her child was snatched away and taken to God and to his throne,* ⁶and the woman fled into the wilderness, where she has a place prepared by God, so that there she can be nourished for one thousand two hundred sixty days.*

MICHAEL DEFEATS THE DRAGON

7 And war broke out in heaven; Michael and his angels fought against the dragon. The dragon and his angels fought back,* ⁸but they were defeated, and there was no longer any place for them in heaven. ⁹The great dragon was thrown down, that ancient serpent, who is called the devil and Satan, the deceiver of the whole world—he was thrown down to the earth, and his angels were thrown down with him.*

10 Then I heard a loud voice in heaven proclaiming,

“Now have come the salvation and the power

and the kingdom of our God

and the authority of his Messiah,^j

for the accuser of our brothers and sisters has been thrown down,

who accuses them day and night before our God.*

¹¹But they have conquered him by the blood of the Lamb
and by the word of their testimony,

for they did not cling to life even in the face of death.*

¹²Rejoice then, you heavens

and those who dwell in them!

But woe to the earth and the sea,

for the devil has come down to you

with great wrath

because he knows that his time is short!”*

THE DRAGON FIGHTS AGAIN ON EARTH

13 So when the dragon saw that he had been thrown down to the earth, he pursued^k the woman who had delivered the male child. ¹⁴But the woman was given the two wings of the great eagle, so that she could fly from the serpent into the wilderness, to her place where she is nourished for a time, and times, and half a time.* ¹⁵Then from his mouth the serpent poured water like a river after the woman, to sweep her away with the flood.* ¹⁶But the earth came to the help of the woman; it opened its mouth and swallowed the river that the dragon had poured from his mouth. ¹⁷Then the dragon was angry with the woman and went off to wage war on the rest of her children, those who keep the commandments of God and hold the testimony of Jesus.*

THE FIRST BEAST

18 Then the dragon^l took his stand on the sand of the seashore.

Revelation 13

1 And I saw a beast rising out of the sea, with ten horns and seven heads, and on its horns were ten diadems, and on its heads were blasphemous names.* **2** And the beast that I saw was like a leopard, its feet were like a bear's, and its mouth was like a lion's mouth. And the dragon gave it his power and his throne and great authority.* **3** One of its heads seemed to have received a death blow, but its fatal wound^m had been healed. In amazement the whole earth followed the beast.* **4** They worshiped the dragon, for he had given his authority to the beast, and they worshiped the beast, saying, "Who is like the beast, and who can fight against it?"*

5 The beast was given a mouth speaking arrogant and blasphemous words, and it was allowed to exercise authority for forty-two months.* **6** It opened its mouth to speak blasphemies against God, blaspheming his name and his dwelling, that is, those who dwell in heaven. **7** Also, it was allowed to wage war on the saints and to conquer them.ⁿ It was given authority over every tribe and people and language and nation,* **8** and all the inhabitants of the earth will worship it, everyone whose name has not been written from the foundation of the world in the book of life of the Lamb that was slaughtered.^{o,*}

9 Let anyone who has an ear listen:

¹⁰If you are to be taken captive,
into captivity you go;
if you kill with the sword,
with the sword you must be killed.

Here is a call for the endurance and faith of the saints.*

THE SECOND BEAST

11 Then I saw another beast that rose out of the earth; it had two horns like a lamb, and it spoke like a dragon. **12** It exercises all the authority of the first beast on its behalf, and it makes the earth and its inhabitants worship the first beast, whose fatal wound^p had been healed. **13** It performs great

signs, even making fire come down from heaven to earth in the sight of all,*
¹⁴and by the signs that it is allowed to perform on behalf of the beast it
deceives the inhabitants of earth, telling them to make an image for the
beast that had been wounded by the sword^q and yet lived,* ¹⁵and it was
allowed to give breath^r to the image of the beast so that the image of the
beast could even speak and cause those who would not worship the image
of the beast to be killed. ¹⁶Also, it causes all, both small and great, both rich
and poor, both free and slave, to be given a brand on the right hand or the
forehead,* ¹⁷so that no one can buy or sell who does not have the brand, that
is, the name of the beast or the number for its name.* ¹⁸This calls for
wisdom: let anyone with understanding calculate the number of the beast,
for it is the number for a person. Its number is six hundred sixty-six.^{s,*}

Revelation 14

THE LAMB AND THE 144,000

1 Then I looked, and there was the Lamb, standing on Mount Zion! And with him were one hundred forty-four thousand who had his name and his Father's name written on their foreheads.* **2** And I heard a voice from heaven like the sound of many waters and like the sound of loud thunder; the voice I heard was like the sound of harpists playing on their harps,* **3** and they sing a new song before the throne and before the four living creatures and before the elders. No one could learn that song except the one hundred forty-four thousand who have been redeemed from the earth. **4** It is these who have not defiled themselves with women, for they are virgins; these follow the Lamb wherever he goes. They have been redeemed from humankind as first fruits for God and the Lamb,* **5** and in their mouth no lie was found; they are blameless.*

THE MESSAGES OF THE THREE ANGELS

6 Then I saw another angel flying in midheaven, with an eternal gospel to proclaim to those who live^t on the earth—to every nation and tribe and language and people.* **7** He said in a loud voice, “Fear God and give him glory, for the hour of his judgment has come, and worship him who made heaven and earth, the sea and the springs of water.”*

8 Then another angel, a second, followed, saying, “Fallen, fallen is Babylon the great! She has made all nations drink of the wine of the wrath of her prostitution.”*

9 Then another angel, a third, followed them, crying with a loud voice, “Those who worship the beast and its image and receive the brand on their foreheads or on their hands,* **10** they will also drink the wine of God's wrath, poured unmixed into the cup of his anger, and they will be tormented with fire and sulfur in the presence of the holy angels and in the presence of the Lamb.* **11** And the smoke of their torment goes up forever and ever. There is no rest day or night for those who worship the beast and its image and for anyone who receives the brand of its name.”*

12 Here is a call for the endurance of the saints, those who keep the commandments of God and hold fast to the faith of^u Jesus.*

13 And I heard a voice from heaven saying, “Write this: Blessed are the dead who from now on die in the Lord.” “Yes,”^v says the Spirit, “they will rest from their labors, for their deeds follow them.”*

REAPING THE EARTH’S HARVEST

14 Then I looked, and there was a white cloud, and seated on the cloud was one like the Son of Man, with a golden crown on his head and a sharp sickle in his hand! * ¹⁵ Another angel came out of the temple, calling with a loud voice to the one who sat on the cloud, “Use your sickle and reap, for the hour to reap has come, because the harvest of the earth is fully ripe.”* ¹⁶ So the one who sat on the cloud swung his sickle over the earth, and the earth was reaped.

17 Then another angel came out of the temple in heaven, and he, too, had a sharp sickle. ¹⁸ Then another angel came out from the altar, the angel who has authority over fire, and he called with a loud voice to him who had the sharp sickle, “Use your sharp sickle and gather the clusters of the vine of the earth, for its grapes are ripe.”* ¹⁹ So the angel swung his sickle over the earth and gathered the vintage of the earth, and he threw it into the great winepress of the wrath of God. ²⁰ And the winepress was trodden outside the city, and blood flowed from the winepress, as high as a horse’s bridle, for a distance of about one thousand six hundred stadia.*

Revelation 15

THE ANGELS WITH THE SEVEN LAST PLAGUES

1 Then I saw another portent in heaven, great and amazing: seven angels with seven plagues, which are the last, for with them the wrath of God is ended.*

2 And I saw what appeared to be a sea of glass mixed with fire and those who had conquered the beast and its image and the number of its name standing beside the sea of glass with harps of God in their hands.* **3** And they sing the song of Moses, the servant of God, and the song of the Lamb:

“Great and amazing are your deeds,

Lord God the Almighty!

Just and true are your ways,

King of the nations!^{w,*}

4 Lord, who will not fear

and glorify your name?

For you alone are holy.

All nations will come

and worship before you,

for your judgments have been revealed.”*

5 After this I looked, and the temple of the tent^x of witness in heaven was opened, **6**and out of the temple came the seven angels with the seven plagues, robed in pure bright linen,^y with golden sashes across their chests. **7**Then one of the four living creatures gave the seven angels seven golden bowls full of the wrath of God, who lives forever and ever;* **8**and the temple was filled with smoke from the glory of God and from his power, and no one could enter the temple until the seven plagues of the seven angels were ended.*

Revelation 16

THE BOWLS OF GOD'S WRATH

1 Then I heard a loud voice from the temple telling the seven angels, “Go and pour out on the earth the seven bowls of the wrath of God.”*

2 So the first angel went and poured his bowl on the earth, and a foul and painful sore came on those who had the brand of the beast and who worshiped its image.*

3 The second angel poured his bowl into the sea, and it became like the blood of a corpse, and every living thing in the sea died.*

4 The third angel poured his bowl into the rivers and the springs of water, and they became blood.* ⁵And I heard the angel of the waters say,

“You are just, O Holy One, who are and were,

for you have judged these things;*

⁶because they shed the blood of saints and prophets,
you have given them blood to drink.

It is what they deserve!”

⁷And I heard the altar respond,

“Yes, O Lord God, the Almighty,

your judgments are true and just!”*

8 The fourth angel poured his bowl on the sun, and it was allowed to scorch people with fire; ⁹they were scorched by the fierce heat, but they cursed the name of God, who had authority over these plagues, and they did not repent and give him glory.*

10 The fifth angel poured his bowl on the throne of the beast, and its kingdom was plunged into darkness; people gnawed their tongues in agony ¹¹and cursed the God of heaven because of their pains and sores, and they did not repent of their deeds.

12 The sixth angel poured his bowl on the great River Euphrates, and its water was dried up in order to prepare the way for the kings from the east.*

¹³And I saw three foul spirits like frogs coming from the mouth of the dragon, from the mouth of the beast, and from the mouth of the false prophet.* ¹⁴These are demonic spirits, performing signs, who go abroad to the kings of the whole world, to assemble them for battle on the great day of God the Almighty.* ¹⁵(“See, I am coming like a thief! Blessed is the one who stays awake and is clothed,^z not going about naked and exposed to shame.”)* ¹⁶And the demonic spirits^a assembled the kings^b at the place that in Hebrew is called Harmagedon.

17 The seventh angel poured his bowl into the air, and a loud voice came out of the temple, from the throne, saying, “It is done!” ¹⁸And there came flashes of lightning, rumblings, peals of thunder, and a violent earthquake, such as had not occurred since people were upon the earth, so violent was that earthquake.* ¹⁹The great city was split into three parts, and the cities of the nations fell. God remembered great Babylon and gave her the wine cup of the fury of his wrath.* ²⁰And every island fled away, and no mountains were to be found, ²¹and huge hailstones, each weighing about a hundred pounds,^c dropped from heaven on people, until they cursed God for the plague of the hail, so fearful was that plague.*

Revelation 17

THE GREAT WHORE AND THE BEAST

1 Then one of the seven angels who had the seven bowls came and said to me, “Come, I will show you the judgment of the great whore^d who is seated on many waters,* ²with whom the kings of the earth have engaged in sexual immorality^e and with the wine of whose prostitution the inhabitants of the earth have become drunk.”* ³So he carried me away in the spirit^f into a wilderness, and I saw a woman sitting on a scarlet beast that was full of blasphemous names, and it had seven heads and ten horns.* ⁴The woman was clothed in purple and scarlet and adorned with gold and jewels and pearls, holding in her hand a golden cup full of abominations and the impurities of her prostitution,* ⁵and on her forehead was written a name, a mystery: “Babylon the great, mother^g of whores^h and of earth’s abominations.”* ⁶And I saw that the woman was drunk with the blood of the saints and the blood of the witnesses to Jesus.

When I saw her, I was greatly amazed.* ⁷But the angel said to me, “Why are you so amazed? I will tell you the mystery of the woman and of the beast with seven heads and ten horns that carries her. ⁸The beast that you saw was and is not and is about to ascend from the bottomless pit and go to destruction. And the inhabitants of the earth, whose names have not been written in the book of life from the foundation of the world, will be amazed when they see the beast, because it was and is not and is to come.*

9 “This calls for a mind that has wisdom: the seven heads are seven mountains on which the woman is seated; also, they are seven kings,* ¹⁰of whom five have fallen, one is living, and the other has not yet come, and when he comes he must remain only a little while. ¹¹As for the beast that was and is not, it is an eighth, but it belongs to the seven, and it goes to destruction. ¹²And the ten horns that you saw are ten kings who have not yet received a kingdom, but they are to receive authority as kings for one hour, together with the beast.* ¹³These are united in yielding their power and authority to the beast; ¹⁴they will wage war on the Lamb, and the Lamb

will conquer them, for he is Lord of lords and King of kings, and those with him are called and chosen and faithful.”*

15 And he said to me, “The waters that you saw, where the whoreⁱ is seated, are peoples and multitudes and nations and languages.* ¹⁶And the ten horns that you saw, they and the beast will hate the whore;^j they will make her desolate and naked; they will devour her flesh and burn her up with fire.* ¹⁷For God has put it into their hearts to carry out his purpose by agreeing to give their kingdom to the beast, until the words of God will be fulfilled.* ¹⁸The woman you saw is the great city that rules over the kings of the earth.”*

Revelation 18

THE FALL OF BABYLON

1 After this I saw another angel coming down from heaven, having great authority, and the earth was illumined by his splendor.* **2**He called out with a mighty voice,

“Fallen, fallen is Babylon the great!

It has become a dwelling place of demons,

a haunt of every foul spirit,

a haunt of every foul bird,

a haunt of every foul and hateful beast.^{k,*}

3For all the nations have fallen^l

from the wine of the wrath of her prostitution,

and the kings of the earth have engaged in sexual immorality^m
with her,

and the merchants of the earth have grown rich from the
powerⁿ of her luxury.”*

4 Then I heard another voice from heaven saying,

“Come out of her, my people,

so that you do not take part in her sins

and so that you do not share in her plagues,*

5for her sins are heaped high as heaven,

and God has remembered her iniquities.*

6Render to her as she herself has rendered,

and repay her double for her deeds;

mix a double dose for her in the cup she mixed.*

7As she glorified herself and lived luxuriously,

so give her a like measure of torment and grief.

Since in her heart she says,

‘I rule as a queen;
I am no widow,
and I will never see grief,’^{*}
⁸therefore her plagues will come in a single day —
pestilence and mourning and famine —
and she will be burned with fire,
for mighty is the Lord God who judges her.”^{*}

9 And the kings of the earth, who engaged in sexual immorality^o and lived in luxury with her, will weep and wail over her when they see the smoke of her burning;^{*} ¹⁰they will stand far off, in fear of her torment, and say,

“Alas, alas, the great city,
Babylon, the mighty city!
For in one hour your judgment has come.”^{*}

11 And the merchants of the earth weep and mourn for her, since no one buys their cargo any more, ¹²cargo of gold, silver, jewels and pearls, fine linen, purple, silk and scarlet, all kinds of scented wood, all articles of ivory, all articles of costly wood, bronze, iron, and marble,^{*} ¹³cinnamon, spice, incense, myrrh, frankincense, wine, olive oil, choice flour and wheat, cattle and sheep, horses and chariots, slaves — and human lives.^{p,*}

¹⁴“The fruit for which your soul longed
has gone from you,
and all your delicacies and your splendor
are lost to you,
never to be found again!”

¹⁵The merchants of these wares, who grew wealthy from her, will stand far off, in fear of her torment, weeping and mourning aloud,^{*}

¹⁶“Alas, alas, the great city,
clothed in fine linen,
in purple and scarlet,
adorned with gold,

with jewels, and with pearls!*

¹⁷For in one hour all this wealth has been laid waste!”

And all shipmasters and seafarers, sailors and all whose trade is on the sea, stood far off* ¹⁸and cried out as they saw the smoke of her burning,

“What city was like the great city?”*

¹⁹And they threw dust on their heads as they wept and mourned, crying out,

“Alas, alas, the great city,

where all who had ships at sea

grew rich by her wealth!

For in one hour she has been laid waste.”*

20 Rejoice over her, O heaven, you saints and apostles and prophets! For God has condemned her condemnation of you.*

21 Then a mighty angel took up a stone like a great millstone and threw it into the sea, saying,

“With such violence Babylon the great city

will be thrown down

and will be found no more;*

²²and the sound of harpists and entertainers and of flutists and trumpeters

will be heard in you no more,

and an artisan of any trade

will be found in you no more,

and the sound of the millstone

will be heard in you no more,*

²³and the light of a lamp

will shine in you no more,

and the voice of bridegroom and bride

will be heard in you no more,

for your merchants were the magnates of the earth,

and all nations were deceived by your sorcery.*

²⁴And in you⁹ was found the blood of prophets and of saints
and of all who have been slaughtered on earth.”*

Revelation 19

THE REJOICING IN HEAVEN

1 After this I heard what seemed to be the loud voice of a great multitude in heaven, saying,

“Hallelujah!

Salvation and glory and power to our God,*

²for his judgments are true and just;

he has judged the great whore^r

who corrupted the earth with her prostitution,

and he has avenged on her the blood of his servants.”*

³Once more they said,

“Hallelujah!

The smoke goes up from her forever and ever.”*

⁴And the twenty-four elders and the four living creatures fell down and worshiped God who is seated on the throne, saying,

“Amen. Hallelujah!”*

5 And from the throne came a voice saying,

“Praise our God,

all you his servants

and^s all who fear him,

small and great.”*

⁶Then I heard what seemed to be the voice of a great multitude, like the sound of many waters and like the sound of mighty thunderpeals, crying out,

“Hallelujah!

For the Lord^t God

the Almighty reigns.*

⁷Let us rejoice and exult

and give him the glory,
for the marriage of the Lamb has come,
and his bride has made herself ready;^{*}
⁸to her it has been granted to be clothed
with fine linen, bright and pure”—
for the fine linen is the righteous deeds of the saints.^{*}

9 And the angel said^u to me, “Write this: Blessed are those who are invited to the marriage supper of the Lamb.” And he said to me, “These are true words of God.”^{*} ¹⁰Then I fell down at his feet to worship him, but he said to me, “You must not do that! I am a fellow servant with you and your brothers and sisters who hold the testimony of Jesus.^v Worship God! For the testimony of Jesus^w is the spirit of prophecy.”^{*}

THE RIDER ON THE WHITE HORSE

11 Then I saw heaven opened, and there was a white horse! Its rider is called Faithful and True, and in righteousness he judges and wages war.^{*} ¹²His eyes are like^x a flame of fire, and on his head are many diadems, and he has a name inscribed that no one knows but himself.^{*} ¹³He is clothed in a robe dipped in^y blood, and his name is called The Word of God.^{*} ¹⁴And the armies of heaven, wearing fine linen, white and pure, were following him on white horses. ¹⁵From his mouth comes a sharp sword with which to strike down the nations, and he will rule^z them with a scepter of iron; he will tread the winepress of the fury of the wrath of God the Almighty.^{*} ¹⁶On his robe and on his thigh he has a name inscribed, “King of kings and Lord of lords.”^{*}

THE BEAST AND ITS ARMIES DEFEATED

17 Then I saw an angel standing in the sun, and with a loud voice he called to all the birds that fly in midheaven, “Come, gather for the great supper of God,^{*} ¹⁸to eat the flesh of kings, the flesh of captains, the flesh of the mighty, the flesh of horses and their riders—flesh of all, both free and slave, both small and great.”^{*} ¹⁹Then I saw the beast and the kings of the earth with their armies gathered to wage war against the rider on the horse

and against his army.* ²⁰And the beast was captured, and with it the false prophet who had performed in its presence the signs by which he deceived those who had received the brand of the beast and those who worshiped its image. These two were thrown alive into the lake of fire that burns with sulfur. ²¹And the rest were killed by the sword of the rider on the horse, the sword that came from his mouth, and all the birds were gorged with their flesh.

Revelation 20

THE THOUSAND YEARS

1 Then I saw an angel coming down from heaven, holding in his hand the key to the bottomless pit and a great chain. **2**He seized the dragon, that ancient serpent, who is the devil and Satan, and bound him for a thousand years* **3**and threw him into the pit and locked and sealed it over him, so that he would deceive the nations no more, until the thousand years were ended. After that he must be let out for a little while.*

4 Then I saw thrones, and those seated on them were given authority to judge. I also saw the souls of those who had been beheaded for their testimony to Jesus^a and for the word of God. They had not worshiped the beast or its image and had not received its brand on their foreheads or their hands. They came to life and reigned with Christ a thousand years.* **5**(The rest of the dead did not come to life until the thousand years were ended.) This is the first resurrection. **6**Blessed and holy are those who share in the first resurrection. Over these the second death has no power, but they will be priests of God and of Christ, and they will reign with him a thousand years.*

SATAN'S DOOM

7 When the thousand years are ended, Satan will be released from his prison ⁸and will come out to deceive the nations at the four corners of the earth, Gog and Magog, in order to gather them for battle; they are as numerous as the sands of the sea.* **9**They marched up over the breadth of the earth and surrounded the camp of the saints and the beloved city. And fire came down from heaven^b and consumed them.* **10**And the devil who had deceived them was thrown into the lake of fire and sulfur, where the beast and the false prophet were, and they will be tormented day and night forever and ever.

THE DEAD ARE JUDGED

11 Then I saw a great white throne and the one who sat on it; the earth and the heaven fled from his^c presence, and no place was found for them.*

¹²And I saw the dead, great and small, standing before the throne, and books were opened. Also another book was opened, the book of life. And the dead were judged according to their works, as recorded in the books.*

¹³And the sea gave up the dead who were in it, Death and Hades gave up the dead who were in them, and all were judged according to what they had done.* ¹⁴Then Death and Hades were thrown into the lake of fire. This is the second death, the lake of fire,* ¹⁵and anyone whose name was not found written in the book of life was thrown into the lake of fire.

Revelation 21

THE NEW HEAVEN AND THE NEW EARTH

1 Then I saw a new heaven and a new earth, for the first heaven and the first earth had passed away, and the sea was no more.* **2** And I saw the holy city, the new Jerusalem, coming down out of heaven from God, prepared as a bride adorned for her husband.* **3** And I heard a loud voice from the throne saying,

“See, the home^d of God is among mortals.

He will dwell^e with them;

they will be his peoples,^f

and God himself will be with them and be their God;^{g,*}

⁴he will wipe every tear from their eyes.

Death will be no more;

mourning and crying and pain will be no more,

for^h the first things have passed away.”*

5 And the one who was seated on the throne said, “See, I am making all things new.” Also he said, “Write this, for these words are trustworthy and true.”* **6** Then he said to me, “It is done! I am the Alpha and the Omega, the Beginning and the End. To the thirsty I will give water as a gift from the spring of the water of life.* **7** Those who conquer will inherit these things, and I will be their God, and they will be my children. **8** But as for the cowardly, the faithless,ⁱ the polluted, the murderers, the sexually immoral,^j the sorcerers, the idolaters, and all liars, their place will be in the lake that burns with fire and sulfur, which is the second death.”*

VISION OF THE NEW JERUSALEM

9 Then one of the seven angels who had the seven bowls full of the seven last plagues came and said to me, “Come, I will show you the bride, the wife of the Lamb.”* **10** And in the spirit^k he carried me away to a great, high mountain and showed me the holy city Jerusalem coming down out of

heaven from God.* ¹¹It has the glory of God and a radiance like a very rare jewel, like jasper, clear as crystal.* ¹²It has a great, high wall with twelve gates, and at the gates twelve angels, and on the gates are inscribed the names that are the names¹ of the twelve tribes of the Israelites: * ¹³on the east three gates, on the north three gates, on the south three gates, and on the west three gates. ¹⁴And the wall of the city has twelve foundations, and on them are the twelve names of the twelve apostles of the Lamb.*

15 The angel^m who talked to me had a measuring rod of gold to measure the city and its gates and walls.* ¹⁶The city has four equal sides, its length the same as its width, and he measured the city with his rod, twelve thousand stadia; its length and width and height are equal. ¹⁷He also measured its wall, one hundred forty-four cubits by human measurement, which the angel was using. ¹⁸The wall is built of jasper, while the city is pure gold, clear as glass. ¹⁹The foundations of the wall of the city are adorned with every jewel; the first was jasper, the second sapphire, the third agate, the fourth emerald, ²⁰the fifth onyx, the sixth carnelian, the seventh chrysolite, the eighth beryl, the ninth topaz, the tenth chrysoprase, the eleventh jacinth, the twelfth amethyst. ²¹And the twelve gates are twelve pearls, each of the gates is a single pearl, and the street of the city is pure gold, transparent as glass.

22 I saw no temple in the city, for its temple is the Lord God the Almighty and the Lamb. ²³And the city has no need of sun or moon to shine on it, for the glory of God is its light, and its lamp is the Lamb.* ²⁴The nations will walk by its light, and the kings of the earth will bring their glory into it.* ²⁵Its gates will never be shut by day—and there will be no night there.* ²⁶People will bring into it the glory and the honor of the nations. ²⁷But nothing unclean will enter it, nor anyone who practices abomination or falsehood, but only those who are written in the Lamb's book of life.*

Revelation 22

THE RIVER OF LIFE

1 Then the angelⁿ showed me the river of the water of life, bright as crystal, flowing from the throne of God and of the Lamb^{*} **2**through the middle of the street of the city. On either side of the river is the tree of life^o with its twelve kinds of fruit, producing its fruit each month, and the leaves of the tree are for the healing of the nations.^{*} **3**Nothing accursed will be found there any more. But the throne of God and of the Lamb will be in it, and his servants will worship him;^{*} **4**they will see his face, and his name will be on their foreheads.^{*} **5**And there will be no more night; they need no light of lamp or sun, for the Lord God will be their light, and they will reign forever and ever.^{*}

6 And he said to me, “These words are trustworthy and true, for the Lord, the God of the spirits of the prophets, has sent his angel to show his servants what must soon take place.”^{*}

7 “See, I am coming soon! Blessed is the one who keeps the words of the prophecy of this book.”^{*}

EPILOGUE AND BENEDICTION

8 I, John, am the one who heard and saw these things. And when I heard and saw them, I fell down to worship at the feet of the angel who showed them to me,⁹ but he said to me, “You must not do that! I am a fellow servant with you and your brothers and sisters the prophets and with those who keep the words of this book. Worship God!”

10 And he said to me, “Do not seal up the words of the prophecy of this book, for the time is near. ¹¹Let the evildoer still do evil, and the filthy still be filthy, and the righteous still do right, and the holy still be holy.”^{*}

12 “See, I am coming soon; my reward is with me, to repay according to everyone’s work.^{*} ¹³I am the Alpha and the Omega, the First and the Last, the Beginning and the End.”

14 Blessed are those who wash their robes,^p so that they will have the right to the tree of life and may enter the city by the gates. ¹⁵Outside are the dogs and sorcerers and sexually immoral^q and murderers and idolaters and everyone who loves and practices falsehood.*

16 “It is I, Jesus, who sent my angel to you with this testimony for the churches. I am the root and the descendant of David, the bright morning star.”*

¹⁷The Spirit and the bride say, “Come.”

And let everyone who hears say, “Come.”

And let everyone who is thirsty come.

Let anyone who wishes take the water of life as a gift.*

18 I warn everyone who hears the words of the prophecy of this book: if anyone adds to them, God will add to that person the plagues described in this book;* ¹⁹if anyone takes away from the words of the book of this prophecy, God will take away that person’s share in the tree of life and in the holy city, which are described in this book.

20 The one who testifies to these things says, “Surely I am coming soon.”

Amen. Come, Lord Jesus!*

21 The grace of the Lord Jesus be with all the saints. Amen.^r